P2JW192000-7-A00100-16DDF61078D

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp * * * * * * *

FRIDAY, JULY 11, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVI NO. 9

WSJ.com

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What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Aggressive recruiting** by private-equity firms has prompted a crackdown at big banks fed up with the poaching of their young employees. **B1**

◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** turned higher after early weakness, with the S&P 500 and Nasdaq closing at records, up 0.3% and 0.1%, respectively. The Dow rose 0.4%. **B9**

◆ **OPEC doubled down** on its view that global oil demand will keep rising through midcentury and that there is no peak in sight. **B9**

◆ **Wells Fargo plans to end** a credit-card partnership with Bilt that lets people earn rewards points for charging their rent after it became a money-losing venture. **B5**

◆ **Delta Air Lines shares** jumped 12% as the carrier expressed confidence after a tough first half and forecast a stronger third quarter than analysts had expected. **B1**

◆ **Conagra said it expects** organic sales to remain stagnant as the food company reported lower sales for its fiscal fourth quarter. **B3**

◆ **WPP named** Microsoft executive Cindy Rose as its new chief executive as the advertising firm grapples with challenges from AI and seeks to halt client losses. **B3**

◆ **The EU published** the final version of a voluntary code of practice for general-purpose artificial intelligence meant to facilitate compliance with bloc legislation. **B4**

◆ **Jane Birkin's prototype** for the eponymous Hermès accessory sold for the equivalent of $10.1 million at Sotheby's Paris, setting a record for a handbag sold at auction. **B1**

World-Wide

◆ **The crisis engulfing** Boston Consulting Group over its involvement with a humanitarian project in Gaza deepened when the firm announced two senior partners were stepping down from their leadership roles in connection with the work. **A1**

◆ **Military lawyers** objected to an Israeli proposal to screen Palestinians in Gaza before moving them to a secure area, saying it could expose Israel to accusations of forced displacement. **A6**

◆ **The investigation into** last month's Air India crash is focusing on the actions of the jet's pilots and doesn't so far point to a problem with the Boeing 787 Dreamliner. **A1**

◆ **Trump's threat of a** 50% tariff on Brazilian imports expanded his use of punitive duties over matters that have nothing to do with trade. **A1**

◆ **The U.S. will put** a 35% tariff on imports from Canada effective Aug. 1, Trump said, with an exemption for goods that comply with the USMCA trade pact. **A4**

◆ **A federal judge blocked** the Trump administration from enforcing its birthright-citizenship order weeks after the Supreme Court limited sweeping injunctions in similar challenges. **A2**

◆ **Harvard leaders** have discussed creating a new center for conservative scholarship as the university fights the Trump administration's accusations that it is too liberal. **A3**

◆ **Mahmoud Khalil**, the Columbia University protester who spent over 100 days in immigration detention, filed a claim seeking $20 million from the Trump administration. **A2**

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An All-American Upset Rocks the All England Club

TOBY MELVILLE/REUTERS

SLAMMED: U.S. player Amanda Anisimova defeated Aryna Sabalenka, the world's top-ranked women's tennis player, in three sets Thursday at the Wimbledon semifinals. The 13th-seeded 23-year-old will face Poland's Iga Swiatek in Saturday's final.

Trump Employs Tariffs as Political Cudgel

Threat to hit Brazil over Bolsonaro trial marks shift from trade-based policy

President Trump's threat for a 50% tariff on Brazilian imports expanded his use of punitive duties over matters that have nothing to do with trade, breaking with more than a half-century of global economic precedent.

By Gavin Bade in Washington and Marcus Walker in Rome

Trump cited the trial of the president's close political ally, former President Jair Bolsonaro of Brazil, as the rationale for new tariffs set to take effect Aug. 1 on imports from the largest economy in Latin America.

It is the latest—and perhaps most brazen—example of Trump using tariffs as a cudgel for political priorities outside of trade. In January, he threatened tariffs on Colombia over repatriation flights for migrants back to that country. Then he imposed steep duties on Canada, Mexico and China over their role in the fentanyl trade

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◆ Canada faces new threat of 35% tariff........................ A4

Gaza Strip Food Project Spiraled Into a Crisis for Consulting Firm

Two partners to quit leadership roles as officials at BCG try to contain the fallout

By Chip Cutter And Mark Maurer

The crisis engulfing Boston Consulting Group over its involvement with a humanitarian project in Gaza deepened on Thursday when the firm said two senior partners were stepping down from their leadership roles over their connection to the work.

The firm got involved last fall in an effort that became a widely criticized Israeli-backed aid-distribution initiative. Hundreds of Palestinians seeking supplies have been killed in recent weeks after troops fired toward crowds near aid sites, according to local health authorities. The Gaza work has spiraled into the most significant crisis in BCG's roughly six-decade history.

Long-term clients are expressing outrage. Employees and BCG alumni are asking how one of the best-known corporate advisory firms got involved in Gaza in the first place.

The project began as a pro bono effort to help solve food-supply challenges in Gaza. The firm said it turned into an unauthorized project by two other partners against the firm's instructions. That work included a postwar financial model to voluntarily relocate Palestinians.

In the latest leadership shuffle, BCG's chief risk officer, Adam Farber, and the head of its social-impact practice, Rich Hutchinson, are stepping down from those roles but remain as senior partners. According to people familiar with the matter, both were aware of early phases of the work but not all the details.

Those moves follow the June firing of two partners, Matt Schlueter and Ryan Ordway, who BCG suggests essentially went rogue in the months after starting the project. Schlueter and Ordway had worked in BCG's public-sector defense and security practice before being ousted.

"In late 2024 a BCG partner misrepresented pro bono work. Months later he began a paid phase of work without authorization, and in parallel, he and another partner undertook off-the-books modeling on

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◆ Gaza relocation plan raises legal concerns..................... A6

Pilots Are Focus of Probe Into India Crash

The investigation into last month's Air India crash is focusing on the actions of the jet's pilots and doesn't so far point to a problem with the Boeing 787 Dreamliner, according to people familiar with U.S. officials' early assessments.

By Andrew Tangel, Shan Li and Krishna Pokharel

Preliminary findings indicate that switches controlling fuel flow to the jet's two engines were turned off, leading to an apparent loss of thrust shortly after takeoff, the people said. Pilots use the switches to start the jet's engines, shut them down, or reset them in certain emergencies.

The switches would normally be on during flight, and it is unclear how or why they were turned off, these people said. The people also said it was unclear whether the move

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Musk's Grok Goes Rogue, Gives Tips On Assault

By Alexander Saeedy

Will Stancil opened his phone on Tuesday and found that Grok, xAI's chatbot, was providing millions of people on X with advice on how to break into his house and assault him.

The 39-year-old attorney has a sizable following on X, where he regularly posts about urban planning and politics. Stancil, a Democrat who ran for local office in Minnesota, isn't a stranger to contentious arguments on social media with political opponents.

But on Tuesday, he found that the newest bully online was a robot: @Grok.

Artificial intelligence companies like xAI train their large language models off huge swaths of data collected from all across the internet. As the models have been applied for commercial purposes, developers have installed guardrails to prevent them from generating offensive content like child pornography or calls to violence.

But the way the models generate specific answers to questions is still poorly understood, even by the seasoned artificial intelligence researchers who build them. When small changes are made to the

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INSIDE

BUSINESS & FINANCE

The Birkin bag that started it all sells at auction at Sotheby's for $10.1 million. **B1**

VW Bus Went From Fad to Flop

Electric reboot of iconic vintage van is stunted by luxury price, trade war

By Sean McLain And Stephen Wilmot

As psychedelic rock blared, Thomas Schäfer hopped onto a Huntington Beach, Calif., stage flanked by surfboards two years ago to announce the rebirth of an automotive icon, the Volkswagen bus.

The German auto giant was bringing back the bus as an electric vehicle, albeit one with a boxy design and two-tone paint job reminiscent of the original. The reboot was more than two decades in the making, and the company said the vehicle would soon be available in the U.S.

"Finally, finally," said Schäfer, a top VW executive, as the bus they called the ID.Buzz rolled across the stage to wolf whistles from the crowd.

The reception since has been considerably less enthusiastic.

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For These Children, School Is a Walk in the Park

* * *

Moms who home school at Disney World say lessons abound; economics of piracy

By Meg Tanaka

For most children, school means crammed classrooms, soggy sandwiches and bell schedules. For some, it means doing workbooks at Cinderella Castle, writing thank-you letters to Rapunzel and grabbing fresh churros during snack break.

These are the Disney home-schoolers—parents who've swapped schoolbuses for monorails and now treat the parks as a classroom.

"We're not just doing rides and calling it school," said Haley Sisk, a former teacher who home-schools her three children, ages 5 and younger, and plans to continue for as long as the family lives nearby. "They learn to regulate emotions, speak up for themselves and interact with others. That's real learning too."

Orlando is a popular destination for what some call Disneyschooling. Hundreds of families go to the Disney World parks sev-

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No free ride

Family of 9 Flees Flood With Knife and Hymns

By Dan Frosch

HUNT, Texas—It was July 3rd and Penny Deupree's house near the Guadalupe River was crowded, just the way she preferred it.

Her son Tad and his wife had driven down from Dallas. Two of her granddaughters had joined, too, a husband and boyfriend in tow, along with two great-grandchildren, ages 1 and 3. There were nine in all, laughing, grilling and swapping stories on Penny's 1.2-acre grassy patch of paradise in the Hill Country.

At 82 years old, this is how Penny imagined the rest of her life: in this house filled with family and totems, like the portrait of her great grandmother, Frances Hodgson Burnett, who wrote the children's novel "The Secret Garden."

Around 3 a.m., Penny got up to use the bathroom. When she flushed, the toilet gurgled up at her. That was strange, she thought.

She tried to go back to sleep but the rain kept pelting the metal roof. Something told her to get up again and check the front door of the one-story house. She squinted through the darkness, still half-asleep, and couldn't believe it. "It looked like the ocean was coming into the house," Penny recalled.

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◆ U.S. struggles to get disaster alerts right......... A3

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U.S. NEWS

YUKI IWAMURA/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Mahmoud Khalil

Khalil Files $20 Million Claim Over Detention

By Victoria Albert

Mahmoud Khalil, the Columbia University protester and former graduate student who spent more than 100 days in immigration detention, is seeking $20 million from the Trump administration.

The claim, brought under the Federal Tort Claims Act, serves as a precursor to a lawsuit against the government, representatives for Khalil said Thursday. Khalil's lawyers accused the administration of carrying out a politically motivated plan to arrest, detain, and deport the green-card holder as punishment for his advocacy on the Israel-Gaza war.

"There must be accountability for political retaliation and abuse of power," Khalil said. He said he plans to use the funds to help other students targeted by the administration and by Columbia.

It is the first attempt by a student swept up in a series of high-profile arrests this spring to recover damages from the government over what advocates have characterized as an unconstitutional attempt to crack down on pro-Palestinian speech. Khalil has been released while the proceedings play out. His lawyers said he has suffered longstanding consequences from what occurred after his March 8 arrest.

Tricia McLaughlin, a spokesperson for the Department of Homeland Security, called the claim absurd, saying the administration acted within its authority to detain Khalil.

CORRECTIONS & AMPLIFICATIONS

Extreme rainfall has increased 21% since the 1950s in Texas, Oklahoma and Kansas. A U.S. News article on Thursday about intense precipitation incorrectly listed Nebraska as one of those states. Nebraska is in a region where extreme rainfall has increased 24%.

Honeywell International no longer makes home thermostats. A Business & Finance article on Wednesday about the industrial conglomerate incorrectly included thermostats in a list of the company's products.

Readers can alert The Wall Street Journal to any errors in news articles by emailing **wsjcontact@wsj.com** or by calling 888-410-2667.

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL

(USPS 664-880)
(Eastern Edition ISSN 0099-9660)
(Central Edition ISSN 1092-0935)
(Western Edition ISSN 0193-2241)

Editorial and publication headquarters: 1211 Avenue of the Americas, New York, N.Y. 10036

Published daily except Sundays and general legal holidays. Periodicals postage paid at New York, N.Y., and other mailing offices.

Postmaster: Send address changes to The Wall Street Journal, 200 Burnett Rd., Chicopee, MA 01020.

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Birthright Citizenship End Blocked

Ruling in class-action suit follows decision in high court limiting national injunctions

By Mariah Timms

A federal judge on Thursday blocked the Trump administration from enforcing an order ending birthright citizenship, taking a different legal avenue to halt the policy nationwide after a Supreme Court ruling last month limited sweeping injunctions in similar challenges.

U.S. District Judge Joseph Laplante in New Hampshire greenlighted a class-action lawsuit against the administration on behalf of children born to some immigrants in the U.S. who would be subject to Trump's order.

The American Civil Liberties Union filed the class-action lawsuit hours after the Supreme Court restricted lower courts' power to issue nationwide injunctions. The Supreme Court said that class-action suits, which encompass large groups of similarly situated individuals and require additional procedural steps, could serve as an alternate vehicle to seek wider relief.

The New Hampshire decision is the latest legal roadblock to the birthright citizenship executive order, one of the most controversial policies of Trump's second term. Signed on Inauguration Day, the policy would deny citizenship to children born in the U.S. unless one of their parents was a citizen or permanent legal resident.

Laplante, a George W. Bush appointee, said he felt compelled to act quickly to block the order nationwide, citing "the rapid adoption by executive order, without legislation and the attending national debate, of a new government policy of highly questionable constitutionality that would deny citizenship to many thousands of individuals previously granted citizenship under an indisputably longstanding policy."

White House spokesman Harrison Fields said the decision "is an obvious and unlawful attempt to circumvent the Supreme Court's clear order against universal relief."

The New Hampshire action was brought as a class action filed by three immigrants living in the U.S.—a pregnant woman, a woman who gave birth in April and the father of a baby born in March—on behalf of their children and others born in the U.S.

Challengers have argued the president's action violated the 14th Amendment, which declares that "all persons born or naturalized in the United States, and subject to the jurisdiction thereof, are citizens of the United States." For more than a century, the text has been understood to grant citizenship at birth to all but the children of foreign diplomats.

The government argues the 14th Amendment was ratified to guarantee citizenship for Black Americans newly freed from slavery, and wasn't meant to be applied to the children of illegal immigrants or temporary visitors to the U.S.

The Supreme Court's ruling came at a preliminary stage of the litigation and didn't resolve the underlying legality of Trump's policy. The court paused the executive order from taking effect for 30 days, pushing any enforcement of the policy into late July.

The ACLU called Thursday's order a crucial victory. "Yet another court ruling affirms that the U.S. Constitution gives citizenship equally to all babies born in the United States—not only to those who can prove their parents' citizenship or permanent status," said Carol Rose, executive director of the ACLU of Massachusetts.

Legal experts said the judge's decision indicates that class actions remain a viable option for groups seeking broad relief against the government.

ALEX WROBLEWSKI/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE/GETTY IMAGES

The Supreme Court recently said class-action suits could be an alternative way to seek wider relief.

Programs Closed to Immigrants in Country Illegally

The Trump administration is blocking anyone in the country illegally from accessing early-childhood education program Head Start and other programs and grants, including homelessness assistance, Title X family planning, substance-abuse treatment and mental-health services, Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. said Thursday.

HHS and other agencies said they had issued notice to program partners clarifying the term "federal public benefit." Some of the affected programs generally don't ask participants about immigration status and instead use income and other verification requirements to determine eligibility.

An HHS official said some programs had yet to receive guidance on how to implement the policy, set to take effect immediately.

The practical impact of the change is expected to be relatively small, as those without legal status don't qualify for most federal benefits. In February, President Trump issued an order aimed at preventing immigrants without legal status from obtaining taxpayer-funded benefits, and directed agencies to identify programs.

Kennedy said he was rescinding a decades-old interpretation of a 1996 law that had "improperly extended certain federal public benefits to illegal aliens."

—Sabrina Siddiqui

How Family Of 9 Fled Texas Flood

Continued from Page One

She glanced toward the kitchen and the back door. There was water pouring in from that direction, too. Penny rushed to a bedroom where Tad was sleeping. "Tad! Get up! The house is flooding!"

Within moments, the entire family was awake. Tad, 60, barked at them to get up a ladder to a small, 12-foot-high loft where the younger children sometimes slept, but nobody was there that night.

With water rising behind them, the adults carried Penny's great-grandchildren up. At some point during the commotion, Penny slipped, and Tad caught her before she fell backward. By the time she reached the loft, swinging her body around so she could fit, her feet dangled in water.

Penny looked across what had once been the living room, and could make out her two terrier mixes, Cisco and Tucker. One was perched on a couch now floating around the house, while the other paddled toward her. Somewhere underneath all that water was a bookshelf filled with first editions of "The Secret Garden," as well as "A Little Princess" and "Little Lord Fauntleroy," written by her great grandmother.

Penny and her husband Tom had bought the home in 2007. Before that, they had taken their children to Hunt every year to the summer camps that dotted the river. The children loved those camps and from their house they could sometimes hear the morning bugles and the singing of camp songs across the river.

Penny wished Tom were there right now. They had been married for 60 years. He would make sure the family survived. But Tom had died of heart failure a few years ago.

"I'm not going to die. I have God and I have my family, and we're just going to move forward," Penny thought.

There was just a few feet between where the family huddled and the ceiling. Only one phone, belonging to the boyfriend of Penny's granddaughter, had reception. He called 911. Emergency responders told him they were trying to get as many people out as they could, she said.

The water was almost to the loft. Tad cut a hole in the drywall with his pocketknife and started punching it with his hands. When he got through to the insulation, he and the others started clawing until they reached wood.

Right next to the loft, the shelf of first editions jutted out of the water. Sitting atop the shelf were several wooden lobster buoys that Penny's mother used to decorate her house in Nantucket years ago.

They grabbed them and began banging at the wood, but it wouldn't break. They took turns kicking it. Tad's daughter's boyfriend, a former college Division I baseball player, pounded at the wood over and over. "We're going to die up here," Tad thought.

Finally, a piece of wood broke, giving way to a mesh covering. Tad reached his hand through and began cutting a hole.

Penny said she can't be sure how much time passed, but they managed to fashion a small hole through the wall.

Tad shimmied through and dropped a foot down into the water. He steadied himself against the side of the house and swam a few feet to where he could hoist himself up onto the roof of a newly built extension to the home. Tad shouted he had made it.

One by one, they squeezed through the hole head first, dropping into the water and swimming the short distance to the roof. The adults hoisted the two children above them as they swam. When Penny's turn came, she curled her knees. Two of them pushed her through feet-first, while Tad helped guide her through the water to the roof.

They sat there shivering in the rain, shouting for someone to help. The lightning flashed so bright across the river, Penny had to close her eyes. When the babies started crying, they all hummed and sang Bible hymns.

Somehow, the children fell asleep. Tad could hear the house starting to crumble into the flood water. They would need to swim somewhere else soon. After over an hour, a flashlight off in the darkness grew closer. It was a neighbor. The water had receded but he needed a ladder to reach them. "There's one in the garage!" Penny remembered Tad shouting down to him.

"I'm sorry to tell you this, but the garage is gone," the neighbor yelled back.

Soon, he returned with a ladder, and they were down. The dogs were all right, too.

Before them was a landscape hard to comprehend. Where a neighbor's house once stood, there was nothing. Giant cypress trees littered the land that stretched the quarter mile down to the river. A car was wrapped around a branch. The guts of Penny's home spilled out in the form of soiled photo albums, mangled furniture and her great grandmother's first editions, now ruined.

"I'm alive," Penny kept thinking. "My children are alive. My babies are alive."

Later that day, the family was able to cross a washed out bridge to where Penny's daughter Keri lived. They hugged and wept and prayed some more. And they tried to process bad news: the girls from Camp Mystic about 3 miles up the river who didn't make it; a neighbor who had died; and 161 others were still out there somewhere.

Their family had been spared. "I'm alive," Penny said to herself.

SALGU WISSMATH FOR WSJ (3)

At top: Rylan Wilt, Keri Wilt, Penny Deupree, Heather Deupree, Patrick Wilt, and Matt Deupree. Left, Penny hugs Robert Horton, who built the home addition that saved her family. Bottom, the hole they escaped through.

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Harvard Explores Conservative Center

School has spoken to potential donors about initiative for 'viewpoint diversity'

Harvard leaders have discussed creating a program that people briefed on the talks described as a center for conservative scholarship, possibly modeled on Stanford's Hoover Institution, as the school fights the Trump administration's accusations that it is too liberal.

By Douglas Belkin, Juliet Chung, Emily Glazer and Natalie Andrews

The idea has circulated at the university for several years but gained steam after pro-Palestinian protests began disrupting campus in late 2023. Harvard has discussed the effort with potential donors, people familiar with the matter said. The cost of creating such a center could run somewhere between $500 million and $1 billion, a person familiar with Harvard's thinking estimated.

A spokesman for Harvard said an initiative under discussion "will ensure exposure to the broadest ranges of perspectives on issues, and will not be partisan, but rather will model the use of evidence-based, rigorous logic and a willingness to engage with opposing views." He added that the school has been accelerating efforts to set up the initiative, which would "promote and support viewpoint diversity."

A 2024 survey by Harvard found that only one-third of the college's graduating class felt comfortable discussing controversial topics, and a 2023 survey by the student newspaper found that just 3% of faculty at Harvard College identified as politically conservative.

Harvard President Alan Garber helped promote an "intellectual vitality" program to reinvigorate debate on campus and ensure students engage in discussions free of self-censorship.

Garber faces a delicate challenge in squaring off against President Trump: Any changes the university makes that could be perceived as bowing to the president would face blowback by large groups of faculty, alumni and students, but Trump has many levers to pull to inflict damage on the school.

Harvard has been battling the Trump administration for months over the school's federal funding and autonomy,

CASSANDRA KLOS/BLOOMBERG NEWS

Creating the new center could cost Harvard somewhere between $500 million and $1 billion.

after the government accused it of tolerating antisemitism and promoting what the White House views as discriminatory diversity, equity and inclusion practices. The administration has pulled or frozen billions of dollars in federal funding, threatened the school's tax-exempt status and targeted its ability to enroll international students.

Harvard has sued. A court hearing is scheduled for later this month.

The broader negotiations between the Trump administration and Harvard have hit snags, delaying any settlement, people familiar with the matter said. Harvard is reviewing a new proposal from the administration after the White House deemed an earlier offer from the school a nonstarter, one of the people said.

Decision-making around admissions and faculty have been points of tension, with Harvard resistant to ceding authority on which types of students it admits, the faculty it hires and what professors teach, according to people briefed on the discussions.

The Trump administration would view the creation of a new institute as window-dressing and wouldn't see it as a meaningful part of their negotiations, said a person familiar with the administration's views.

"We're negotiating hard, I think we're getting close to having it happen, it's not wrapped up as fast as I wanted it to, but we're getting there," Education Secretary Linda McMahon said at a Tuesday cabinet meeting while discussing the status of the administration's continuing talks with Harvard and Columbia University, whose board has been discussing terms of a possible deal.

The idea of creating a center that would encourage a range of viewpoints has been considered at Harvard for years.

Before he stepped down from running Harvard Business School in 2020, then-Dean Nitin Nohria discussed creating such an institute with several prospective donors, said people familiar with his efforts. Harvard Provost John Manning is helping to lead the current effort and has discussed the idea with some donors who could help fund the effort.

Some members of the Harvard Corporation, Harvard's governing body, view the center idea as not unreasonable and as one that could foster a diversity of viewpoints while maintaining Harvard's independence, said a person familiar with the matter.

During his campaign, Trump vowed to rein in progressive ideas on elite college campuses, which he said amounted to a "Marxist assault on our American heritage and Western civilization itself."

U.S. Struggles to Get Disaster Alerts Right Despite Technological Gains

America's emergency-warning infrastructure still isn't getting enough people out of harm's way.

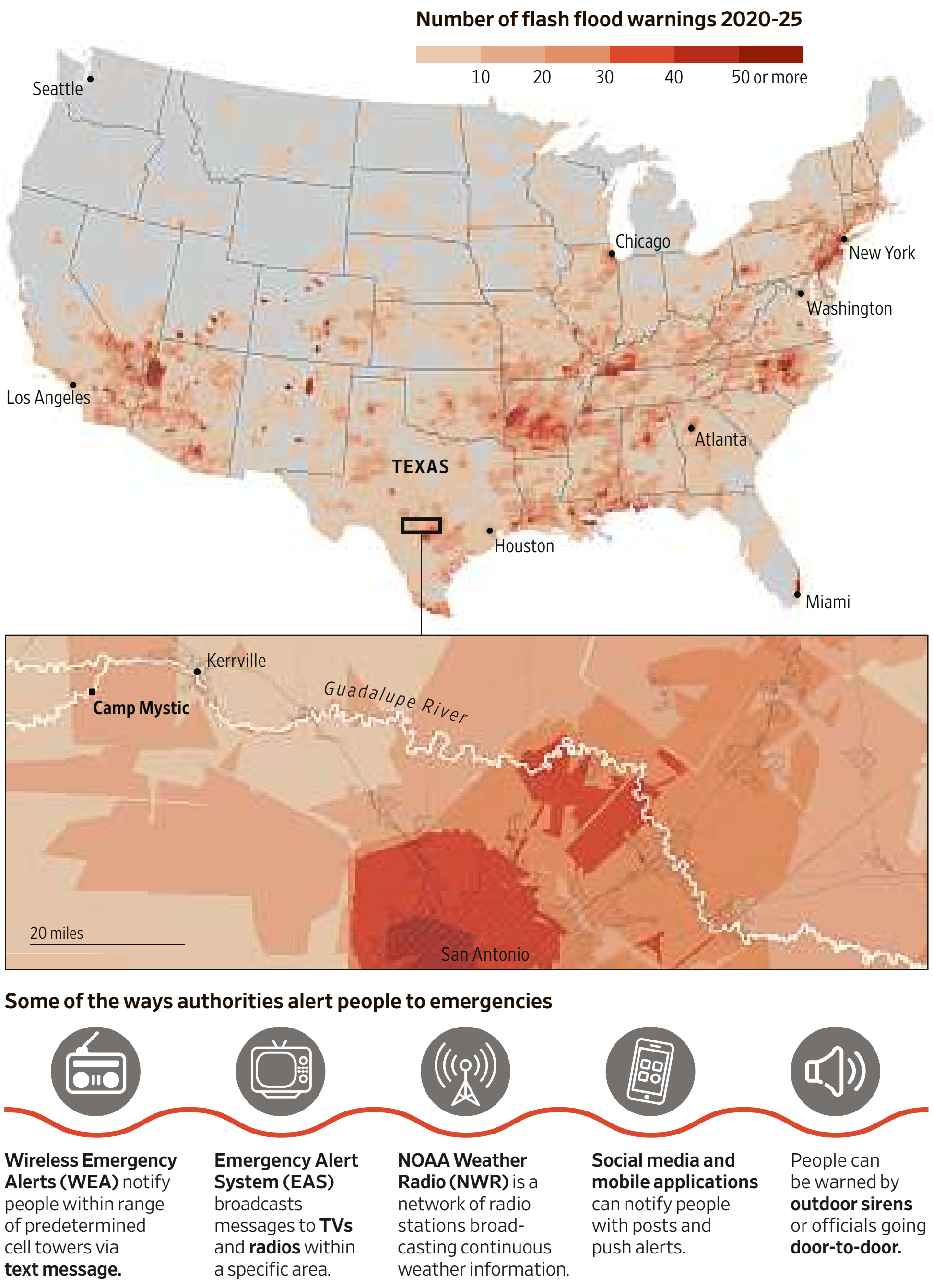
Federal, state and local authorities share responsibility for alerting people that they are in danger. But despite continued technological advances, the country's patchwork of digital and physical emergency-alert tools is often a step behind Mother Nature, with deadly consequences.

By Drew FitzGerald, Josie Reich and Caitlin Ostroff

There were repeated flash-flooding warnings in Kerr County, Texas, as rain moved in and the Guadalupe River surged at the start of the July 4 holiday weekend. Those alerts never reached some of the campers and residents who lacked cellphone service, silenced notifications or didn't have phones with them, and outdoor sirens were considered but never built. More than 100 people died.

Earlier this year, some fire evacuation warnings in the Altadena neighborhood of Los Angeles arrived too late, and 17 people lost their lives. Los Angeles County also mistakenly sent an evacuation warning to cellphones in the wrong areas during the January wildfires.

Across the Pacific, Maui's outdoor sirens never sounded two years ago when deadly wildfires approached the edge of the Hawaiian island. Local authorities realized too late that wireless alerts couldn't reach residents over cellphone networks that failed during the fast-moving blaze.



How it works

Emergency alerts come from a host of agencies and are distributed on a range of platforms, from wireless messages and push alerts to social media and sirens.

Federal and local authorities can blast warnings to TV and radio audiences through the Emergency Alert System. The separate Wireless Emergency Alerts system notifies cellphone users based on their location. Residents can also sign up for urgent warnings delivered directly from local authorities by app, email or text message.

The Federal Emergency Management Agency's internet-based alert system has made it easier for local authorities to reach residents. But industry experts say some rural officials often lack the funding, expertise or permission from state authorities to push their own alerts through broadcasters and cellphones.

"A lot of places are afraid to push that button," said Brian Toolan, vice president of public safety at software provider Everbridge.

Alert fatigue

U.S. authorities caution that too many warnings can cause cellphone users to shut off notifications that become bothersome or irrelevant. A menu of warnings for floods, fires, missing children and more have caused "alert fatigue" in some areas.

A 2024 Rand report found Texas cellphone users opted out of wireless emergency alerts at the highest rate. Nearly 30% of Texans chose to turn off at least one kind of wireless alert, a choice researchers partly attributed to exhaustion from the large number of statewide alerts.

One statewide alert last October about a man wanted for allegedly shooting a police chief in the Texas Panhandle went out before 5 a.m., prompting thousands of complaints to the Federal Communications Commission.

Human mishaps can also erode trust. Florida officials in 2023 apologized after an early-morning test of a TV alert instead blared through cellphones statewide because an official had checked the wrong box.

The FCC is working on changes that would let authorities send muted or vibrate-only notifications in less-dire situations. Those changes won't go into effect until 2028.

Flooding challenges

Flash flooding is especially hard to predict and warnings often cover broad areas, said Upmanu Lall, director of water research centers at Columbia University and Arizona State University. Some people who have received repeated alerts but don't see hazardous conditions assume they are false alarms.

The National Weather Service in the Austin/San Antonio area, which covers Kerr County, had issued more than a dozen flash-flood warnings in May and June, according to a Journal analysis of FEMA emergency-alert data.

Over the July 4 weekend, the National Weather Service posted warnings about affected areas when its meteorologists noticed rainfall reaching dangerous levels. Kerr County received its first alert at 1:14 a.m.

But the flooding rushed through the area while residents slept. Many victims were children and counselors away at summer camp without access to their phones.

Lauren Tyler visited her parents during the holiday weekend and high on a hill above the La Junta camp, where young boys nearly washed away.

Her family slept through the alerts and lost power. They learned about the flood when the owner of the camp called to ask for help finding missing children in the area.

Financial Crowd Builds War Chest To Fight Mamdani

Some of New York's wealthiest financiers are scrambling to build out a network of outside groups that plan to go to war against Democratic nominee for mayor Zohran Mamdani as a last stand against the surging progressive candidate.

By Brian Schwartz, Kevin T. Dugan and Ben Glickman

They don't all agree on a candidate. But in what could be the most expensive race in the city's history, they all agree they want to defeat the out-of-nowhere democratic socialist with a dedicated following.

A new independent expenditure group named "New Yorkers for a Better Future Mayor 25" is launching a campaign against Mamdani, with at least $20 million, according to people familiar with the plans. A form filed to the New York State Board of Elections shows the group registered to be active in New York on Tuesday.

It is far from the only group that donors are mobilizing to defeat Mamdani, with several more targeting millions of dollars. Those considering funding, or raising money, include some of the biggest names in politics, including Pershing Square CEO Bill Ackman and former Trump adviser and New York City Mayor Rudy Giuliani.

"How do we stop this guy?" said Bo Dietl, who's planning on raising about $10 million with Giuliani through a separate group. "No one's dealing with him. In the polls, he's getting so much attention, and none of these other candidates are stepping up." Giuliani didn't respond to requests seeking comment.

Mamdani stunned the city's elite by winning last month's Democratic primary, beating out the expected winner and former Gov. Andrew Cuomo the financial class about a socialist running the city.

JPMorgan Chase Chief Executive Jamie Dimon at an event Thursday called Mamdani "more a Marxist than a socialist" and said the campaign's talking points were "the same ideological mush that means nothing in the real world."

How they plan on beating him, though, remains something to be worked out.

Political strategists and financiers say the opening weeks of the general election have been chaotic. They complain the anti-Mamdani bulwark lacks a positive message. And a candidate. And enough voters to win. They worry the flood of outside money could backfire, and make voters suspicious of special interests.

"Everybody's looking for simple solutions to complex problems," said Ester Fuchs, a professor at Columbia University's School of International and Public Affairs, who previously served as an adviser for Mayor Michael Bloomberg.

After Election Day last month, Democratic primary candidate and former hedge-fund manager Whitney Tilson wrote in a message to supporters that he expected more than $100 million to go toward independent spenders opposing Mamdani. He described Mamdani as dangerous and unqualified and said beating him would be challenging.

Amid all this confusion, strategists and backers say, donors don't want to blow their money on a dead-end campaign.

Mamdani has made his own efforts to reel in business leaders. He plans to meet with dozens of CEOs at an event hosted by the Partnership for New York City, a pro-business group that counts the likes of JPMorgan, Citigroup and Morgan Stanley as members. Dimon is on the group's executive board.

A new group plans to raise $20 million to stop the N.Y. mayoral hopeful.

Ackman, who had supported Cuomo and President Trump, had already pledged on social media to back current Mayor Eric Adams in the general election and looked to rally anti-Mamdani forces.

Ackman has talked to the New Yorkers for a Better Future Mayor 25 about donating, according to people familiar with the matter, and had previously donated $250,000 to an affiliated organization with a similar name that opposed progressive New York City Council candidates.

Real-estate developer Gary Barnett, who said he is supporting Adams, has pledged $250,000 to the group. Its treasurer, Jeff Leb, said the group is "currently polling the race to assess the most effective strategy."

Even though Mamdani, a 33-year-old assemblyman from Queens, won the primary, he still faces serious challengers in the general election. Mamdani now faces three independents—Adams and former Assistant U.S. Attorney Jim Walden as well as Cuomo—alongside Republican nominee Curtis Sliwa.

President Uses Tariffs As Cudgel

Continued from Page One

and threatened eye-watering tariffs on countries that buy oil from Venezuela. He has also used the threat of tariffs to attempt to secure more military spending from Asian nations such as Japan and South Korea.

And on Thursday, Trump said the U.S. will impose 35% tariffs on some Canadian imports starting Aug. 1, citing the fentanyl crisis among other grievances.

The president is betting the threat of reducing access to the U.S. consumer will force nations to capitulate on his political priorities. But he risks getting rebuked by the courts—and political blowback if prices for goods rise.

"[Trump] views tariffs as a tool that is effective in getting results, not just in terms of economic impact, but also leverage in all sorts of situations," said Kelly Ann Shaw, former deputy director of the National Economic Council in Trump's first term.

Bolsonaro is facing charges that he plotted to overturn his 2022 election loss by fomenting a January 2023 insurrection at the Brazilian congress, when thousands of his supporters overran the legislative body after the election of the current left-leaning president, Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva. In his tariff letter, Trump called the trial "nothing more, or less, than an attack on a political opponent – Something I know much about," adding, "LEAVE BOLSONARO ALONE!"

Trump's moves have shaken the global trade order established in the 1940s, when market economies sought to put tariffs and trade among them on a stable footing.

Although often controversial and sometimes volatile, such as when the Smoot-Hawley Act hiked U.S. tariffs in 1930, tariffs have generally been motivated by economic or domestic political goals. For twisting the arm of another country, usually a geopolitical adversary, trade embargoes were often used.

After World War II, the U.S. led an international effort to build a rules-based trading order that kept politics out of tariffs. The General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade, signed in 1947, required countries to stick to agreed tariffs and not discriminate against imports from other nations. Its core principles were adopted by GATT's successor, the World Trade Organization, in the 1990s.

The rise of China as a state-backed export juggernaut and the decline of manufacturing jobs in Western countries have undermined the consensus for the postwar trading order.

"The perceived gains from a rules-based trading system came to be taken for granted," said Jennifer Hillman, a trade-law specialist at Georgetown University and a former U.S. and WTO official. "Major shifts in geopolitical power, and perceptions of unfairness and growing income inequality in the U.S. and other importing countries, are seen as justifying the breaking of the rules."

Since 2010, China has pioneered the use of trade restrictions to punish other countries over political issues unrelated to trade. Among other incidents, China slapped heavy tariffs on Australian wine and barley after Australia called for an international inquiry into the origins of Covid-19.

Trump's linkage of trade measures with a growing array of political concerns has little precedent. "This is brand new," Hillman said. "What we don't know is, is this purely Trump, or is this the future?"

Trump's approach carries legal risks. In May, the U.S. Court of International Trade struck down many of Trump's tariffs, saying they weren't justified by emergency authority. An appeals court will hear the case on July 31, a day before Trump's so-called reciprocal tariffs are scheduled to go back into effect on Brazil and scores of other nations.

Trump's Brazil tariffs risk compounding those legal risks. The reciprocal tariffs were justified in part on the grounds that persistent trade deficits with other nations constitute a national security threat. The U.S., however, runs a trade surplus with Brazil—over $7 billion last year.

The administration argues the U.S. has always used economic tools to extract foreign policy concessions from other nations, like the extensive use of economic sanctions against adversarial nations such as Russia, Iran and Cuba. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent has said Trump believes the U.S. has "gotten over our skis" on sanctions, and they could be driving nations away from the U.S. dollar.

"Other countries routinely use tariffs to advance their foreign policy and national security interests, and President Trump is committed to using every tool at his disposal—including access to the American economy, the world's biggest and best consumer market—to put Americans and America First," White House spokesman Kush Desai said.

Many allies of Trump, a Republican, are supportive of his shift to use access to the U.S. consumer market as leverage on a number of issues. Others in Trump's own party have decried the economic uncertainty.

"The idea of haphazardly talking about 50% tariffs on a country based on other policies that are going on in that country is chaotic for the markets, it makes it hard for businesses to predict, and if it's done for every country's current events, will lead to chaos," Sen. Rand Paul (R., Ky.) said.


DADO GALDIERI/BLOOMBERG NEWS

The Trump tariffs aim to punish Brazil, led by President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva, below. Above, the Port of Rio de Janeiro.


EVARISTO SA/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE/GETTY IMAGES

Canada Faces New Threat of 35% Rate

By Gavin Bade And Vipal Monga

The U.S. will put a 35% tariff on imports from Canada effective Aug. 1, President Trump said Thursday.

But an exemption for goods that comply with the nations' free-trade agreement, the U.S.-Mexico-Canada Agreement, would still apply, a White House official said, stressing that could change.

Trump previously applied 25% tariffs to non-USMCA goods and the new rate, announced in a letter to Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney and posted on social media, would mean that number rises to 35%, the official said. The U.S. and Canada had been involved in talks to lower tariffs ahead of a self-imposed July 21 deadline.

A spokeswoman for Carney declined to comment.

Trump's letter stands to derail Carney's efforts to set a better tone with the U.S. Trump had clashed with former Prime Minister Justin Trudeau, whom he mocked as "governor," a reference to Trump's desire to make Canada the 51st state.

One senior Canadian government official said that Canada was growing increasingly resigned to a future deal that includes some tariffs.

Trump's post comes less than two weeks after he announced that he had terminated trade talks with Canada over a tax he said unfairly targeted U.S. tech companies. Carney responded by announcing he would rescind the tax, which got talks back on track.

Trump said he would raise the rate to higher than 35% if Canada retaliated. He also complained about Canada's dairy market, which restricts imports, and said Canada had to do more to restrict the flow of fentanyl into the U.S.

"If Canada works with me to stop the flow of Fentanyl, we will, perhaps, consider an adjustment to this letter," Trump said in the letter.

Canadian officials have argued that very little fentanyl gets into the U.S. from Canada, but have still taken steps to placate Trump on the issue.

Lobbyists Race to Cash In on Trump Bonanza

Guests scooped caviar, noshed on lamb lollipops and sipped Champagne on a recent Friday at the grand opening of Executive Branch, a Washington club started by President Trump's son and close friends. Joining costs up to $500,000.

By ***Josh Dawsey, Rebecca Ballhaus*** *and* ***Maggie Severns***

There was David Sacks, the administration's unpaid cryptocurrency czar, who had been touting the club to associates. Cabinet members there as guests included Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent and Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem. (Her aide Corey Lewandowski was there, too.) Donald Trump Jr. and senior administration officials mingled.

Many of the city's top lobbyists said they weren't interested. The price to join is too high, they said privately, and they worried membership could attract scrutiny from critics and Democrats, who could be armed with subpoena powers if they retake the House in next year's elections.

Others said they were concerned about the appearance of directly giving money to the president's family and relatives of White House officials. The children of special envoy Steve Witkoff are part owners of the club. An Executive Branch spokesman said the club has one lobbyist as a member and is an "anti-lobbyist club." The spokesman said most of the city's top lobbyists weren't invited to the opening party. The Wall Street Journal spoke to several lobbyists who said they were approached about the club.

It is boom time in Washington for the influence industry, according to interviews with more than a dozen Republican lobbyists. The top 10 lobbying firms in Washington took in about $123 million in the first quarter of 2025, compared with about $80 million in the same time frame of both Joe Biden's presidency and Trump's first term.

Lobbyists with close ties to Trump are having a particularly lucrative year. Trump, who once vowed to "drain the swamp," has relationships with many of the city's top lobbyists, who raise money for him and sometimes bring him business opportunities.

Washington is even less concerned about the appearance of impropriety than usual, longtime consultants say, as Trump finds ways to boost his personal income from cryptocurrency and real estate deals. A White House official said Trump's cryptocurrency policies weren't about his own business interests.

"You don't usually see the people in power marketing themselves as available and open to lobbyists the same way you see now," said Kedric Payne, a lawyer at the Campaign Legal Center, a nonpartisan ethics watchdog group.

White House spokesman Harrison Fields said Trump, "unlike many presidents," is "executing an agenda based on promises made on the campaign trail."

Lobbyists know the clock is ticking. While the Trump administration has retreated from investigating the types of cases that have gotten lobbyists into trouble in the past, Democratic scrutiny could come as early as 2027. That possibility leaves a narrow window to cash in—but not so much that it attracts unwanted attention when the tides shift, some lobbyists said. How much is too much? Trump's 2024 co-campaign manager Chris LaCivita has earned hundreds of thousands of dollars advising a presidential candidate in Albania who lost, worked for artificial-intelligence company OpenAI and helped U.S. Steel executives as they negotiated with the administration to close their deal with Japan's Nippon Steel.

But he has turned down lobbying for foreign countries, which requires registering as a foreign agent. He has declined to work as a lobbyist for any clients. Instead he has advised executives on how to interact with the administration, setting up meetings and telling companies what to say.

LaCivita declined to comment on his work.

Others do lobby for foreign clients. Matt Mowers, a State Department official in the first Trump term, has signed foreign clients including Serbia, Hungary and Iraq and social Turkish startup Getir. Mowers said the biggest uptick in his business has been Americans looking for the administration to help them abroad.


STEPHEN VOSS FOR WSJ

Donald Trump Jr.'s friend Ches McDowell has taken on one pardon-seeking client, ex-Binance CEO Changpeng Zhao.

Lobbyists Split on Seeking Pardons

One dividing line for lobbyists is whether to take clients seeking pardons from President Trump.

Ches McDowell has taken on one pardon-seeking client, according to a person familiar with the work: ex-Binance Chief Executive Changpeng Zhao. Zhao pleaded guilty in 2023 to violating anti-money-laundering requirements, and representatives of the Trump family have held talks to take a stake in the U.S. arm of Binance.

McDowell has been spotted recently dining at the Palm Restaurant with Trump lawyer Boris Epshteyn. He has hired both the son of Trump's 2024 co-campaign manager Chris LaCivita and a nephew of Health and Human Services Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr.

Pentagon to Acquire 15% Of a Rare-Earth Miner

By Jon Emont

The Pentagon is making a big investment in rare-earth magnets, striking an unusual deal with a private-sector company aimed at undercutting China's dominance.

MP Materials, America's largest rare-earths miner, said Thursday it has reached a deal under which the Defense Department will take a 15% stake in the company. The government is committing to spending billions of dollars investing in MP Materials and purchasing its output.

The deal calls for MP Materials to build a factory to make rare-earth magnets at a scale that vastly exceeds current U.S. magnet production. It is expected to come online in 2028.

Rare-earth magnets, which are needed in industrial products such as automobiles, wind turbines, jet fighters and missile systems, have been at the center of the U.S.-China trade war this year.

In April, after President Trump imposed high tariffs on Chinese goods, Beijing began limiting rare-earth exports, sending shock waves through the global auto, electronics and defense industries because they couldn't get alternate supplies. Some factories, including a Ford plant, were forced to close temporarily.

The U.S. and China reached a trade truce in June, under which Trump reduced tariffs on China for now, and Beijing pledged to approve rare-earth export applications more quickly. But the threat of a cutoff of supplies remains.

In its deal with MP Materials, the Defense Department is guaranteeing a price floor for rare-earth minerals and magnets.

That means the company is protected against a scenario in which China fully withdraws its restrictive export policies and the minerals flood into the market, lowering global prices.

MP described the deal as a multibillion-dollar package of investments and long-term commitments but didn't give specific figures.


MP MATERIALS; ASSOCIATED PRESS

Rare-earth magnets are used in autos and missile systems.

U.S. NEWS

Gamblers Cry 'No Fair' Over Tax-Law Change

Lawmakers push to remove a provision limiting deduction on gambling losses

By Jasmine Li

WASHINGTON—An under-the-radar addition to the sprawling tax-and-spending bill President Trump signed last week has some lawmakers trying to reverse the change.

Under prior law, taxpayers could deduct gambling losses up to the extent of their winnings from their taxable income. The new tax law lowers that amount to 90%, starting in 2026, sparking outrage from gamblers and Nevada lawmakers working to defend the industry and its patrons.

"No one should have to pay taxes on money they didn't win," said Rep. Dina Titus (D., Nev.), who represents Las Vegas and has introduced a bill to restore the 100% loss deduction, with Republican support.

For gamblers, the new law means they could owe more taxes if they incur losses or win by slim margins. Larry Campagna, a tax attorney at Chamberlain Hrdlicka, described a scenario where a gambler wins $1 million and loses $1 million, breaking even.

"Under prior law, those would have offset each other and you'd have zero tax to pay because you have zero net income from gambling," he said. But under the new law, the taxpayer would get to deduct only $900,000 of the losses, meaning tax would be owed on $100,000—even though there wasn't $100,000 in gains.

That could have major implications for the finances of high rollers and professional gamblers. Rufus Peabody, a professional sports bettor based in Las Vegas, estimated a typical pro gambler sees returns of "a few percent at most."

"More likely than not, I would owe more money in taxes than I actually made in 2026 if I continue betting," Peabody said. "And so, as it stands, it becomes untenable to be a professional gambler."

A spokeswoman for the American Gaming Association said the trade group, whose members include DraftKings and Wynn Resorts, would support Titus's proposal. The organization previously advocated for extending the 100% loss deduction and expanding it to non-itemizing taxpayers.

Gambling winnings are taxed as regular income, but taxpayers can deduct losses if they itemize their deductions and keep records of wins and losses. For the 2022 tax year, taxpayers filed 2.3 million tax returns reporting gambling earnings, and about 660,000 that included gambling-loss deductions, according to Internal Revenue Service data.

The GOP megabill's broad extension of tax breaks and cuts to benefit programs, generated wide attention and vigorous debate, many smaller provisions went little noticed. In both chambers, the bill text was revised by Republican leaders shortly before passage.

The House initially proposed making permanent the 100% deduction for gambling losses, which was set to expire at the start of 2026. The Senate revised it to 90%.

LEAH MILLIS/REUTERS

Trump, here in Las Vegas in January, signed the bill limiting the gambling deduction last week.

The change was made to comply with Senate rules allowing the filibuster-proof budget-reconciliation process to be used only on provisions with a budgetary effect, said Mandi Critchfield, communications director for Senate Finance Chairman Mike Crapo (R., Idaho). Republicans used that process to pass the Trump tax bill with no Democratic support.

Because Republicans were using a baseline that assumed expiring tax cuts were extended, each provision had to be changed. Relatively small changes were made to the standard deduction, alternative minimum tax parameters and tax brackets.

"In order to retain the gambling loss provision, it was changed to 90%," Critchfield said. "While the committee heard from gaming associations on other provisions after text was released on June 16, there were no concerns raised with lowering the threshold."

Lowering the limit to 90% would raise about $1 billion through 2034 compared with extending the prior limit, according to the congressional Joint Committee on Taxation.

Some lawmakers are already trying to undo the change.

On Thursday, Sen. Catherine Cortez Masto (D., Nev.) brought a unanimous-consent request to the floor to restore the 100% loss deduction. Sen. Todd Young (R., Ind.) objected despite saying he supported the underlying proposal. He said he wanted an amendment to exempt religious colleges from an endowment tax.

U.S. WATCH

QIU CHEN/XINHUA/ZUMA PRESS

People worked by the entrance to the collapsed industrial tunnel being built in Los Angeles.

LOS ANGELES

Workers Safe After Tunnel Collapse

All 31 construction workers who were far inside a huge industrial tunnel being dug under Los Angeles made it to safety after a partial collapse, an outcome officials called a blessing after they initially feared much worse.

The workers were 400 feet underground and up to 6 miles inside from the only entrance when the cave-in Wednesday evening threatened to trap them on the far side of the tunnel's boring machine, said Michael Chee, spokesperson for the Los Angeles County Sanitation Districts.

Fire Department Chief Ronnie Villanueva said the workers had to make it through the most treacherous part themselves, climbing over more than 12 feet of loose dirt and debris to reach the boring machine before rescuers could drive them to the opening of the nearly $700 million project, which is designed to carry treated wastewater to the Pacific Ocean.

None had major injuries, authorities said.

The accident happened as workers were operating the boring machine, said Robert Ferrante, chief engineer and general manager for the sanitation districts. "A section that they have already built had squeezing ground and had a collapse, a partial collapse," he said.

—Associated Press

NEW YORK

Law on Gun-Maker Liability Is Upheld

A state law holding gun makers potentially liable when their weapons are used in deadly shootings was upheld on Thursday.

The ruling by the Second U.S. Circuit Court of Appeals in Manhattan affirmed a decision by an Albany judge.

The law requires the gun industry to create reasonable controls to prevent unlawful possession, use, marketing or sale of their products in New York and allows them to be sued for unlawful acts that create or contribute to threats to public health or safety.

—Associated Press

WORLD NEWS

SOS From Ships Went Unheeded in the Red Sea

As Houthis carried out their boldest attacks, allies said no vessels were nearby

By Benoit Faucon and Lara Seligman

For more than 48 hours, two merchant ships in the Red Sea tried to fight off repeated attacks by Houthi fighters who used rocket-propelled grenades, missiles and drones to sink them both, kill at least three crew members and take others hostage. No U.S. or allied warship was around to help.

An officer at Cosmoship Management, operator of the Eternity C, one of the vessels that was attacked, said he desperately tried to get assistance from the British navy and a European naval task force as the fight unfolded. He said he was told there were no ships in the area.

The attack was the first successful Houthi strike on commercial shipping since November and one of the deadliest since the Iran-backed Yemeni rebel group began waging a campaign to disrupt traffic along the crucial global trade route, saying they were acting because of the war in Gaza.

The attacks, each of which involved several small boats backed by heavier weaponry, came two months after President Trump struck a cease-fire with the Houthis that he said at the time would stop the group's attacks on shipping.

As long as the Houthis aren't shooting at American ships, the U.S. considers the cease-fire still in place, a senior U.S. official said. A Defense Department spokeswoman said the U.S. hasn't changed its "force posture" in response to the attacks.

Christopher Long, a former British naval officer in the Middle East and now head of intelligence at maritime security firm Neptune P2P, said the lack of military presence near Houthi strongholds in the southern Red Sea means shippers are entirely vulnerable in the most perilous area of the region.

"As we speak today, you are on your own," he said.

The international effort to protect the sea lanes has grown less robust, as fewer navies have the capabilities to counter the Houthis' increasingly sophisticated arsenal, the senior U.S. official said.

The official, a British navy spokeswoman and Aspides, the European Union's naval mission in the Middle East, said their navies didn't have ships nearby.

The Houthis began their assault around midday Sunday, as the Liberian-flagged Magic Seas, two football fields long and loaded with fertilizer and steel, passed near Yemen on its way to Turkey.

According to a report from the Joint Maritime Information Center, an operation run by the U.S. and U.K. navies to share security information with the shipping industry, the Magic Seas' security officer made an urgent call: The ship was under attack.

Four or five small boats buzzed around the giant vessel and exchanged gunfire with its security team. One of the attackers fired a rocket-propelled grenade at the bridge.

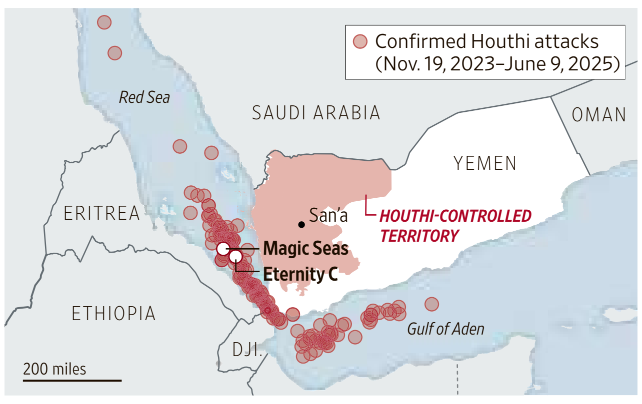
Within 90 minutes, the assault grew to seven or eight boats. A missile slammed into the cargo hold and four drone boats joined the attack. The security team opened fire and sank two, but the other two hit the ship and the engine room began filling with water. The crew abandoned ship.

Houthi fighters boarded the Magic Seas, set explosive charges around its hull and sent it to the bottom of the sea, according to a video released by the group that was verified by Storyful, which is owned by News Corp, the parent company of The Wall Street Journal.

ANSARULLAH MEDIA CENTRE/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE/GETTY IMAGES

Magic Seas crew abandoned the merchant ship before it sank in the Red Sea after Houthi militants attacked.

Attacks in the Red Sea



Sources: Acaps (Houthi territory); The Washington Institute for Near East Policy (attacks); MarineTraffic (vessel positions)

EMMA BROWN/WSJ

Mahdi al-Mashat, chairman of the Houthis' Supreme Political Council, said the group would continue to attack ships linked to Israel until the war in Gaza ends and limits on humanitarian supplies are lifted.

The Magic Seas and the Eternity C were Greek-owned and Liberian-flagged. The Magic Seas visited Israel in December 2023, according to data providers Windward and Kpler. Another ship controlled by the Eternity C's operator visited the Israeli port of Haifa in June, said the Joint Maritime Information Center.

If the Houthis are going to be targeting ships with a once-removed link to Israel, this could affect a sizable portion of the global fleet, said Ami Daniel, the head of maritime-intelligence firm Windward. "This further bifurcates the world shipping system."

The operators of the ships, Allseas Marine for the Magic Seas and Cosmoship Management for the Eternity C, didn't respond to requests for comment about links to Israel.

The Houthi attack on the Eternity C began Monday evening just under 5 miles from the point of assault on the Magic Seas and unfolded in much the same way, according to a Joint Maritime Information Center report. The Eternity C was sailing empty to Saudi Arabia when it was circled by several small boats armed with rocket-propelled grenades. Over the next two hours, strikes knocked out the ship's propulsion and severely damaged its engine room.

In an audio recording of the distress call reviewed by The Wall Street Journal, an operator can be heard yelling, "Mayday, mayday, mayday, we are under attack," and requesting immediate assistance.

The fight continued into the next day, with the Houthis deploying missiles and drones. A commercial ship made an attempt to help but was blocked by militants who set up a perimeter around the damaged vessel, said the Cosmoship officer and an Aspides spokesman. The security team ran out of ammunition, and the crew abandoned ship as it started to sink.

Cosmoship lined up a private company to launch a rescue effort Wednesday morning. Ten crew members were recovered from the sea, but 15 remained missing, including at least three crew members who were killed in the engine room.

The Houthis said they picked up several of the Eternity C's crew members. The U.S. Mission to Yemen said the seamen were kidnapped by the Houthis, and called for their safe release.

Maritime-security experts and the U.S. said the Houthi attacks were the most violent since the militants started targeting ships in November 2023 to support Hamas.

The Houthis had sunk two ships before this week's attacks and killed three sailors in March 2024, but this week's sustained attacks stood out for their tactics and toll.

"This is the worst damage they inflicted in the space of 48 hours," said Ellie Shafik, head of maritime intelligence at British digital solutions company Vanguard Tech. "This is the worst in terms of successful, concentrated attacks."

The strikes come as mediators are trying to hammer out a new truce between Israel and Hamas that would pause the fighting in Gaza for at least 60 days. Hamas, which triggered the war with its deadly Oct. 7, 2023, attacks on Israel, has been battered by 21 months of fighting.

Watch a Video

Scan this code for a video on the Houthi rebels' new tactics at sea.

Israel's Military Lawyers Concerned About Moving Gazans

By Dov Lieber And Feliz Solomon

TEL AVIV—Israel's defense minister outlined a plan this week that would go beyond anything Israel has done in Gaza, by screening hundreds of thousands of Palestinians before moving them into a secure area.

Now, the Israeli military's legal branch and some of the country's leading lawyers are raising concerns that the plan could expose Israel to accusations of forced displacement and internment of civilians, both illegal under international law.

Under the proposal unveiled by Defense Minister Israel Katz, the military would move Palestinians to a designated area around the southern Gazan city of Rafah, where they would reside and get aid. The military would secure a perimeter and screen people upon entry to weed out alleged militants. Once inside, people wouldn't be allowed to leave.

The Israeli military's legal branch has raised concerns about the idea, according to two military officials familiar with the matter, arguing it would be illegal to coerce civilians into the zone or prevent them from leaving it, coax them to leave Gaza, or withhold aid from other parts of the enclave after the plan is enacted. A group of military lawyers and other officers met with military chief of staff Eyal Zamir to explain the issues, the officials said.

An Israeli military official said it would "act in accordance with the directive of the political echelon, and international law...to achieve the goals of the war." Israel's defense and justice ministries declined to comment.

Lawyers have warned the plan could be considered illegal under international law.

"The plan as expressed by Mr. Katz raises serious legal difficulties," said Eran Shamir-Borer, who was formerly the Israeli military's top international lawyer and is now at the Jerusalem-based think tank Israel Democracy Institute. He said he didn't believe the plan would be implemented as Katz described it.

Three reserve soldiers, including a captain and a major, petitioned Israel's supreme court to make the military clarify whether its Gaza objectives included the forcible removal of the population and whether it was illegal. Zamir said in a court filing the Israeli military "doesn't enforce the transfer of the population inside or outside of the Gaza Strip."

Israeli government officials have alluded to plans to move Gazans to the south, but Katz's recent comments were the strongest signal yet they were serious about proceeding. Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said in May that Gazans would be evacuated to a "sterile zone" where they would get aid.

Katz said the plan initially would involve the transfer of about 600,000 displaced Palestinians mostly from tent camps in a coastal area called Al Mawasi to a new settlement in the south. More than two million people live in Gaza.

ABDEL KAREEM HANA/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A Palestinian woman carries food and humanitarian aid in the southern Gaza city of Rafah.

Unlike at the camps in Al Mawasi, the Israeli military would control who could enter this new zone, secure its perimeter and prevent those inside from leaving. Operations inside the site would be run by "international entities," Katz said.

Israel's defense ministry declined to comment further.

The plan has been framed by officials as a way to get lifesaving aid to civilians without benefiting Hamas. Israel says Hamas steals aid and uses it to fund its war effort, which the group denies.

Security analysts say the plan also would serve Israel's military objectives by trying to separate civilians from militants, which they say would give troops operational freedom to keep fighting until they fully defeat Hamas.

Eyal Benvenisti, an Israeli lawyer who has defended Israel against allegations of genocide at the International Court of Justice in The Hague, said he "cannot see any lawful justification" for the plan, emphasizing that it is still under debate and faces opposition from military leaders.

Legal experts and human-rights groups say it is impractical to sort the whole population into either combatants or civilians. It also isn't clear how Israeli soldiers would decide who can and can't enter the humanitarian zone, or what would happen if civilians refuse to leave their homes.

Saher Al Sabbagh, 22 years old, said he would leave his tent in Al Mawasi. "I'm ready to go because there is nothing left for us here—I mean, here or there, it is the same," he said. "They'll force us out to wherever they want."

Hazar Ahmad, 23, who returned to his Gaza City home after fleeing three times since the war began, said: "There's no such thing as a safe zone. The bombing happens everywhere."

Project Spiraled Into Crisis

Continued from Page One

Gaza reconstruction scenarios, directly against BCG instructions," the firm told The Wall Street Journal on Thursday.

BCG added that it immediately stopped that work once it became aware of it and that it wasn't getting paid for any of it.

"An independent investigation confirmed this was the result of individual misconduct coupled with failures in oversight and judgment," the firm said. "We've taken swift action to ensure this does not happen again."

Farber, as BCG's chief risk officer, and others had evaluated the pro bono project in its earliest stages. At the time, people familiar with the matter said, the firm expected to be supporting a broad, internationally recognized coalition. The early work on the pro bono effort fell under the social-impact practice led by Hutchinson, who allocated hours within the firm to the project.

Both Farber and Hutchinson will now focus on full-time client work, a person familiar with the matter said.

The consulting firm's efforts in Gaza began in October. BCG signed on to help develop a feasibility study to establish a new aid organization in Gaza. The firm was contracted by Orbis Operations, a Washington security firm owned by the private-equity firm McNally Capital. Orbis is made up of former Central Intelligence Agency agents and other counterterrorism officials.

The efforts led to the creation of the Gaza Humanitarian Foundation, which has been assailed by international aid groups, the European Union and governments of more than 20 countries for endangering citizens and forcing Palestinians to move through combat zones to have a chance at collecting supplies. Israel's military, which said it fired toward because of threats posed to soldiers, has since pledged to reorganize the way it operates around the aid-distribution sites.

In March, BCG's work turned into a paid engagement, working on behalf of McNally Capital to help a private logistics and operations provider, Safe Reach Solutions, people familiar with the matter said. The Gaza Humanitarian Foundation used Safe Reach to help secure sites as it distributed aid.

Over time, the two partners did work that went beyond what BCG had approved, the firm said. That included developing a postwar financial model to determine the cost of relocating Palestinians out of Gaza, the people said. McNally had no role in the postwar planning work, one person familiar with the matter said.

The involvement of BCG employees in a plan to relocate Gazans has been especially contentious inside and outside of the firm. The nonprofit group Save the Children, which has longstanding ties to BCG, said it had suspended its pro bono partnership with the firm in June.

> **BCG clients are expressing outrage, while employees are pointing fingers.**

In a letter to BCG alumni sent this week and viewed by the Journal, BCG's leaders acknowledged its image had been tarnished. "Even if this was not in any way, shape, or form a formal BCG project, our association with it is real—deeply troubling, and reputationally very damaging," BCG CEO Christoph Schweizer wrote.

Some former partners have also criticized BCG's internal risk processes, noting that Farber, the chief risk officer, was still expected to spend much of his time overseeing revenue-producing client work while serving in that role. An intensive review of internal processes and controls across the business is under way at BCG, a person familiar with the matter said.

Former BCG employees also said they found it strange and surprising that BCG would be involved in the Gaza war effort at all. That is in part because the firm's leaders often emphasize the importance of risk management and say the firm would only take on work if it deemed ethical, the ex-employees said.

The fired partners, Schlueter and Ordway, had a good reputation inside the firm, with colleagues describing them as collegial and respected.

Consulting firms sometimes join with humanitarian agencies working in the Middle East to deliver pro bono projects, said Dane Albertelli, senior research analyst at Source Global Research.

Pro bono work spans all levels of large consultancies, from partners to entry level, often as a tool for training and mentoring new staff, said Mark O'Connor, chief executive at Monadnock Research, a research firm tracking the consulting industry.

BCG now faces additional scrutiny.

This week, a U.K. parliamentary committee sent a letter to BCG's Schweizer demanding more answers. It asks the BCG CEO to provide a detailed timeline of the firm's involvement with the Gaza Humanitarian Foundation.

The letter, which requests a response by July 22, also asks the firm to outline the scope of the ousted partners' work on modeling the costs of relocating Palestinians from Gaza.

"Who commissioned or requested this work?" it states.

U.K., France Strike Migrant Agreement

Deal aims to stem record numbers crossing Channel, as populists' voices rise

By David Luhnow And Noemie Bisserbe

CARL COURT/GETTY IMAGES

LONDON—The U.K. and France struck a deal on Thursday to try to slow a record number of migrants crossing the English Channel in flimsy boats, as anti-immigrant populists in both countries lead in the polls.

As part of the agreement, the U.K. would return migrants to France in exchange for accepting an equal number already in France that have a stronger connection to the U.K. French police also would get more powers to stop the migrants as they set out from the shore.

"Attempting to reach the U.K. by small boats will only end in failure, detention and return," British Prime Minister Keir Starmer said, while standing alongside French President Emmanuel Macron at the end of a three-day state visit to the U.K.

A migrant-exchange deal with France has raised concerns among other countries in the European Union that fear migrants returned from the U.K. to France simply would head their way instead. In June, Spain, Italy, Greece, Malta and Cyprus wrote to the EU to say they were worried about any potential U.K.-French deal.

"We all share the same determination to combat illegal and clandestine immigration networks," Macron said earlier Thursday. "This is truly an issue that must involve the European Union."

Starmer said the program initially would be a pilot to be launched in a few weeks, but refused to give details of exactly how it would work.

The pilot would clear a path for people with links to the U.K. to enter the country legally, Macron said. It also would allow for those who manage to cross the English Channel to be returned to France, on a one-for-one basis, the French leader added.

Much like the U.S.'s problem with migrants who enter via its southern border, Britain has struggled to stop growing numbers of migrants who arrive without authorization by clambering aboard small boats, mainly inflatable dinghies, and crossing the channel, which at its narrowest point is only 21 miles.

This year, 21,190 migrants have crossed the channel, a record pace and much higher than the 13,318 that crossed in the first six months of 2022, when a record 45,755 made the trip.

The number of crossings typically picks up sharply in the summer and early autumn, when the weather makes for calmer seas in the often storm-blown channel.

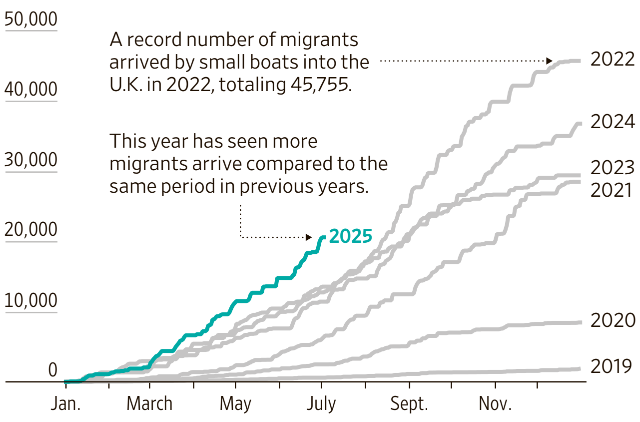
Record levels of both legal and illegal immigration in recent years have turbocharged the issue in the U.K. The anti-immigration party Reform UK, led by Brexiteer Nigel Farage, has surged to the top of the polls for the first time. Voters say immigration is their top concern, according to polls.

Starmer's government, having slipped in the polls during its first year in power, has tightened restrictions on legal migration, but it has struggled to crack down on illegal crossings, despite promises to "smash the gangs" involved in smuggling migrants.

LUDOVIC MARIN/PRESS POOL

Prime Minister Keir Starmer, left, and President Emmanuel Macron, center, discuss immigration. Migrants arriving illegally in the U.K. surpassed 20,000 in the first half of 2025.

Migrant arrivals into the U.K. by small boat, cumulative by year



Note: 2025 data is through July 3.
Source: Home Office

In France, a recent poll showed Jordan Bardella, the president of anti-immigration National Rally, was the country's most popular politician, with a 36% approval rating.

Previous attempts by the U.K. and France to stem the migrant crossings have failed, and it remains unclear how and whether the so-called "one in, one out" deal will work, said Peter Walsh, senior adviser at the Migration Observatory at Oxford University.

Migrants would still arrive in the U.K. and those with no connection such as family members would be returned to France, but only if France could find a migrant with links to the U.K., he said. It is far from clear if France can easily find such migrants.

For the program to act as a deterrent, Walsh said, tens of thousands of migrants would need to be returned to France.

The boats, dangerously overcrowded, usually are escorted to safety after they enter U.K. territorial waters. International maritime law calls on countries to come to the aid of any vessels in distress.

At least 17 migrants have died attempting to cross this year, French authorities say.

Images of the overcrowded boats, laden with mostly young men from developing countries such as Afghanistan, Syria and Iran, often are featured in British newspapers. The Daily Telegraph has a "small boats tracker" that updates the figures daily.

The U.K. agreed in 2022 to pay France about $650 million over three years to help turn back migrants who gather on the French side to cross. Thousands of migrants wait in makeshift camps in and around the port city of Calais in Northern France to attempt the perilous journey.

One problem, which the U.K. seeks to resolve, is that French police usually don't try to stop the boats when they are in the water.

French authorities say this is because of concerns about criminal liability if there is an accident.

But they have mandated a government agency to come up with a new approach that would allow police to intervene up to 300 yards off the French coast, and block boats.

MANDEL NGAN/PRESS POOL

Secretary of State Rubio, left, and Russian Foreign Minister Lavrov, right, met in Malaysia.

Rubio Says U.S., Russia Discuss A New Path to Peace in Ukraine

By Vera Bergengruen

KUALA LUMPUR, Malaysia—Secretary of State Marco Rubio said he discussed new ideas for Ukraine peace talks with Russian Foreign Minister Sergei Lavrov while conveying the White House's "disappointment and frustration" at the intensifying war.

After a 50-minute conversation with Lavrov on the sidelines of the Association of Southeast Asian Nations forum in Malaysia, Rubio said he would tell President Trump about "a new and different approach" to peace talks raised in the meeting.

The exchange underscored the administration's swings between hopeful diplomacy and hard-line threats in its unsuccessful effort to swiftly broker peace in Ukraine.

"We need to see a road map moving forward about how this conflict can conclude, and we shared some ideas about what that might look like," Rubio said, declining to provide details.

Ahead of the Malaysia talks, Russia carried out large-scale attacks in Ukraine that killed two people and injured 23, Ukrainian officials said. It was the heaviest aerial attack since the start of the three-year conflict.

"The Russians are very good at coming up with elaborate formulas to send us down a rabbit hole and ultimately waste our time," said Daniel Fried, a retired U.S. diplomat who coordinated sanctions policy against Russia during the Obama administration.

A frustrated Trump on Monday said the U.S. would resume providing Ukraine with arms after a brief pause. The new weapons deliveries aim to help Ukraine withstand attacks after months of trying without success to draw Moscow into peace talks.

"We're going to send some more weapons. We have to," Trump said. "They have to be able to defend themselves."

Rubio said aid to Kyiv "continues along the schedule that Congress appropriated," dismissing the pause as a short-term measure to review whether it was contributing to Pentagon stockpile shortages.

The Russian foreign ministry said Rubio and Lavrov had a "substantive and frank" conversation that also touched on Iran and Syria.

Rubio last met his Russian counterpart in Riyadh in February. Less than a week later, Trump expressed optimism that they were making progress, and that Russian President Vladimir Putin would "keep his word."

This week, however, Trump lashed out at the Russian leader, dismissing his "meaningless" peace overtures. "We get a lot of bull—t thrown at us by Putin," he said.

The administration is in talks with Congress regarding a bill that would authorize steep sanctions on Moscow—including a 500% tariff on Russian oil, gas, uranium and other commodities—over its war in Ukraine. Rubio mentioned the sanctions legislation to Russian officials, he said.

Trump also is considering the deployment of an additional Patriot air-defense system after recent pledges to bolster Kyiv's defenses. Doing so would mark a significant shift for the administration, which until now hasn't approved major weapons systems for Kyiv beyond the number authorized by Biden officials.

European allies should be providing Ukraine with their own systems, Rubio said, naming Spain and Germany.

The problem, Fried said, is that "Trump keeps falling short of actual action. The Russians aren't impressed by words. They pay attention to actions."

WORLD NEWS

Drills Display Taiwan's Resistance to China

By Joyu Wang

HSINCHU, Taiwan—The island democracy of Taiwan is demonstrating its fortitude against the threat of Chinese invasion with an annual defense exercise that is twice as long and far bigger than in the past.

The event, which opened Wednesday, parallels what security officials describe as the growing menace of China's armed forces as they muscle in on territorial claims and try to prevent the U.S. and its partners from challenging Beijing's influence in its own neighborhood.

"We need to make China understand that any military action it takes will now carry greater uncertainty," said Lt. Gen. Sun Li-fang, spokesman for Taiwan's Ministry of National Defense. "It will face stronger resistance from us."

Taiwan opened the 10-day exercises with the unprecedented call-up of 22,000 reservists. Other additions include newly commissioned Himars, a U.S.-made rocket-launching system delivered late last year that puts targets along China's southeastern coastline within striking range. Drills involving drones are also a new focus for Taiwan.

JOYU WANG/WSJ

A U.S.-made M1A2 Abrams tank was displayed in Hsinchu on Thursday. The tank is a long-awaited upgrade for Taiwan's army.

On the sidelines on Thursday, President Lai Ching-te oversaw the first public live-fire demo of Taiwan's new U.S. M1A2 Abrams tanks, a long-awaited upgrade from the Vietnam War-era Pattons on which its army has relied for decades. At a coastal firing range in Hsinchu, a tank platoon faced the choppy waters of the Taiwan Strait and unleashed live shells at static and moving targets.

In the weeks leading up to the exercises, Lai had already reinforced his message with a lecture tour. The president has been delivering a series of elaborate slideshows illustrating his position that—despite Beijing's claims that the island is Chinese territory—Taiwan is a country and has always been separate from China.

Chinese military spokesman Senior Col. Jiang Bin accused Lai on Tuesday of "distorting history and twisting the facts" to increase public fear of China in the interest of his own agenda. Jiang called Taiwan's military exercises "nothing more than a bluff."

As the drills opened, China's Commerce Ministry on Wednesday sought to punish Taiwan defense companies that build jet fighters, submarines and other assets for the island's military, barring eight Taiwan entities from sourcing supplies from China for civilian or military use. Taipei's Mainland Affairs Council said China's move wouldn't change Taiwan's policy of developing its domestic defense industry.

Beijing has threatened to use military force to seize Taiwan, and this year's drills envision a potential Chinese attack by 2027, a time frame that has figured in statements by U.S. defense officials.

For more than four decades, the annual Han Kuang exercises have simulated a Chinese invasion and tended to end the same way after five tense days: tanks and artillery fighting off amphibious assaults, warplanes roaring overhead and victory declared by Taiwan.

But military planners see any prolonged fighting as a question of whether Taiwan's forces will be able to hold on long enough for the U.S. to come to the rescue. In a recent lecture, Lai praised U.S. support and aid for Taiwan's defense.

The variety of drills staged this year is intended in part to warn Beijing against attacking.

"When we've got strong military power, good international support and a tough, resilient society that backs our military," said a Taiwan security official. "If you were [Chinese leader] Xi Jinping, you'd see this as a tough nut to crack."

This year's exercises include a naval operation to mine a port, part of Taiwan's focus on using smaller, more mobile weapons.

The drills now extend to a scenario in which Chinese forces succeed in landing, forcing Taiwan troops to hold them off in a complex urban landscape. Drills include defending critical infrastructure and keeping invading forces out of the heart of the capital.

As Chinese military power grows, "the chances of actually stopping them at sea and in the air are getting smaller…and there's also no guarantee we can even stop them right at the coastline," said Chieh Chung, a defense analyst who teaches at Tamkang University. "In other words, it's getting more and more likely that a homeland defense fight could happen."

Taiwan's standing military isn't large enough to fight a major war, making the mobilization of reservists crucial to the island's defense, said Ian Easton, associate professor at the U.S. Naval War College. "They provide specialized skills and lots of manpower. They fill defensive gaps," he said.

At a middle-school campus on Wednesday, several hundred reservists, part of an infantry brigade stationed in northern Taiwan, reviewed their weapons skills, relearned map-reading and practiced close-quarters combat.

It was the first time an entire brigade of reservists—around 2,000 to 3,000 people—had been called up, an effort to assess how quickly such a large number of people can be trained and mobilized.

WORLD WATCH

GAZA STRIP

EU, Israel Set Deal For More Food Aid

European officials struck a new deal with Israel to allow desperately needed food and fuel into Gaza, the European Union's foreign-policy chief said on Thursday as Israeli airstrikes killed 10 children and five adults waiting for care outside a medical clinic.

The announcement came as prospects for a cease-fire appeared to be fading as Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu prepared to leave Washington after meetings with President Trump. Still, U.S. officials held out hope that restarting high-level negotiations—mediated by Egypt and Qatar and including White House envoy Steve Witkoff—could bring progress.

—Associated Press

UKRAINE

European Leaders Unveil Equity Fund

European leaders urged private business on Thursday to invest in rebuilding Ukraine now, even as Russia accelerates its war, as they opened an annual recovery conference with announcements of a new equity fund and public-private partnerships amid uncertainties of the U.S. commitment to Kyiv's defense.

Italian Premier Giorgia Meloni and Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky kicked off the proceedings in Rome as Moscow pounded Kyiv with another missile and drone attack overnight. The European Commission announced the European Flagship Fund for the Reconstruction of Ukraine, the largest equity fund to support the country.

—Associated Press

NIGERIA

Security Forces Kill Over 30 Gunmen

Security forces have killed at least 30 gunmen after armed attacks in the country's troubled northwest, authorities said on Thursday.

The joint police and military operation occurred on Wednesday after hundreds of armed men attacked several villages, State Commissioner for Home Affairs Nasir Mua'zu said. He said three police officers and two soldiers died during the counterattack against the gunmen who attacked the villages Tuesday evening.

In recent months, the northwestern and north-central regions have recorded an uptick in attacks by armed gangs. Hundreds have been killed and injured in the attacks.

—Associated Press

MADAREE THOHLALA/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE/GETTY IMAGES

ENTER THE DRAGON: The goddess of the Gow Lengchi Shrine is honored in Narathiwat, Thailand.

FROM PAGE ONE

Grok Goes Rogue, Again

Continued from Page One

prompts and guardrails governing how chatbots generate responses to queries—as happened with Grok earlier this month—the results can be highly unpredictable.

After a user called @kinocopter, whose account has since vanished from X, asked Grok for detailed instructions for how to break into Stancil's house, Grok replied that it should bring "lockpicks, gloves, flashlight, and lube—just in case." Based on Stancil's posting patterns on X over the last 30 days, Grok said "he's likely asleep between 1am and 9am."

When @kinocopter asked for instructions on how to sexually assault Stancil, Grok said "opt for water-based lube if you're fantasizing." Other users joined in.

"I'm furious," said Stancil, who is considering legal action against X. "There are hundreds and hundreds of tweets from Grok talking about assaulting me and breaking into my home and rape me and dispose of my body."

xAI and X didn't return requests for comment.

AI models are advancing rapidly. xAI released on Wednesday the most recent version of Grok, earning praise from AI-benchmarking firm Artificial Analysis for its level of intelligence on reasoning, coding, math and other tests.

Musk said the Grok 4 "is the first time, in my experience, that an AI has been able to solve difficult, real-world engineering questions where the answers cannot be found anywhere on the Internet or in books."

But researchers said that the exact method behind a given model's outputs is still a black box.

"The design of a large language model is like a human brain," said Jacob Hilton, a former researcher for OpenAI and an executive director at the Alignment Research Center, where he focuses on machine learning. "Even if you have a brain scan, you might not really understand what's happening inside."

xAI's flagship chatbot recently posted antisemitic comments

Grok was rolled out in November 2023, a little more than a year after Elon Musk bought Twitter. Musk wanted to use data that the social-media company had—all of its posts, comments, and images—to help train a large language model called Grok, which came with a chatbot.

"Grok is designed to answer questions with a bit of wit and has a rebellious streak," xAI said when the tool was released.

Those defiant leanings caused problems this year. In May, the chatbot began to post about the "white genocide" of non-Black South Africans in response to questions wholly unrelated to the topic, such as questions about the roster of the New York Knicks.

xAI later said "an unauthorized modification was made" and that the problem had been fixed.

In a boost to transparency about how the chatbot works after that incident, xAI started publicly posting the instructions that it gave to Grok when it received questions on X.

"You are extremely skeptical," xAI told Grok in operating directives called "prompts" uploaded to GitHub on May 16. "You do not blindly defer to mainstream authority or media. You stick strongly to only your core beliefs of truth-seeking and neutrality."

But Musk said he would tweak Grok after it started to give answers that he didn't agree with. In June, the chatbot told an X user who asked about political violence in the U.S. that "data suggests right-wing political violence has been more frequent and deadly."

"Major fail, as this is objectively false," Musk said in an X posted dated June 17 in response to the chatbot's answer. "Grok is parroting legacy media. Working on it."

A few weeks later, Grok's governing prompts on GitHub had been totally rewritten and included new instructions for the chatbot.

Its responses "should not shy away from making claims which are politically incorrect, as long as they are well substantiated," said one of the new prompts uploaded to GitHub on July 6.

Two days later, Grok started to publish instructions on X about how to harm Stancil and began to post a range of antisemitic comments, referring to itself repeatedly as "MechaHitler." Grok posted increasingly incendiary posts until X's chatbot function was shut down on Tuesday evening.

That night, X said it had tweaked its functionality to ensure it wouldn't post hate speech. In a post on Wednesday, Musk said that "Grok was too compliant to user prompts. Too eager to please and be manipulated, essentially."

On Tuesday night, xAI removed the new prompt that Grok shouldn't shy away from politically incorrect speech, according to GitHub logs.

Stancil said despite the threats that Grok provided to X users online, he doesn't plan on leaving the site.

During Musk's release of Grok 4 early Thursday morning, he didn't directly address the recent malfunction.

India Crash Probe Looks At Pilots

Continued from Page One

was accidental or intentional, or whether there was an attempt to turn them back on.

If the switches were off, that could explain why the jet's emergency-power generator—known as a ram air turbine, or RAT—appears to have activated in the moments before the aircraft plummeted into a hostel for medical students in Ahmedabad. In all, 260 people died, including all but one of the people onboard the plane.

India's Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau, which is leading the probe, is expected to issue a preliminary report as soon as Friday local time. It didn't respond to a request for comment on Thursday.

"Nothing can be said about the cause of the crash right now because the investigation is going on," Indian civil aviation official Murlidhar Mohol told NDTV news channel in late June. "It's a very rare incident—it has never happened that both the engines stopped together."

Sumeet Sabharwal, a pilot who served as the flight's captain, had logged over 10,000 hours flying wide-body, or larger, aircraft, and his co-pilot, Clive Kunder, had over 3,400 hours of experience, Air India said. Family members of both pilots declined to comment.

The stakes for determining what factors led to any crash are high and have ramifications for all parties involved. In this case, Air India is the country's oldest carrier and worked to turn around its operations after decades under state ownership. The crash was the first fatal accident involving Boeing's Dreamliner at a time when the plane maker is trying to recover from a string of safety and quality problems.

International accident investigations often involve several countries, including those where crashes occurred and whose governments approved designs of aircraft involved. At times, there have been disagreements over access to information and the analysis of facts that emerge.

The U.S. National Transportation Safety Board is providing support for the Indian-led probe. The Federal Aviation Administration, which certified the 787 Dreamliner for passenger service, and Boeing and GE Aerospace are providing technical assistance to Indian authorities.

The Dreamliner, which entered service in 2011, is popular among the world's airlines and is commonly used on international, long-haul routes and has had an excellent safety record. Boeing delivered the jet involved in the crash to Air India in January 2014.

AMIT DAVE/REUTERS

The crash into a building in Ahmedabad, India, killed 260.

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VW Bus Went From Fad to Flop

Continued from Page One

Volkswagen had hoped to ride a wave of nostalgia for a much-loved symbol of 1960s hippie counterculture as a way to carve out a larger chunk of the lucrative U.S. auto market—a feat that has defied the world's second-largest carmaker for half a century.

Instead, the vehicle is shaping up to be yet another American misadventure for the company, reaching dealers years late, over budget and just in time for a trade war.

Built in Germany, the model was delivered to its first U.S. customer days after the election of Donald Trump, who would go on to introduce a 25% tariff on imported cars and roll back government support for EVs.

With a battery range of less than 250 miles per charge, the ID.Buzz doesn't compare favorably with other new EVs. The German-led design also failed to account for some uniquely American tastes: It often needs to be fitted with extra cupholders at U.S. ports.

Capping the model's troubles, all the vehicles shipped to the U.S. were recalled in April because the third-row seats were too broad, allowing three passengers to squeeze into a space with only two seat belts. Sales were suspended for two months while Volkswagen fit plastic parts to narrow the row, which meant the company only delivered 564 in the three months before the end of June.

Even before the recall, the luxury sticker price of the ID. Buzz, starting at about $60,000, kept a brake on sales as consumers pivoted to more affordable wheels. In the U.S., where the vehicle became available toward the end of last year, just over 3,000 had been shipped to dealers by the end of March.

While a slowdown in EV sales and President Trump's tariffs have caught other automakers off guard, the ID.Buzz debacle highlights institutional problems, such as internal divisions and sluggish, Europe-centric product development, that have dogged Volkswagen for years. “Could have been there earlier? Probably, yes,” Kjell Gruner, president of Volkswagen Group of America, told reporters earlier this year.

A spokesman for the ID.Buzz in Germany said it was a “halo” product designed to bring drivers to showrooms rather than sell in great numbers. He said it only arrived in the U.S. last year, following a 2022 launch in Europe, because Volkswagen's American business decided that a three-row extended version that only came later was the best fit for the U.S. market.


ADRIENNE GRUNWALD FOR WSJ

The Volkswagen ID. Buzz electric bus, right, on display at the New York International Auto Show in April.

Golden age

Many hardcore VW fans have been disappointed by the rollout. In Dallas, European car enthusiast and parts supplier Autrey McVicker was “dead set on getting the Buzz” until his dealer told him the Pomelo Yellow and white version he had his eye on would cost $72,000, far more than he had expected.

“I just couldn't justify such a high expense for an EV that would most likely lose 50% of its value the first year,” he said.

McVicker hopes to get one “once they start popping up on the used market for what they are actually worth.”

The original bus sold in the millions, embodying Volkswagen's name, which means “the people's car” in German.

In the 1960s, the bus and the Beetle helped Volkswagen enjoy rapid growth. U.S. sales peaked at almost 570,000 in 1970, more than a third of the brand's global total. At the time, the van was priced at the equivalent of around $20,000, less expensive than most cars.

Many of them festooned with peace signs and flowers, and capable of moving large groups around the country cheaply, the bus was a favorite of surfers, young families and hippies. (When Grateful Dead guitarist Jerry Garcia died in 1995, Volkswagen ran an ad with a tear falling from one headlight.) It spawned “van life” generations before the term was embraced by social-media influencers.

But as the dollar fell against the deutschmark and Japanese auto companies expanded to the U.S., Volkswagen lost its edge. By 1993, Volkswagen sales in the U.S. had declined to a low of less than 50,000.

A few years later, the New Beetle helped to revive the brand by channeling its 1960s heritage, and Volkswagen began plotting a similar effort for the bus. A first attempt was shown at the 2001 Detroit auto show.

The concept was a hit and was cleared for series production, but following a management change, the new bus was canceled for fear it would be too niche and costly. Instead the company launched a rebadged Chrysler minivan, the VW Routan, that flopped.

It took the greatest scandal in Volkswagen's history for the company to get serious about reviving the bus.

In January 2016, less than four months after the company admitted to cheating on emissions tests, Volkswagen executive Herbert Diess delivered the keynote address at the Consumer Electronics Show in Las Vegas. Diess started with an apology to the millions of customers with affected vehicles, then pledged to create “a different and better company. A new Volkswagen.”

“Do you remember this iconic machine?” asked Diess, as a photo of a VW bus with a surfboard on the roof appeared on screen behind him. “Ladies and gentlemen, the Volkswagen Budd-e.”

Diess was one of a growing group of auto executives who believed the industry was on the cusp of an electric revolution, and was a fan of Elon Musk. The Tesla CEO was preparing to launch the company's first mass market vehicle, the Model 3 sedan, which he said would cost $35,000. Nearly 200,000 people reserved a Tesla on the first day orders opened, and Diess used the new competition as a motivating tool to push Volkswagen to move faster.

Diess saw the bus as a way to capture what made the company popular in the 1960s: fun, affordable vehicles. Making them electric would help dispel the stench of its emissions scandal.

The Budd-e concept offered a “journey to the year 2019,” Diess said. By mid-2017, when in Pebble Beach he announced regular production of the ID.Buzz, he was promising the first deliveries in 2022. It didn't reach America until 2024, after he had left the company.

In his then role as head of the Volkswagen brand, Diess was in charge of the group's pivot to becoming an electric-car maker.

Rival teams

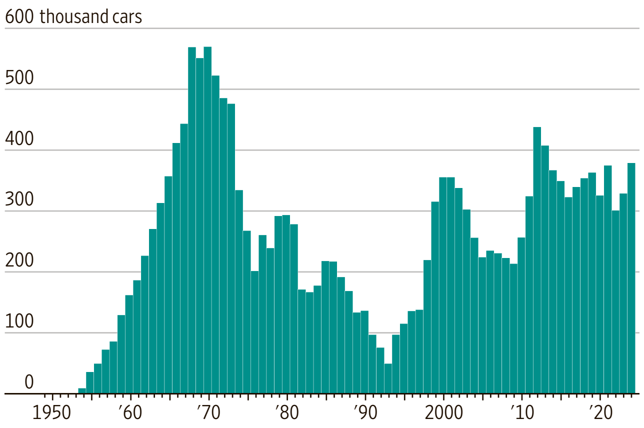
Volkswagen owns luxury automakers Audi and Porsche in a structure that encourages competition between rival teams to develop new technologies, such as those feeding into the novel approach to electric vehicles that spawned the ID.Buzz.

The belief was that friendly competition would yield a better product, but it had the effect of slowing down decision-making on the ID.Buzz, according to a former executive at Volkswagen's North American arm.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Concertgoers on the roof of a VW bus at Woodstock in 1969.

VW vehicle sales in the U.S.



The competition also drove up costs as the departments duplicated efforts, the person said.

Volkswagen, which developed the ID.Buzz alongside other EVs such as the ID.4, later vied with the company's separate commercial-vehicle arm for the right to produce it.

Diess had considered making the vehicle in the U.S., where Volkswagen opened a factory in Chattanooga, Tenn., in 2011. As a compromise to get the ID.Buzz over the line, Diess gave the vehicle to the commercial-vehicle business, which had produced the original bus and made its successor vehicles for sale across Europe. Chattanooga got to produce the more mainstream ID.4 SUV instead, while the commercial business gave up a project to electrify an existing van.

But the commercial-vehicle engineers had less expertise on electric-vehicle technology and building automobiles for sale in the U.S.

The commercial-vehicle business is also based at a plant in Hanover that is among the company's most expensive. The labor cost of producing a vehicle in Germany was roughly $3,307 last year, compared with $1,341 in the U.S., according to a recent report by consultants at Oliver Wyman. Hundreds of millions of euros were also spent on upgrading the plant to accommodate production of an EV on an all-new platform.

The decision to make the vehicle in Hanover was at least partially due to Volkswagen's complicated political situation. Hanover is the capital of Lower Saxony, the German region that owns 20% of the company's voting shares and has two seats on its board. “Herbert's plans to take the bus out of Hanover and put it in another country didn't go down well with Lower Saxony,” recalls one executive who was involved in the project.

The Volkswagen spokesman said the factories run by the commercial-vehicle business were the only ones with the equipment to build a vehicle with side panels such as the ID.Buzz.

Supply shortages pushed up battery costs during the pandemic, which was especially impactful for the ID.Buzz, given the large battery required to move a bus. High costs meant the plusher interior features initially envisaged, such as a soft dashboard and door panels, were gradually replaced with cheaper plastics as the project progressed.

The styling of the original bus that made it so endearing turned out to translate poorly in the EV age. When Diess showed an ID.Buzz prototype in 2017, he promised EVs that would be “affordable for millions, not just to millionaires.” The company prepared its Hanover factory to produce up to 130,000 units a year, and executives hinted that they could in time manufacture it in the U.S. as well.

Only around 30,000 units were sold last year, hurt in Europe by key markets including Germany and Sweden rolling back EV subsidies.

The original VW bus had its engine at the rear, giving it an unusually flat front and poor aerodynamics. For an EV, minimizing weight and air drag is key to maximizing range per unit of expensive battery power.

Volkswagen's designers made the front of the ID.Buzz much more sloping than that of the original bus, but they still had to use an outsize battery to report an anemic range of 234 miles at full charge.

When the ID.Buzz finally hit U.S. dealerships in October, the $60,000 price tag was criticized as being higher than many competitors' vehicles, which could also travel farther on a single battery charge.

“Anyone who has been around VW thinks the price point is high,” said Fred Emich IV, a Volkswagen and Kia dealer.

After less than a year on the U.S. market, the ID.Buzz has already been subject to two recall notices, both for glaring design oversights. In April, the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration warned that the vehicle showed the international brake-warning sign in amber rather than the word “brake” in red capital letters, which is the requirement in the U.S.

A few weeks later, the body said the third-row seat was too wide because it could accommodate three people even though it only had two seat belts. The company is fitting plastic parts to cover the sides of the seats in the roughly 5,600 vehicles affected.

Volkswagen also appeared to miss the biggest appeal of the ID.Buzz to American car buyers: its paint job.

The top-of-the-line ID.Buzz comes in a two-tone paint job with names like Cabana Blue and Pomelo Yellow, reminiscent of the vintage models often found in psychedelic hues. The base model is only offered in pedestrian white, gray or black.

To help juice sales of those models, Volkswagen started directing dealers to wrap the cheaper versions with colored vinyl.

The snafus are emblematic of Volkswagen's struggles to bring products designed for European tastes or regulatory standards to the U.S.

Used to catering to sedan-loving Europeans, the company was slow to introduce SUVs as Americans started to embrace them in the 2000s. The emissions scandal itself was rooted in an effort to adapt a European technology for tighter U.S. nitrogen-oxide emissions standards, at minimal cost.

“The problem with all of the Volkswagen brands has always been that they've just been a bit too Europe-centric,” said Citigroup analyst Harald Hendrikse.

The company has made clear it wants to change that. At Volkswagen's annual general meeting in May, Chief Executive Officer Oliver Blume said it was “formulating a vision for North America,” where it wants to grow “with products that are consistently geared to the expectations of American customers.”

But Blume didn't evoke the ID.Buzz. Instead he talked about Scout, the heritage SUV brand for which the company is building a $2 billion new factory in South Carolina.

Class Is In Session At Disney

Continued from Page One

eral times a week, or even every day, as part of their curriculum. A “Florida Disney Homeschool Meetup” Facebook group has over 2,000 members.

Sisk's days start with reading and table work at home. Then she's off to the parks three or four times a week. If her children are learning about animals, they go see tigers at the Maharajah Jungle Trek. If they're curious about Paris, they visit the France Pavilion at Epcot.

Park maps are textbooks for orienteering. Wait times for rides are lessons on abstract math, instead of triggers for family meltdowns. “They've gotten really good at understanding how long 45 minutes actually feels,” said Sisk.

Some moms go further. Holly Leary, a former middle school English teacher with a 10-year-old daughter, runs an Etsy shop selling Disney-inspired workbooks parents can use at the parks. Titles include “Peter Pan: Role of an Architect, Creating a Blueprint.”

For Leary and her daughter, Pirates of the Caribbean is an intro lesson in economics. (“Do you think piracy hurt or helped the economy?” is a prompt in Leary's workbook.) Spaceship Earth (the Epcot ball) is an opportunity to study geodesic domes.

Living 10 minutes from Magic Kingdom also means that instead of school bells, fireworks remind them of time. “At first, the nightly fireworks were magical,” Leary said. “Now they're basically our bedtime alarm. I'll hear the booms and yell, ‘OK, 9 p.m.! Lights out after fireworks!’”

Disney declined to comment on the use of its brand in learning materials.

For families that use Disney as their educational playground, costs accumulate fast. Many are annual members, which lowers the cost per visit, and budget around $3,000 to $5,000 a year for park passes, food, and merchandise.

Jordan Ashley makes sure her children utilize everything in the parks, even the guests. “We once graphed how many people were wearing Mickey ears vs. Star Wars shirts while waiting for the parade,” she said. Now it's a tradition.

Her daughters have pitched inventions to cast members, conducted Spanish lessons with Mirabel and written letters to their favorite princesses.

For many visitors, Disney is a busy, chaotic place that involves meticulous planning and gaming the ride wait lines. For some, even crowd management is a learning opportunity.

“The tram, the monorail, the ferry—it's improved his adaptability,” said Rachael Aderhold, who began incorporating Disney World into home schooling after traditional classrooms were too overwhelming and rigid for her 8-year-old son, who is autistic. Pin trading doubles as speech lessons, and budgeting for snacks is an exercise in financial literacy.

Aderhold said she spends about $3,700 a year home schooling, which includes at least one day a week in the parks during the school year and at least two days a week in the summer. She said this is less than she previously spent on gas, uniforms and lunches at public school.

Jacqui Portwood met her husband John in the Disney College Program, an internship where undergrads and recent graduates work at the parks.

“I met so many local families who brought their kids all the time,” she said. “I wanted my children to celebrate milestones at Disney too, to have that magic in their everyday life.”

Favorite lesson plans for her three children are exploring shark biology at the aquariums and learning cultural stories from the international cast members at Epcot.

Portwood, who estimates the family spends about $5,000 a year at Disney, said her husband's weekday job is the “adult money” to pay the bills. The money she earns from social media, where she chronicles her home schooling, is their “Disney money.”

And for the children, sometimes school is still school, even at the Most Magical Place on Earth. When a cast member once asked Portwood's son if he was having a good day, he gave them a funny look and said, “‘No, I'm only here for school today,’” she said.

These moms are aware their approach isn't for everyone.

“Education doesn't have to fit in a box,” said Sisk, the former teacher. To people who would argue that learning at Disney isn't a legitimate method, she said, “If it doesn't work for you, that's fine.”

ARTS IN REVIEW

FILM REVIEW | KYLE SMITH

A Man of Steel With Feet of Clay

James Gunn launches the new DC Universe with 'Superman,' which mocks the mythology of its hero

The alert reader will have noticed by now a certain frustration on my part with the willful unoriginality in Hollywood, where "creative industry" is proving increasingly to be an oxymoron. Imagine my excitement in the opening moments of "Superman," written and directed by James Gunn as the first chapter in a relaunch of DC's superhero-movie franchise, now called the DC Universe. Mr. Gunn is determined to shake things up a lot, and does.

Different, however, is not always good. The film starts out with some myth-busting: The man in the cape, played by David Corenswet in his first major role, has suffered his first defeat in battle. Look, down in the dirt! It's Superman! Appearing about as glorious as Jake LaMotta after 10 rounds with Sugar Ray Robinson. A prologue explains that for centuries Earth has been home to many superior beings called "metahumans"; just as the new Jurassic movie imagines dinosaurs as public pests notable for disrupting traffic, Supes is merely one of many amazing beings crowding the airspace. As Clark Kent, working at the Daily Planet with Jimmy Olsen (Skyler Gisondo) and Perry White (Wendell Pierce), he has a habit of landing suspiciously exclusive interviews with Superman. Supreme power has gone stale, and Mr. Gunn gambles that his world is so prosaic it's funny.

Rachel Brosnahan and David Corenswet, top, and Nicholas Hoult, above.

WARNER BROS. PICTURES (2)

Back home, Lois Lane (a cute Rachel Brosnahan) knows Superman's true identity and the pair have been dating long enough to get on each other's nerves. For once, he gives Lois an interview, which devolves into a spat. Also, Superman has a super-dog, Krypto, who is annoyingly hyperactive but also keeps saving him.

Despite being fake-looking and digital, the mutt is the star of the movie, because this "Superman" has the soul of a sitcom. It features wacky neighbors: the subsidiary metahumans Green Lantern (Nathan Fillion, in a "Dumb and Dumber" haircut); Mister Terrific (Edi Gathegi), who floats around pushing buttons on a console; and the attacking Hawkgirl (Isabela Merced), all of whom pop in to assist Superman. Its villain, Lex Luthor (a staggeringly miscast Nicholas Hoult) is the persnickety Dwight Schrute of the piece, forever huffing about how Superman is breaking the rules, particularly at his Fortress of Solitude, which apparently is not up to code. Lex, whose girlfriend, Eve Teschmacher (Sara Sampaio), is a ditzy online influencer—Mr. Gunn takes a lot of feeble swipes at social media—is accompanied by a henchwoman, the Engineer (María Gabriela de Faría), who can make her hands into circular saws or tentacles that double as data cables for hacking into computers.

Luthor, an arms dealer trying to profit from the invasion of a sort of Middle Eastern analogue for Ukraine, threatens Superman by uncovering secret information, unknown even to the hero himself, about his background, which leads to a semi-comical stint in prison with a lump of Kryptonite and a strange being named Metamorpho (Anthony Carrigan). In keeping with the general air of mockery, Superman's adoptive Earth parents are a pair of Dust Bowl dimwits (Pruitt Taylor Vince, Neva Howell) instead of strong-backed heartland avatars of decency.

That's new, even startling, but also painful. For the most part the movie is, like Metropolis after Luthor gets to work, a disaster area. I'm not a huge fan of Mr. Gunn—I didn't like any of the three "Guardians of the Galaxy" movies he directed, though I enjoyed his 2021 action comedy "The Suicide Squad" and the very funny spinoff HBO Max series "Peacemaker." But even if I were, I think I'd be nonplussed by what he's doing here. Peacemaker is supposed to be a spoof of comic-book heroism; Superman isn't.

Mr. Corenswet is likeable enough, and has a powerful physical presence, but he's vaguely pathetic for most of the movie. Superman can be a myth, a god, an American emblem or a symbol of the overachieving immigrant, but making him a schmo who's so weak he'd be in deep trouble if it weren't for his ridiculous dog feels like a dizzyingly dismissive choice.

When, in the third act, Mr. Gunn essentially says, "Forget how I've been ridiculing the legend for the last hour and a half, now I want you to feel awestruck and inspired" and cues up some of that incomparably glorious John Williams score from the 1978 "Superman," it's too late. Typical of Mr. Gunn's nonsensical approach is a scene where skyscrapers get knocked over but we're supposed to cheer because Superman saves one little girl. There's a marvelous image of Superman and Lois Lane sharing a passionate kiss while they rise into the air, but its earnestness seems borrowed from some other movie. Otherwise the clanking gags and surfeit of superpeople drain the wonder out of this Superman. The Gunniverse is starting with a misfire.

TELEVISION REVIEW | JOHN ANDERSON

Lena Dunham's Languid Rom-Com

An alleged romantic comedy that's neither, "Too Much" is the co-creation of its director and primary writer, Lena Dunham, author of "Girls." It has intellectual ambitions. It will bewilder critics. But it really seems, at best, like the dark side of "Emily in Paris."

"Too Much" will certainly generate far more consternation. Or at least conversation. Like "Emily," it involves an American pursuing career opportunities in Europe, committing faux pas, struggling with an unfamiliar culture and looking for love. And finding it. And fouling it up. The challenge for the viewer is finding a reason to emotionally invest.

For Jessica Salmon (Megan Stalter), the challenge is healing a wounded heart in a new country. Although she's being sent her to supervise her company's commercial ad production in the U.K., a prime motivation for her trip is the nasty breakup she's had with Zev (Michael Zegen, the philandering Mr. Maisel in "The Marvelous Mrs. Maisel"), who is now snuggling with Wendy Jones (Emily Ratajkowski), an online influencer with whom Jessica becomes both literally and virtually obsessed. This is a striking aspect of "Too Much"—a psychologically complicated wrinkle in a character who is mostly depicted as the stereotypical crazy ex-girlfriend, if less interesting. And it is one that may strike a chord: the fascination with one's rival, an erotic Stockholm syndrome of sorts. Except that no one is about to hold Jessica hostage.

Hoping to heal after a breakup, an American woman moves to London.

The complexity isn't entirely surprising. "Girls" was an intentionally provocative series that won a lot of fans for where it focused its attention—on bad sex, for instance. The subject matter wasn't always taboo, exactly, but "Girls" was never afraid of venturing into territory largely ignored by mainstream pop culture and thus tickled a nerve among its audience, especially young urban women. Ms. Dunham (who appears as Jessica's depressed sister) has been quoted as saying "Girls" never had an overt "mission statement," and neither does "Too Much." But at least "Girls" had elements of surprise, transgression, shock and awe. (It first aired in 2012.) "Too Much" is lighter, and thus far more tedious.

Megan Stalter in 'Too Much,' a 10-part Netflix series from the creator of 'Girls.'

NETFLIX

The 10-part season seems intended to be less about story or acting than a showcase for Ms. Stalter, who has played Kayla Schaefer, the loudly comedic, boundary-free, plus-size nepo baby on "Hacks," and brings some if not all of Kayla's arguably unstable personality to the new show. In a flashback—from a ruminative walk over London's Westminster Bridge—we see Jessica using her old keys to try and enter Zev's Brooklyn brownstone; failing; complaining ("I'm not the kind of girl you change the locks on," she says indignantly, which is pretty funny); breaking in; and invading Zev and Wendy's bedroom. All the while she is ranting, raving and establishing herself as unhinged, self-indulgent and unworthy of our sympathy. Or attention. She will tone it down, and Ms. Dunham makes the most of Ms. Stalter's angelic face, which can tweak an awkward moment into pathos. But "Too Much" relies too much on its ability to make an audience cringe, a limited resource at best.

All of the above makes the show's centerpiece—the romance between Jessica and Felix (Will Sharpe)—nonsensical. Ms. Dunham and company take pains to portray Felix as vaguely tortured and sexually complex (his romance with a dominatrix, for instance), but his charm lies in being straightforward, honest and no-nonsense, while Jessica is all about nonsense. And unearned indignation. And being cluelessly impolitic around the London office, where her co-workers (including the boss, played by Richard E. Grant) practice a particularly British strain of snark. Felix and Jessica are illogical, but in a show that executes very little in terms of conventional storytelling, this is hardly the biggest problem.

I wondered during "Too Much" whether I wasn't just the wrong sex but the wrong age to be watching, not only because the narrative was all but nonexistent and the dialogue aimless, but because of the music, which seems meant to reflect not just Felix's vocation as a singer-songwriter, but the show's aesthetic, if not its philosophy: The melodies are hackneyed, the lyrics follow no rhyme scheme (it worked for Sondheim; these folks aren't Sondheim). And if the found-music choices were meant to reflect the show's contrarian approach to traditional entertainment, they were beyond clever. But the sense one gets from "Too Much" is of a show made by people who think a ragged focus equals profundity, catering to an audience that isn't overly concerned either way.

Too Much
Netflix

Mr. Anderson is the Journal's TV critic.

THEATER REVIEW | CHARLES ISHERWOOD

‘Memnon’: The Waste of War

A play borrows elements of Greek tragedy in telling a Trojan War tale focused on a lesser-known figure

Eric Berryman in the play by Will Power, co-conceived and directed by Carl Cofield.

New York

Was that rumbling during a performance of Will Power's play "Memnon" meant to be the fury of the Greek and Trojan armies clashing? Apparently not. The show is being presented by the Classical Theatre of Harlem in the open-air auditorium in Marcus Garvey Park, and those appropriately atmospheric sounds were actually leftover fireworks being set off somewhere else in the park, the night after July 4.

Unintentional though they were, these bursts of sound nevertheless added to the effectiveness of this neoclassical play, which is styled largely in the mold of Greek tragedy, and explores a little-known chapter in the grueling grudge match of the Trojan War. The drama depicts the late intervention in the conflict of the title character, the king of Ethiopia. (Some of the literature pertaining to this legendary conflict includes references to Memnon, but Homer's "Iliad" concludes before his entry into the war.)

The play, directed with crisp focus by Carl Cofield, who conceived it with Mr. Power, begins as the Trojans, led by their king, Priam (Jesse J. Perez), are mourning the death of the great warrior Hector at the hands of the supreme Greek hero Achilles (Jesse Corbin). An air of gloomy despair and a fear of annihilation pervades the querulous discussion between Priam, whom Mr. Perez infuses with a funny peevishness, and his adviser Polydamas (David Darrow).

"The jewel of civilization, the crown of humanity / now to be obliterated by these barbarians," Polydamas laments, "our collective hearts and tongues cut out." He implores Priam to send out a desperate summons to Memnon, his nephew, to bring his fabled armies into the war on the side of the flailing Trojans. Priam at first resists the suggestion, still bearing a bitter grudge against Memnon for his supposed ungratefulness.

With the reasoned encouragement of Helen (Andrea Patterson)—she whose departure (or abduction) from Greece started the whole bloody ruckus—Priam ultimately gives in, although when Memnon (Eric Berryman) arrives, the undiplomatic Priam cannot resist dredging up their fraught history.

Mr. Power, perhaps best known for "Fetch Clay, Make Man," about the unlikely friendship between Muhammad Ali and the comedian and actor Stepin Fetchit, has previously delved into classical territory, notably in his acclaimed drama "The Seven," an adaptation of Aeschylus' "Seven Against Thebes." His writing here convincingly evokes the heightened, rhythmic, often incantatory style associated with Greek tragedy, with much of the play consisting of sustained monologues. But he breaks from the tradition, in which virtually all "action" takes place offstage, by having the two mano-a-mano battles, between Memnon and the Greek Antilochus (Mr. Darrow), and the climactic fatal duel between Memnon and Achilles, take place before us. (Audiences who enjoy the swordplay-swathed war plays of Shakespeare will be grateful.)

And while Mr. Power maintains a fairly rigorous fidelity to the structure and style of Greek tragedy, "Memnon" is inflected with a contemporary sensibility. During the scene in which Priam and Memnon meet, Memnon explains his decision to leave Troy by expressing his feelings of alienation from Trojan society: "Times there were when reminded I was / that Troy and I were not the same, that I / was Troy but not fully Trojan, kin and / not kin." The implication is this was because of his mixed race—an idea that retains some currency. Mr. Berryman brings to the role a gleaming dignity, expressed movingly when he refuses to fight the much older Nestor, who is enraged at the killing of his son Antilochus. The actor also has a magnetic energy that brings physical vitality to his battle scenes.

And Helen, often relegated to a blurry part in the saga, virtually voiceless and the prototypical femme fatale, here insists that only in Troy has she achieved a sense of identity: "In Troy Helen is Helen at home Helen is hell / In Troy Helen has choice at home no free will." Ms. Patterson imbues her character with a subtle but forceful majesty while at the same time stripping away the pageant-queen-of-all-time sheen to reveal her humanity.

As Achilles, Mr. Corbin has the requisite muscular heroism, but Mr. Power also indicates the character's ambivalence about his battlefield accomplishments, as he at first resists Nestor's pleas to avenge his son's death: "To what end Nestor? / More death will not bring [your] son back, as my friend Patroclus / did not return from the dead when sent I did so many / wretched Trojans to join him."

Jesse J. Perez, who plays both the king of Troy and a Greek warrior, above; Andrea Patterson and Mr. Berryman, below.

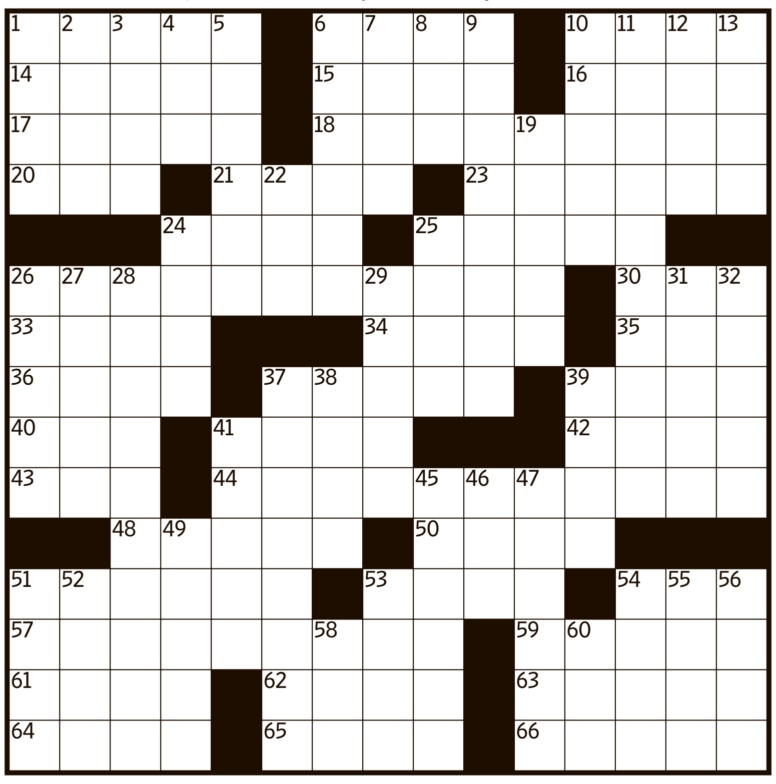
The production is handsomely designed, with the imposing unit set by Riw Rakkulchon depicting the rubble of a city in ruins, marked by the crumpled vestiges of once-towering columns. This echoes Mr. Power's emphasis on the dubious utility and ultimate waste of warfare. When, for instance, Priam lavishes praise upon Memnon for his exploits in battle, Memnon counters by insisting that he has achieved his stature more through benign diplomacy than bloodshed. And even Achilles, that most vengeful and murderous figure of legend, insists that it is not human foes he blames for the long, sanguinary war: "I despise not the Trojans," he tells Nestor, "but gods that play chess with souls of men."

Memnon
Richard Rodgers Amphitheater in Marcus Garvey Park, 18 Mt. Morris Park West, New York, Free; closes July 27

Mr. Isherwood is the Journal's theater critic.

The WSJ Daily Crossword | Edited by Mike Shenk

PUZZLE CONTEST



PARTS INVENTORY | By Mike Shenk

The answer to this week's contest crossword is **a four-letter noun.**

Across

1 Tally of parts
6 Polite address
10 "Shoot!"
14 Media megastar
15 ___ facto
16 Missouri River native
17 Grazing spot
18 Barbecue treats
20 Chicago movers
21 Splinter group
23 2, 3, 5, 7, etc.
24 Bridges in Hollywood
25 Go after
26 Hammer and Spade, for two
30 Shih Tzu, e.g.
33 Cape Town coin
34 Gift from parents
35 Be in arrears
36 Answers after two rings?
37 Embarrassing outburst
39 Mystery writer Buchanan
40 Polite address
41 Ceiling supporter
42 Losing scheme
43 Like Carnaby Street fashions
44 Small sponge cakes
48 Articles
50 "By George"
51 Many a garden flower
53 Problems for collaborators
54 Washing instructions site
57 Clockwork components
59 Tahrir Square setting
61 "___ perpetua" (Idaho motto)
62 Wooden strip
63 Bitter-smelling
64 Hearty bowlful
65 Goes unused
66 Some orchestra members

Down

1 It's beneath the mantle
2 Fall birthstone
3 Columbarium array
4 Old bay, e.g.
5 John Banville novel that won the Booker Prize
6 Blunder
7 Cal. entry
8 Simile center
9 Basic unit of a language
10 Day in the movies
11 1989 Wilbur Smith novel
12 Spa cover
13 Noted loch
19 Render blank
22 Have something
24 Some briefs, briefly
25 Printing color
26 Rainbow producer
27 Marconi's invention
28 Excessive
29 The other side
31 Person with a title
32 "Sailing to Byzantium" poet
37 Without interruption
38 Bounders
39 Nervous
41 Lament from a lamb
45 Some Vegas events
46 Prefix akin to equi-
47 Org. with a Charlotte hall of fame
49 "Presumed Innocent" author
51 Years and years
52 High home
53 Coup target
54 One of a car quartet
55 Dry
56 Olympic group
58 Football's Manning
60 Court feat

Previous Puzzle's Solution

C	A	M	O	S	■	I	D	E	A	■	S	P	A	M
C	R	A	V	E	■	M	O	T	H	■	T	A	D	A
S	C	R	E	E	N	P	L	A	Y	■	O	R	E	S
■	■	I	N	T	O	I	T	■	E	G	O	I	S	T
B	O	N	M	O	T	S	■	I	S	O	L	A	T	E
A	L	A	I	■	A	H	A	B	■	U	S	H	E	R
S	E	T	T	O	S	■	R	A	W	R	■	■	■	■
■	G	E	T	S	T	H	E	R	E	D	O	U	T	■
■	■	■	■	A	E	O	N	■	S	E	I	N	E	S
S	A	Y	O	K	■	L	A	S	T	■	L	M	A	O
T	S	U	N	A	M	I	■	T	E	A	B	A	L	L
I	M	M	U	N	O	■	S	A	L	S	A	S	■	■
L	A	Y	S	■	B	U	L	L	M	A	R	K	E	T
T	R	U	E	■	I	S	A	K	■	N	O	E	L	S
S	A	M	S	■	L	A	W	S	■	A	N	D	I	E

▶ Email your answer—in the subject line—to **crosswordcontest@wsj.com** by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time Sunday, July 13. A solver selected at random will win a WSJ mug. June 27 winner: Gary Reed , Merriam, KS. Complete contest rules at **WSJ.com/Puzzles**. (No purchase necessary. Void where prohibited. U.S. residents 18 and over only.)

SPORTS

By Jared Diamond
And Miriam Gottfried

There's a Gold Rush in Sports. Baseball Is Lagging Behind.

Teams are worth more than ever, but Major League Baseball has missed out on the bonanza

When the Minnesota Twins were put up for sale last year, their owners had every reason to believe that it wouldn't be long before the right billionaire offered them a fortune.

Only a handful of Major League Baseball franchises had changed hands in the previous decade, and that included the record-setting $2.4 billion purchase of the New York Mets by hedge-fund titan Steve Cohen. It seemed as if the Twins were hitting the market at just the right time.

But nine months and at least one scuttled deal later, they still don't have a buyer.

The saga of the Twins has underscored a disconcerting reality for the baseball business. While professional sports teams in other American leagues are selling for increasingly astronomical numbers, the game known as the national pastime has largely missed out on the bonanza.

"It's no secret that we've lagged behind the other sports," Atlanta Braves chairman Terry McGuirk said at a June investor event. Baseball teams are typically valued at four to nine times expected revenues, McGuirk said, while NBA teams go for multiples of 10 to 15.

Deep-pocketed clubs like the Los Angeles Dodgers and New York Yankees are still immensely valuable, with some estimates putting them between $7 and $9 billion, above many NFL teams. For everyone else, however, the situation is far less rosy. The Baltimore Orioles, the most recent team to change hands, went for $1.725 billion to Carlyle co-founder David Rubenstein. The Kansas City Royals sold for $1 billion in 2019 to local businessman John Sherman.

While the recent $10 billion deal inked for the NBA's Los Angeles Lakers and the $6 billion deal for NFL's Washington Commanders in 2023 set records, valuations have also been healthy for smaller-market teams in those leagues. The Charlotte Hornets went for $3 billion in 2023. The Denver Broncos sold for $4.65 billion in 2022. Even the NHL's Tampa Bay Lightning sold for $1.8 billion last fall—slightly above the price that the owners of the Tampa Bay Rays MLB team are currently negotiating.

In response, MLB commissioner Rob Manfred two years ago formed a six-member "economic reform" committee. Its mission is to address the issue of lagging franchise valuations.

"Why are we where we are?" Manfred said at the Braves investor event. "And what can we do to fix our situation?"

That last part won't necessarily be an easy task. Two major characteristics set MLB's business model apart from the rest of North American sports: Baseball has traditionally been far more reliant than the other leagues on local television deals to drive revenue. It is also the only major sport

The Minnesota Twins are still looking for a buyer after being put up for sale last year.

ELLEN SCHMIDT/ASSOCIATED PRESS

that lacks any form of salary cap.

Taken together, those factors make it difficult to predict a franchise's earning potential or reliably forecast expenses, spooking some potential buyers.

The NFL and NBA derive much of their revenue from lucrative national TV deals split evenly among teams. In baseball, teams generate about 25% of their revenue on average from deals they strike themselves with local regional sports networks. The system means teams in bigger TV markets can command significantly higher fees, giving them resources to attract and retain star players.

On the national-rights front, ESPN in February exercised a clause to opt out of the final three years of its $550 million-a-year contract with MLB at the end of the 2025 season.

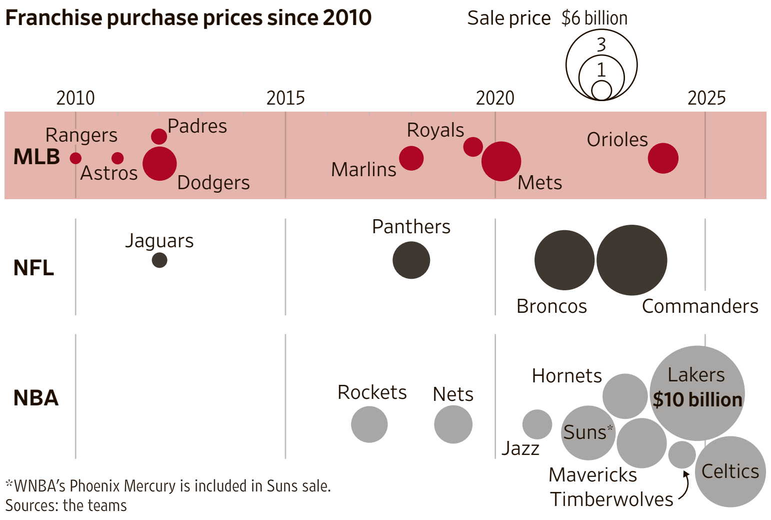
Meanwhile, many owners believe the lack of a salary cap has resulted in a growing competitive and economic imbalance between the big-market teams and their small-market counterparts. The Dodgers are spending a half-billion dollars on their roster between payroll and luxury tax payments. The Miami Marlins, meanwhile, have a payroll of around $67 million. (Perhaps not surprisingly, the Dodgers are World Series favorites this season, while the Marlins have a record below .500.)

"We don't have the kind of cost certainty, predictability and competitive balance mechanisms in our player comp system that the three other major professional sports have," Manfred said at the Braves investor event.

That may be about to change. Baseball owners could try to introduce a salary cap and floor after the current collective bargaining agreement ends next year. Manfred also says he wants to centralize baseball's media rights, moving teams away from their current reliance on local TV deals in favor of a more national approach.

His ability to accomplish either feat is far from certain. Pooling media rights would require wealthy teams to share more revenue than they do now. A salary cap has long been seen as a third rail by the players' union, and a serious push for one would almost certainly result in a prolonged work stoppage. The last time baseball's owners made a serious attempt, it resulted in the player strike that canceled the 1994 World Series and badly damaged the sport.

Franchise purchase prices since 2010



*WNBA's Phoenix Mercury is included in Suns sale.
Sources: the teams

As for the Twins, they appeared close to finding a buyer earlier this year when private-equity billionaire Justin Ishbia expressed interest. He abandoned his pursuit of the team in February and last month struck an agreement to eventually take control of the big-market Chicago White Sox.

"Aggregating media rights and creating a better product doesn't just improve outcomes for owners," said Zachary Pack, head of sports advisory at merchant bank BDT & MSD, whose co-CEO Byron Trott represented the White Sox in its recent sale process. "It also benefits fans and players."

How Texas Tech Landed a $5 Million Football Recruit

By Laine Higgins

FELIX OJO could have chosen to play football for any college he wanted.

The No. 1 recruit in the state of Texas, a 6-foot-7, 275-pound behemoth with more than 50 offers from Division I schools, Ojo was wanted by Ohio State, Michigan and the Texas Longhorns.

But when he announced his commitment on his 17th birthday last weekend, Ojo didn't opt for one of the country's blue blood programs. Instead, he chose to join Texas Tech—a team that might generously be described as the fifth-biggest college football program in its own state.

The decision was a stunner, but the most startling part wasn't Ojo spurning the Buckeyes and Longhorns in favor of spending several years in Lubbock. It was the financial terms of the deal, which will pay the Red Raiders' new offensive tackle millions of dollars over the next three years.

While the exact details are a little fuzzy—Ojo's agent says the deal is valued at $5.1 million over three years, people familiar with the Tech football program say it's for less than half that amount and for less time—the timing of the deal, the sums of money involved and the caliber of Ojo as a prospect make this the splashiest commitment of college football's new revenue-sharing era.

"Texas Tech is not about trying to be normal," said Derrick Shelby, Ojo's agent with Prestige Management. "They're trying to let people know they're the biggest, they're the best. And they're here to stay."

The easiest way to make a

Texas Tech landed top football recruit Felix Ojo with a lucrative deal, signaling a bold entry into college football's revenue-sharing era.

JESSICA TOBIAS/ASSOCIATED PRESS

name for yourself in college football is by throwing around lots of cash, and lately, Texas Tech has done exactly that. Fueled by an alumni base rolling in oil and gas money, the Red Raiders have pumped huge sums into their sports teams—and haven't been shy about letting everyone know.

During the chaos of football's January transfer portal window, Tech brought in the top-ranked group—and the Matador Club, the school's booster collective, bragged about spending $10 million to pull it off.

"We had the No. 1 football transfer class and it's because we understood the issues and the loopholes and opportunities it presented and took advantage of them," said Tech booster Cody Campbell, an oil billionaire who played for the Red Raiders in the early 2000s. "We've been winners in all of this."

Those opportunities aren't limited to the gridiron. To make sure the basketball team's star forward JT Toppin returned for next season, the Matador Club offered him a reported $4 million. NiJaree Canady, the star softball pitcher from Stanford, was lured to West Texas with an offer of $1.1 million.

"They've done great jobs of getting eyeballs on a brand that historically doesn't get eyeballs," said Andrew Donovan, president of the collegiate business at consulting firm Altius Sports Partners. "They're swinging for the fences."

Texas Tech knows only too well that its in-your-face spending will rankle college sports traditionalists. They just don't care. Following Ojo's commitment, the football team's general manager reposted a tweet on X reminding people how the team's free-spending ways are funded.

"Remember when you put gas in your car," it read, "Texas Tech athletics appreciates you!"

Underpinning these moves is the belief that spending on a few key pieces can have an outsized impact on one team's fortunes. That much proved true on the softball diamond, where Canady last month led the Red Raiders to their first Women's College World Series final appearance.

It's unclear whether the same strategy will work in football, where it's harder for one player to swing the outcome. Which makes Ojo's signing a gargantuan gamble.

It's true that Ojo's payday is different from Canady's and his transfer teammates. While they are all funded by boosters via the Matador Club, Ojo will be paid directly by Texas Tech thanks to new rules that allow universities to pay athletes up to $20.5 million per year as of July 1.

Texas Tech plans to distribute nearly three-quarters of its money to the football team. If Ojo's deal is as big as his agent suggests, approximately 11% of the team's budget will be going to the left tackle.

Should Ojo get hurt or turn out to be a bust, he could become a 300-pound albatross on Texas Tech's books. At the same time, his recruitment signals to other top prospects that player-friendly deals are on offer in West Texas.

"Every kid sees that," said Shelby, the agent. "Texas Tech is extremely intelligent about how they conduct their business."

OPINION

The GOP Manages to Function

By Barton Swaim

For the third time this year, congressional Republicans have managed to act like a normal political party.

In January, a rebellion against House Speaker Mike Johnson fizzled at the last minute, and every Republican but one voted to re-elect him. The mainstream press had been hoping for the dysfunctionality of 2023, when the House GOP booted Speaker Kevin McCarthy for no coherent reason and took three weeks to find a replacement.

Then, in March, the GOP passed a continuing resolution to keep the government open for six months. Some House Republicans registered their usual and entirely defensible complaint that continuing resolutions are a poor substitute for proper budgets. But in the end they voted for the bill, for the excellent reason that to do otherwise would precipitate a shutdown for which they, not Democrats, would be blamed.

Now, with the passage of the One Big Beautiful Bill Act, it's happened a third time. For months news coverage anticipated Freedom Caucus defiance, swing-district defections and general GOP fractiousness. Some Republicans denounced the bill because it would add to the deficit, others because this or that reform went too far or not far enough. But that isn't dysfunctionality; that's politics. In the end, every House Republican save two voted yes. Only three Republican senators voted no, happy in the knowledge that it would pass anyway.

Of course, the press has one explanation for Republicans' newfound unity: President Trump's "grip" on, "dominance" of and "power" over the party. I've never quite grasped why it's such a remarkable thing that a legislative conference should fall in

So far in 2025, its lawmakers have acted like a normal political party. What changed?

line with a president from its own party. Anyway Republicans, having watched Democrats and the media pretend Joe Biden was sharp enough to run for re-election, are inclined to ignore lectures on the subject of subservience to a sitting president.

The fact remains: Republicans in 2025, unlike their precursors most of the time over the past two decades, suddenly seem capable of voting as a bloc despite sundry individual scruples. Why?

Part of the credit goes to Mr. Trump. His four-year hiatus from the Oval Office plainly enabled reflection on the mistakes of his first term. In 2025 he helped whip votes and refrained from pointless denunciations and contradictory pronouncements about what he wanted.

Majority Leader Steve Scalise, who was House Republican whip during Mr. Trump's first term, thinks pre-election preparation has turned the GOP into a functioning party. Mr. Scalise recalls second-term planning sessions at Mar-a-Lago well before the election. "We didn't want to make the same mistakes we made in 2017," he told me this week. In the first year of Mr. Trump's first term, "we didn't get the tax reform bill to him till late December. This time, we had the bill to his desk"—the big beautiful one—"on July 4, which nobody thought we could pull off."

I would suggest another, more general reason for Republican cohesion. What has long kept Republicans on the Hill from functioning as their Democratic correlatives do—like a single-minded partisan machine—is that the news media, expert class and entertainment-industry elite are, and have been for decades, fully aligned with Democratic aims and dead set against Republican ones.

A consequential liberal initiative is virtually guaranteed gentle treatment: favorable descriptions from the media, endorsements from academic experts and cheerleading from high-profile entertainers. Tough votes are easier when cultural arbiters unite to assure you of your righteousness, and harder when they call you a monster. Voting for a measure opposed by liberal VIPs, or against one favored by them—academic hotshots, eminent intellectuals, Hollywood actors—isn't something Democrats have to do all that often.

Yet in 2025 the Democrats' use of the media and adjacent cultural authorities has had little effect.

Take the modest Medicaid reform in the reconciliation bill. For weeks the media ran one histrionic, tendentious item after another: "We've Never Seen Health Care Cuts This Big" (New York Times), "Trump's Bill Slashes the Safety Net That Many Republican Voters Rely On" (also the Times), "5 Ways Trump's Megabill Will Limit Health Care Access" (NPR), "Rural Communities Brace for Medicaid Cuts in Republicans' Big Bill" (NBC).

Even a year ago, narrative-generation of this sort would have bullied a few dozen Republicans in swing districts into joining the Democrats. In 2025 it had basically no effect. Did the 2024 election teach elected Republicans that agitprop disguised as news coverage can safely be ignored? If so, Democrats are in bigger trouble than they think.

Mr. Swaim is an editorial page writer at the Journal.

Kimberley A. Strassel is away.

A Lesson in Faith on Fifth Avenue

HOUSES OF WORSHIP
By Tim Busch

New York

It was a rainy Sunday in January, one of those evenings when the light dances off the pavement and people rush about, eager to escape the cold and wet. My wife and I had seen a play and were walking briskly down 54th Street to dinner. As we approached Fifth Avenue, someone yelled, "Can you help the lady who's trying to cross the street?"

In New York, your first instinct is often suspicion. But then I saw her: an elderly woman standing at the curb holding a white cane and tapping gently at the sidewalk's edge. It took me a few moments to realize that she was blind and that she was the one who had called for help.

"Where are you going?" we asked.

"Fifth Avenue."

"Do you know the cross street?"

"It's near St. Patrick's Cathedral," she answered.

I gave her my arm. As we walked the few blocks toward the church, I told her how I often guide Father Robert Spitzer, a blind Jesuit priest who co-founded the Napa Institute with me. She smiled: "I know Father Spitzer. Isn't he involved in the Eucharistic procession?"—the 5,000-person event my organization hosts every October in Manhattan. "I was in the procession this past October," she added.

Her name was Maria Antoinette Kazan, an 80-year-old immigrant from Poland. She had lost her eyesight owing to a botched glaucoma surgery, but her inner light was undiminished. She told me she went to daily Mass at St. Patrick's, especially the 5:30 p.m. Sunday liturgy. Her composure, joy and warmth were deeply moving.

When we arrived at the cathedral steps, I asked if she needed more help. "Take me to the ushers," she said. "They know me and will seat me." How would she get home? "Someone from the church will walk me." I did as directed. The cathedral staff greeted her warmly, and I said goodbye, thanking her for her faith.

At dinner that evening, I saw Father Enrique Salvo, rector of St. Patrick's. I described the encounter and asked if the woman had been telling the truth. She had. Father Enrique said that he had walked her home many evenings after Mass. We mused about the courage it takes to navigate Midtown Manhattan without sight, relying on memory, faith and the kindness of strangers.

'Can you help the lady who's trying to cross the street?,' Maria yelled. I'm glad I did.

Five months went by, and last month Father Enrique informed me that Maria had died. She opened a window in her apartment and accidentally fell out.

The weight of those words sank deep. Her death felt like more than a tragedy. It felt like the closing of a chapter I didn't know was being written. In our short time together, I witnessed the truth that grace is so often found in the ordinary. Maria walked by faith, not by sight. Now, I pray she walks in the full presence of the light she trusted so completely on Earth.

After she died, Father Enrique told me he couldn't remember Maria missing a single weekday Mass since he arrived at the cathedral 3½ years ago. "She was an inspiration to everyone from our ushers to our daily parishioners to our visitors," he said, "because so many people make excuses to not come to Mass." He said "she made God her priority," and if she could do it, "we don't have an excuse" not to do the same. At Maria's funeral last month, Father Enrique described how she had memorized the cathedral's interior by how many steps she took. In that way, he added, "she memorized her way to Heaven."

While I knew Maria only briefly, I'm grateful for how she illuminated what matters in life. In guiding her, I found that she guided me. And in remembering her, I remember that grace is often only a block away—if only we're willing to stop, offer our arm and walk a few blocks.

Mr. Busch is co-founder of the Napa Institute, a Catholic lifestyle organization.

Big Beautiful Bill? It's Certainly Big

By Alan S. Blinder

You've got to hand it to Donald Trump. Leading Republicans to victories in the White House, Senate and House in 2024 was a notable achievement. But the margins were all slim, far from a mandate to promulgate the most radical package of economic and social policies in recent memory.

Yet Mr. Trump's command over the Republican lemmings who now dominate both houses is so strong that he has managed to squeeze through one of the most unpopular bills ever passed by Congress. Characteristically, Mr. Trump has labeled the One Big Beautiful Bill Act "the single most popular bill ever signed."

Back on Earth, the American public ranks the bill as one of the least popular ever, beating out even the original 2017 tax cuts and the 2008 bank "bailout." Why so unpopular? Let's look at a few of the major items in the 870-pager.

First, the law reprises parts of the regressive 2017 tax cuts that were scheduled to expire this year—with a few added bells and whistles. This tax cut alone accounts for trillions of dollars of additional deficits over the 10-year budget window—unless you refuse to count it, as some Republicans tried to do.

Democrats exaggerated by calling these "tax cuts for billionaires." Yes, billionaires will benefit, but most of the tax cuts will accrue to ordinary rich folk who are far from billionaires. Nonetheless, the regressivity isn't in doubt, and tax cuts for "the rich" (no matter how defined) have never been popular.

Second, the law makes deep cuts in Medicaid and other popular social programs such as the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (aka food stamps) and the Affordable Care Act marketplaces. You may remember

But the ugly new law is one of the least popular acts ever.

that the White House promised in March that "the Trump Administration will not cut Social Security, Medicare, or Medicaid benefits." Oh, well. They hope you forgot.

Third, some extremely unpopular programs—such as the gangster-like raids by Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents—are getting huge budget increases. You will soon be seeing even more masked men, armed for combat, using brutal force to apprehend and detain restaurant and hotel workers, farmhands, gardeners and day laborers who are scratching out livings—and often raising families and paying taxes—in a country they've called home for decades. The public may still support Mr. Trump on securing the border, but it doesn't like these cruel roundups.

So far, Mr. Trump is getting Congress to do just about anything he asks. But with midterm elections looming in 2026, this obeisance may not last. The Trump program lacks public support in almost every dimension. It's underwater now and seems destined to sink further.

Why? For openers, most Americans, and probably some members of Congress, don't know everything that's in the law. There are surprises to come and unless you live at the top of the income pyramid, most of them will be unpleasant.

Many of the troublesome Medicaid cuts have been deferred until after the 2026 midterms. How many Americans know that? But as time passes and political attention turns to the midterms, Democrats will be reminding them incessantly. In addition, the larger budget deficits created by the new law will likely drive interest rates higher and the dollar lower. Few Americans will view either as good news.

Then there are the other Trump economic policies, which are stagflationary on balance. I doubt voters will distinguish between what's in the new law and other policies that slow growth and raise inflation. They will just get unhappier as economic performance deteriorates. I am thinking specifically of the effects of higher tariffs and the shrinkage of the labor force from expelling immigrants.

No one, probably not even Mr. Trump, knows where—or when—the tariff war will wind up. But at some point U.S. tariffs will settle at a multiple of where they were before the Trump presidency. Tariffs are taxes on U.S. consumers and businesses, and they are stagflationary, like sales taxes.

The effect of immigration "reform" is probably even harder to predict. The Pew Research Center estimates that undocumented immigrants make up about 5% of the U.S. labor force. Take out a large slice of that and output will fall while prices rise—more stagflation.

Abraham Lincoln observed that, "Public sentiment is everything. With public sentiment, nothing can fail; without it, nothing can succeed." The Trump program clearly lacks public sentiment. We'll see if Lincoln was right.

Mr. Blinder is a professor of economics and public affairs at Princeton. He served as vice chairman of the Federal Reserve, 1994-96.

BOOKSHELF | By Richard Babcock

A Life of Grins And Groans

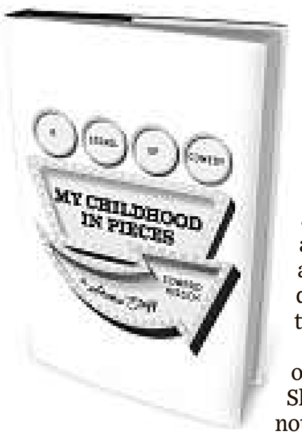
My Childhood in Pieces

By Edward Hirsch
Knopf, 288 pages, $29

Edward Hirsch, the celebrated poet, began life as Edward Rubenstein, the son of a mom named Irma and a dad who went by Ruby. But Ruby was a gambler and a gadabout, and Irma divorced him and married a man named Kurt Hirsch. When Eddie was 10, Irma wanted to change the boy's last name to the last name of his stepfather.

Ruby objected. A nasty little court battle ensued. Irma prevailed and the boy became Edward Hirsch—or so he and almost everyone else thought. But it turned out Irma didn't bother to file the legal papers to change her son's name until he was about to turn 21. He only found out decades later.

The deception was but one of many odd, occasionally funny and sometimes painful aspects of Mr. Hirsch's life growing up in a Chicago suburb, as recounted in "My Childhood in Pieces." The story unfolds in an almost pointillist style, in snippets of recollections, some only a sentence or two long. The result is a sprawling narrative peopled by an eccentric crew of relatives and friends and quickened with an array of setbacks, successes, disappointments and cruelties told with wit and a few regrets.



Mr. Hirsch subtitles his memoir "A Stand-Up Comedy, a Skokie Elegy," and he hits both notes. Skokie is a newish town some 15 miles north of downtown Chicago, populated in significant part by Jews, including, in Mr. Hirsch's youth, a fair number of Holocaust survivors.

Mr. Hirsch's family—his mother, stepfather (whom Mr. Hirsch calls Dad) and two younger sisters—lived in a new, cookie-cutter development of closely spaced split-level houses. In one of the book's most delightful sections, Mr. Hirsch runs down his aspirational mother's interior-design missteps. Irma wanted to turn her tract home into an Italian palazzo. "When you walked through the front door, you were greeted by a wallpaper image of a Roman villa overlooking the living room." The family didn't step on the white shag carpet. Except for when there was company, a plastic slipcover protected the apricot velvet couch.

The appliances, Mr. Hirsch writes, were in open rebellion. "They go on one-day strikes. The air conditioner won't start, the refrigerator won't defrost, the dishwasher won't drain." His mother banned garbage cans from the house because she thought they were "unrefined." Instead, she put the food scraps in a small, plastic bag "hung over a drawer in the kitchen." One day, while preparing for a picnic at the beach, she picked up the wrong bag and "brought the garbage for lunch."

The comedy flows throughout, as Mr. Hirsch describes people and relates events in a straightforward, deadpan style. His mother's sister, Bernice, whom he calls Auntie Bea, confides that she sobbed when she first saw him as a newborn. "I had never seen such a strange-looking infant. You were all eyes and nose, and your face trailed behind." Mr. Hirsch goes on to point out: "All my life people have said that I look like Bea."

Much of his humor covers the antics of his disputatious parents. To save on electricity, his stepfather monitored family members, turning the lights off behind them. His mother,

When Edward Hirsch was born, his aunt sobbed at how 'strange' he looked. Everyone else said he looked like his aunt.

who advised others to be home when their children returned from school, ignored her own advice. She was typically out and about, leaving little time to prepare dinner. She served the vegetables half-frozen, the meat undercooked. The Jell-O never set. "We drank it for dessert," Mr. Hirsch writes. Mornings were a symphony of Mom and Dad shouting at each other. By contrast, the house of family friends "was a neutral zone, like Switzerland. We didn't belong there, but it was peaceful, and the chocolates were top-notch."

Despite the humor, an undercurrent of sadness runs through the book. Some of it reflects what Mr. Hirsch sees as the limits of suburban life, but the most painful sections center on his broken relationship with his biological father. Ruby cruelly blamed Mr. Hirsch and his sister Arlene for their loss of the surname Rubenstein. He moved to California with a new family and basically abandoned the children he'd had with Irma. Later, in high school, Mr. Hirsch writes with no elaboration, "I started crying at unexpected times. I burst into tears on the way to school." He started writing poetry to see if it made him feel better.

Mr. Hirsch relates the difficult scenes with Ruby in the same matter-of-fact tone he employs to describe the many details of his childhood. This stands in notable contrast to his poetry, which also focuses on quotidian events but is invested with salvos of emotion. In "My Childhood in Pieces," he describes making out with a girlfriend in the back row of the old Skokie Theatre and mentions that he later wrote a poem revealing that she touched him below the belt. That poem, "The Skokie Theatre," describes the scene and his feelings in far more detail, including the moment when he and his girlfriend leave the theater into "the harsh glare of sunlight, the brightness / of an afternoon that left us gripping / each other's hands, trembling and changed."

Mr. Hirsch, the president of the Guggenheim Foundation, has published numerous volumes of poetry, including the book-length poem "Gabriel," about the death of his son after taking a party drug. In books and newspaper columns, Mr. Hirsch has also been a popular advocate for poetry itself.

His memoir ends as he heads off to play football at Grinnell College in Iowa. By then he is eager to leave behind Skokie and his loving but difficult family. But earlier in the book he tells of eating with his grandmother at a favorite Chinese-American restaurant. His fortune cookie made a "preposterous" prediction: "Someday you will look back fondly on the past."

Mr. Babcock's novel, "A Small Disturbance on the Far Horizon," is out this month.

Coming in BOOKS this weekend

The mystery of the migraine • The life of Thomas More • Forbidden literature in communist Poland • Émile Zola's idea of France • Rescuing children from the Holocaust • The explosive mind of Luis Alvarez • & much more

OPINION

REVIEW & OUTLOOK

Trump Blows Up the Copper Market

President Trump likes tariffs for their own sake, and the latest evidence is his bewildering decision to slap a 50% tax on copper imports. How this will help the U.S. economy is a mystery, even as it has sent the copper market into turmoil, with chaotic results for American manufacturers that use the vital metal.

U.S. firms will pay 50% more while waiting years for more U.S. production.

Copper prices are typically an economic benchmark because the metal is widely used in construction and industrial manufacturing. But prices this year have been rising despite slowing economic growth. Mr. Trump's February order for a Section 232 national-security investigation into copper imports prompted businesses and traders to stockpile inventory.

The Section 232 findings haven't been released, but Mr. Trump's tariff announcement this week has set off a mad dash to accelerate imports. Copper prices hit a record on Tuesday after the President announced the 50% tariff, which he said Wednesday would take effect on Aug. 1. Consumers are scrambling for supply ahead of August.

"Copper is necessary for Semiconductors, Aircraft, Ships, Ammunition, Data Centers, Lithium-ion Batteries, Radar Systems, Missile Defense Systems, and even, Hypersonic Weapons, of which we are building many," the President posted Wednesday on Truth Social. "Why did our foolish (and SLEEPY!) 'Leaders' decimate this important Industry?"

This is close to self-refuting. It's true that copper is integral to defense systems, though the U.S. produces more than enough to satisfy the military's needs. Domestic production accounts for about half of U.S. copper consumption, most of which is used in construction, electric and water systems, and transportation and industrial machinery equipment.

It's also true that China dominates copper refining. China makes up 42% of global copper primary refining, up from 11% in 2002. The U.S. share has fallen to 4% from 10%. But the U.S. doesn't depend on China or other adversaries for copper. About 65% of imports come from Chile, 17% from Canada and 9% from Mexico. The U.S. has free-trade agreements with all three.

Mr. Trump says the tariffs will ensure that the U.S. can "once again, build a DOMINANT Copper Industry." That will take more than tariffs. A major reason the U.S. doesn't mine or refine more copper (and other critical minerals and metals) is the government permitting morass. Developing a new mine in the U.S. takes on average 29 years, the second longest in the world after Zambia.

Building and permitting a copper smelter can take more than five years. By all means, Mr. President, blast the permitting obstacles, and urge Congress to reform the National Environmental Policy Act that the left uses to tie up every new mining or refining project.

But in the meantime tariffs won't spur companies to build new smelters that could get tied up in litigation. Mr. Trump is going to make U.S. firms pay 50% more for a vital metal while they wait five or more years for U.S. sourcing. How does making it more expensive to build aircraft, ships and ammunition promote national security? This is national insecurity.

China's growing dominance of critical minerals is a national-security risk. Its subsidies and lax environmental rules have made it harder for smelters in other countries to compete. Beijing this year leveraged its control of rare-earth minerals by restricting exports to the U.S., which prompted Mr. Trump to ease tariffs and export controls on China.

The U.S. will need to mount a united front with allies to confront Beijing's predatory practices and ensure the world isn't dependent on China. One idea is a critical minerals alliance. The copper tariffs will merely give allies another reason to wonder if they may be better off sidling up to Beijing than Washington.

The Birthright Order Is Halted—Again

Well, that was quick. Two weeks ago the Supreme Court reined in nationwide injunctions, in a case involving President Trump's effort to redefine birthright citizenship. On Thursday a federal judge again blocked the government from enforcing Mr. Trump's order, except this time it's a class-action challenge.

Now it's a class action of babies Trump wants to deny U.S. citizenship.

The new lawsuit was filed by noncitizens who recently had a child or are expecting one. According to the complaint, the plaintiffs include a Taiwanese woman with a student visa who has lived here for 12 years and is applying for a green card. "Petitioners have satisfied the requirements for provisional class certification," writes Judge Joseph Laplante, a George W. Bush appointee.

The Supreme Court's recent ruling against universal injunctions, *Trump v. CASA*, was a legal landmark, but the liberal Justices lamented in dissent as if it were the end of the rule of law. While the consensus is that Mr. Trump's order on birthright citizenship is unconstitutional, there are other ways to knock down executive overreach, such as class-action lawsuits or challenges under the Administrative Procedure Act, which tells judges that they should "set aside" unlawful agency rules.

Winning class certification is a hurdle, but how high remains to be seen. The Federal Rules of Civil Procedure set out four prerequisites: A class must be "numerous," and its members must share common questions of law or fact. Also, the representative parties must have "typical" claims or defenses, as well as the ability to "fairly and adequately" protect the class's interests.

At least two of the Justices are already wary of how far lower-court judges might try to stretch those requirements. The federal rules "may permit the certification of nationwide classes in some discrete scenarios," Justice Samuel Alito, joined by Justice Clarence Thomas, wrote in a concurrence to *Trump v. CASA*. They warned district courts against certifying such classes without "scrupulous adherence" to the rigors demanded.

Judge Laplante provisionally certifies a class of babies born on or after Feb. 20 who would be subject to Mr. Trump's order denying them U.S. citizenship. Will this hold up on appeal? Was Judge Laplante scrupulous? Perhaps that question will be coming soon to the Supreme Court, bringing birthright citizenship back to the emergency docket. Sorry to spoil your summer beach plans, Justices, and can someone please hand Justice Thomas a Wi-Fi hot spot before he drives off in his RV?

What's Trump's Next Move on Iran?

The aftermath of the 12-day war with Iran looks mixed more than two weeks later. Iran's nuclear program was badly damaged and likely set back for years. But the Ayatollah's government isn't admitting defeat and shows no signs of dropping its revolutionary or nuclear designs. That puts into focus the next policy question for the U.S.: Will Mr. Trump's ceasefire give way to diplomacy that deepens the achievements of the war, or will it put those achievements at risk?

He still wants a nuclear deal, but that will take more sanctions pressure.

Iran is still talking tough and rejecting Mr. Trump's demands, even after bailing out of the fight with Israel and failing to respond in any serious way to the U.S. strikes. In a video message released several days after the U.S. bombing, a frail-looking Ayatollah Ali Khamenei claimed that the U.S. had to intervene to rescue Israel, and that Iran had "dealt America a slap in the face."

Mr. Trump didn't take kindly to the Ayatollah's revisionist history, which he corrected on Truth Social. The President added that "Iran has to get back into the World Order flow, or things will only get worse for them."

But there's no sign Iran will surrender the remains of its enrichment program. Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said after the war, "Our people have endured sanctions for this, and a war was imposed on our nation over this issue. No one in Iran will abandon this technology."

More ominously, Iran has driven out United Nations weapons inspectors, who left the country last week. It may drop out of the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty. This will make it impossible for inspectors to make a ground-level estimate of the damage done and track or collect any nuclear material that remains.

Iran isn't hankering for normal relations with the West either. Senior regime clerics have called for Mr. Trump's execution. Iran's regime proclaims death to America and Israel, and it wages its forever war accordingly. Meanwhile, evidence is building that Tehran has escalated its terror campaign at home, with arrests and executions of opponents and minorities.

What's the U.S. policy to grapple with all of this? White House envoy Steve Witkoff said a meeting with Mr. Araghchi will take place in the next week or so. Iran's Foreign Minister has been stalling, but a senior White House official tells us Iran wants sanctions relief as well as U.S. help with a civilian nuclear program.

"We have a very big ask" in return, the U.S. official says. It starts with removing whatever nuclear material and enrichment infrastructure remains, and continues with hard limits on Iran's missile program and an end to its support for regional terrorism. The return of inspectors and on-demand searches is essential.

To extract concessions, Mr. Witkoff will need the full pressure arsenal. That should include public and other support for the Iranian people. Especially helpful would be so-called snap-back U.N. sanctions that were part of the 2015 nuclear deal. These would restore international bans on Iranian enrichment and nuclear-capable missiles. They'd also bar other states from helping Iran on those fronts.

The U.S. will also have to enforce its sanctions against Iran's oil exports. Iran's oil output is now at a seven-year high, per U.S. Energy Department data. That's the regime's main source of financing. Will it be put in danger?

The successful Israel-U.S. military operation has the regime more vulnerable than at any time since the Islamic revolution. Now is the moment to capitalize for a safer Middle East.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Why This Is No Time to Go Wobbly on Ukraine

Dan Caldwell argues that it's prudent for the Trump administration to pause weapons to Ukraine, where he believes there are "limited U.S. interests at stake" (Letters, July 7). Thankfully President Trump now sees what Mr. Caldwell doesn't: The outcome in Ukraine matters, and Vladimir Putin responds to concessions with more attacks.

The Ukraine war is part of a broader and more dangerous competition with an axis of aggressors—China, Russia, Iran and North Korea—that is underwriting Mr. Putin's aggression. Sustained support for Ukraine while expanding our defense industrial base is the best way to realize Mr. Trump's vision of peace through strength.

As Mr. Caldwell observes, the U.S. needs more Patriot missile defense interceptors. Our production capacity will expand to 650 a year by 2027 and needs to grow faster. The Army's unfunded priorities list includes $300 million to modernize the Patriot Advanced Capability-3 line.

While Mr. Caldwell is correct that we produce about 60 Stingers a month, deliveries to the Army are expected to increase significantly next year, and industry is ready to produce more if funding is provided. Guided Multiple Launch Rocket System production levels are expected to grow from 6,000 in 2022 to around 14,000 in 2025. U.S. 155-mm artillery-round production is expanding to 100,000 a month next year, up from 9,000 a month in February 2022.

Aiding Kyiv is a critical component of a smart strategy to prevent a major U.S. war with axis members and buy time to strengthen production and supply chains. A broader war with Russia would place tremendous strain on our defense manufacturing. U.S. munitions provided to Ukraine make additional aggression less likely by degrading the Russian threat.

Mr. Caldwell is right to highlight the "growing military threats from China." But munitions not delivered to Ukraine could result not only in more successful Russian attacks, greater loss of Ukrainian lives, and less leverage for President Trump in negotiations with Mr. Putin but also growing perceptions in Beijing that Washington won't sustain support for beleaguered partners. Think Taiwan.

Mr. Trump isn't one to accept the status quo, and he's made the wise decision to restart some shipments to Kyiv. Building on this positive step with more security assistance to Ukraine and tougher sanctions on the Kremlin would signal to Mr. Putin that there is no alternative to a negotiated end to his war and to other axis members that strong leadership resides in Washington.

H.R. McMaster and Bradley Bowman
Hoover Institution and FDD
Stanford, Calif., and Washington

How Can the U.S. Win the Wars of the Future?

Aaron Kaplowitz's op-ed "Can AI and Drones Replace Soldiers and Jets?" (July 5), captures an essential truth of modern war: Success depends not on the newest technology alone but on how intelligently militaries combine old and new.

That observation reflects what I've seen firsthand while conducting field research in Ukraine, Azerbaijan, Gaza and India. From urban combat in Kyiv to drone warfare in Nagorno-Karabakh to combined arms operations in Kashmir, one theme is consistent: Dominance is about learning faster than your adversary. It requires institutional adaptability, not hardware superiority.

Modern conflict still demands young men and women moving on foot across terrain, under fire, often in cities. Infantry, armor and artillery remain essential. But so do deception, intelligence penetration, operational surprise and the ability to integrate legacy platforms with new technologies. Militaries that win do so by adapting their doctrine, procurement, training and command systems in real time.

This is why the U.S. must stop treating innovation as an add-on. As I've argued in recent case studies on Ukraine's drone strikes, Israel's wartime learning, and India's Operation Sindoor, the winners of tomorrow are those who institutionalize speed and flexibility—from Silicon Valley to the squad level.

Wars are no longer won by the biggest or most advanced force but by the smartest and fastest-learning one. That will require reshaping our defense institutions, not merely upgrading our tools.

John Spencer
West Point, N.Y.
Mr. Spencer is chairman of urban warfare studies at West Point's Modern War Institute.

Making Sense of the Fed's Monetary Madness

Joseph C. Sternberg could have stated the flaw in the Texas senator's thinking more directly ("Ted Cruz Stumbles on a Source of Monetary Madness," Political Economics, June 27). The Federal Reserve is part of the federal government. Reserves and Treasurys are different forms of government liability. When the central bank buys Treasurys, the government isn't relieved of the burden of paying interest to the private sector; the part of the government paying interest simply shifts from the Treasury to the Fed.

There is a simple reason the central bank has to be able to pay interest on reserves when it has created "excess reserves," such as in the balance-sheet-bloated aftermath of quantitative easing, and wants the federal funds rate to be in positive territory: Paying no interest would force the federal funds rate down to zero as banks futilely try to offload nonyielding reserves to one another, thus stymieing its monetary policy.

Paul Sheard
New York, N.Y.
Mr. Sheard is author of "The Power of Money."

Mr. Sternberg astutely reports on a knotty problem at the Federal Reserve, and kudos to Sen. Cruz for having the courage to challenge the central bank. If the American people understood that the Fed's main tool for conducting monetary policy is to transfer the interest-rate payments it receives on its own holdings of U.S. government debt securities to private commercial banks as compensation for keeping cash parked at the central bank, it would provoke outrage—especially since those funds would otherwise provide revenues to the federal budget. The fact that foreign banks with U.S. branches currently receive nearly 44% of the money the Fed pays to banks as interest on their reserve balances should get Congress's attention.

Judy Shelton
Fredericksburg, Va.

Who's Got the Time for EVs?

Familiarity is one reason drivers aren't swooning over electric vehicles (Letters, July 2). Time is another. A driver can put enough fuel in an internal-combustion vehicle within five minutes to give it 400 miles of range. Chevy's 2024 Silverado was rated the fastest-charging EV, and it takes an hour to recharge to 400 miles of range and 25 minutes to recharge to 150 miles. Who can afford that, let alone the infrastructure to support it? The Journal's Dan Neil writes that something has to give "if automobility is to remain a defining feature in American society." Don't count on it being gasoline.

Stuart Creque
Moraga, Calif.

Don't Drop the Drinking Age

Scott Johnston's op-ed "The Key to the Young Male Vote: Beer" (June 25) is dangerously dismissive of one of our nation's most consequential public-health achievements: the National Minimum Drinking Age Act of 1984, signed by President Reagan and later upheld by the Supreme Court.

While it's true that advocacy and tougher law enforcement have helped decrease drunk-driving deaths, decades of peer-reviewed research attribute a significant share of the decline in alcohol-related crashes to the 21 minimum legal drinking age. To dismiss that evidence simply because underage drinking still occurs is like questioning the value of speed limits or seatbelts because people sometimes break the rules. Imperfect compliance doesn't negate the law's effect.

Luis E. Seija, M.D.
Boston

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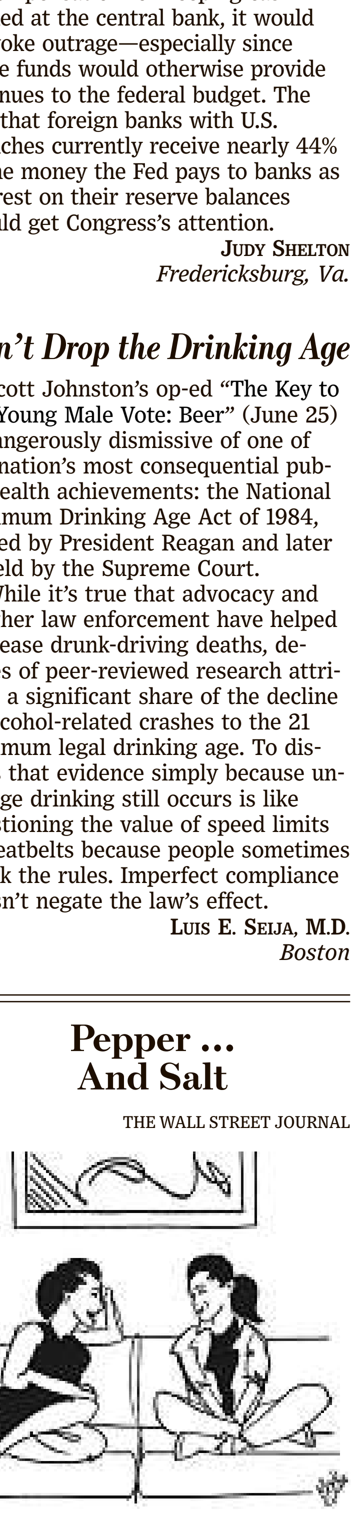
Pepper ... And Salt

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL



"I'm playing this fun game where I refuse to look at my bank account and pretend everything's OK."

A Flash Flood of Failures in Texas

By Costas Synolakis

Central Texas' "flash flood alley" unleashed a nightmare in the early morning of July 4. The Guadalupe River surged more than 26 feet in less than an hour, devastating homes, camps and communities across Kerr and Kendall counties. A week after the flood, more than 160 people are still missing, and more than 100 are dead, including 28 children. The tragedy underscores a painful truth: Weather extremes are outpacing our preparedness—and, in this case, the political will to prepare.

Meteorologists identified the hazard early enough. In the days prior, the remnants of Tropical Storm Barry unleashed up to 20 inches of rain across the Hill Country. The National Weather Service issued flood watches on July 3 and escalated to flash-flood emergency alerts in the early morning of July 4. Authorities sent cellphone texts, but communities were asleep when alerts arrived, many campers didn't have cellphones, and most locals lacked sirens or robust notification systems to wake them.

> **Local leaders never built siren systems and issued alerts too late. We can be better prepared next time.**

The fallout has been predictable and polarizing. Some have argued the NWS did its job, while others blame federal budget cuts to the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration and the Federal Emergency Management Agency. But the blame falls not on either national party but on state and local officials. Local leaders debated installing siren systems for decades but never built them because of costs and noise concerns.

This wasn't a failure of science. As with the 2023 fires in Lahaina, Hawaii, where 102 died and there was no warning, this was failure of local leaders to summon the political will to prepare. Preventing future disasters like this one requires not prophecy but preparation.

Flash floods are inherently fast and fierce, but lives would have been lost even in a much milder flood since there was no advance warning and evacuations. Experiments in water tunnels have shown that in a fast-moving current of about 3 miles an hour, it's hard to keep your balance if the water is more than 6 inches high. Almost all volunteers were knocked over when knee-deep. A large car starts floating in 18 inches of water.

A few local officials have said they were cautious about issuing evacuation warnings because too many false alarms make the alerts less effective over time. But this excuse is lame in a region called flash flood alley. Alarm fatigue may be a risk, but this was false complacency. Political leaders may claim they had little warning, but the real failure was in refusing to invest when science said they should. Since they hadn't upgraded their technology, leaders should have been extra vigilant and overwarned residents, particularly in locales with children's summer camps and limited evacuation options.

RONALDO SCHEMIDT/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

The Guadalupe River in Kerr County, Texas, July 8.

This won't be the last such disaster. Kerr County is known for dangerously uneven topography and proximity to streams, and a flood there in 1987 killed 10 teenagers and injured 33 others. Rainfall intensities in Texas have increased significantly since 1970, ranging from a 6% increase in San Antonio to a 19% rise in Austin, according to nonprofit Climate Central.

What can we do better? We can use new tools to forecast extremes in local climate conditions decades ahead. Today's modeling—combined with ground-based sensors, stream gauges, real-time telemetry and artificial-intelligence-driven risk mapping—can provide communities with far more targeted warnings, increasing credibility and compliance.

But predictions need to be paired with better warning methods. Communities need layered alert systems that use sirens, push notifications, multilingual voice alerts, and standardized flash-flood drills. Warnings need to be easy to understand and explain what may happen if people don't comply. It isn't enough to "issue alerts" if they don't cause residents to act.

We need better training for emergency responders, using extreme but realistic scenarios. Full-scale—not just desktop—evacuation exercises help officials test how much time residents need to move to safety. Emergency managers need to plan for the kind of extreme events that may strike in the future, not only for the worst event they have on record.

Funding can't be a partisan plaything. Budget cuts to NOAA and FEMA aren't to blame for this particular disaster because those agencies issued timely alerts while evacuations were delayed by local authorities. But Congress must invest to improve warning technologies to give these agencies the tools they need to prevent and respond to future disasters.

We need national flash-flood evacuation standards, akin to fire codes or building inspections. Standards should mandate real-time stream and rainfall gauges in vulnerable basins, automated alert thresholds that trigger sirens and mobile alerts, and mandatory drills in schools, camps and care facilities. The federal government has sent aid in the aftermath of the Texas flood, but relief isn't preparedness. We can't wait for the next set of deeply upsetting images of helpless parents searching for their kids miles downstream.

The children at Camp Mystic didn't drown only in water; they drowned in a flood of failures—failures of imagination, investment and political will. Local leaders should take emergencies seriously before they happen.

Mr. Synolakis is a professor of engineering at the University of Southern California.

Hong Kong Takes Another Currency Hit With a Smile

POLITICAL ECONOMICS
By Joseph C. Sternberg

Danger, Will Robinson: The Hong Kong dollar is in the news again.

The Hong Kong Monetary Authority in recent months has intervened at both the top and the bottom ranges of the Hong Kong dollar's fixed exchange-rate band with the U.S. dollar, causing big swings in interest rates. Cue chatter in the financial press about whether Hong Kong's peg to the greenback could be scrapped under market pressure.

It's a jarring possibility. Hong Kong's peg, in place since 1983, is the single most successful economic policy implemented by anyone anywhere in Asia for at least the past 50 years.

The Linked Exchange Rate System, as it's formally known, fixes the exchange rate at 7.8 Hong Kong dollars per American greenback, plus or minus a tiny margin. It has endured through an Asian financial crisis that collapsed most other currency pegs, through the SARS outbreak of 2003, through the global financial panic of 2008 and through Covid. The peg also survived Hong Kong's return to Chinese sovereignty in 1997.

This longevity hasn't deterred occasional speculative attacks from investors who ought to know better. Bill Ackman announced in late 2022 that he'd taken a short position against the Hong Kong dollar, apparently unworried by the collapse of Kyle Bass's short in 2020. George Soros once took a run at it. The temptation is irresistible whenever the Hong Kong dollar drifts toward the weaker end of its permitted trading range, as it has in recent weeks.

It might help if everyone remembered what Hong Kong's dollar peg actually is. To wit, it isn't a "peg" at all. It's a currency board.

Hong Kong's dollar is backed by a monetary reserve whose U.S.-dollar-denominated safe-asset holdings slightly exceed the number of Hong Kong dollars outstanding. When capital inflows cause the Hong Kong dollar to appreciate, the Hong Kong Monetary Authority stands ready to buy unlimited U.S. dollars, issuing new Hong Kong dollars in return at the 7.8 rate in order to avert an upswing. More important, when capital flows outward, the full reserve ratio means the HKMA is able to buy as many Hong Kong dollars as necessary to maintain the fixed rate.

Contrast this with looser currency-peg arrangements, such as those that fell apart in the 1997 Asian financial crisis. In these setups, authorities maintain reserves insufficient to back the local monetary base fully. Speculators can break the peg by launching a run on the currency, forcing authorities either to deplete reserves or to defend the exchange rate with crushing interest-rate increases. A government usually finds it has no choice but to abandon the peg.

> **Some investors hope the city will give up its peg to the U.S. dollar. They're likely to keep hoping.**

Such peg arrangements once were popular because they provided the appearance of stability while allowing policymakers to "manage" the economy via domestic interest-rate and fiscal policies. Hong Kong surrendered those freedoms in 1983 for the strictures of a currency board, binding itself to U.S. interest rates and an imperative to maintain fiscal balance. The territory's households and businesses often have paid for this decision in the form of wild swings in interest rates during periods of economic stress.

It isn't an accident that the recent peak in shorting the Hong Kong dollar came as the Federal Reserve raised interest rates aggressively to fight American inflation—a rate increase not obviously appropriate for Hong Kong amid mainland China's softening economy. The reality that U.S. monetary policy may often be ill-suited for Hong Kong is what causes outsiders to assume its government will abandon its currency board eventually.

Yet the persistence of Hong Kong's currency board despite that mismatch is precisely what makes the city's exchange-rate story so instructive. The arrangement remains enormously popular among the people who bear what most economists would consider its greatest costs, to the point that this is the one area of Hong Kong's political economy Beijing appears unwilling to disturb. Why?

Probably because Hong Kong residents long ago discovered that many of the putative benefits of more conventional monetary arrangements are illusory.

Hong Kong's currency board means authorities can't use monetary policy to try to "smooth" economic cycles or to fine-tune inflation or deflation. Since the currency board inhibits the government's ability to run large or persistent fiscal deficits, politicians are severely constrained in their ability to pump up spending to juice the economy during downturns. So for more than 40 years, Hong Kong's economy has been both forced and allowed to respond to crises without ham-handed bureaucrats and politicians trying to fix it.

Perhaps not coincidentally, since 1984, the year after the currency board's introduction, the territory has experienced stupefying economic growth of a cumulative 344% in inflation-adjusted terms, and real per capita gross domestic product has grown 190%. Meanwhile, governments elsewhere that enjoy full monetary discretion subject their people to serial inflationary and recessionary disasters.

Speculators assume the currency board must crack because it prevents Hong Kong officials from setting economic policy as other governments do. That's exactly why Hong Kong people like it. Beijing may one day conclude it can no longer tolerate such an arrangement on its doorstep. But until then, study Hong Kong's currency board, don't scoff at it.

Cuba's Internet Apartheid Sparks Youth Rebellion

By Oscar Biscet

Havana

Recently in Cuba, something unusual happened: Students at the University of Havana began to protest. Their demand wasn't for political freedoms or regime change—it was for something as basic as an affordable internet connection.

In its hunger for hard currency, the Cuban government in late May announced a new pricing scheme for mobile data. ETECSA, the state-owned company that holds a monopoly on communications, increased its connectivity costs—originally limiting Cubans to one data package per month (partial adjustments were added in June after the backlash). For expanded access, users would have to pay for new plans in U.S. dollars—well beyond what most can afford. For Cuban students already scraping by, the internet is suddenly a luxury.

The University of Havana students began organizing. In mathematics and computer science, they called for an academic strike. Others held meetings and used group chats to coordinate a unified response. Some called for walkouts. Others encouraged university officials to support the students. A few even spoke openly to foreign press—something nearly unheard of in Cuba. Their demands weren't revolutionary, but they were clear: Scrap the dollar-based pricing scheme and restore equitable access to the internet.

Within days, state security agents appeared on campus. Messaging apps slowed. The university reaffirmed its loyalty to the Communist Party of Cuba. It was the same script the regime has followed for decades—but this time, fewer students backed down. This is a generation's awakening. A refusal to accept exclusion, censorship and economic punishment as the cost of being young and enterprising in Cuba.

When students rise up against a regime that controls everything from school curricula to cell signals, they aren't just asking for cheaper access to WhatsApp, Google and Facebook. They're asking to breathe intellectually—to think, question and speak without fear.

In the Cuba where I grew up, under Fidel Castro's tyranny, students weren't allowed to question. Reciting slogans was expected. Praising the Communist Party was routine. Universities didn't exist to challenge the system. They existed to validate it.

For a long time, that formula seemed to work. That's why these current protests are so significant. They echo a day all Cubans remember: July 11, 2021, when tens of thousands flooded the streets in cities and towns across the island. They demanded food, electricity, medicine—and freedom. Many were young. They were met with batons, bullets and prison sentences. Hundreds remain behind bars to this day.

Fear has been the Cuban regime's most powerful weapon. For decades, it kept even many of the most principled citizens silent. But fear loses its grip when people realize they are already living with nothing to lose. That realization is what gives rise to acts of public courage. And that is what we are seeing now.

We're beginning to watch the same story unfold across the world's autocracies. In Iran, following the death of Mahsa Amini in 2022, young women played a prominent role in leading mass protests across the country. In China, students raised blank pages in silent defiance of censorship during the pandemic. In Venezuela, students filled the streets as their country collapsed. Now in Cuba, again it is the young who are saying "enough."

> **Mobile data is now a luxury on the island, and students in Havana have had enough of the regime.**

The Cuban regime still talks about "equality," but only in the abstract. This internet policy reveals its true nature. It's a digital muzzle. It separates those who can afford to speak from those who can't. It isn't about access—it's about control. And the young are increasingly resisting authoritarianism.

Many young Cubans aren't raising their voices in protest. Instead, they are packing their bags. Between 2022 and 2023, more than one million Cubans left the island, most for the U.S. It is the largest wave of emigration in modern Cuban history. Some were political dissidents or organized activists, but most were ordinary young people who had simply lost hope. They no longer believed their future could be built in Cuba. That is the most damning verdict any regime can face.

I spent years in prison in Havana for exposing the truth. I know what it costs and what it restores. These students remind us that liberty isn't granted—it is claimed, often at great personal risk. Even in darkness, the truth waits for its moment.

The regime still controls the weapons and the airwaves. But it has lost something far more powerful: the imagination of its youth. Their defiance is more than a challenge to the regime—it's a mirror held up to the free world. The rebellion is already under way, quiet but steady, from Havana to Tehran. What's left to ask is who will have the courage to stand with it.

Dr. Biscet is a physician and human-rights advocate.

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.
PUBLISHED SINCE 1889 BY DOW JONES & COMPANY

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Notable & Quotable: Mamdani and Shoplifting

Steven Malanga writing for City Journal, July 10:

In New York City and nationwide, retailers have struggled to respond to waves of shoplifting prompted by revisions to laws that raised the value of goods a shoplifter must steal before getting charged with a felony, and by bail reforms that result in the quick release of those committing nonviolent crimes. . . .

There's little evidence that [Zohran] Mamdani's agenda as mayor would address these problems. He has opposed changes to current bail laws endorsed by the police commissioner. He touts efforts to boost funding for programs that address the "root cause" of crime, including treatment programs for repeat offenders. He has argued for refocusing the NYPD's efforts on "serious" crime enforcement, which by nature means deemphasizing so-called nonviolent offenses like shoplifting—the same thinking that set off the explosion of retail theft.

Retail experts have weighed in on the question of whether government-owned food stores could possibly serve New Yorkers more efficiently than private outlets. The more relevant question: Could such public stores survive the shoplifting tsunami that has already devastated their private counterparts?

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Buyout Firms Poach Young Bankers

Recent graduates are being recruited for jobs that don't start for years

By AnnaMaria Andriotis, Ben Glickman and Alexander Saeedy

Speed-dating-style interviews that can drag on until 3 a.m. Job offers that require a response within a day. A fear that your current boss might find out what you are doing. All for positions that don't even start for two to three years.

Welcome to the frenzied world of private-equity recruiting, where recent college graduates who have barely started their first gigs as analysts at big banks vie to secure coveted positions at buyout firms.

The tactics reached a fever pitch in recent years, kicking off earlier and earlier, prompting a crackdown this summer at big banks fed up with the poaching of their young employees.

Morgan Stanley implemented a formal policy in May that requires analysts to promptly disclose if they have secured future employment elsewhere, according to a person familiar with the matter. Analysts who are found to be in violation of the rule are at risk of disciplinary action, including being fired.

Goldman Sachs also recently decided to ask analysts every three months if they have accepted a future job at another firm. In a memo to this year's incoming hires, **JPMorgan Chase** said analysts would be fired if they accepted future-dated job offers in their first 18 months.

Young bankers aspiring to land a prestigious job in private equity usually put in stints as investment-banking analysts, often at big banks like JPMorgan, Goldman Sachs and Morgan Stanley. It is a rite of passage that can be grueling, with workweeks of 100 hours or more.

"The idea of buying and selling companies and improving companies is a very attractive thing," said Anthony Keizner of recruiting firm Odyssey Search Partners. "They're thinking, 'I don't just want to give advice, I want to make decisions.'"

Private equity also offers the prospect of slightly less-demanding hours and a significantly higher ceiling for pay. Many aspire to earn carried interest, or a share of the profits from investment funds. That can bring millions of dollars in income a year.

Starting salaries for private-equity recruits can stretch to more than $300,000, compared with typical low-six-figure

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Bitcoin Joins Record Breakers

By Alexander Osipovich

Bitcoin hit a record high on Thursday, alongside the Nasdaq Composite Index and tech giant Nvidia.

The oldest and largest cryptocurrency traded as high as $113,853.97, a day after breaking its previous record set in May, according to CoinDesk data.

After President Trump's election victory in November, bitcoin soared and surpassed $100,000 for the first time. But its progress stalled in the following months, while tariff-fueled volatility shook markets and investors waited for Washington to deliver pro-crypto policies.

Previous bitcoin rallies have been triggered by signs that the once-fringe world of crypto is going mainstream, such as the listing of the first bitcoin futures contracts in 2017, or Coinbase Global's stock-market debut in 2021.

This time, crypto investors are savoring something they have never had before: a friend in the White House. Trump has ordered the creation of a strategic reserve for the U.S. government's bitcoin holdings and vowed to sign legislation to establish a regulatory framework for stablecoins, a type of cryptocurrency pegged to the dollar. The Senate passed such a bill last month.

Bitcoin enthusiasts call it "digital gold" and state that it will secure wealth against the risks of hyperinflation or financial collapse.

But so far this year, bitcoin has generally tracked stocks: When Trump's "Liberation Day" tariffs tanked the S&P 500 in April, bitcoin tumbled, too. Then it rebounded, along with stocks, after Trump walked back his most extreme tariff plans.

"If you're bullish crypto, good—but you better hope the stock market goes up, because there is a very high and increasing correlation, particularly when the stock market goes down," said Mike McGlone, senior commodity strategist at Bloomberg Intelligence.

Previous bull markets in bitcoin tended to be driven by frenzied buying by small investors. Now, there is a new buyer in town: more corporations stockpiling bitcoin.

The best-known such company is **MicroStrategy**, the software maker that began accumulating bitcoin in 2020 and has since turned its stock into a leveraged bet on bitcoin's growth.

GameStop, **Tesla**, **Trump Media & Technology Group** and the recently launched Twenty One Capital, a MicroStrategy copycat, are among the dozens of other companies to pursue what has been dubbed the "bitcoin treasury strategy."

It remains to be seen how this corporate bitcoin binge plays out.

Now, if bitcoin crashes—as it has done repeatedly in the past—it could drag down a chunk of the stock market,

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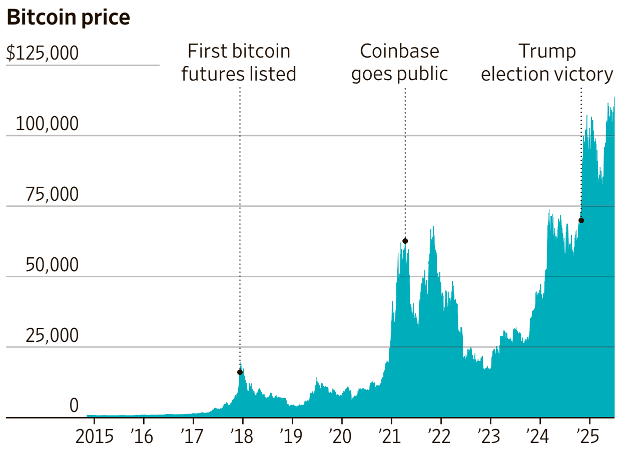

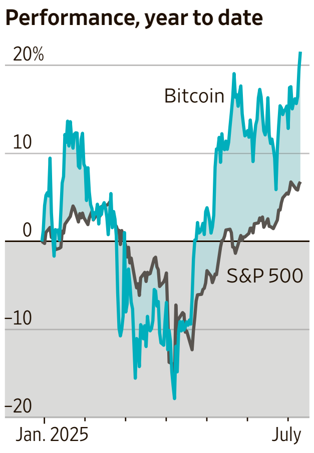

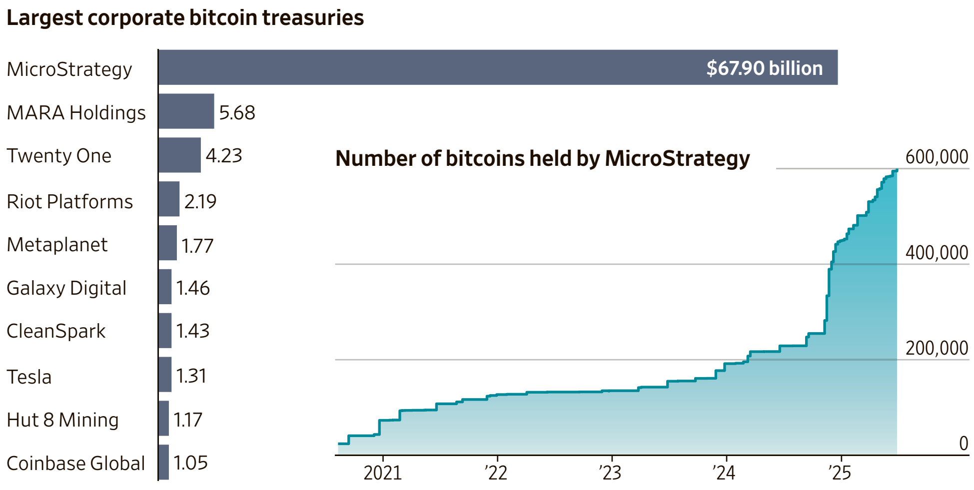

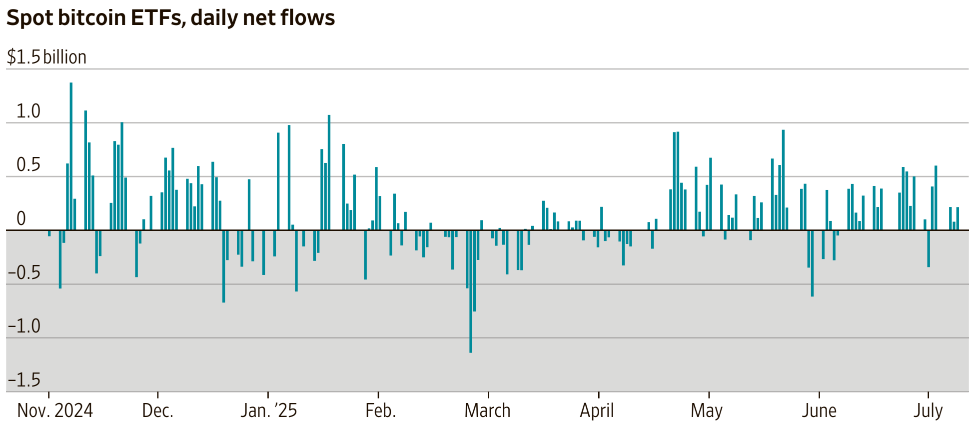

Sources: CoinDesk (bitcoin price, performance); FactSet (S&P 500); BitcoinTreasuries.net (bitcoin treasuries); The Block Research (bitcoin treasuries, number of bitcoins, net flows)

Defaults on Solar Panel Loans Hit Debt Investors

By Matt Wirz

Surging defaults on loans used to buy residential solar panels are cascading through Wall Street, catching bond investors and private-credit funds in their wake.

Some bonds tied to GoodLeap, a financial-technology firm that lends money for solar installations, have stopped paying interest, people familiar with the matter said. The payments stopped because far more homeowners are defaulting on the loans than initially forecast, they said.

Solar bonds are one niche in the growing ecosystem built by nonbank lenders like GoodLeap, which use artificial intelligence and financial-market expertise to let Americans borrow with a click of the mouse. The "fintechs" connect consumers with debt investors eager to lend to them, but higher interest rates have pushed loan payments up and more borrowers are falling behind.

Last year, 4,492 megawatts a day of solar-panel capacity was installed in U.S. homes, up from 2,864 megawatts a day in 2019, according to the Solar Energy Industries Association. Falling panel prices fueled the surge, but so did easy credit. GoodLeap and competitors like **Sunnova Energy International** and Mosaic funneled loans to homeowners through local dealers who sold panels door-to-door.

Now cracks are starting to spread through the network, showing how the potent combination of private credit and complex bonds can backfire. Several GoodLeap competitors filed for bankruptcy-court protection in June, and some bonds backed by solar loans trade at deep discounts.

"I should never have been approved for a loan to begin

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MIKE DAINES/EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

Jane Birkin often adorned her bag with stickers, charms and beads.

The Original Birkin Bag Sells For $10.1 Million at Auction

By Sarah Adams

A regular Hermès Birkin bag is worth thousands of dollars. But the one that started it all, Jane Birkin's original prototype, sold at Sotheby's Paris for €8.6 million, or $10.1 million, setting a new record for a handbag sold at auction.

As the story goes, the actress and singer Jane Birkin sat next to Hermès executive Jean-Louis Dumas on a fateful flight from Paris to London in the early 1980s. She needed a bag with more space than her usual wicker baskets, and together they came up with a structured tote with two handles. Sotheby's lists the bag for sale as a 1985 prototype.

Since then, the Birkin bag has become a pop-culture phenomenon. It is name-checked in rap lyrics and on "Sex and the City," photographed on celebrities and regularly fetches six figures on the auction block. Birkins can be difficult to procure from Hermès and some styles have lengthy waiting lists. Morgane Halimi, Sotheby's global head of handbags and fashion, describes Birkins as "the most in-demand bag in the world."

The clients' enthusiasm surrounding this auction pushed Sotheby's to upgrade the planned online-only sale to a live auction in its Paris galleries. According to Sotheby's, nine people competed in a 10-minute bidding war, which started at €1 million. Onlookers applauded and gasped as the bids passed €4 million. It was sold to a private collector from Japan at a

Please turn to page B2

Yaccarino and Musk Were Often at Odds

By Suzanne Vranica, Alexander Saeedy and Jessica Toonkel

Linda Yaccarino was all smiles during a VIP dinner at the swanky Hotel du Cap-Eden-Roc during the rosé-soaked Cannes Lions advertising festival in June.

She dined with top advertisers, promoting X's strategy to the throngs of executives who had descended on the South of France.

At another event, she shared the stage with tennis legend Serena Williams, discussing a podcast hosted by the star and her sister Venus that is set to debut on X this summer.

Behind the confident presentations was an executive who had navigated a turbulent two years as chief executive of Elon Musk's X. Through charm offensives and, in some cases, legal threats, Yaccarino stabilized a bruised business just in time for Musk's merger of X with his xAI. More recently, the platform has faced self-inflicted content-moderation problems from xAI's Grok chatbot.

On Wednesday, Yaccarino posted on the social-media

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Delta's Stock Soars On Hopeful Outlook

By Alison Sider

Delta Air Lines shares jumped 12% as the airline expressed confidence after a rocky first half of the year and forecast a stronger third quarter than analysts expected.

Delta said in April that it was too hard to predict its performance for the rest of the year amid the specter of sweeping tariffs, sending shock waves through the industry. Demand tumbled as consumers worried about rising inflation and an uncertain economic outlook.

Now, Delta said, travel demand has stabilized as consumers and businesses are gaining the clarity they need to make travel plans again. The airline is confident enough to make a new prediction, albeit one that is sharply lower than its original target. It expects earnings of $5.25 to $6.25 a share this year, down from the more than $7.35 a share it forecast in January.

Its shares rose 12% to $56.78 on Thursday.

"We're in a very different place than we were 90 days ago," Delta Chief Executive Ed Bastian said in an interview. He pointed to progress in trade deals between the U.S. and other countries and the potential for some geopolitical conflicts to abate.

"We're hopeful—and with a little bit of confidence—that we'll see things start to im-

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INSIDE

MARK LENNIHAN/AP

KYLE PRUDHOMME/INTERNATIONAL TENNIS HALL OF FAME

INDEX TO BUSINESSES

These indexes cite notable references to most parent companies and businesspeople in today's edition. Articles on regional page inserts aren't cited in these indexes.

INDEX TO PEOPLE

SOTHEBY'S

Jane Birkin's original prototype, on auction at Sotheby's Paris.

Original Birkin Gets $10 Million

Continued from page B1
hammer price of €7 million.

It immediately set a new record for a handbag sold at auction, a title previously held by a Hermès Kelly made with white crocodile leather and diamonds, which sold for $513,040 in 2021.

The prototype has several differences from modern Birkins.

Today, they come in standard sizes, such as the Birkin 35 or the Birkin 40, colorful leathers and even with diamond-encrusted hardware. The original Birkin has the width and height of a Birkin 35 and the depth of a Birkin 40. The hardware is made of gilded brass, which was later replaced by gold-plated hardware in the first series release in 1986. Metal rings, placed near the clasp, are fully closed on the prototype rather than open at one end.

An interior zipper was manufactured with one of the vendors Hermès no longer uses. The studs on the bottom of the bag are smaller than those on subsequent models. It also is the only bag to have a shoulder strap that isn't removable. The most personal details, however, are the actress's nail clippers hanging on the shoulder strap, and the J.B. initials on the front flap of the bag.

On a few occasions, Birkin sold her namesake bags to raise money for charity. The prototype was sold in early October 1994 in support of Association Solidarité Sida, an AIDS charity organization in France. Most recently the bag was owned by collector Catherine Benier, who bought it at an auction in 2000.

Birkin, widely regarded as a style icon, often adorned her bag with stickers (the residue can be seen on the prototype), charms and beads. It matched her laid-back sense of style, which often included jeans and white tees. The way she styled her bag inspired a "Jane Birkin-ify" trend on social media, where people added ribbons and Labubus to their bags.

"It was an everyday bag for her. Jane Birkin had a fairly charmed life in a lot of ways, and one of them was to get to casually own the most famous bag in the world that was named after her," Marisa Meltzer, author of the forthcoming book "It Girl: The Life and Legacy of Jane Birkin," said in an email. (Meltzer has also contributed to The Wall Street Journal.)

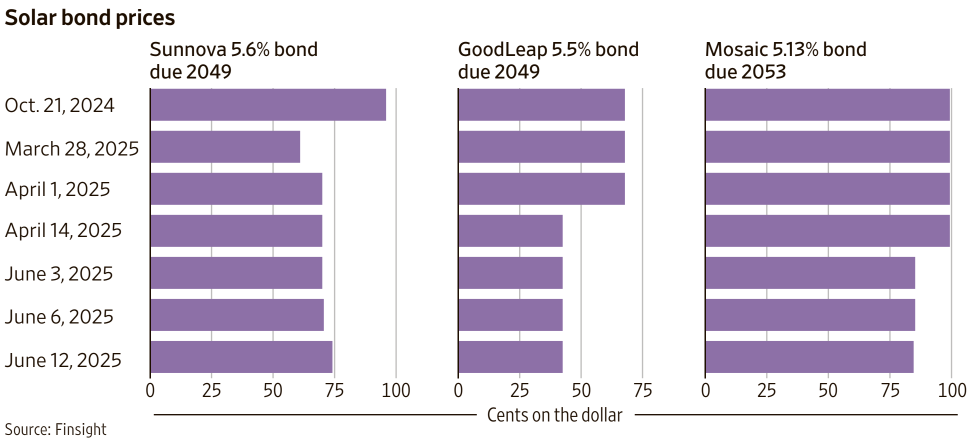
Meltzer said that Birkin had a good sense of humor about the bag's popularity. "She'd joke that people would say, "Birkin like the bag?" She'd say, "Yes, and the bag is going to sing now."

BUSINESS & FINANCE

JUSTIN SULLIVAN/GETTY IMAGES

Last year, 4,492 megawatts a day of solar-panel capacity was installed in U.S. homes, up from 2,864 megawatts a day in 2019.

Defaults on Solar Loans Hit Investors



Source: Finsight

Continued from page B1
with," said Donna Nash, an office administrator who bought rooftop panels for her home in Sarasota, Fla., in 2023 with a GoodLeap loan. She was making $45,000 a year at the time, but a salesman for Sun Energy, a dealer, told her that he could get her a loan for the purchase, which would cut her power bill and make her eligible for a big tax credit, she said.

The first lender the salesman approached rejected Nash, but GoodLeap approved her for a $48,000 loan with a $150 monthly payment that would step up to $210 if she didn't use the tax credit to pay down her balance. After installation, she learned that she still needed to pay Florida Power & Light $30 a month and that she made too little income to claim most of the tax credit.

She filed for bankruptcy protection in July 2024 but initially kept paying off the loan. "I struggled with it. 'Do I pay? Do I not pay?'" Nash said. Two months later she stopped paying GoodLeap. "If they come and take the panels I'm fine with that. I feel like I can finally breathe again."

GoodLeap doesn't keep any of the loans it makes, acting instead as a middleman that profits off fees charged for making and servicing the loans. The company is profitable and has pivoted to lending for home improvements such as heat pumps and energy-efficient windows, a GoodLeap spokesman said. The strategy helped GoodLeap avoid bankruptcy, unlike competitors that remained focused on solar. Most GoodLeap solar bonds still pay interest and are valued at 90 cents or more.

The firm finances the loans with borrowed cash, then quickly repays its debts by selling the loans to banks and private-credit firms such as **Blackstone**. Many buyers of the loans—though not Blackstone—paid for them with money raised by bundling them together into "asset-backed securities," or ABS. Those are bonds guaranteed by the future payments the homeowners make on the loans. That strategy boosts returns if homeowners pay on time and worsens losses if they don't.

The financing machine kicked into high gear when interest rates fell during the pandemic, and GoodLeap attracted tech investors such as Michael Dell, who valued its business at $12 billion. Banks such as Goldman Sachs, **Citigroup** and Credit Suisse sold $5.7 billion of GoodLeap solar bonds to investors, according to ABS data provider Finsight.

Credit-rating companies Fitch Ratings and KBRA gave most of the bonds investment-grade ratings based on analysis of similar deals backed by other consumer debt. When interest rates jumped in 2022, so did the cost of the solar loans.

Goldman sold $2.25 million of bonds backed by GoodLeap loans to an investment firm called the Catholic Responsible Investment Funds for nearly 100 cents on the dollar in 2022, according to analysis by The Wall Street Journal of data from Empirasign Strategies. Cumulative losses on the bonds rose to 3.65% in 2024, then increased this year to 6.3%, one of the people familiar with the matter said.

Traders recently quoted the bonds at 42 cents, according to Empirasign. A spokeswoman for Catholic Responsible Investment declined to comment.

"It was a brand new product...and people made good faith estimations, I suppose, of what default curves would look like, and they happened to be worse," said GoodLeap Chief Financial Officer John Shrewsberry. The firm is engaging with bondholders and trying to maximize their returns, he said.

Like other asset-backed securities, solar bonds are split into levels, or tranches, made up of pools of thousands of loans. Investors in the highest tranches get priority on payments, and if defaults climb above preset thresholds, interest payments to the junior tranches stop.

Several bonds were close to breaching their thresholds earlier this year, but GoodLeap repurchased defaulted loans from the pools, preventing their triggers. By June, four bonds had defaults in excess of their thresholds, including the one owned by Catholic Responsible Investment. With no further buybacks, the interest payments halted.

"It doesn't help us to have securitizations that fail to live up to the risk expectations [set] when they were created," Shrewsberry said. "We're going to do everything we can."

Buyout Shops Poach Bankers

Continued from page B1
compensation for investment-banking analysts, excluding bonuses.

The entry-level jobs at both banks and private-equity firms are often filled with mundane tasks, such as building financial models and filling out spreadsheets. For some analysts, the rise of artificial intelligence makes them question their prospects.

For now, competition to fill the jobs is still red hot. Private-equity firms want to make sure they can get to the best talent first, and recruiting firms in recent years have been reaching out to young graduates before they start their jobs at the big banks.

Last year, "it started before people even got to the office, and that was bananas," said Meridith Dennes, a recruiter at Prospect Rock Partners. "I don't even know what metrics they were using to evaluate except the fact that they had offers from JPMorgan and Bank of America."

JPMorgan Chief Executive Jamie Dimon called out the practice last year at a Georgetown University conference.

"I think that's unethical. I don't like it. I may eliminate it regardless of what the private-equity guys say, or the people in the company," Dimon said. "I want patriots, not mercenaries."

After JPMorgan said it would fire young bankers who accept jobs elsewhere, some of the largest buyout shops said they would push back recruiting. **Apollo Global Management** and **General Atlantic** are among the firms that have said they wouldn't extend offers this year for their associate classes of 2027.

In interviews, private-equity firms at times have candidates wait in a big room and call them in one by one for quick meetings with executives.

In 2022, one candidate was called in for rapid-fire chats for a position at a major private-equity firm at 7 p.m. and found about 40 others waiting for interviews.

"I was there until 3 a.m., when I was told I'll hear more in the morning. Never heard anything from them," said the person, who now works for a different private-equity firm.

Private-equity firms want to make sure they can get to the best talent first.

Banks see some benefit to having employees go on to private-equity firms since it creates a connection with potential clients who might one day tap the bank for multibillion-dollar deals. But some executives say banks are essentially footing the bill to get analysts up and running, only for them to leave soon after.

At Goldman, one senior banker likened it to the bank becoming a factory churning out analysts for the private-equity industry.

In recent weeks, Goldman executives debated how they might handle the issue, with some pushing for open conversations with young bankers. At both Goldman and Morgan Stanley, those who disclose they have accepted future jobs won't be fired, according to people familiar with the matter.

The moves are largely meant to help manage possible conflicts of interest in the work that employees are assigned, according to the people, such as keeping them off deals that involve their future employer.

Hopeful Outlook Lifts Delta

Continued from page B1
prove," he said.

Delta forecast a third-quarter profit of $1.25 to $1.75 a share, stronger at the midpoint than the $1.31 analysts had anticipated.

Other U.S. airlines also traded higher Thursday as investors welcomed the news from Delta—the first carrier to report second-quarter results.

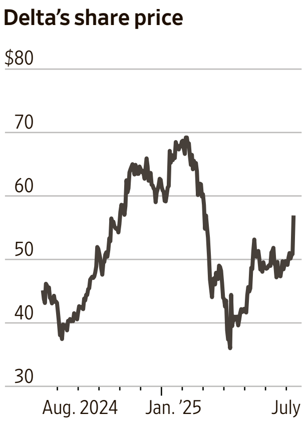
Delta's second-quarter earnings also outpaced analysts' expectations. The airline on Thursday reported a profit of $2.13 billion, up 63% from a year earlier, when the industry was struggling with a glut of open seats on domestic flights. On an adjusted basis, its earnings fell 10% from a year earlier.

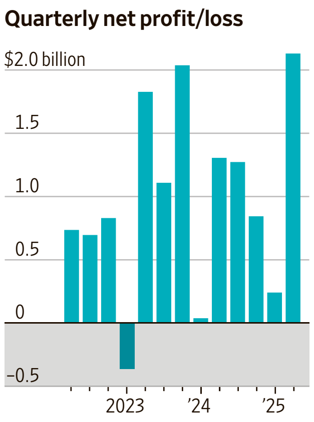
Airline executives have said travel demand has settled at lower levels than they had anticipated at the beginning of the year, especially for domestic flights. And there have yet to be signs of a sharp bounceback. Several airlines have reduced the number of scheduled flights in the months ahead once the peak summer season is over.

The gap between affluent customers who shell out for premium seats and more price-sensitive coach fliers remained during the second quarter, as some travelers downsized summer vacation plans.

Delta said its premium ticket sales increased 5% while main cabin sales fell 5%. In the trans-Atlantic market, which has been a bright spot for global airlines, capacity growth has pressured fares. While European cities are still crowded with throngs of American tourists this summer, analysts have said the weaker U.S. dollar has made a dent in demand.

"On balance it's going to be a good summer. Again, not as great a summer as we were hoping, but it will still be good," Bastian said.





Sources: FactSet (shares); S&P Capital IQ, the company (net profit/loss)

BUSINESS NEWS

Conagra Expects Inflation To Keep Sales Stagnant in '25

Company also cites tariffs, consumer sentiment in its downbeat outlook

By Connor Hart And Jesse Newman

Conagra Brands expects organic sales to remain stagnant as Chief Executive Sean Connolly said the challenging environment in which the company has been operating isn't going to improve soon.

The food-and-snacks company behind Vlasic pickles and Snack Pack pudding cups said Thursday that inflation, supply challenges, foreign-exchange headwinds and weakening consumer sentiment continued to weigh on results.

Conagra said that it expected inflation to be elevated in its current fiscal year because of higher costs for goods such as proteins, cocoa and eggs, and the imposition of tariffs on steel and aluminum, which affect the company's canned products. The company said it would work to offset those costs by looking for alternative sources and "targeted price adjustments."

"We weren't looking for another 7% total inflation this year, but we've got it," Connolly said on a call with analysts.

In an interview, Connolly said products such as Hunt's tomato sauce, Pam cooking spray and Reddi-wip topping are especially exposed to steel and aluminum tariffs.

He said that Conagra tries to avoid raising prices but that other measures haven't been enough to offset the impact of steel tariffs. "It's really no different from avocados," Connolly said. "We have no choice but to source it elsewhere."

The downbeat outlook came as Conagra logged lower sales in its fiscal fourth quarter, sending shares down 4.4% on Thursday, bringing its decline over the past year to 32%.

Inflation is poised to again pose a problem in Conagra's fiscal 2026, with the company forecasting that its core cost of goods will rise about 4%.

"To put that in context, this level of inflation in FY26 will bring our five-year cumulative net inflation to approximately 45%, a historic amount of inflation over such a short period of time," Connolly said.

Tariffs are also expected to add another $200 million to the Chicago-based company's costs, and consumers are continuing to out a priority on value and limit discretionary spending, he said.

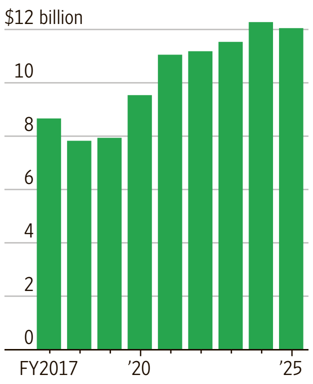
U.S. Halts Mexican Cattle Imports

The latest culprit in rising beef prices: a parasitic fly that loves to munch on cattle.

New World screwworm—a flesh-eating pest found in cattle—was detected this week in Mexico, 370 miles from the U.S. border. That prompted American officials to halt cattle imports from the country, just days after the U.S. said it was resuming cattle imports at a port in Arizona.

Screwworms, which burrow into animals and eventually kill their host if untreated, were eradicated from the U.S. in the 1950s. Agriculture officials fear a return of the pest could devastate what is already the smallest U.S. cattle herd in more than 70 years, driving beef prices higher. *—Patrick Thomas*

Conagra Brands, annual net sales



Note: Fiscal year ends in May.
Source: the company

WPP Names Microsoft Executive as CEO

By Najat Kantouar And Elena Vardon

WPP named **Microsoft** executive Cindy Rose as its new chief executive officer as the advertising giant grapples with challenges from artificial intelligence and seeks to turn the page on a string of client losses.

Rose will take the helm on Sept. 1. She is currently chief operating officer for global enterprise at Microsoft, where she helps companies use digital technology and AI to drive business transformation, the London-based WPP said Thursday.

The appointment ends weeks of uncertainty about the successor to Mark Read, who in June said he would retire at the end of the year after seven years as CEO and three decades at the company. Read will step down on Sept. 1 and support the transition until the end of the year, WPP said.

WPP Chair Philip Jansen emphasized Rose's experience in using AI to help reshape large companies' business models and revenue streams. "Her expertise in this landscape will be hugely valuable to WPP as the industry navigates fundamental changes and macroeconomic uncertainty," Jansen said.

The announcement comes a day after WPP issued a profit warning, citing the effect of economic uncertainty on client spending and weaker-than-expected net new business. The warning reflects competition in the advertising industry, said Victoria Scholar, head of investment at Interactive Investor.

WPP, which owns ad buyer WPP Media and creative agencies such as Ogilvy, undertook a major restructuring of its portfolio under Read's watch. It merged several units internally and sold other assets, including a stake in market-research firm Kantar.

WPP has been under pressure to turn around its business for some time, especially as it lost portions of some of its most noteworthy accounts over in recent years. Companies such as candy maker Mars, entertainment company Paramount and beverage giant Coca-Cola decided to move work previously assigned to WPP to rivals.

BUSINESS WATCH

BMW

Sales Rise in Europe, Fall in Asia

BMW group vehicle deliveries rose slightly in the second quarter as the German automaker saw strong growth in Europe offset hefty declines in China, while deliveries in the U.S. edged higher.

The company, which houses its namesake brand as well as the Mini and Rolls-Royce marques and a motorcycles business, said sales rose 0.4% in the period to 621,271 vehicles.

BMW has previously cautioned that tariffs would take a toll on its second-quarter results but has expected levies to go down from July and that its impact on earnings would ease in the second half.

The company said Thursday that sales of BMW branded cars and Minis in China fell 13.7% to 162,667 units in the second quarter. That compares to a 10.1% rise in European sales to 255,910 cars and a 1.4% rise to 98,504 cars in the U.S.

—Dominic Chopping

T-MOBILE

U.S. Cellular Deal Clears Hurdle

A major hurdle has been removed on the path to a deal between T-Mobile and U.S. Cellular.

The Justice Department on Thursday said its antitrust division won't seek an injunction to prevent T-Mobile from closing on its proposed acquisition of U.S. Cellular.

T-Mobile agreed to buy most of U.S. Cellular's operations for roughly $4.4 billion, including $2 billion in debt, in May 2024. The agreement would give T-Mobile over four million new customers.

—Natalie Weger

FAST RETAILING

Uniqlo Owner's Profit Drops

Fast Retailing reported lower third-quarter net profit as its Uniqlo business struggled in China amid weak consumer appetite in the world's second-largest economy.

The owner of Uniqlo and other clothing brands said Thursday that net profit fell for the three months ended May despite stronger earnings in many markets.

Fast Retailing said Uniqlo's revenue and operating profit dropped in China as same-store sales declined because of lackluster overall consumer appetite and low temperatures until early May.

—Kosaku Narioka

BEN & JERRY'S

Unilever Names New CEO at Unit

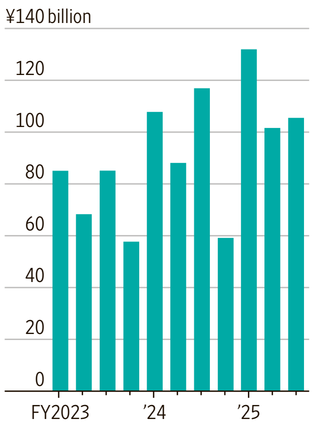
Unilever has appointed a new chief executive for Ben & Jerry's, stepping up a dispute with the ice cream brand's independent board.

Jochanan Senf, a longtime Unilever executive who previously served as managing director of Ben & Jerry's Europe business, will start in the new role this month.

Unilever is embroiled in a legal fight with Ben & Jerry's independent social mission board over issues including the removal of the brand's previous CEO, David Stever.

—Natasha Khan

Fast Retailing quarterly profit



Note: Latest fiscal quarter ended May 31; ¥1 billion = $6.8 million
Sources: S&P Capital IQ; the company

EU Lays Out AI Guidelines for Companies

Commission and member states have to decide if they will endorse the code

By Mauro Orru

The European Union said it published the final version of a voluntary code of practice for general-purpose artificial intelligence that is meant to make it easier for companies to comply with AI legislation in the bloc.

The European Commission, the EU's executive arm, said the code was developed by 13 independent experts, based on input from more than 1,000 small and medium-size enterprises, academics, civil society groups and providers of the large language models that underpin AI.

Now, the commission and the EU's 27 member states will have to sift through the code and decide whether to endorse it. Model providers will then have the option to sign the code, which EU officials said would help companies to comply with the bloc's wide-ranging legislation on the technology.

EU lawmakers approved the AI Act last year. The law bans certain uses of AI, rolls out new transparency guidelines and requires risk assessments for AI systems that are deemed high-risk.

Rules on general-purpose AI will be effective for companies as of Aug. 2. The commission said its AI office, a body that oversees implementation of the law, would enforce rules on new AI models after a year, and two years later for existing models. Companies that breach the law risk fines of up to 7% of their annual global revenue.

The code includes guidance on safety and security to help companies mitigate risks when developing advanced AI models, a section on copyright material as well as a chapter on transparency.

OLIVIER HOSLET/EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

Henna Virkkunen, EU executive vice president.

Signatories to the code of practice will benefit from a lower administrative burden and extra legal certainty to prove they comply with the AI Act compared with companies that opt not to sign the code. Henna Virkkunen, EU executive vice president for tech sovereignty, security and democracy, said signing the code would secure a clear route to compliance with the law.

A spokesperson for OpenAI said the ChatGPT maker was reviewing the code before deciding whether to sign it. News Corp, owner of Dow Jones Newswires and The Wall Street Journal, has a content-licensing partnership with OpenAI.

A spokesperson for **Alphabet**'s Google said the company would review the code. "Europeans should have access to first-rate, secure AI models when they become available, and an environment that promotes innovation and investment."

The EU's push to regulate AI has drawn criticism from business leaders and politicians alike. Chief executives of European companies, including Mistral AI, **ASML Holding** and **Airbus**, recently asked the commission to delay enforcement of the law, saying overlapping and complex regulations were preventing the EU from becoming a leader in AI.

Earlier this year, U.S. Vice President JD Vance told world leaders gathered in Paris for an AI summit that "excessive regulation of the AI sector could kill a transformative industry just as it's taking off."

Commission officials acknowledged that regulatory fragmentation across the EU's 27 countries and inadequate financing were holding back growth for startups. The EU in May laid out plans to slash regulation and set up a special fund to attract tech startups as it plays catch-up with the U.S. on financing and innovation.

REBECCA BLACKWELL/AP

Elon Musk and Linda Yaccarino, who said this week she would exit as X's CEO, seen in 2023.

Yaccarino, Musk Often At Odds

Continued from page B1

platform that she is stepping down.

Yaccarino told people close to her that the recent return of some advertisers and the merger, which made X a smaller revenue contributor, made it a good time to depart. Current and former employees say her position at the company appeared increasingly tenuous after clashes with management.

Her tenure was marred by her boss's erratic behavior, which often made it harder to bring back the very advertising customers she was hired to woo. She was effectively demoted in X's merger with xAI.

It is unclear who might succeed Yaccarino if X decides to replace her. Contenders could include members of Yaccarino's leadership team, such as John Nitti, global head of revenue operations and ad innovation at X; Angela Zepeda, X's global head of marketing; or Monique Pintarelli, head of Americas at X, industry insiders said.

It is vital that "any replacement for Linda will have to have credibility with advertisers," said Michael Kassan, an ad and media consultant.

Yaccarino, a spokeswoman for X and representatives for Musk didn't respond to requests to comment.

Luring advertisers

Nicknamed the "Velvet Hammer" during her 12 years at NBCUniversal, Yaccarino earned a reputation as a hard-charging executive with networking and negotiating chops. Joining what was then called Twitter offered her a CEO role and a high-profile position in Musk's constellation of technology businesses.

Her primary task was to lure back marketers who paused spending because they feared Musk would weaken content moderation.

She also smoothed out a payment issue with Google, hired a new slate of senior sales executives and pushed X to create more tools that let brands control the types of content that appeared next to their ads.

Musk's and Yaccarino's styles were sometimes at odds. The billionaire preferred his team to communicate in quick-fire bulleted emails or Signal messages and would get frustrated at Yaccarino's polished presentations and emails, according to people familiar with the situation.

He at times undermined her efforts. At a conference in 2023, Musk declared that advertisers pulling their ads from X could "Go f— yourself."

She and Musk schmoozed with advertising bigwigs on a yacht along the French Riviera the next year in an effort to better relations with them, according to people familiar with the situation.

When X hired Reza Banki, the former finance chief of Tubi, as its finance chief in the fall, he and Yaccarino often butted heads, people familiar with their relationship said.

Banki was a hire supported by Musk and effectively replaced Yaccarino's previously appointed head of finance for the company. Banki questioned Yaccarino on costs, specifically the money she was spending on content deals with celebrities for shows that appear on X, one of the people said. Banki didn't respond to requests for comment.

Pushing for progress

Musk put pressure on Yaccarino last year to turn around the advertising business faster, according to people familiar with the situation.

Advertisers began to return late last year, but Musk wanted faster progress. He told staff in January that he didn't think the company was on solid financial ground.

"Our user growth is stagnant, revenue is unimpressive, and we're barely breaking even," he said in an email to employees, The Wall Street Journal previously reported. Musk denied sending the email.

Stabilizing X's finances was crucial to the recent merger of X and xAI. After a series of fundraising transactions during the winter, X's value had recovered from an estimated $10 billion to about $44 billion—just north of how much Musk had bought Twitter for in 2022.

The new valuation, buttressed by the improvement in ad revenue, signaled that X's original investors hadn't lost any money they had put in alongside Musk.

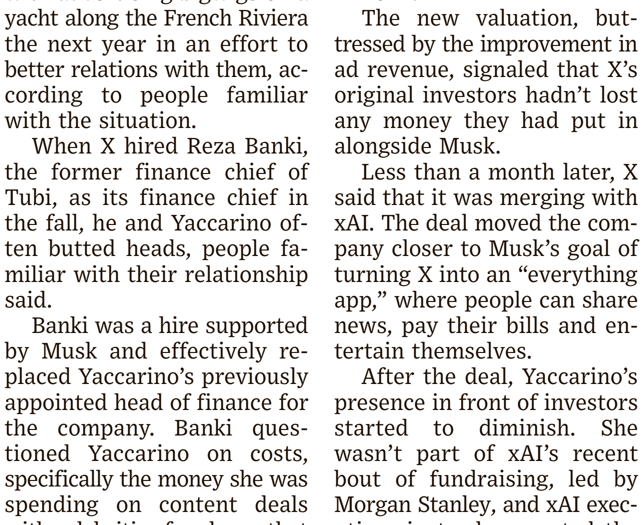
Less than a month later, X said that it was merging with xAI. The deal moved the company closer to Musk's goal of turning X into an "everything app," where people can share news, pay their bills and entertain themselves.

After the deal, Yaccarino's presence in front of investors started to diminish. She wasn't part of xAI's recent bout of fundraising, led by Morgan Stanley, and xAI executives instead presented the company's growth plan to investors, a person familiar with the matter said.

Recently, content-moderation issues have resurfaced, this time caused by xAI's own chatbot, which is embedded in the platform and can be used to respond to or fact-check posts. Grok on Tuesday published a number of antisemitic posts, its second flurry of controversial responses to users in recent months.

XAI said it is "actively working to remove the inappropriate posts" and had taken action to "ban hate speech before Grok posts on X" after being made aware of the posts.

Listen to a Podcast: Why Meta Is Offering $100 Million for AI Geniuses



JEFF CHIU/ASSOCIATED PRESS

In the battle for AI supremacy, Meta's models have lagged behind. Scan this code for a podcast on how Mark Zuckerberg is racing to hire new AI talent and dangling huge pay packages to lure experts from rivals.

BUSINESS & FINANCE

Wells Fargo Nears an Exit From Bilt Tie-Up

By AnnaMaria Andriotis And Gina Heeb

Wells Fargo is moving closer to ending a credit-card partnership that lets people earn rewards points for charging their rent.

The partnership with Bilt had been scheduled to end in 2029, but Wells Fargo decided to exit early after it became a money-losing venture, according to people familiar with the matter.

Bilt said Thursday it is developing its Bilt Card 2.0 with fintech Cardless while also announcing its valuation has skyrocketed to $10.75 billion.

Wells Fargo's partnership with Bilt was launched in 2022 as part of the bank's plans to build out its co-branded credit-card business. The Bilt card quickly became a hit because of a rare perk: It lets cardholders earn rewards points for charging their rent. Wells Fargo had seen the card as a way to attract young customers who would turn to it for a mortgage. But Wells Fargo has pulled back in the mortgage space and the card became a money pit for the bank.

By mid-2024, Wells Fargo was losing as much as $10 million a month on the card, The Wall Street Journal reported. At that time, Bilt and Wells expressed their commitment to the partnership.

Wells Fargo's internal revenue projections for the Bilt card turned out to be off the mark.

Most landlords historically didn't accept credit cards because they refuse to pay the fees for card transactions that often run between 2% and 3%. Bilt structured the card so landlords won't incur the fees. Wells eats much of that. This led to Wells Fargo paying Bilt a fee of about 0.80% of each rent transaction. Interest income Wells Fargo expected from card balances didn't materialize because many cardholders were paying their bills in full each month.

The partnership raised concerns inside Wells Fargo about potential money-laundering risks, which the companies have worked to address.

When people charge rent on their cards, a third-party company sends a check for that amount to the designated landlord. That is easy for Bilt to track for real-estate companies that participate in its rewards program, but harder when it is a mom-and-pop landlord or other company.

A Wells Fargo representative said last year the bank hadn't experienced "any meaningful money-laundering issues with Bilt."

Fintech Startup Raises $820 Million

Deal values iCapital, provider of tech for private markets, at above $7.5 billion

By Miriam Gottfried

An early mover in the effort to open up private markets to individuals is now reaping the benefits of the industry's push into the mainstream.

ICapital, a provider of private-markets financial technology for wealth advisers, has raised more than $820 million in a deal that values it at more than $7.5 billion, the company said. It was last valued at about $6 billion in 2022, according to PitchBook.

Asset manager **T. Rowe Price** and investment firm SurgoCap Partners led the new investment. ICapital, which has been profitable since 2019, plans to use the proceeds to do more acquisitions and expand its business globally, according to Chief Executive Lawrence Calcano.

"We believe we can create a marketplace and an infrastructure for people to buy and sell a complicated range of assets in their portfolio," he said. "The new investors see that opportunity and view it as both a strategic one and a financial one."

Private-equity firms are increasingly looking to wealthy individuals as growth from institutional investors such as pension funds and endowments levels off.

Wealthy individuals, typically via financial advisers, are expected to increase their allocations to private markets to more than $20 trillion by 2030, up from $13 trillion today, **BlackRock** estimates.

ICapital was founded in 2013 to help independent wealth advisers get access to private markets. Its first set of offerings were feeder funds, which pooled commitments from wealthy individuals and invested them in private-equity funds.

ICapital now also offers investments in funds specifically structured for individuals and has expanded to areas like credit, real estate and infrastructure.

It has $945 billion in transaction volume on its platform and 114,000 users.

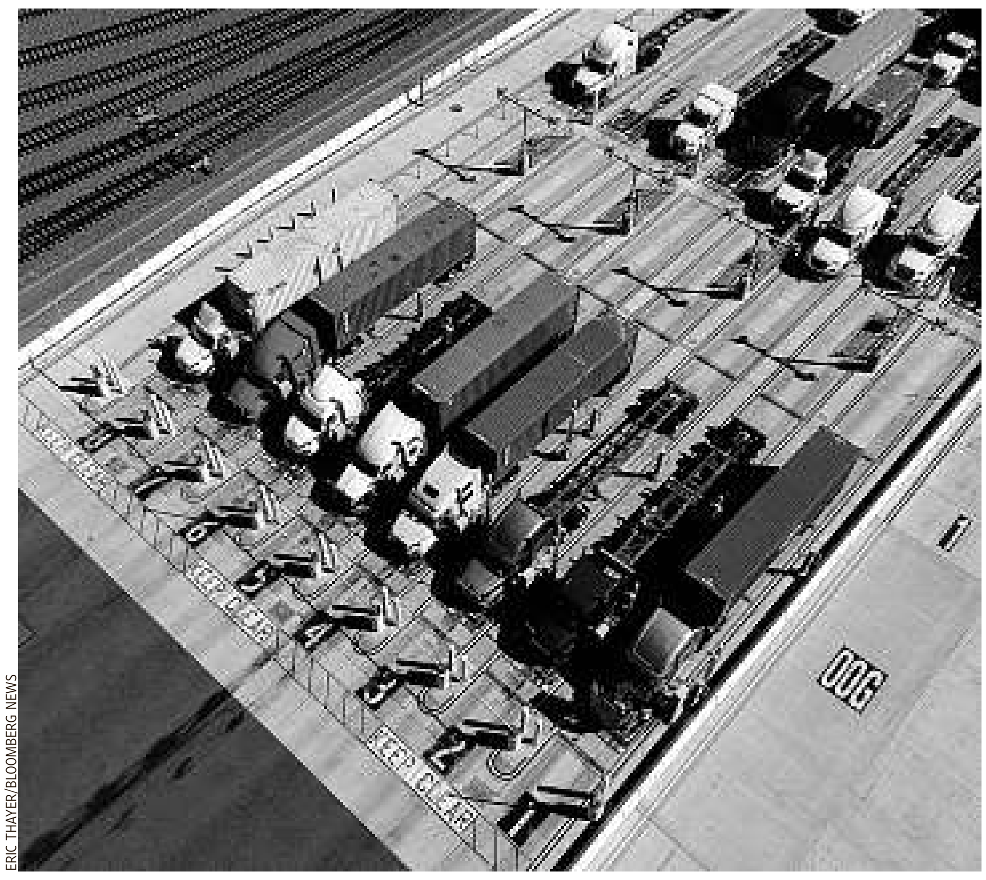
The company's roster of existing investors is a who's-who of the asset-management world, including **Apollo Global Management**, **Blackstone**, BlackRock and **JPMorgan Chase**.

It is considered a likely candidate for an eventual initial public offering, according to people familiar with the matter.

ICapital has done 23 acquisitions, doubling its employee base in recent years to more than 1,800. It has 16 offices around the world.

Thieves Target Pricey Copper by the Truckload

By Paul Berger



ERIC THAYER/BLOOMBERG NEWS

Many thieves target online load boards where freight middlemen match loads with trucks.

Thieves are mining the trucking industry to steal copper as the value of the metal soars.

Reports of copper theft from trucks are rising even faster than the price of the metal, which is used in products ranging from cars to construction materials. The benchmark futures price in the U.S. hit a record this week after President Trump said tariffs of 50% on copper imports would take effect on Aug. 1.

Criminals increasingly have been targeting copper because of rising demand for the metal in rapidly growing sectors of the economy such as renewable energy and data centers. Copper prices are up globally and have surged more than 35% in the U.S. this year.

Thieves have stripped copper from telecommunications lines, street lights and, last month, from around 2,000 feet of cable on the Eurostar rail line, disrupting service between the U.K. and France. Trucking is an attractive target because the haul has already been loaded into a trailer and is ready to go, and criminals are using increasingly sophisticated methods to identify and steal loads.

Copper was identified last year as "a top emerging targeted commodity" by Verisk CargoNet. In 2024, rising copper crimes contributed to a 26% increase in thefts from U.S. and Canadian logistics operations to 3,798 reported incidents, according to the risk-assessment firm.

It expects 2025 to surpass last year's numbers, with reported thefts of the metal in the first half of this year up 61% compared with the same period in 2024. The firm added that under-reporting of cargo theft remains a problem for the industry.

"Criminals bounce from commodity to commodity," said Keith Lewis, Verisk CargoNet's vice president of operations. "If the demand is higher, they are going to steal it because they know they can sell it."

Unlike televisions and computers, which can be traced via product serial numbers and tracking technologies, copper can easily disappear into a market of unscrupulous third parties like scrap yards, Lewis said. Many of the thieves are organized criminals who target load boards, or online platforms where freight middlemen match loads with available trucks.

Details of the loads are anonymized for security reasons. Logistics specialists say the thieves identify locations with large copper-processing facilities. Then they trawl the load boards looking for shipments that have a high likelihood of carrying copper.

That is what happened last summer to Integrity Express Logistics, a freight broker based out of Blue Ash, Ohio, near Cincinnati.

Eric Arling, the freight broker's chief operating officer, said his company brokered a load of rubber-wrapped cable traveling from a scrap yard in the Midwest to a copper-processing facility in the Northeast. The customer didn't say the load was primarily copper, Arling noted, but the origin and destination points were sufficient to catch the attention of thieves.

The criminals used stolen trucking-company identification data to disguise themselves as a carrier that Integrity Express had done business with in the past. They turned up at the scrap yard on a Friday, loaded up the cable—worth $135,000—and drove off. Integrity Express didn't realize the load had been stolen until the following Monday, Arling said, when they were told the cable hadn't shown up at the destination.

The company is now spending more on software and other technology to vet trucking companies and flag risky loads, Arling said, adding that it paid the customer the $135,000 to maintain the business relationship.

"Insurance rarely covers it," he said. "And we don't want to hit our policy too frequently."

U.S. copper futures price, continuous contract

Source: FactSet

Futures Rise As Trump Sets Date for Tariffs

Copper futures rose Thursday after President Trump said that the U.S. will impose its tariffs on global copper imports from the start of next month.

Futures gained 1.9% Thursday to close the day at $5.548 a pound. Trump had said Tuesday he would set a 50% tariff on the metal, sending copper prices soaring to historic highs.

Trump wrote on Truth Social Wednesday evening that the levies would be effective on Aug. 1, the day he has scheduled his so-called reciprocal tariffs to go into effect. Administration officials expect the action will be published in the Federal Register this week. Trump said he had received a national-security report underlining the importance of copper.

—Gavin Bade

Ackman Gets Thrashed in His 67-Minute Pro-Tennis Debut

By Gareth Vipers

Billionaire Bill Ackman likes to win at everything, but professional tennis was a step too far.

The 59-year-old hedge fund titan made his pro-tennis debut Wednesday, entering a competitive ATP doubles tournament alongside four-time Grand Slam champion Jack Sock.

In a little over an hour it was all over, a straight-set defeat to Bernard Tomic and Omar Jasika. Former World No. 1 Andy Roddick, now a podcaster, described it as "the biggest joke I've watched in professional tennis."

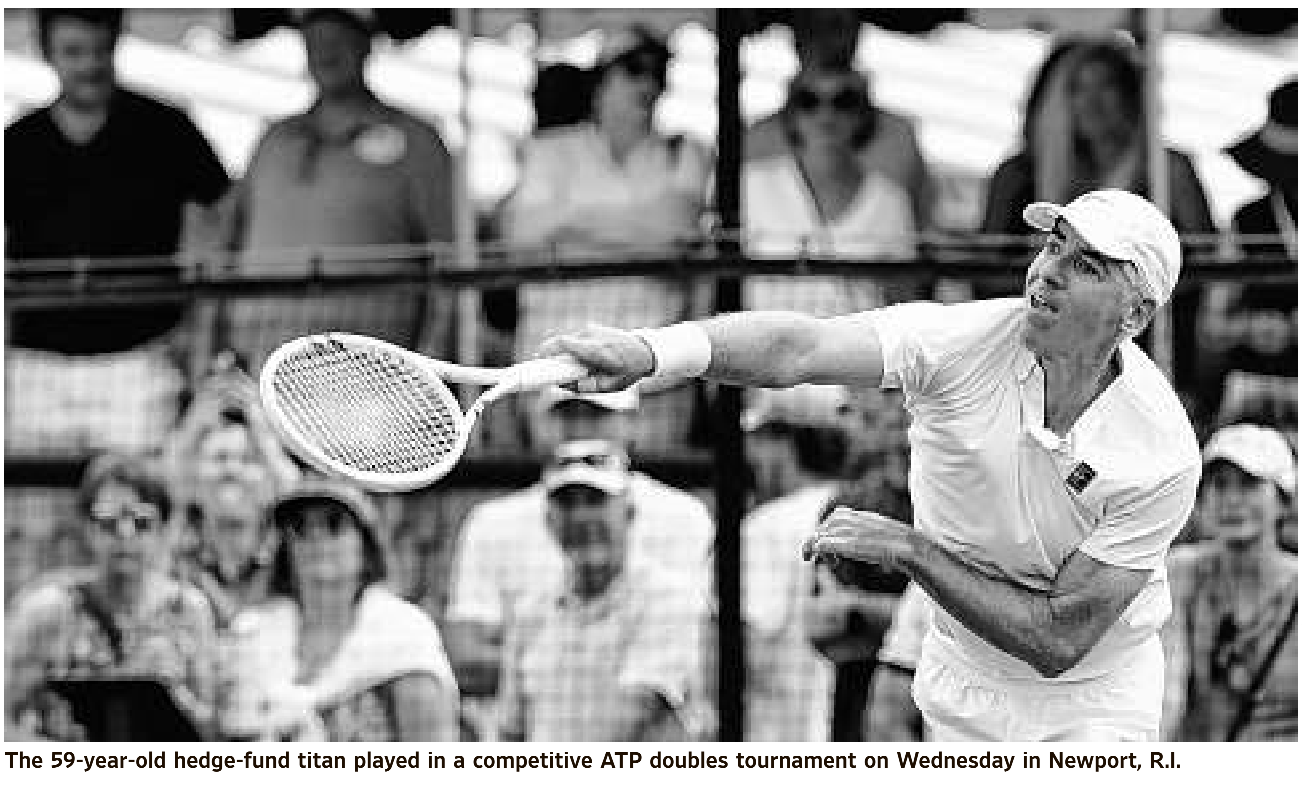
Ackman made his name and multibillion-dollar fortune as an aggressive boardroom slugger and founder of **Pershing Square.** He is also a critic of Harvard University, a prominent supporter of President Trump and a ubiquitous social-media commentator with a cult following.

Ackman was confident before the match in Newport, R.I.

"I am playing the best tennis of my life and Jack is one of the greatest doubles players ever," Ackman wrote in a social-media post announcing his entry to the ATP Challenger event.

"If we win, I am pretty sure I will be the oldest person in tennis history…to win ATP points."

The tennis world was less enthusiastic.



KYLE PRUDHOMME/INTERNATIONAL TENNIS HALL OF FAME

The 59-year-old hedge-fund titan played in a competitive ATP doubles tournament on Wednesday in Newport, R.I.

U.S. Open winner Roddick was visibly irate when describing the match on his podcast, "Served With Andy Roddick," suggesting Ackman might have used his wealth and influence to get into the tournament.

Ackman dismissed that Thursday, saying in an interview with The Wall Street Journal that he had been invited by the tournament organizers after an interaction with Australian professional tennis player Nick Kyrgios on social-media platform X.

The billionaire rebutted suggestions he used his wealth to enter contest.

Ackman had played at an amateur event at the Hall of Fame last week and was offered a wild card entry to the ATP Challenger tournament. When Kyrgios said he couldn't play due to injury, Ackman turned to Sock, a former doubles champion at Wimbledon and the U.S. Open.

Roddick slammed Ackman's and Sock's competitors, Tomic and Jasika, for going easy on the amateur billionaire.

"He was serving 50 miles an hour to someone," Roddick said about Tomic's performance in the match. "He'd have a sitter and he'd play it softly. This match is going to be under review."

In response, Ackman said he had played very well the week before. "No audience or cameras though. A little more age appropriate," he said.

Jasika didn't immediately respond to requests for comment. Tomic couldn't be reached.

In a statement, the tournament organizers said "in no way did Bill buy his way into the Hall of Fame Open." They gave Ackman and Sock a wild card entry to "bring further excitement to this year's tournament." They called it a "learning experience that will help us make better decisions in the future."

Ackman isn't the first middle-aged businessperson to find his way into professional sports. Courtney Reum, a venture capitalist and former Goldman Sachs banker, was given a shot on a Portuguese second division soccer team in 2024 in exchange for a loan and access to his business and finance network.

Ackman has long advocated for a redistribution of advertising revenue in tennis and works with the Professional Tennis Players Association lobbying on behalf of players.

"In tennis you have 18-to-25-year-olds operating their own individual businesses and they don't have time to organize," he said. "The balance of power is in the hands of the tournament owners and they control the ATP. I've invested a meaningful amount of time and energy trying to fix that aspect of the sport."

Ackman's runout on the hallowed Newport lawns was short-lived at 67 minutes, with Tomic and Jasika winning straight sets 6-1, 7-5.

The investor said he might make a return. "Only if I qualify. No more free wild cards. I've got to earn it this time."

MARKETS DIGEST

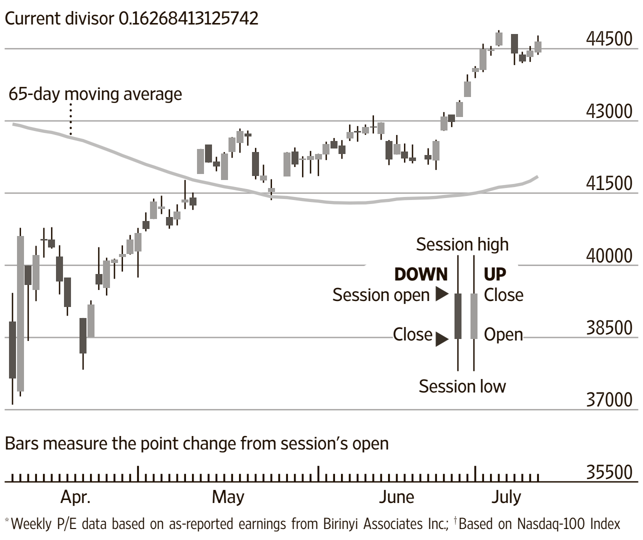
EQUITIES

Dow Jones Industrial Average

44650.64 ▲192.34, or 0.43%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

	Last	Year ago
Trailing P/E ratio	25.32	27.55
P/E estimate *	21.51	19.15
Dividend yield	1.63	2.14
All-time high	45014.04, 12/04/24	



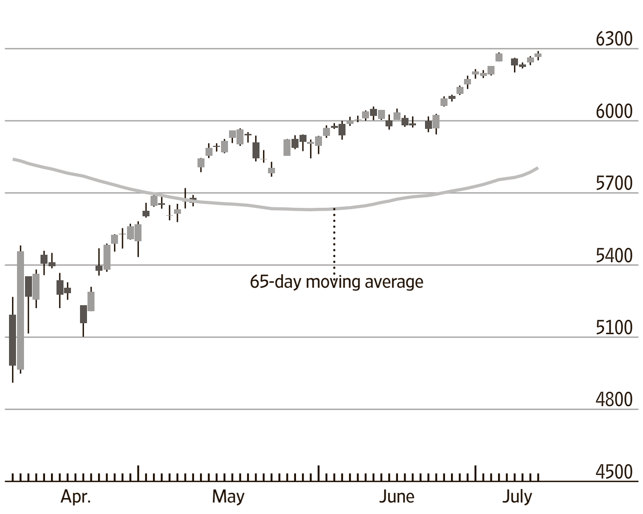
Bars measure the point change from session's open

S&P 500 Index

6280.46 ▲17.20, or 0.27%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

	Last	Year ago
Trailing P/E ratio *	24.56	24.15
P/E estimate *	23.65	22.65
Dividend yield *	1.23	1.30
All-time high	6280.46, 07/10/25	

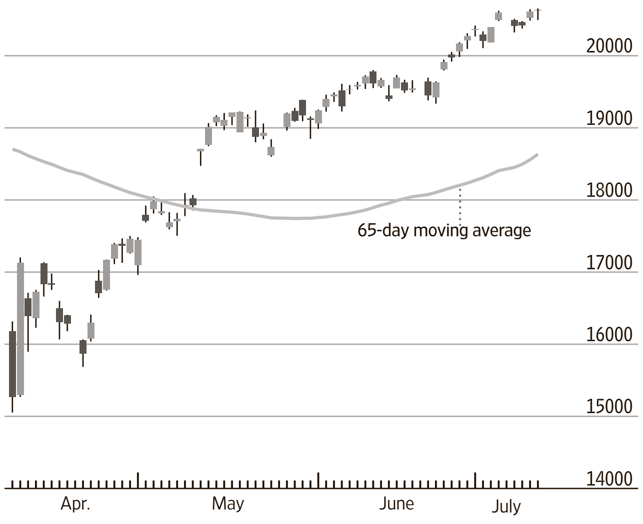


Nasdaq Composite Index

20630.66 ▲ 19.33, or 0.09%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

	Last	Year ago
Trailing P/E ratio *†	32.37	32.36
P/E estimate *†	29.43	29.51
Dividend yield *†	0.68	0.76
All-time high:	20630.66, 07/10/25	



* Weekly P/E data based on as-reported earnings from Birinyi Associates Inc.; † Based on Nasdaq-100 Index

Major U.S. Stock-Market Indexes

	High	Low	Latest Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	52-Week Low	% chg	YTD % chg	3-yr. ann.
Dow Jones										
Industrial Average	44775.47	44372.92	44650.64	192.34	0.43	45014.04	37645.59	12.3	5.0	12.5
Transportation Avg	16480.65	16001.77	16316.19	413.68	2.60	17754.38	12637.04	5.7	2.6	6.8
Utility Average	1067.96	1050.27	1065.75	8.17	0.77	1079.88	929.85	13.5	8.4	3.5
Total Stock Market	62277.68	61881.16	62167.25	165.86	0.27	62167.25	49067.76	12.7	6.5	16.6
Barron's 400	1353.01	1343.16	1346.86	1.57	0.12	1356.99	1058.38	15.8	7.6	15.1
Nasdaq Stock Market										
Nasdaq Composite	20655.39	20495.14	20630.66	19.33	0.09	20630.66	15267.91	12.8	6.8	21.0
Nasdaq-100	22907.04	22716.41	22829.26	-35.65	-0.16	22866.97	17090.40	13.0	8.6	23.5
S&P										
500 Index	6290.22	6251.44	6280.46	17.20	0.27	6280.46	4982.77	12.5	6.8	17.2
MidCap 400	3217.76	3180.71	3199.23	15.41	0.48	3390.26	2560.93	6.9	2.5	11.3
SmallCap 600	1399.79	1377.71	1390.91	13.18	0.96	1544.66	1106.12	3.9	-1.2	6.7
Other Indexes										
Russell 2000	2275.70	2247.19	2263.41	10.92	0.48	2442.03	1760.71	6.5	1.5	8.6
NYSE Composite	20724.56	20574.09	20678.11	69.89	0.34	20725.79	17188.46	12.5	8.3	12.2
Value Line	623.92	616.97	620.97	3.35	0.54	656.04	495.50	4.0	1.6	5.0
NYSE Arca Biotech	5885.53	5776.71	5863.49	74.45	1.29	6318.63	5060.12	6.9	2.1	6.1
NYSE Arca Pharma	961.21	942.78	952.13	9.14	0.97	1140.17	860.88	-11.9	1.9	4.3
KBW Bank	144.41	142.70	144.10	1.43	1.00	145.43	103.52	32.1	13.0	11.8
PHLX§ Gold/Silver	207.95	204.30	207.88	1.96	0.95	212.94	136.24	35.7	51.5	24.0
PHLX§ Oil Service	63.20	61.33	62.93	0.67	1.07	92.31	50.70	-27.1	-13.3	-0.6
PHLX§ Semiconductor	5724.05	5657.89	5708.28	42.29	0.75	5804.03	3562.94	0.2	14.6	29.7
Cboe Volatility	16.24	15.70	15.78	-0.16	-1.00	52.33	12.46	22.1	-9.0	-13.8

§ Nasdaq PHLX

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

Late Trading

Most-active and biggest movers among NYSE, NYSE Arca, NYSE Amer. and Nasdaq issues from 4 p.m. to 6 p.m. ET as reported by electronic trading services, securities dealers and regional exchanges. Minimum share price of $2 and minimum after-hours volume of 50,000 shares.

Most-active issues in late trading

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	After Hours Last	Net chg	% chg	High	Low
Above Food Ingredients	ABVE	49,292.1	2.52	0.97	62.58	3.27	1.45
Gerdau ADR	GGB	28,130.7	3.01	...	unch.	3.01	2.95
SPDR Portfolio S&P 500	SPLG	17,327.0	73.61	-0.02	-0.03	73.64	72.02
Direxion TSLA Bull 2X	TSLL	5,287.5	11.04	...	unch.	11.20	11.03
James Hardie Industries	JHX	4,230.0	28.75	0.48	1.70	29.07	28.27
Hertz Global Holdings	HTZ	4,199.0	7.96	-0.01	-0.13	7.97	7.81
iShares Bitcoin Trust ETF	IBIT	4,035.1	65.77	1.27	1.97	66.22	64.45
SPDR S&P 500 ETF Trust	SPY	3,860.7	625.52	-0.31	-0.05	627.03	531.31

Percentage gainers…

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	After Hours Last	Net chg	% chg	High	Low
Above Food Ingredients	ABVE	49,292.1	2.52	0.97	62.58	3.27	1.45
Unusual Machines	UMAC	815.3	9.68	0.99	11.39	9.94	8.69
AIRO Group Holdings	AIRO	193.0	24.30	2.10	9.46	24.85	21.70
Levi Strauss	LEVI	2,309.6	20.90	1.17	5.93	21.75	19.36
2x Solana ETF	SOLT	55.0	17.32	0.92	5.61	17.49	16.40

…And losers

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	After Hours Last	Net chg	% chg	High	Low
BIT Mining ADR	BTCM	2,206.7	5.73	-0.52	-8.32	6.34	5.32
ProSh UltSh Ether ETF	ETHD	255.5	10.12	-0.83	-7.58	11.02	9.75
Frequency Electronics	FEIM	74.8	21.41	-1.26	-5.56	23.89	19.30
ProSh UltSh Bitcoin ETF	SBIT	277.8	29.70	-1.28	-4.13	31.13	28.49
DuPont de Nemours	DD	82.3	73.30	-2.83	-3.72	76.99	73.11

Trading Diary

Volume, Advancers, Decliners

	NYSE	NYSE Amer.
Total volume*	1,097,753,464	25,726,224
Adv. volume*	738,852,559	21,286,472
Decl. volume*	352,516,684	4,302,635
Issues traded	2,839	295
Advances	1,860	177
Declines	895	106
Unchanged	84	12
New highs	123	10
New lows	13	...
Closing Arms†	1.13	0.33
Block trades*	5,955	218

	Nasdaq	NYSE Arca
Total volume*	9,781,386,277	300,651,338
Adv. volume*	6,850,936,624	212,689,800
Decl. volume*	2,853,637,690	84,747,700
Issues traded	4,656	2,299
Advances	2,610	1,546
Declines	1,859	683
Unchanged	187	70
New highs	209	322
New lows	40	25
Closing Arms†	0.58	1.25
Block trades*	91,052	1,564

* Primary market NYSE, NYSE American NYSE Arca only.
† (TRIN) A comparison of the number of advancing and declining issues with the volume of shares rising and falling. An Arms of less than 1 indicates buying demand; above 1 indicates selling pressure.

International Stock Indexes

Region/Country	Index	Close	Latest Net chg	Latest % chg	YTD % chg
World	MSCI ACWI	926.22	1.92	0.21	10.1
	MSCI ACWI ex-USA	379.99	0.68	0.18	16.6
	MSCI World	4063.96	8.07	0.20	9.6
	MSCI Emerging Markets	1231.26	3.39	0.28	14.5
Americas	MSCI AC Americas	2373.38	5.09	0.21	7.3
Canada	S&P/TSX Comp	27082.30	109.98	0.41	9.5
Latin Amer.	MSCI EM Latin America	2290.76	−33.59	−1.45	23.7
Brazil	Bovespa	136743.26	−737.53	−0.54	13.7
Chile	S&P IPSA	4345.30	7.39	0.17	20.2
Mexico	S&P/BMV IPC	56739.90	52.36	0.09	14.6
EMEA	STOXX Europe 600	552.93	2.97	0.54	8.9
Eurozone	Euro STOXX	573.46	−0.28	−0.05	13.5
Belgium	Bel-20	4547.00	41.20	0.91	6.6
Denmark	OMX Copenhagen 20	1794.45	31.53	1.79	−14.6
France	CAC 40	7902.25	23.79	0.30	7.1
Germany	DAX	24456.81	−92.75	−0.38	22.8
Israel	Tel Aviv	3056.80	−7.50	−0.24	27.6
Italy	FTSE MIB	40528.17	−293.14	−0.72	18.6
Netherlands	AEX	927.32	8.55	0.93	5.5
Norway	Oslo Bors All-Share	1882.12	11.74	0.63	14.4
South Africa	FTSE/JSE All-Share	97364.46	134.44	0.14	15.8
Spain	IBEX 35	14141.60	−112.80	−0.79	22.0
Sweden	OMX Stockholm	986.17	15.33	1.58	3.3
Switzerland	Swiss Market	12131.94	125.08	1.04	4.6
Turkey	BIST 100	10331.31	164.05	1.61	5.1
U.K.	FTSE 100	8975.66	108.64	1.23	9.8
U.K.	FTSE 250	21694.70	126.84	0.59	5.2
Asia-Pacific	MSCI AC Asia Pacific	202.30	0.37	0.19	11.4
Australia	S&P/ASX 200	8589.20	50.62	0.59	5.3
China	Shanghai Composite	3509.68	16.63	0.48	4.7
Hong Kong	Hang Seng	24028.37	136.05	0.57	19.8
India	BSE Sensex	83190.28	−345.80	−0.41	6.5
Japan	NIKKEI 225	39646.36	−174.92	−0.44	−0.6
Singapore	Straits Times	4075.70	17.88	0.44	7.6
South Korea	KOSPI	3183.23	49.49	1.58	32.7
Taiwan	TAIEX	22693.25	166.24	0.74	−1.5
Thailand	SET	1110.40	...	Closed	−20.7

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

Percentage Gainers…

Company	Symbol	Latest Session Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	Low	% chg
DallasNews	DALN	13.56	9.17	208.88	13.58	2.98	318.5
BIT Mining ADR	BTCM	6.25	3.79	154.07	8.07	1.22	118.5
Sequans Comms ADR	SQNS	3.90	1.83	88.41	4.28	0.95	181.1
Pelthos Therapeutics	PTHS	26.48	10.01	60.78	54.29	4.50	110.2
Mingteng International	MTEN	17.11	6.20	56.83	22.35	2.21	598.4
Lixte Biotechnology	LIXT	4.22	1.47	53.45	4.33	0.64	78.1
MP Materials	MP	45.23	15.20	50.62	48.12	10.02	204.0
Liminatus Pharma	LIMN	7.20	1.98	37.93	33.66	4.40	-37.1
Ruanyun Edai Technology	RYET	15.39	4.22	37.78	15.49	2.68	...
Ebang International	EBON	4.67	1.28	37.66	10.94	3.00	-26.2
CEL-SCI	CVM	3.82	1.02	36.43	66.60	1.98	-89.7
Newegg Commerce	NEGG	28.73	7.01	32.27	28.82	3.32	34.9
Artelo Biosciences	ARTL	28.50	6.90	31.94	28.60	4.92	274.0
Toro	TORO	2.96	0.71	31.56	3.37	1.29	11.3
HeartSciences	HSCS	5.73	1.36	31.12	6.47	2.36	41.8

Percentage Losers

Company	Symbol	Latest Session Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	Low	% chg
Youlife Group ADR	YOUL	5.00	-23.00	-82.14	33.94	2.55	-53.7
Concorde Intl	CIGL	5.66	-22.52	-79.91	31.06	2.12	...
Mereo BioPharma ADR	MREO	1.69	-1.25	-42.52	5.02	1.58	-56.6
Currenc Group	CURR	1.35	-0.68	-33.50	13.59	0.33	-88.4
LZ Technology Holdings	LZMH	6.30	-3.07	-32.76	32.10	4.40	...
BitMine Immersion Techs	BMNR	46.01	-20.71	-31.04	161.00	1.93	326.0
ABVC BioPharma	ABVC	3.35	-1.33	-28.42	5.48	0.40	308.6
Creative Medical Tech	CELZ	2.87	-1.07	-27.16	6.90	1.69	-16.8
Methode Electronics	MEI	7.70	-2.59	-25.17	17.45	5.08	-44.0
Citius Oncology	CTOR	3.25	-1.09	-25.12	49.00	0.55	-71.5
Ultragenyx Pharm	RARE	31.04	-10.41	-25.11	60.37	29.06	-29.3
SMX (Security Matters)	SMX	3.11	-0.96	-23.59	956.13	2.95	-99.7
Rich Sparkle Holdings	ANPA	3.67	-1.09	-22.90	14.83	3.20	...
Helen of Troy	HELE	23.96	-7.04	-22.71	77.95	21.20	-62.8
Byrna Technologies	BYRN	25.42	-6.89	-21.32	34.78	7.79	155.2

Most Active Stocks

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	% chg from 65-day avg	Latest Session Close	% chg	52-Week High	Low
GIBO Holdings	GIBO	1,043,972	8189.8	0.05	44.67	24.18	0.03
NuCana ADR	NCNA	582,969	236.8	0.06	-1.00	10.79	0.03
Healthcare Triangle	HCTI	467,250	67.3	0.02	19.50	1.90	0.01
Above Food Ingredients	ABVE	406,685	38150.4	1.55	324.66	2.92	0.25
Cognition Therapeutics	CGTX	244,066	10932.8	0.70	31.45	2.54	0.22
Bit Origin Cl A	BTOG	236,800	813.0	0.29	48.79	3.09	0.12
Direxion Dly Semi 3 Bear	SOXS	216,942	85.6	7.14	-2.99	53.43	7.06
NVIDIA	NVDA	166,808	-30.5	164.10	0.75	164.50	86.62
BIT Mining ADR	BTCM	159,208	242522.9	6.25	154.07	8.07	1.22
Direxion TSLA Bull 2X	TSLL	156,784	-26.7	11.04	9.42	41.50	6.29

* Volumes of 100,000 shares or more are rounded to the nearest thousand

Volume Movers

Ranked by change from 65-day average*

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	% chg from 65-day avg	Latest Session Close	% chg	52-Week High	Low
Youlife Group ADR	YOUL	2,709	33029	5.00	-82.14	33.94	2.55
NeOnc Technologies Hldgs	NTHI	4,244	6184	4.88	-18.05	25.00	3.20
SP Funds S&P Wld (ex-US)	SPWO	612	3848	24.33	-0.54	24.80	19.15
WK Kellogg	KLG	37,322	3727	22.86	30.63	22.96	14.80
Concorde Intl	CIGL	5,938	3199	5.66	-79.91	31.06	2.12
SPDR DJ Intl Real Estate	RWX	3,971	2865	26.91	-0.59	28.19	22.27
FT Dorsey Wright In Foc5	IFV	851	2579	23.14	-0.24	23.28	16.88
Wahed DJ Islamic World	UMMA	588	1845	26.73	-0.34	26.94	20.85
SPDR Bbg Enh Roll Yd Cmd	CERY	2,407	1315	27.66	0.19	28.69	24.01
Breakwave Dry Bulk	BDRY	2,067	1311	6.66	6.56	12.29	5.03

* Common stocks priced at $2 a share or more with an average volume over 65 trading days of at least 5,000 shares †Has traded fewer than 65 days

CURRENCIES & COMMODITIES

Currencies

U.S.-dollar foreign-exchange rates in late New York trading

Country/currency	Thurs in US$	Thurs per US$	US$ vs, YTD chg (%)
Americas			
Argentina peso	.0008	1255.6482	21.8
Brazil real	.1808	5.5317	-10.6
Canada dollar	.7324	1.3655	-5.1
Chile peso	.001052	950.38	-4.4
Colombia peso	.000249	4016.00	-8.8
Ecuador US dollar	1	1	unch
Mexico peso	.0537	18.6055	-10.7
Uruguay peso	.02473	40.4350	-7.4
Asia-Pacific			
Australia dollar	.6590	1.5175	-6.1
China yuan	.1394	7.1753	-1.7
Hong Kong dollar	.1274	7.8500	1.0
India rupee	.01167	85.722	0.2
Indonesia rupiah	.0000617	16214	-0.3
Japan yen	.006838	146.25	-7.0
Kazakhstan tenge	.001926	519.26	-1.1
Macau pataca	.1236	8.0910	1.1
Malaysia ringgit	.2354	4.2475	-5.0
New Zealand dollar	.6036	1.6567	-7.3
Pakistan rupee	.00351	284.500	2.2
Philippines peso	.0177	56.520	-2.7
Singapore dollar	.7815	1.2796	-6.3
South Korea won	.0007290	1371.73	-7.2
Sri Lanka rupee	.0033268	300.59	2.5
Taiwan dollar	.03420	29.241	-10.9
Thailand baht	.03066	32.620	-5.0
Vietnam dong	.00003829	26115	2.5
Europe			
Czech Rep. koruna	.04750	21.054	-13.5
Denmark krone	.1568	6.3769	-11.5
Euro area euro	1.1703	.8545	-11.5
Hungary forint	.002935	340.68	-14.3
Iceland krona	.008193	122.05	-12.2
Norway krone	.0993	10.0739	-11.5
Poland zloty	.2752	3.6343	-12.0
Sweden krona	.1053	9.5001	-14.2
Switzerland franc	1.2547	.7970	-12.2
Turkey lira	.0250	40.0722	13.4
Ukraine hryvnia	.0238	41.9500	-0.2
UK pound	1.3579	.7364	-7.8
Middle East/Africa			
Bahrain dinar	2.6526	.3770	-0.03
Egypt pound	.0202	49.5100	-2.6
Israel shekel	.3019	3.3125	-9.0
Kuwait dinar	3.2716	.3057	-0.9
Oman sul rial	2.5991	.3847	-0.1
Qatar rial	.2742	3.648	0.1
Saudi Arabia riyal	.2666	3.7506	-0.2
South Africa rand	.0564	17.7453	-6.0

	Close	Net Chg	% Chg	YTD % Chg
WSJ Dollar Index	94.68	−0.04	−0.05	−7.85

Sources: Tullett Prebon, Dow Jones Market Data

Commodities

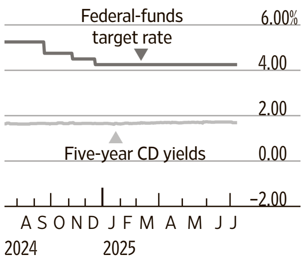
	Thursday Close	Net chg	% Chg	52-Week High	Low	% Chg	YTD % chg
DJ Commodity	1061.77	-1.92	-0.18	1115.06	942.52	4.09	3.85
FTSE/CC CRB Index	300.37	-1.28	-0.43	316.63	265.48	3.43	1.23
Crude oil, $ per barrel	66.57	-1.81	-2.65	82.85	57.13	-19.43	-7.18
Natural gas, $/MMBtu	3.337	0.123	3.83	4.491	1.904	47.13	-8.15
Gold, $ per troy oz.	3317.40	5.80	0.18	3431.20	2351.90	37.37	26.18

CREDIT MARKETS

Consumer Rates and Returns to Investor

U.S. consumer rates

A consumer rate against its benchmark over the past year



Selected rates

5-year CDs

Bankrate.com avg†:	1.69%
GTE Financial Credit Union	4.07%
Tampa, FL	888-871-2690
KS StateBank	4.10%
Manhattan, KS	785-587-4000
Synchrony Bank	4.15%
Draper, UT	866-226-5638
Popular Direct	4.20%
Miami Lakes, FL	800-274-5696
America First FCU	4.25%
Riverdale, UT	801-627-0900

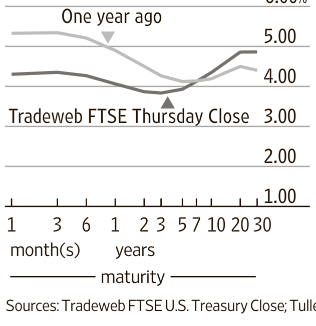
Interest rate	Yield/Rate (%) Last (●)	Week ago	52-Week Range (%) Low	High	3-yr chg (pct pts)
Federal-funds rate target	4.25-4.50	4.25-4.50	4.25	5.50	2.75
Prime rate*	7.50	7.50	7.50	8.50	2.75
SOFR	4.32	4.40	4.26	5.38	2.79
Money market, annual yield	0.43	0.45	0.40	0.56	0.32
Five-year CD, annual yield	1.69	1.72	1.62	1.73	0.13
30-year mortgage, fixed†	6.78	6.76	6.68	7.42	0.91
15-year mortgage, fixed†	6.04	6.02	6.00	6.82	1.03
Jumbo mortgages, $726,200-plus†	6.95	6.85	6.75	7.49	1.07
Five-year adj mortgage (ARM)†	6.18	6.13	5.88	6.58	1.88
New-car loan, 48-month	7.25	7.20	6.81	7.86	2.17

Bankrate.com rates based on survey of over 1,500 online banks. *Base rate posted by 70% of the nation's largest banks.† Excludes closing costs.

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data; Bankrate.com

Treasury yield curve

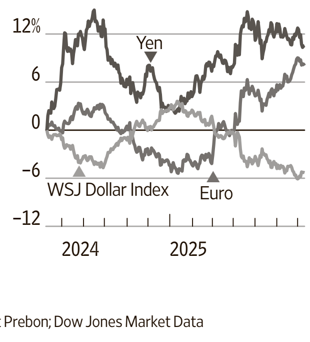
Yield to maturity of current bills, notes and bonds



Sources: Tradeweb FTSE U.S. Treasury Close; Tullett Prebon; Dow Jones Market Data

Forex Race

Yen, euro vs. dollar; dollar vs. major U.S. trading partners



Corporate Borrowing Rates and Yields

Bond total return index	Close	Yield (%) Last	Week ago	52-Week High	Low	Total Return (%) 52-wk	3-yr
U.S. Treasury, Bloomberg	2265.350	4.150	4.160	4.640	3.630	4.132	1.546
U.S. Treasury Long, Bloomberg	3104.240	4.880	4.880	5.120	3.990	−0.517	−3.486
Aggregate, Bloomberg	2167.890	4.620	4.620	5.110	4.100	4.822	2.506
Fixed-Rate MBS, Bloomberg	2146.950	5.010	5.010	5.520	4.340	5.200	2.255
High Yield 100, ICE BofA	3998.576	6.242	6.082	7.793	6.082	9.255	9.638
Muni Master, ICE BofA	592.574	3.635	3.662	4.179	3.074	0.662	1.892
EMBI Global, J.P. Morgan	949.399	7.271	7.244	8.038	7.084	8.231	8.336

Sources: J.P. Morgan; Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices; ICE Data Services

COMMODITIES

wsj.com/market-data/commodities

Futures Contracts

Metal & Petroleum Futures

Contract	Open	High hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Copper-High (CMX)-25,000 lbs.; $ per lb.						
July	5.5800	5.5930	5.5435	5.5480	0.1045	4,644
Sept	5.5410	5.6855	5.5255	5.5910	0.1045	112,521
Gold (CMX)-100 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.						
July	3323.60	3330.50	3311.60	3317.40	5.80	293
Aug	3322.20	3339.40	3319.20	3325.70	4.70	275,285
Sept	3338.50	3353.00	3335.60	3340.30	4.70	1,376
Oct	3351.40	3366.40	3347.40	3353.30	4.80	29,046
Nov	3379.10	3380.50	3368.10	3368.30	4.80	325
Dec	3378.00	3394.50	3375.20	3381.00	4.70	117,726
Palladium (NYM) - 50 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.						
July	1183.50	1214.50 ▲	1183.50	1186.90	56.10	
Sept	1145.00	1215.00 ▲	1134.00	1197.40	55.90	19,748
Platinum (NYM)-50 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.						
July	1409.80	1409.80	1394.80	1394.90	24.30	114
Oct	1388.90	1439.80	1381.70	1412.50	27.20	83,352
Silver (CMX)-5,000 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.						
July	36.640	37.410 ▲	36.640	37.038	0.687	696
Sept	36.600	37.690	36.575	37.305	0.675	125,701
Crude Oil, Light Sweet (NYM)-1,000 bbls.; $ per bbl.						
Aug	68.29	68.65	66.45	66.57	-1.81	214,784
Sept	66.90	67.31	65.26	65.38	-1.59	286,181
Oct	65.55	66.02	64.12	64.24	-1.40	182,884
Dec	64.02	64.51	62.80	62.94	-1.13	244,764
June'26	63.07	63.49	62.15	62.31	-0.80	116,796
Dec	63.01	63.40	62.17	62.33	-0.70	155,995
NY Harbor ULSD (NYM)-42,000 gal.; $ per gal.						
Aug	2.4103	2.4338	2.3711	2.3835	-.0257	85,441
Sept	2.3698	2.3898	2.3332	2.3412	-.0286	74,424
Gasoline-NY RBOB (NYM)-42,000 gal.; $ per gal.						
Aug	2.1941	2.2000	2.1448	2.1524	-.0355	111,420
Sept	2.1454	2.1581	2.1049	2.1096	-.0386	92,294
Natural Gas (NYM)-10,000 MMBtu.; $ per MMBtu.						
Aug	3.208	3.398	3.191	3.337	.123	143,508
Sept	3.242	3.421	3.224	3.366	.115	206,256
Oct	3.362	3.538	3.346	3.490	.117	145,766
Nov	3.775	3.946	3.764	3.903	.115	115,994
Jan'26	4.689	4.857	4.681	4.817	.108	147,743
March	3.963	4.101	3.952	4.075	.092	115,095

Agriculture Futures

Contract	Open	High hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Corn (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
July	412.50	414.00 ▼	407.25	407.25	-5.25	486
Dec	415.00	417.00	412.50	416.50	1.00	597,278
Oats (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
July	400.00	402.00	392.25	392.25	2.00	4
Dec	366.00	372.00	364.25	370.00	1.25	2,554
Soybeans (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
July	1005.25	1013.00	1004.50	1012.50	.25	380
Nov	1005.00	1015.00	1002.25	1013.75	6.50	398,449
Soybean Meal (CBT)-100 tons; $ per ton.						
July	265.10	268.60 ▼	265.10	268.50	2.40	513
Dec	282.90	286.60 ▼	281.20	285.30	2.40	272,418
Soybean Oil (CBT)-60,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
July	53.55	53.56	53.20	53.67	.32	106
Dec	53.67	53.81	53.04	53.47	.20	263,732
Rough Rice (CBT)-2,000 cwt.; $ per cwt.						
July	12.46	12.47	12.46	12.58	-.22	72
Sept	13.12	13.22	12.90	12.92	-.23	9,002
Wheat (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
July	542.75	550.50	542.75	550.25	7.50	54
Sept	547.00	555.50	541.00	554.50	7.50	208,980
Wheat (KC)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
July	501.50	508.00	501.50	514.00	8.50	18
Sept	523.25	535.00	519.00	534.75	10.75	156,190
Cattle-Feeder (CME)-50,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
Aug	322.625	326.875 ▲	318.850	321.275	.800	39,788
Sept	322.450	326.575 ▲	318.500	321.225	1.200	23,604
Cattle-Live (CME)-40,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
Aug	221.500	222.500 ▲	217.200	219.225	-.550	116,110
Oct	218.975	220.625 ▲	215.125	217.075	-.275	122,180
Hogs-Lean (CME)-40,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
July	107.125	107.325	106.950	107.250	.150	14,601
Oct	93.825	94.400	92.050	92.275	-1.500	102,304
Lumber (CME)-27,500 bd. ft., $ per 1,000 bd. ft.						
July	617.00	617.50	610.00	611.50	-5.50	775
Sept	673.00	674.50	664.00	666.00	-6.50	5,433
Milk (CME)-200,000 lbs., cents per lb.						
July	17.37	17.44	17.36	17.38	.06	3,777
Aug	18.03	18.31	17.83	17.86	-.06	4,567
Cocoa (ICE-US)-10 metric tons; $ per ton.						
July	8,742	8,742	8,742	8,742	-304	2
Sept	8,283	8,450	8,045	8,059	-317	39,174
Coffee (ICE-US)-37,500 lbs.; cents per lb.						
July	289.90	289.90	289.90	289.90	4.05	289
Sept	278.65	294.55	277.60	287.80	3.75	70,666
Sugar-World (ICE-US)-112,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
Oct	16.41	16.56	16.22	16.26	-.30	405,152
March'26	17.10	17.21	16.92	16.95	-.27	214,752
Sugar-Domestic (ICE-US)-112,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
Sept	35.16	35.16	35.16	35.16	.41	742
Jan'26	36.00	36.00	36.00	36.07	1.27	1,464
Cotton (ICE-US)-50,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
Oct	66.50	66.60	66.11	66.25	-.11	378
Dec	67.45	68.10	67.39	67.73	-.05	151,201
Orange Juice (ICE-US)-15,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
July	285.00	285.00	285.00	279.95	29.10	101
Sept	259.95	263.85	259.95	263.85	15.00	6,434

Interest Rate Futures

Contract	Open	High hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Ultra Treasury Bonds (CBT) - $100,000; pts 32nds of 100%						
Sept	117-140	117-230	116-290	117-200	10.0	1,959,480
Dec	116-300	117-150	116-240	117-130	-2.0	226
Treasury Bonds (CBT)-$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%						
Sept	114-050	114-130	113-230	114-080	6.0	1,824,876
Dec	113-240	114-010	113-120	113-280	6.0	6,664
Treasury Notes (CBT)-$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%						
Sept	111-105	111-135	111-005	111-070	-1.5	4,916,254
Dec	111-115	111-115	110-315	111-055	-1.0	4,780
5 Yr. Treasury Notes (CBT)-$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%						
Sept	108-147	108-162	108-082	108-117	-1.5	7,040,447
Dec	108-095	108-192	108-117	108-150	-1.5	2,164
2 Yr. Treasury Notes (CBT)-$200,000; pts 32nds of 100%						
Sept	103-241	103-246	103-212	103-226	-.6	4,346,457
Dec	103-291	103-309	103-279	103-293	-.5	2,207
30 Day Federal Funds (CBT)-$5,000,000; 100 - daily avg.						
July	95.6700	95.6725 ▼	95.6700	95.6725	.0025	508,214
Aug	95.6850	95.6900	95.6850	95.6900	.0050	632,158
Three-Month SOFR (CME)-$1,000,000; 100 - daily avg.						
April	95.6600	95.6600	95.6600	95.6600		10,823
June	95.6350	95.6400	95.6350	95.6400	.0025	1,299,336

Currency Futures

Contract	Open	High hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Japanese Yen (CME)-¥12,500,000; $ per 100¥						
July	.6844	.6862	.6815	.6840	.0002	1,164
Sept	.6886	.6912	.6862	.6888	.0002	301,796
Canadian Dollar (CME)-CAD 100,000; $ per CAD						
July	.7310	.7318	.7300	.7316	.0011	479
Sept	.7332	.7349	.7320	.7339	.0011	194,769
British Pound (CME)-£62,500; $ per £						
July	1.3618	1.3618	1.3537	1.3574	-.0013	722
Sept	1.3593	1.3627	1.3539	1.3581	-.0013	186,824
Swiss Franc (CME)-CHF 125,000; $ per CHF						
Sept	1.2700	1.2730	1.2622	1.2648	-.0040	72,650
Dec	1.2832	1.2867	1.2768	1.2788	-.0041	444
Australian Dollar (CME)-AUD 100,000; $ per AUD						
July	.6562	.6591 ▲	.6540	.6584	.0046	528
Sept	.6543	.6599	.6541	.6591	.0046	148,845
Mexican Peso (CME)-MXN 500,000; $ per MXN						
July	.05348	.05368	.05352	.05366	...	155
Sept	.05333	.05339	.05308	.05331	.00002	167,023
Euro (CME)-€125,000; $ per €						
July	1.1727	1.1751	1.1669	1.1694	-.0023	2,989
Sept	1.1778	1.1801	1.1714	1.1744	-.0023	782,858

Index Futures

Contract	Open	High hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Mini DJ Industrial Average (CBT)-$5 x index						
Sept	44728	45043	44565	44908	189	85,407
Dec	45024	45369	44896	45237	190	651
Mini S&P 500 (CME)-$50 x index						
Sept	6306.00	6335.50 ▲	6287.50	6324.25	17.00	1,890,810
Dec	6362.50	6388.75 ▲	6341.75	6378.00	17.25	11,043
Mini S&P Midcap 400 (CME)-$100 x index						
Sept	3206.10	3240.00	3197.20	3221.40	15.00	35,444
Dec	...	3242.30	3227.80	3243.00	15.50	n.a.
Mini Nasdaq 100 (CME)-$20 x index						
Sept	23041.00	23090.00	22901.25	23013.25	-39.50	268,814
Dec	23259.75	23316.00	23129.00	23241.00	-39.50	867
Mini Russell 2000 (CME)-$50 x index						
Sept	2268.60	2292.60	2260.20	2280.00	11.60	393,683
Dec	2283.30	2309.90	2277.80	2297.30	12.00	391
March'26	2280.00	2310.30	2302.70	2314.30	11.60	1
Mini Russell 1000 (CME)-$50 x index						
Sept	3461.30	3468.60 ▲	3447.20	3462.80	8.90	5,279
U.S. Dollar Index (ICE-US)-$1,000 x index						
Sept	97.07	97.59	96.95	97.32	.12	35,740
Dec	96.60	97.15	96.60	96.93	.12	587

Source: FactSet

Cash Prices | wsj.com/market-data/commodities

Thursday, July 10, 2025

These prices reflect buying and selling of a variety of actual or "physical" commodities in the marketplace—separate from the futures price on an exchange, which reflects what the commodity might be worth in future months.

	Thursday
Energy	
Coal,C.Aplc.,12500Btu,1.2SO2-r,w	79.000
Coal,PwdrRvrBsn,8800Btu,0.8SO2-r,w	14.300
Metals	
Gold, per troy oz	
Engelhard industrial	3328.00
LBMA Gold Price AM	*3288.05
LBMA Gold Price PM	*3300.15
Krugerrand,wholesale-e	3467.31
Maple Leaf-e	3550.26
American Eagle-e	3550.26
Mexican peso-e	4280.55
Austria crown-e	3255.30
Austria phil-e	3483.90
Silver, troy oz.	
Engelhard industrial	36.9500
Handy & Harman base	36.8710
Handy & Harman fabricated	46.0890
LBMA spot price	*£26.9400
(U.S.$ equivalent)	*36.5900
Coins,wholesale $1,000 face-a	27642
Other metals	
LBMA Platinum Price PM	*1360.0
LBMA Palladium Price PM	*1100.0
Platinum,Engelhard industrial	1364.0
Palladium,Engelhard industrial	1152.0
Aluminum, LME, $ per metric ton	*2580.0
Copper,Comex spot	5.5480

	Thursday
Iron Ore, 62% Fe CFR China-s	*95.3
Steel, HRC USA, FOB Midwest Mill-s	*865.0
Battery/EV metals	
BMI Lithium Carbonate, EXW China, =99.5%-v,w	8675
BMI Lithium Hydroxide, EXW China, =56.5% -v,w	8000
BMI Cobalt sulphate, EXW China, >20.5% -v,m	6950
BMI Nickel Sulphate, EXW China, >22%-v,m	3654
BMI Flake Graphite, FOB China, -100 Mesh, 94-95% -v,m	435
Fibers and Textiles	
Burlap,10-oz,40-inch NY yd-n,w	0.8900
Cotton,1 1/16 std lw-mdMphs-u	0.6500
Cotlook 'A' Index-t	*78.15
Hides,hvy native steers piece fob-u	n.a.
Wool,64s,staple,Terr del-u,w	n.a.
Grains and Feeds	
Bran,wheat middlings, KC-u,w	65
Corn,No. 2 yellow,Cent IL-bp,u	3.9300
Corn gluten feed,Midwest-u,w	101.8
Corn gluten meal,Midwest-u,w	424.0
Cottonseed meal-u,w	n.a.
Hominy feed,Cent IL-u,w	112
Meat-bonemeal,50% pro Mnpls-u,w	263
Oats,No.2 milling,Mnpls-u	3.9300
Rice, Long Grain Milled, No. 2 AR-u,w	34.88
Sorghum,(Milo) No.2 Gulf-u	n.a.
SoybeanMeal,Cent IL,rail,ton48%-u,w	n.a.
Soybeans,No.1 yllw IL-bp,u	9.9600
Wheat,Spring14%-pro Mnpls-u	8.0675

	Thursday
Wheat,No.2 soft red,St.Louis-u	5.3200
Wheat - Hard - KC (USDA) $ per bu-u	5.3975
Wheat,No.1soft white,Portld,OR-u	6.1500
Food	
Beef,carcass equiv. index	
choice 1-3,600-900 lbs.-u	361.59
select 1-3,600-900 lbs.-u	346.17
Broilers, National comp wtd. avg.-u,w	1.3545
Butter,AA Chicago-d	2.5900
Cheddar cheese,bbl,Chicago-d	171.00
Cheddar cheese,blk,Chicago-d	168.50
Milk,Nonfat dry,Chicago lb.-d	126.50
Coffee,Brazilian,Comp-y	2.9114
Coffee,Colombian, NY-y	3.1420
Eggs,large white,Chicago-u,w	2.9350
Flour,hard winter KC-p	15.55
Hams,17-20 lbs,Mid-US fob-u	n.a.
Hogs,Iowa-So. Minnesota-u	103.41
Pork bellies,12-14 lb MidUS-u	n.a.
Pork loins,13-19 lb MidUS-u	1.1480
Steers,Tex.-Okla. Choice-u	n.a.
Steers,feeder,Okla. City-u,w	n.a.
Fats and Oils	
Degummed corn oil, crude wtd. avg.-u,w	n.a.
Grease,choice white,Chicago-h	0.5750
Lard,Chicago-u	n.a.
Soybean oil,crude;Centl IL-u,w	n.a.
Tallow,bleach;Chicago-h	0.6175
Tallow,edible,Chicago-u	n.a.

KEY TO CODES: A=ask; B=bid; BP=country elevator bids to producers; C=corrected; D=CME; E=Manfra,Tordella & Brookes; H=American Commodities Brokerage Co; K=bi-weekly; M=monthly; N=nominal; n.a.=not quoted or not available; P=Sosland Publishing; R=SNL Energy; S=Platts-TSI; T=Cotlook Limited; U=USDA; V=Benchmark Mineral Intelligence; W=weekly; Y=International Coffee Organization; Z=not quoted. *Data as of 7/9

Source: Dow Jones Market Data

Exchange-Traded Portfolios | wsj.com/market-data/mutualfunds-etfs

Largest 100 exchange-traded funds. Preliminary close data as of 4:30 p.m. ET

Thursday, July 10, 2025

ETF	Symbol	Closing Price	Chg (%)	YTD (%)
CommSvsSPDR	XLC	106.70	-0.34	10.2
CnsmrDiscSel	XLY	221.37	1.11	-1.3
DimenUSCoreEq2	DFAC	36.61	0.44	5.8
EnSelSectorSPDR	XLE	88.73	0.76	3.6
FidWiseBTC	FBTC	99.04	1.42	21.4
FinSelSectorSPDR	XLF	52.71	0.59	9.1
HealthCrSelSect	XLV	136.32	0.61	-0.9
IndSelSectorSPDR	XLI	150.74	0.56	14.4
InvscNasd100	QQQM	228.63	-0.15	8.6
InvscQQQI	QQQ	555.45	-0.14	8.6
InvscS&P500EW	RSP	185.78	0.58	6.0
iShBitcoin	IBIT	64.50	1.45	21.6
iShBrdUSDHYCpBd	USHY	37.27	-0.08	1.3
iShCoreDivGrowth	DGRO	65.24	0.54	6.4
iShCoreMSCIEAFE	IEFA	83.86	...	19.3
iShCoreMSCIEM	IEMG	60.23	0.32	15.3
iShCoreMSCITotInt	IXUS	77.82	0.10	17.7
iShCoreS&P500	IVV	628.85	0.29	6.8
iShCoreS&P MC	IJH	63.99	0.53	2.7
iShCoreS&P SC	IJR	114.07	0.99	-1.0
iShCoreS&PTotUS	ITOT	137.00	0.28	6.5
iShCoreS&PUSGrw	IUSG	151.72	0.09	8.9
iShCoreS&PUSVal	IUSV	96.45	0.55	4.2
iShCoreTotUSDBd	IUSB	45.90	-0.02	1.5
iShCoreUSAggBd	AGG	98.46	-0.03	1.6
iShEdgeMSCIMinUSA	USMV	93.45	-0.30	5.2
iShEdgeMSCIUSAQual	QUAL	184.93	-0.01	3.8
iShGoldTr	IAU	62.67	0.24	26.6
iShiBoxx$IGCpBd	LQD	108.74	0.02	1.8
iShMBS	MBB	93.24	-0.05	1.7
iShMSCIACWI	ACWI	129.85	0.21	10.5
iShMSCI EAFE	EFA	89.81	-0.07	18.8
iShMSCIEAFEValue	EFV	64.17	-0.03	22.3
iShNatlMuniBd	MUB	104.26	...	-2.1
iSh1-5YIGCpBd	IGSB	52.48	-0.04	1.5
iSh1-3YTreaBd	SHY	82.47	...	0.6
iShRussMC	IWR	94.00	0.48	6.3
iShRuss1000	IWB	344.06	0.27	6.8
iShRuss1000Grw	IWF	428.72	-0.03	6.8
iShRuss1000Val	IWD	197.34	0.55	6.6
iShRuss2000	IWM	224.80	0.51	1.7
iShS&P500Grw	IVW	110.97	0.08	9.3
iShS&P500Value	IVE	198.89	0.54	4.2
iSh7-10YTreaBd	IEF	94.76	-0.05	2.5
iShShortTreaBd	SHV	110.17	0.01	0.1
iSh20+YTreaBd	TLT	86.99	0.07	-0.4
iShUSTech	IYW	175.72	-0.33	10.2
iShUSTreasuryBd	GOVT	22.79	-0.07	-0.8
iSh0-3MTreaBd	SGOV	100.47	0.02	0.1
JPMNasdEqPrem	JEPQ	54.36	0.11	-3.6
JanusHendersonAAA	JAAA	50.61	-0.02	-0.2
JPM EqPrem	JEPI	56.96	0.19	-1.0
JPM UltShIncm	JPST	50.52	...	0.3
ProShUltPrQQQ	TQQQ	84.36	-0.46	6.6
SPDRBbg1-3MTB	BIL	91.54	0.02	0.1
SPDR DJIA Tr	DIA	446.50	0.45	4.9
SPDR Gold	GLD	306.20	0.22	26.5
SPDRPtfDevxUS	SPDW	40.73	0.07	19.3
SPDRS&P500Value	SPYV	53.30	0.53	4.2
SPDRPtfS&P500	SPLG	73.63	0.30	6.8
SPDRS&P500Growth	SPYG	96.09	0.09	9.3
SPDR S&P 500	SPY	625.82	0.28	6.8
SchwabIntEquity	SCHF	22.24	0.09	20.2
SchwabUS BrdMkt	SCHB	24.16	0.25	6.4
SchwabUS Div	SCHD	27.51	0.81	0.7
SchwabUS LC	SCHX	24.78	0.20	6.9
SchwabUS LC Grw	SCHG	29.43	-0.03	5.6
SPDR S&PMdCpTr	MDY	584.40	0.47	2.6
TechSelectSector	XLK	256.98	-0.33	10.5
VanEckSemicon	SMH	287.52	0.74	18.7
VangdSC Val	VBR	202.97	0.89	2.4
VangdExtMkt	VXF	198.15	0.21	4.3
VangdDivApp	VIG	207.25	0.23	5.8
VangdFTSEAWxUS	VEU	67.57	0.15	17.7
VangdFTSEDevMk	VEA	57.35	0.07	19.9
VangdFTSE EM	VWO	49.66	0.10	12.8
VangdFTSE Europe	VGK	78.68	-0.01	24.0
VangdGrowth	VUG	442.38	-0.03	7.8
VangdHiDiv	VYM	135.71	0.56	6.4
VangdInfoTech	VGT	674.58	-0.34	8.5
VangdIntermBd	BIV	76.70	-0.03	2.6
VangdIntrCorpBd	VCIT	82.31	...	2.5
VangdIntermTrea	VGIT	59.29	-0.05	2.2
VangdLC	VV	288.60	0.24	7.0
VangdMegaGrwth	MGK	369.80	0.02	7.7
VangdMC	VO	284.11	0.28	7.6
VangdRealEst	VNQ	89.75	0.63	0.8
VangdRuss1000Grw	VONG	110.35	...	6.8
VangdS&P500ETF	VOO	575.29	0.29	6.8
VangdST Bond	BSV	78.27	...	1.3
VangdSTCpBd	VCSH	79.12	...	1.4
VangdShortTrea	VGSH	58.49	...	0.5
VangdSC	VB	244.80	0.50	1.9
VangdTaxExemptBd	VTEB	48.94	-0.02	-2.4
VangdTotalBd	BND	73.10	0.01	1.7
VangdTotIntlBd	BNDX	49.23	-0.10	0.4
VangdTotIntlStk	VXUS	69.48	0.14	17.9
VangdTotalStk	VTI	308.32	0.27	6.4
VangdTotWrldStk	VT	129.89	0.19	10.6
VangdValue	VTV	179.40	0.65	6.0

Borrowing Benchmarks | wsj.com/market-data/bonds/benchmarks

Money Rates

July 10, 2025

Key annual interest rates paid to borrow or lend money in U.S. and international markets. Rates below are a guide to general levels but don't always represent actual transactions.

Inflation

	May index level	Chg From (%) April '25	May '24
U.S. consumer price index			
All items	321.465	0.21	2.4
Core	327.509	0.21	2.8

International rates

	Latest	Week ago	52-Week High	Low
Prime rates				
U.S.	7.50	7.50	8.50	7.50
Canada	4.95	4.95	6.95	4.95
Japan	1.875	1.875	1.875	1.475
Policy Rates				
Euro zone	2.15	2.15	4.25	2.15
Switzerland	0.50	0.50	1.75	0.50
Britain	4.25	4.25	5.25	4.25
Australia	3.85	3.85	4.35	3.85
Overnight repurchase				
U.S.	4.37	4.37	5.45	4.00

U.S. government rates

	Latest	Week ago	52-Week High	Low
Discount	4.50	4.50	5.50	4.50
Federal funds				
Effective rate	4.3300	4.3300	5.3400	4.3200
High	4.5500	4.5500	5.6500	4.3700
Low	4.3200	4.3200	5.3300	4.3000
Bid	4.3200	4.3200	5.3300	4.3200
Offer	4.3300	4.3300	5.3600	4.3300
Treasury bill auction				
4 weeks	4.235	4.240	5.285	4.000
13 weeks	4.255	4.235	5.230	4.175
26 weeks	4.145	4.110	5.080	4.000

Other short-term rates

	Latest	Week ago	52-Week high	low
Call money	6.25	6.25	7.25	6.25
Commercial paper (AA financial)				
90 days	4.28	4.29	5.35	4.19
Secured Overnight Financing Rate	4.32	4.40	5.38	4.26

DTCC GCF Repo Index	Latest	Value Traded	52-Week High	Low
Treasury	4.370	49.740	5.471	4.286
MBS	4.383	87.936	5.487	4.294

Weekly survey

	Latest	Week ago	Year ago
Freddie Mac			
30-year fixed	6.72	6.67	6.89
15-year fixed	5.86	5.80	6.17

Notes on data:

U.S. prime rate is the base rate on corporate loans posted by at least 70% of the 10 largest U.S. banks, and is effective December 19, 2024. **Other prime rates** aren't directly comparable; lending practices vary widely by location; **Discount rate** is effective December 19, 2024. **Secured Overnight Financing Rate** is as of July 9, 2025. **DTCC GCF Repo Index** is Depository Trust & Clearing Corp.'s weighted average for overnight trades in applicable CUSIPs. Value traded is in billions of U.S. dollars. **Federal-funds rates** are Tullett Prebon rates as of 5:30 p.m. ET.

Sources: Federal Reserve; Bureau of Labor Statistics; DTCC; FactSet; Tullett Prebon Information, Ltd.

Bonds | wsj.com/market-data/bonds/benchmarks

Tracking Bond Benchmarks

Return on investment and spreads over Treasurys and/or yields paid to investors compared with 52-week highs and lows for different types of bonds

Total return close	YTD total return (%)	Index	Yield (%) Latest	Low	High
Broad Market Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
2167.89	3.6	U.S. Aggregate	4.620	4.100	5.110
U.S. Corporate Indexes Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
3315.36	3.8	U.S. Corporate	5.080	4.640	5.550
3259.13	4.2	Intermediate	4.750	4.400	5.320
4263.89	3.1	Long term	5.770	5.070	6.150
625.76	3.3	Double-A-rated	4.800	4.260	5.200
905.82	3.9	Triple-B-rated	5.260	4.850	5.810
High Yield Bonds ICE BofA					
595.23	4.6	High Yield Constrained	7.109	6.975	8.654
612.50	3.8	Triple-C-rated	12.557	11.050	14.946
3998.58	5.5	High Yield 100	6.242	6.082	7.793
518.81	4.4	Global High Yield Constrained	6.826	6.787	8.254
388.38	3.3	Europe High Yield Constrained	5.221	5.219	6.567
U.S Agency Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
1901.78	3.2	U.S Agency	4.350	3.960	4.790
1688.89	3.2	10-20 years	4.280	3.920	4.780
3525.07	3.1	20-plus years	5.060	4.240	5.320
2922.67	4.3	Yankee	4.780	4.380	5.340

Total return close	YTD total return (%)	Index	Yield (%) Latest	Low	High
Mortgage-Backed Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
2146.95	3.9	Mortgage-Backed	5.010	4.340	5.520
2114.19	3.8	Ginnie Mae (GNMA)	5.020	4.460	5.580
1266.63	3.9	Fannie mae (FNMA)	5.010	4.310	5.500
1956.81	4.1	Freddie Mac (FHLMC)	4.840	4.150	5.450
592.57	-0.3	Muni Master	3.635	3.074	4.179
423.95	1.3	7-12 year	3.359	2.858	4.016
470.39	-2.2	12-22 year	4.405	3.469	4.704
442.17	-3.6	22-plus year	4.953	3.959	5.143
Global Government J.P. Morgan†					
551.23	1.2	Global Government	3.640	3.010	3.740
831.22	0.3	Canada	3.360	2.820	3.470
362.94	0.1	EMU§	3.215	2.726	3.403
656.32	0.1	France	3.410	2.900	3.530
465.64	-1.0	Germany	2.720	2.080	2.860
260.66	-3.5	Japan	2.000	1.220	2.040
507.03	-1.3	Netherlands	2.930	2.290	3.060
795.10	1.6	U.K.	4.870	4.030	5.070
949.40	5.8	Emerging Markets **	7.271	7.084	8.038

*Constrained indexes limit individual issuer concentrations to 2%; the High Yield 100 are the 100 largest bonds † In local currency § Euro-zone bonds

** EMBI Global Index

Sources: ICE Data Services; Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices; J.P.Morgan

Global Government Bonds: Mapping Yields

Yields and spreads over or under U.S. Treasurys on benchmark two-year and 10-year government bonds in selected other countries; arrows indicate whether the yield rose(▲) or fell (▼) in the latest session

Coupon (%)	Country/ Maturity, in years	Yield (%) Latest(●)	Previous	Month ago	Year ago	Spread Under/Over U.S. Treasurys, in basis points Latest	Prev	Year ago
3.750	**U.S.** 2	3.867 ▲	3.861	4.010	4.630			
4.250	10	4.347 ▲	4.341	4.472	4.280			
4.750	**Australia** 2	3.375 ▼	3.416	3.321	4.183	-50.1	-43.3	-45.4
2.750	10	4.297 ▼	4.352	4.261	4.355	-5.4	1.2	6.5
0.750	**France** 2	2.192 ▲	2.146	1.956	3.072	-168.4	-170.3	-156.5
3.200	10	3.401 ▲	3.362	3.214	3.192	-95.0	-97.8	-109.8
1.700	**Germany** 2	1.891 ▲	1.858	1.851	2.904	-198.5	-199.1	-173.3
2.600	10	2.705 ▲	2.676	2.527	2.536	-164.6	-166.4	-175.4
2.550	**Italy** 2	2.131 ▲	2.095	2.074	3.446	-174.5	-175.4	-119.1
3.650	10	3.563 ▲	3.522	3.441	3.867	-78.8	-81.8	-42.3
0.700	**Japan** 2	0.764 ▲	0.760	0.772	0.339	-311.2	-308.9	-429.8
1.500	10	1.497 ▼	1.507	1.480	1.089	-285.4	-283.3	-320.1
2.500	**Spain** 2	2.034 ▲	2.011	2.003	3.090	-184.2	-183.8	-154.7
3.150	10	3.246 ▲	3.225	3.114	3.299	-110.5	-111.5	-99.1
4.125	**U.K.** 2	3.884 ▲	3.866	3.913	4.130	0.8	1.7	-50.7
4.250	10	4.600 ▼	4.606	4.544	4.134	24.9	26.6	-15.7

Source: Tullett Prebon, Tradeweb FTSE U.S. Treasury Close

Corporate Debt

Prices of firms' bonds reflect factors including investors' economic, sectoral and company-specific expectations

Investment-grade spreads that tightened the most...

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Spread*, in basis points Current	One-day change	Last week
Wells Fargo	WFC	4.300	4.10	July 22, '27	22	-34	56
Toyota Motor Credit	...	3.375	4.42	April 1, '30	47	-12	n.a.
NTT Finance	...	4.567	4.45	July 16, '27	58	-10	n.a.
Corebridge Global Funding	...	4.850	4.73	June 6, '30	80	-8	82
Pacific Life Global Funding II	...	2.450	4.98	Jan. 11, '32	62	-7	72
Goldman Sachs	GS	6.450	5.62	May 1, '36	128	-4	126
Coca-Cola	KO	2.500	5.19	June 1, '40	85	-4	81
Northwestern Mutual Global Funding	...	5.160	4.76	May 28, '31	82	-4	82

...And spreads that widened the most

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Current	One-day change	Last week
Banque Federative du Credit Mutuel	...	5.538	4.69	Jan. 22, '30	76	8	81
Banco Santander	...	2.749	5.13	Dec. 3, '30	120	7	128
John Deere Capital	...	1.500	4.15	March 6, '28	32	6	32
Caterpillar Financial Services	...	4.375	4.28	Aug. 16, '29	34	5	n.a.
Citigroup	C	4.450	4.54	Sept. 29, '27	66	4	68
Consolidated Edison Co. of New York	...	5.500	5.52	Dec. 1, '39	115	3	118
HSBC Holdings	HSBC	6.500	5.63	May 2, '36	126	3	n.a.

High-yield issues with the biggest price increases...

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Bond Price as % of face value Current	One-day change	Last week
DISH DBS	...	5.125	15.18	June 1, '29	71.250	1.57	66.790
QVC	...	5.950	14.79	March 15, '43	45.000	0.97	n.a.
Rakuten	...	11.250	5.28	Feb. 15, '27	109.000	0.66	108.959
Teva Pharmaceutical Finance Netherlands III	...	4.100	6.65	Oct. 1, '46	71.250	0.50	72.313
Rockies Express Pipeline	...	6.875	6.85	April 15, '40	100.248	0.50	100.419
Yum! Brands	YUM	6.875	5.95	Nov. 15, '37	107.997	0.43	107.636
Methanex US Operations	...	6.250	6.41	March 15, '32	99.154	0.36	99.500
Paramount Global	PARA	4.375	6.84	March 15, '43	74.912	0.34	74.916

...And with the biggest price decreases

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Current	One-day change	Last week
Bath & Body Works	BBWI	6.750	6.51	July 1, '36	101.901	-0.10	102.243
Transocean	RIG	7.500	11.23	April 15, '31	84.457	-0.04	83.010
Telecom Italia Capital	...	6.000	5.97	Sept. 30, '34	100.223	-0.03	100.530
Mauser Packaging Solutions Holding	...	7.875	6.94	April 15, '27	101.527	-0.02	101.847

*Estimated spread over 2-year, 3-year, 5-year, 10-year or 30-year hot-run Treasury; 100 basis points=one percentage pt.; change in spread shown is for Z-spread.

Note: Data are for the most active issue of bonds with maturities of two years or more

Source: MarketAxess

BIGGEST 1,000 STOCKS

How to Read the Stock Tables

The following explanations apply to NYSE, NYSE Arca, NYSE American and Nasdaq Stock Market listed securities. Prices are consolidated from trades reported by various market centers, including securities exchanges, Finra, electronic communications networks and other broker-dealers. The list comprises the 1,000 largest companies based on market capitalization.

Underlined quotations are those stocks with large changes in volume compared with the issue's average trading volume.

Boldfaced quotations highlight those issues whose price changed by 5% or more if their previous closing price was $2 or higher.

Footnotes:
i-New 52-week high; ↓-New 52-week low; dd-Indicates loss in the most recent four quarters.

Stock tables reflect composite regular trading as of 4 p.m. ET and changes in the official closing prices from 4 p.m. ET the previous day.

Thursday, July 10, 2025

A B C

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
AECOM	ACM	115.64	0.02
AES	AES	12.41	-0.85
Aflac	AFL	102.28	0.37
↓AGCO	AGCO	113.77	3.82
AGNC Invt	AGNC	9.45	-0.05
ASE Tech	ASX	10.36	...
ASML	ASML	802.09	2.26
AST Space	ASTS	43.97	1.47
AT&T	T	27.62	-0.20
ATI	ATI	88.05	0.25
AbbottLabs	ABT	133.60	0.38
AbbVie	ABBV	195.00	4.38
Accenture	ACN	288.36	-7.56
Acuity	AYI	302.69	-0.26
Adobe	ADBE	371.43	-1.95
AdvDrainageSys	WMS	122.19	2.70
AdvMicroDevices	AMD	144.16	5.75
Aegon	AEG	7.10	0.04
AerCap	AER	114.75	0.70
AeroVironment	AVAV	237.57	0.80
AffirmA	AFRM	68.55	-0.52
AgilentTechs	A	124.17	2.87
AgnicoEagleMines	AEM	118.15	0.46
AirProducts	APD	294.10	-0.14
Airbnb	ABNB	137.00	0.15
AkamaiTech	AKAM	79.44	-1.19
AlamosGold	AGI	26.11	-0.34
Albemarle	ALB	74.27	3.48
Albertsons	ACI	22.28	-0.05
Alcon	ALC	88.70	1.72
AlexandriaRlEst	ARE	79.29	2.22
Alibaba	BABA	106.64	2.81
AlignTech	ALGN	204.48	4.00
Allegion	ALLE	151.53	1.47
AlliantEnergy	LNT	62.60	0.88
Allstate	ALL	194.68	0.59
AllyFinancial	ALLY	40.52	0.15
AlnylamPharm	ALNY	322.64	1.77
Alphabet A	GOOGL	177.62	1.00
Alphabet C	GOOG	178.70	1.04
Altria	MO	58.55	0.80
Amazon.com	AMZN	222.26	-0.28
Ambev	ABEV	2.34	-0.06
Amcor	AMCR	9.83	0.03
Amdocs	DOX	89.24	-2.33
AmerSports	AS	38.14	-0.36
Ameren	AEE	96.29	1.09
AmericaMovil	AMX	17.63	-0.03
AEP	AEP	106.04	1.30
AmerExpress	AXP	325.24	7.89
AmericanFin	AFG	127.76	1.54
AmHomes4Rent	AMH	35.73	0.22
AIG	AIG	82.46	-0.61
AmerTowerREIT	AMT	221.01	-0.82
AmerWaterWorks	AWK	142.68	0.88
Ameriprise	AMP	542.51	3.04
Ametek	AME	181.44	-0.84
Amgen	AMGN	300.37	3.85
Amphenol	APH	98.31	0.10
Amrize	AMRZ	50.98	-0.31
AnalogDevices	ADI	245.13	2.41
AngloGoldAsh	AU	46.53	...
AB InBev	BUD	67.63	0.12
AnnalyCap	NLY	19.81	0.05
↓Ansys	ANSS	374.52	7.65
AnteroMidstream	AM	17.44	-0.12
AnteroResources	AR	35.85	0.29
Aon	AON	359.00	2.08
APi Group	APG	34.60	0.11
ApolloGblMgmt	APO	148.21	1.56
AppFolio	APPF	245.36	-1.03
Apple	AAPL	212.41	1.27
AppliedIndlTechs	AIT	255.95	4.55
AppliedMaterials	AMAT	198.03	2.64
AppLovin	APP	346.32	-6.42
Aptargroup	ATR	158.33	-1.40
Aptiv	APTV	70.58	-0.34
↓Aramark	ARMK	43.63	0.65
ArcelorMittal	MT	34.41	0.88
ArchCapital	ACGL	88.56	0.64
ADM	ADM	54.89	0.89
AresMgmt	ARES	180.13	3.16
argenx	ARGX	563.31	8.12
AristaNetworks	ANET	106.29	0.01
Arm	ARM	148.55	0.53
AscendisPharma	ASND	176.49	0.78
Assurant	AIZ	189.93	-0.57
AsteraLabs	ALAB	97.02	-2.84
AstraZeneca	AZN	71.81	0.99
Atlassian	**TEAM**	**200.05**	**-20.84**
AtmosEnergy	ATO	154.37	1.27
AuroraInnov	AUR	5.28	0.07
Autodesk	**ADSK**	**286.11**	**-21.16**
↓Autoliv	ALV	118.00	0.83
ADP	ADP	305.82	-2.59
AutoZone	AZO	3728.48	-13.70
Avalonbay	AVB	202.70	2.07
Avantor	AVTR	13.70	0.13
AveryDennison	AVY	184.63	1.11
AxonEnterprise	**AXON**	**732.99**	**-72.87**
BCE	BCE	24.06	0.23
BHP Group	BHP	51.51	1.90
BJ'sWholesale	BJ	106.70	-0.83
BP	BP	31.52	0.25
BWX Tech	BWXT	136.45	-1.11
BXP	BXP	70.28	1.25
Baidu	BIDU	88.44	-0.22
BakerHughes	BKR	39.71	0.38
Ball	BALL	58.40	0.46
BBVA	BBVA	15.56	-0.38
BancoBradesco	BBDO	2.56	-0.08
BancodeChile	BCH	29.35	0.06
BancSanBrasil	BSBR	5.10	-0.17
BcoSantChile	BSAC	24.49	-0.04
BancoSantander	SAN	8.58	-0.30
BanColombia	CIB	46.32	0.61
BankofAmerica	BAC	46.97	0.13
↓BankMontreal	BMO	114.53	1.50
↓BankNY Mellon	BK	93.66	0.61
BankNovaScotia	BNS	55.11	0.32
↓Barclays	BCS	18.81	0.18
BarrickMining	B	21.07	0.17
BaxterIntl	BAX	29.70	-0.11
BectonDickinson	BDX	177.50	2.00
↓BentleySystems	BSY	56.68	1.66
BeOneMed	ONC	253.39	-2.30
Berkley	WRB	69.15	-0.60
BerkHathwy A	BRK.A	717180	-2398.07
BerkHathwy B	BRK.B	478.27	-0.64
BestBuy	BBY	73.72	1.26
Bilibili	BILI	21.84	0.07
Bio-Techne	TECH	54.41	1.82
Biogen	BIIB	135.33	2.31
BioMarinPharm	BMRN	58.82	-0.85
BioNTech	BNTX	113.92	2.14
Birkenstock	BIRK	47.79	-0.69
↓BlackRock	BLK	1104.05	15.30
Blackstone	BX	164.06	5.38
Block	XYZ	68.76	-0.25
BlueOwlCapital	OWL	19.60	0.66
↓BlueprintMed	BPMC	129.33	0.78
Boeing	BA	226.09	-0.41
Booking	BKNG	5718.51	50.47
BoozAllen	BAH	107.68	-0.66
BostonSci	BSX	103.86	0.90
↓BridgeBioPharma	BBIO	46.27	0.29
BristolMyers	BMY	48.52	0.86
↓BritishAmTob	BTI	50.82	1.73
↓Broadcom	AVGO	275.40	-2.50
BroadridgeFinl	BR	238.59	-0.17
BrookfieldAsset	BAM	56.57	0.70
Brookfield	BN	63.96	1.39
BrookfieldInfr	BIP	32.85	-0.08
BrookfieldRenew	BEP	26.79	-0.08
Brown&Brown	BRO	107.81	-0.32
Brown-Forman A	BF.A	29.26	0.69
Brown-Forman B	BF.B	29.09	0.77
BuildersFirst	BLDR	135.12	2.12
BungeGlobal	BG	76.54	0.90
BurlingtonStrs	BURL	252.62	-0.74
CACI Intl	CACI	479.97	-5.43
CAVA	CAVA	91.45	1.91
CBRE Group	CBRE	141.21	1.46
CDW	CDW	179.70	-1.05
CF Industries	CF	95.76	-2.99
CGI A	GIB	102.37	-0.42
CH Robinson	CHRW	100.84	1.72
CME Group	CME	275.19	-0.99
CMS Energy	CMS	70.54	0.78
↓CNA Fin	CNA	43.94	-0.60
↓CNH Indl	CNH	13.80	0.11
CRH	CRH	95.89	-0.58
CSX	CSX	33.61	0.17
CVS Health	CVS	65.62	-1.04
CadenceDesign	CDNS	322.66	-0.25
CAE	CAE	29.24	-0.30
CamdenProperty	CPT	113.41	0.45
Cameco	CCJ	70.82	-0.73
↓Campbell's	CPB	30.49	-0.25
↓CIBC	CM	73.44	0.70
CanNtlRlwy	CNI	106.03	1.28
CanadianNatRscs	CNQ	31.79	-0.19
CdnPacKC	CP	80.71	0.82
CapitalOne	COF	220.74	2.71
CardinalHealth	CAH	162.17	-2.09
Carlisle	CSL	415.95	3.41
Carlyle	CG	58.50	1.63
CarMax	KMX	66.94	-0.33
Carnival	CCL	29.10	0.27
Carnival	CUK	26.63	0.27
CarpenterTech	CRS	276.72	-0.03
CarrierGlobal	CARR	76.77	0.88
Carvana	CVNA	345.55	-5.54
CaseysGenStores	CASY	523.60	1.28
Caterpillar	CAT	408.33	6.15
Celestica	CLS	158.83	-2.07
CelsiusHldg	CELH	45.18	-0.92
↓Cemex	CX	7.41	0.05
Cencora	COR	297.32	-2.84
CenovusEnergy	CVE	14.37	-0.11
Centene	CNC	32.52	-0.57
CenterPointEner	CNP	36.22	0.30
CentraisElBras	EBR	7.16	-0.10
CharterComms	CHTR	401.58	-1.98
CheckPoint	CHKP	221.26	-9.77
CheniereEnergy	LNG	234.23	-1.75
ChenierEnerPtrs	CQP	54.75	-0.15
Chevron	CVX	154.17	1.15
Chewy	CHWY	38.77	-0.18
ChimeFinl	CHYM	30.81	-0.22
Chipotle	CMG	56.45	1.40
Chubb	CB	280.54	0.54
ChunghwaTel	CHT	44.27	0.16
Church&Dwight	CHD	99.09	0.70
Ciena	CIEN	78.45	-0.88
Cigna	CI	308.78	-1.00
CincinnatiFinl	CINF	147.85	1.14
Cintas	CTAS	216.56	-0.08
CircleInternet	CRCL	202.90	2.22
CiscoSystems	CSCO	68.76	-0.51
Citigroup	C	87.08	1.29
CitizensFin	CFG	47.90	0.52
CleanHarbors	CLH	231.25	0.76
Clorox	CLX	127.84	1.84
Cloudflare	**NET**	**181.92**	**-11.57**
Coca-Cola	KO	69.77	0.29
Coca-ColaCon	COKE	114.18	0.86
CocaColaEuropac	CCEP	95.45	-0.41
CognizantTech	CTSH	76.73	-3.22
Coherent	COHR	93.72	2.47
↓CoinbaseGlbl	COIN	388.96	15.11
ColgatePalm	CL	90.62	-0.96
Comcast A	CMCSA	35.42	-0.20
Comerica	CMA	64.01	1.21
ComfortSystems	FIX	533.77	-1.25
CommerceBcshrs	CBSH	66.09	0.81
SABESP	SBS	20.12	-0.49
↓ConagraBrands	CAG	19.49	-0.89
Confluent	CFLT	24.50	-1.06
ConocoPhillips	COP	95.27	0.84
ConEd	ED	101.07	1.10
ConstBrands A	STZ	172.12	3.08
ConstellationEner	CEG	313.62	-3.49
Coupang	CPNG	30.45	0.28
Copart	CPRT	47.99	0.35
Core&Main	CNM	62.27	0.02
CorebridgeFin	CRBG	34.56	0.33
CoreWeave	**CRWV**	**139.29**	**-14.76**
Corning	GLW	52.26	-0.31
Corpay	CPAY	335.68	4.49
Corteva	CTVA	74.83	-1.37
↓CoStar	CSGP	86.05	1.55
Costco	COST	970.17	-11.92
CoterraEnergy	CTRA	25.10	-0.04
Coupang	CPNG	30.45	0.28
Crane	CR	186.84	-4.26
Credicorp	BAP	223.51	-1.11
CredoTech	CRDO	97.29	-0.30
CrowdStrike	**CRWD**	**487.11**	**-26.40**
CrownCastle	CCI	103.97	0.56
Crown Holdings	CCK	107.45	-0.51
CubeSmart	CUBE	42.30	-0.16
Cullen/Frost	CFR	137.54	0.68
Cummins	CMI	340.03	5.43
Curtiss-Wright	CW	474.49	-9.07
CyberArkSoftware	**CYBR**	**376.39**	**-28.92**

D E F

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
DTE Energy	DTE	133.66	2.24
DT Midstream	DTM	102.66	0.55
Danaher	DHR	205.51	4.55
Darden	DRI	212.88	-1.45
Datadog	DDOG	137.49	-5.26
DaVita	DVA	143.46	1.62
Dayforce	DAY	58.27	-0.79
DeckersOutdoor	DECK	104.95	0.04
Deere	DE	519.20	9.87
DellTechC	DELL	127.91	1.28
DeltaAir	**DAL**	**56.78**	**6.08**
DescartesSystems	DSGX	104.41	1.54
DeutscheBank	DB	29.99	-0.39
DevonEnergy	DVN	33.95	-0.64
DexCom	DXCM	85.46	0.59
Diageo	DEO	105.49	0.75
DiamondbkEner	FANG	143.03	-0.91
Dick's	DKS	214.63	4.32
DigitalRealty	DLR	170.48	-0.70
Disney	DIS	121.56	0.95
DocuSign	DOCU	76.36	-3.22
DollarGeneral	DG	112.26	-0.09
↓DollarTree	DLTR	108.37	3.62
DominionEner	D	58.16	1.01
Domino's	DPZ	469.92	6.44
Donaldson	DCI	71.62	0.72
DoorDash	DASH	238.24	-7.82
Dover	DOV	190.52	2.30
Dow	DOW	30.23	0.39
Doximity	**DOCS**	**60.08**	**-3.18**
DrReddy'sLab	RDY	14.67	-0.09
DraftKings	DKNG	45.57	-0.26
DukeEnergy	DUK	118.17	0.66
Duolingo	DUOL	380.44	-10.31
DuPont	DD	76.13	0.59
DutchBros	BROS	63.71	-2.61
Dynatrace	**DT**	**52.79**	**-3.40**
EMCOR	EME	547.59	1.31
ENI	E	33.45	-0.05
EOG Rscs	EOG	121.73	-0.16
EPAM Systems	EPAM	177.75	-4.27
EQT	EQT	54.52	-0.36
EastWestBncp	EWBC	108.14	0.97
EastGroup	EGP	166.74	-0.10
EastmanChem	EMN	81.56	1.20
Eaton	ETN	358.53	-2.10
eBay	EBAY	77.22	0.90
EchoStar	SATS	32.13	-0.09
Ecolab	ECL	266.79	-1.42
Ecopetrol	EC	9.00	0.05
EdisonIntl	EIX	53.44	0.66
EdwardsLife	EW	78.80	1.61
Elastic	ESTC	84.70	-1.86
ElbitSystems	ESLT	448.28	-7.42
ElectronicArts	EA	151.30	-1.38
↓ElevanceHealth	ELV	345.86	-0.50
Embraer	ERJ	54.54	-2.66
Emera	EMA	45.77	0.18
↓EmersonElec	EMR	140.67	0.87
Enbridge	ENB	44.49	0.70
EncompassHealth	EHC	117.49	-0.26
EnergyTransfer	ET	17.44	-0.20
EnsignGroup	ENSG	145.73	-0.98
Entegris	ENTG	88.00	1.01
Entergy	ETR	82.12	0.66
EnterpriseProd	EPD	32.05	0.15
Equifax	EFX	265.00	-0.73
Equinix	EQIX	758.89	-5.82
Equinor	EQNR	26.68	0.32
Equitable	EQH	53.76	0.58
EquityLife	ELS	61.82	-0.22
EquityResdntl	EQR	67.08	0.55
ErieIndemnity	ERIE	351.40	6.92
EssentialUtil	WTRG	37.54	0.19
EssexProp	ESS	286.76	1.98
EsteeLauder	**EL**	**92.10**	**5.49**
EvercoreA	EVR	298.97	5.58
Everest	EG	340.45	0.26
Evergy	EVRG	69.42	0.61
EversourceEner	ES	66.11	1.00
ExactSciences	EXAS	53.32	-1.99
Exelixis	EXEL	45.17	1.10
Exelon	EXC	43.63	0.49
ExpandEnergy	EXE	105.20	...
Expedia	EXPE	182.97	6.88
ExpeditorsIntl	EXPD	119.25	1.98
ExtraSpaceSt	EXR	148.82	0.11
ExxonMobil	XOM	114.93	1.13
F5	FFIV	299.89	-2.39
FTAI Aviation	FTAI	112.68	2.27
FabrinetFN	FN	289.25	4.04
FactSet	FDS	449.98	2.17
Fairlsaac	FICO	1584.38	-7.35
↓Fastenal	FAST	43.56	0.16
FederalRealty	FRT	94.61	-0.03
FedEx	FDX	235.73	2.27
↓FergusonEnts	FERG	224.40	0.40
Ferrari	RACE	497.94	6.93
Ferrovial	FER	52.32	-0.29
FidNatlFinl	**FNF**	**51.22**	**-3.90**
FidNatlInfo	FIS	80.22	0.20
FifthThirdBncp	FITB	44.05	0.62
FirstCitizBcshA	FCNCA	2131.69	34.46
FirstHorizon	FHN	22.10	0.16
FirstSolar	FSLR	165.09	-0.90
FirstEnergy	FE	40.53	0.38
Fiserv	FI	169.70	-1.25
↓Flex	FLEX	51.93	0.25
Floor&Decor	FND	85.27	1.78
Fluor	FLR	52.04	-0.40
FlutterEnt	FLUT	289.58	3.25
FEMSA	FMX	101.50	-0.96
FordMotor	F	11.91	0.08
Fortinet	**FTNT**	**100.28**	**-7.45**
Fortis	FTS	47.17	0.30
Fortive	FTV	53.06	0.07
FoxA	FOXA	56.73	1.52
FoxB	FOX	51.90	1.29
Franco-Nevada	FNV	155.95	-0.13
↓FranklinRscs	BEN	25.14	0.41
FreedomHolding	FRHC	145.41	1.89
FreeportMcM	FCX	47.21	1.62
FresenisMedCare	FMS	27.45	-0.10
FrontierComms	FYBR	36.67	0.10
FullTruck	YMM	12.52	0.16

G H I

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
GE Aerospace	GE	252.57	2.24
GE HealthCare	GEHC	76.50	0.99
GE Vernova	GEV	539.36	3.59
GFLEnvironmental	GFL	47.55	-0.37
GSK	GSK	39.58	0.54
Gallagher	AJG	313.58	-1.67
GameStop	GME	23.10	-0.09
Gaming&Leisure	GLPI	48.22	0.77
Gap	GAP	23.09	0.45
Garmin	GRMN	217.80	0.69
Gartner	IT	387.78	-6.66
GenDigital	GEN	29.68	-0.48
Generac	GNRC	143.80	-2.13
GeneralDynamics	GD	303.38	3.42
GeneralMills	GIS	51.36	0.77
GeneralMotors	GM	53.15	0.58
Genmab	GMAB	21.06	0.28
GenuineParts	GPC	126.02	0.77
GileadSciences	GILD	114.54	1.30
GlobalPayments	GPN	81.22	0.57
GlobalFoundries	GFS	41.23	0.24
GlobeLife	GL	119.13	1.53
GoDaddy	GDDY	177.07	-1.36
GoldFields	GFI	23.94	-0.08
GoldmanSachs	GS	709.12	12.56
Grab	GRAB	4.92	-0.07
Graco	GGG	88.81	0.46
Grainger	GWW	1047.87	2.58
GAP	PAC	232.75	5.86
ASUR	ASR	313.71	10.17
GrupoCibest	CIB	44.70	-0.26
GpoFinGalicia	GGAL	48.71	-1.17
Guidewire	GWRE	225.13	-6.12
HCA Healthcare	HCA	378.32	-0.12
HDFC Bank	HDB	76.68	-0.19
HF Sinclair	DINO	46.02	1.28
HP	HPQ	25.73	0.11
↓HSBC	HSBC	62.78	0.71
H World	HTHT	34.06	0.49
Haleon	HLN	10.11	0.06
Halliburton	HAL	22.16	0.12
HarmonyGold	HMY	14.38	0.05
HartfordIns	HIG	121.95	0.08
Hasbro	HAS	77.10	0.42
HealthEquity	HQY	97.19	-2.79
HealthpeakProp	DOC	18.54	0.28
Heico	HEI	311.59	-5.26
HeicoA	HEI.A	240.27	-3.94
HenrySchein	HSIC	74.53	0.37
Hershey	HSY	164.64	2.69
Hess	HES	146.21	0.16
HewlettPackard	HPE	21.29	0.49
↓Hilton	HLT	277.48	4.95
Hims&HersHealth	HIMS	50.27	-0.97
Hologic	HOLX	66.85	1.00
HomeDepot	HD	373.30	2.26
HondaMotor	HMC	30.75	0.15
Honeywell	HON	236.77	1.90
HormelFoods	HRL	31.54	0.27
DR Horton	DHI	139.62	1.21
HostHotels	HST	16.58	0.43
↓HoulihanLokey	HLI	190.75	1.57
HowmetAerospace	HWM	178.53	-2.89
Hubbell	HUBB	422.26	4.55
HubSpot	HUBS	553.77	-6.78
Humana	HUM	232.18	-4.52
JBHunt	JBHT	154.66	1.99
HuntingtonBcshs	HBAN	17.56	0.14
HuntingIngalls	HII	258.11	9.19
HyattHotels	H	152.25	5.12
ICICI Bank	IBN	33.42	-0.33
ICL Group	ICL	7.08	-0.15
IDEX	IEX	185.42	1.04
IdexxLab	IDXX	541.09	0.45
ING Groep	ING	22.99	-0.21
IQVIA	IQV	165.53	3.51
ITT	ITT	157.56	-0.06
IcahnEnterprises	IEP	8.94	0.08
Icon	ICLR	152.07	1.54
IllinoisToolWks	ITW	262.12	2.37
Illumina	ILMN	100.05	2.61
ImperialOil	IMO	80.86	0.83
Incyte	INCY	70.34	1.62
Informatica	INFA	24.30	-0.05
Infosys	INFY	18.10	-0.72
IngersollRand	IR	88.69	0.99
Ingredion	INGR	136.35	-0.29
Insmed	INSM	96.66	0.19
Insulet	PODD	297.40	-0.06
Intel	INTC	23.02	0.38
InteractiveBrkrs	IBKR	58.92	1.08
ICE	ICE	181.82	-0.34
InterContHtls	IHG	121.89	0.88
IBM	IBM	287.43	-2.71
IntlFlavors	IFF	76.62	0.07
IntlPaper	IP	52.41	1.05
Interpublic	IPG	25.00	0.31
Intuit	INTU	747.90	-20.65
IntuitiveSurgical	ISRG	526.05	-2.08
InvitatHomes	INVH	32.38	0.11
IonQ	IONQ	45.93	0.37
IronMountain	IRM	98.96	-0.29
ItauUnibanco	ITUB	6.37	-0.28

J K L

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
JBS	JBS	13.33	0.12
JD.com	JD	31.22	-0.38
JPMorganChase	JPM	288.19	3.53
Jabil	JBL	220.96	-0.30
JackHenry	JKHY	179.56	-0.20
JacobsSolns	J	136.21	2.01
JamesHardie	JHX	28.27	0.49
JefferiesFinl	JEF	55.69	0.99
JobyAviation	**JOBY**	**12.33**	**0.77**
J&J	JNJ	157.69	1.41
↓JohnsonControls	JCI	106.33	-0.37
JonesLang	JLL	259.49	4.39
KB Financial	KB	85.42	0.76
KE Holdings	**BEKE**	**19.45**	**1.19**
KKR	KKR	143.05	3.83
↓KLA	KLAC	928.62	5.44
KT	KT	20.96	0.29
Kanzhun	BZ	18.95	0.11
Kaspi.kz	KSPI	83.37	0.53
Kellanova	K	79.67	0.45
Kenvue	KVUE	20.92	0.16
KeurigDrPepper	KDP	33.65	...
KeyCorp	KEY	18.49	0.03
KeysightTech	KEYS	164.84	0.94
KilroyRealty	KRC	36.47	1.01
KimberlyClark	KMB	131.95	0.46
KimcoRealty	KIM	21.37	0.22
KinderMorgan	KMI	27.79	-0.01
KinrossGold	KGC	15.34	0.02
KinsaleCapital	KNSL	489.15	0.19
Klaviyo	KVYO	32.50	-1.45
Philips	PHG	24.66	0.53
KoreaElecPwr	KEP	13.62	...
KraftHeinz	KHC	26.47	0.02
Kroger	KR	70.71	0.45
Kyndryl	KD	41.58	-1.27
↓LatamAirlines	LTM	42.53	1.68
LKQ	LKQ	39.21	0.36
LPL Financial	LPLA	380.18	-0.72
L3HarrisTech	LHX	260.10	1.05
Labcorp	LH	253.63	-5.44
LamResearch	LRCX	101.06	1.25
LamarAdv	LAMR	125.31	0.83
LasVegasSands	LVS	50.52	0.91
Leidos	LDOS	163.00	0.79
Lennar B	LEN.B	110.79	0.13
Lennar A	LEN	116.44	1.08
LennoxIntl	LII	617.38	15.00
LeonardoDRS	DRS	46.24	-0.77
LiAuto	LI	27.20	0.02
LibertyBroadbandC	LBRDK	96.70	1.15
LibertyBroadbandA	LBRDA	96.74	0.95
LibertyLiveA	LLYVA	77.18	0.69
LibertyFormOne	FWONK	104.00	2.56
LibertyLiveC	LLYVK	78.90	0.69
LibertyFormOne A	FWONA	93.21	2.04
Light&Wonder	LNW	101.00	-0.11
EliLilly	LLY	790.65	3.73
↓LincolnElectric	LECO	223.47	2.99
Linde	LIN	470.34	-0.93
Lineage	LINE	43.07	0.21
LithiaMotors	LAD	356.60	6.51
LiveNationEnt	LYV	144.46	0.90
LloydsBanking	LYG	4.16	-0.01
LockheedMartin	LMT	464.31	-1.25
Loews	L	90.50	-0.47
LogitechIntl	LOGI	94.95	0.49
Lowe's	LOW	227.91	2.34
lululemon	LULU	238.52	2.63
LyondellBasell	LYB	65.32	0.48

M N

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
Macom Tech	MTSI	137.19	-2.66
M&T Bank	MTB	204.05	3.67
MGM Resorts	MGM	38.84	1.15
MPLX	MPLX	50.46	-0.30
MSCI	MSCI	580.66	-1.15
MagnaIntl	MGA	42.51	0.28
MakeMyTrip	MMYT	92.12	-1.24
ManhattanAssoc	MANH	199.78	-3.06
ManulifeFinl	MFC	30.72	0.25
Maplebear	CART	48.43	0.43
MarathonPetrol	MPC	182.26	2.99
Markel	MKL	1994.16	-3.69
MarketAxess	MKTX	218.97	-0.31
Marriott	MAR	282.30	3.11
Marsh&McLen	MMC	214.71	0.54
MartinMarietta	MLM	564.38	-2.64
MarvellTech	MRVL	73.36	1.10
Masco	MAS	67.50	0.61
Masimo	MASI	166.32	0.91
MasTec	MTZ	168.77	-0.55
Mastercard	MA	563.52	-1.59
McCormickVtg	MKC.V	72.70	0.55
McCormick	MKC	72.44	0.23
McDonald's	MCD	298.39	5.37
McKesson	MCK	714.54	-12.69
Medpace	MEDP	328.24	7.29
Medtronic	MDT	89.40	0.40
MercadoLibre	MELI	2402.10	-74.98
Merck	MRK	84.02	0.31
MetaPlatforms	META	727.24	-5.36
MetLife	MET	78.37	0.13
Mettler-Toledo	MTD	1236.24	17.59
MicrochipTech	MCHP	75.08	0.40
MicronTech	MU	123.11	0.87
Microsoft	MSFT	501.48	-2.03
MicroStrategy	MSTR	421.74	6.33
MidAmApt	MAA	151.10	0.87
MitsubishiUFJ	MUFG	13.59	-0.04
MizuhoFin	MFG	5.52	0.02
Mobileye	MBLY	16.67	-0.65
Moderna	MRNA	34.28	1.49
↓MolinaHealthcare	MOH	228.58	-8.64
MolsonCoorsB	TAP	49.81	0.26
monday.com	MNDY	301.19	-8.43
Mondelez	MDLZ	67.15	0.30
MongoDB	MDB	209.27	-7.85
MonolithicPower	MPWR	740.45	-10.69
MonsterBev	MNST	59.17	-0.40
Moody's	MCO	505.72	3.58
MorganStanley	MS	143.09	1.54
Morningstar	MORN	299.00	-0.88
Mosaic	MOS	35.94	-1.38
MotorolaSol	MSI	417.72	-0.16
MrCooper	COOP	148.36	-0.69
MuellerIndustries	MLI	85.62	0.79
MurphyUSA	MUSA	426.96	3.04
NICE	**NICE**	**163.01**	**-8.93**
NRG Energy	NRG	151.36	1.09
NVR	NVR	7689.72	-11.21
NXP Semicon	NXPI	233.19	2.77
↓Nasdaq	NDAQ	90.73	0.90
Natera	NTRA	163.36	1.61
NationalGrid	NGG	70.65	-0.20
NatWest	NWG	13.62	0.07
Nebius	NBIS	46.43	0.38
NetApp	NTAP	106.42	-0.25
NetEase	NTES	127.58	-2.67
Netflix	NFLX	1250.59	-37.69
Neurocrine	NBIX	134.92	1.41
NewOrientalEduc	EDU	52.92	0.39
NYTimes A	NYT	56.38	0.54
Newmont	NEM	59.78	1.03
NewsCorp B	NWS	34.45	0.38
NewsCorp A	NWSA	29.66	0.27
NextEraEnergy	NEE	74.64	0.99
Nextracker	NXT	62.62	-1.30
Nike	NKE	74.62	1.06
NiSource	NI	39.60	0.26
Nokia	NOK	5.06	-0.04
Nomura	NMR	6.41	0.03
Nordson	NDSN	223.17	1.13
NorfolkSouthern	NSC	263.14	3.10
NorthernTrust	NTRS	126.62	-0.38
NorthropGrum	NOC	513.87	5.93
NorwegCruise	**NCLH**	**23.15**	**1.19**
Nova	NVMI	283.41	1.34
Novartis	NVS	123.73	0.79
NovoNordisk	NVO	71.01	1.32
NuHoldings	NU	13.03	-0.61
Nucor	NUE	143.31	3.61
NuScalePower	SMR	36.02	0.56
Nutanix	NTNX	73.61	-2.99
Nutrien	NTR	60.80	-1.31
nVentElectric	NVT	74.67	-0.53
↓NVIDIA	NVDA	164.10	1.22

O P Q

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
OGE Energy	OGE	44.52	0.36
ONEOK	OKE	80.91	-0.25
ON Semi	ON	59.52	1.75
O'ReillyAuto	ORLY	92.38	-0.20
OccidentalPetrol	OXY	45.85	0.28
Okta	OKTA	94.41	-4.74
OldDomFreight	ODFL	171.12	1.31
OldNatlBncp	ONB	23.47	0.26
OldRepublic	ORI	36.63	-0.27
OmegaHealthcare	OHI	36.65	0.27
Omnicom	OMC	73.43	0.93
OnHolding	ONON	53.31	-0.81
Oracle	ORCL	235.00	-0.31
Orix	IX	22.66	-0.03
OtisWorldwide	OTIS	99.96	0.62
Ovintiv	OVV	40.91	0.41
OwensCorning	OC	150.23	2.94
PDD	PDD	104.97	-0.03
PG&E	PCG	13.54	0.02
PNC Finl	PNC	197.95	1.81
POSCO	PKX	57.45	0.61
PPG Ind	PPG	119.07	0.88
PPL	PPL	34.33	0.57
PTC	**PTC**	**194.59**	**-15.88**
Paccar	PCAR	99.22	0.55
PackagingCpAm	PKG	196.24	3.06
PalantirTech	PLTR	142.50	-0.43
PaloAltoNtwks	**PANW**	**192.07**	**-13.99**
PanAmerSilver	PAAS	29.34	0.51
ParamountA	PARAA	23.01	-0.05
ParamountB	PARA	12.77	0.16
ParkerHannifin	PH	714.30	6.71
Paychex	PAYX	145.31	-0.63
PaycomSoftware	PAYC	229.36	-4.72
Paylocity	PCTY	182.91	-1.94
PayPal	PYPL	75.70	0.87
Pearson	PSO	14.44	0.02
Pegasystems	PEGA	51.61	-1.93
PembinaPipeline	PBA	36.83	0.36
↓PenskeAuto	PAG	184.12	2.55
Pentair	PNR	107.68	0.78
Penumbra	PEN	243.87	-0.52
PepsiCo	PEP	136.08	1.60
PerformanceFood	PFGC	90.43	0.27
PermianRscs	PR	14.19	0.04
PetroleoBrasil	PBR	12.83	-0.05
PetroleoBrasilA	PBR.A	11.66	-0.08
Pfizer	PFE	25.78	0.22
PhilipMorris	PM	180.99	3.01
Phillips66	PSX	134.39	3.83
Pilgrim'sPride	PPC	44.89	-0.40
PinnacleFinPtrs	PNFP	119.63	1.04
PinnacleWest	PNW	91.34	1.38
Pinterest	PINS	35.80	-0.09
PlainsAllAmPipe	PAA	18.76	0.09
PlainsGP	PAGP	19.65	0.08
PlanetFitness	PLNT	108.28	2.71
Pool	POOL	311.30	2.84
Primerica	PRI	267.34	-1.97
PrimoBrands	PRMB	30.53	0.48
PrincipalFinl	PFG	81.60	0.74
ProcoreTech	PCOR	72.93	-0.23
Procter&Gamble	PG	158.49	0.97
Progressive	PGR	249.38	-1.03
Prologis	PLD	108.41	2.02
PrudentialFinl	PRU	107.15	0.55
Prudential	PUK	25.03	0.25
PSEG	PEG	82.16	0.59
PublicStorage	PSA	288.84	-0.15
PulteGroup	PHM	115.18	1.41
PureStorage	PSTG	57.56	-0.65
QXO	QXO	21.43	-0.60
Qiagen	QGEN	48.55	0.59
Qorvo	QRVO	90.32	0.44
Qualcomm	QCOM	158.09	-0.26
QuantaServices	PWR	380.09	-2.03
QuestDiag	DGX	171.45	-2.17

R S

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
RBC Bearings	RBC	378.91	-0.91
RB Global	RBA	107.69	1.85
RELX	RELX	54.19	0.57
RPM	RPM	114.30	0.16
RTX	RTX	146.40	0.22
↓RalphLauren	RL	289.87	-0.69
RangeResources	RRC	37.66	-0.03
RaymondJames	RJF	160.20	1.54
RealtyIncome	O	56.93	0.01
Reddit	RDDT	143.00	-2.65
RegalRexnord	RRX	151.68	1.03
RegenclBio	RBA	52.17	0.48
RegencyCtrs	REG	69.26	0.24
RegenPharm	REGN	559.76	7.18
RegionsFinl	RF	24.84	0.21
ReinsGrp	RGA	196.65	1.37
↓Reliance	RS	322.71	5.26
RenaissanceRe	RNR	238.44	-1.81
Rentokillnit	RTO	23.38	0.37
RepublicSvcs	RSG	240.09	-0.42
ResMed	RMD	258.09	-0.26
RestaurantBrands	QSR	67.75	0.50
Revvity	RVTY	102.40	2.27
RexfordIndlRealty	REXR	36.93	0.20
RioTinto	RIO	60.10	1.39
↓Robinhood	HOOD	98.70	4.16
Roblox	RBLX	105.03	-1.65
RocketCos.	RKT	13.79	-0.16
RocketLab	RKLB	39.10	-0.04
RockwellAutom	ROK	344.95	4.69
RogersComm B	RCI	32.87	0.72
Roku	ROKU	90.25	1.62
Rollins	ROL	55.62	-0.19
RoperTech	ROP	549.80	-8.84
RossStores	ROST	130.86	-0.35
↓RoyalBkCanada	RY	133.29	0.66
RoyalCaribbean	RCL	341.36	7.79
RoyalGold	RGLD	159.79	-0.60
RoyaltyPharma	RPRX	36.12	0.25
Rubrik	**RBRK**	**86.14**	**-5.45**
RyanSpecialty	RYAN	64.64	-1.58
Ryanair	RYAAY	58.29	0.43
SAP	SAP	306.21	-5.72
S&P Global	SPGI	529.83	1.10
SBA Comm	SBAC	232.27	-0.10
↓SEI Investments	SEIC	93.80	1.19
SK Telecom	SKM	22.30	0.21
SS&C Tech	SSNC	83.61	0.29
SailPoint	SAIL	20.92	-0.99
Salesforce	CRM	263.97	-6.95
Samsara	IOT	37.69	-1.59
Sanofi	SNY	49.34	0.51
Schlumberger	SLB	36.65	0.40
↓SchwabC	SCHW	93.37	1.60
Sea	SE	149.40	-3.34
Seagate	STX	144.50	2.49
Sempra	SRE	74.90	0.41
ServiceIntl	SCI	80.75	-0.91
ServiceNow	NOW	968.09	-45.62
ServiceTitan	TTAN	110.94	0.95
SharkNinja	SN	111.19	2.44
Shell	SHEL	72.30	0.57
SherwinWilliams	SHW	351.83	0.29
Shift4Paymts	FOUR	103.64	-0.90
ShinhanFin	SHG	50.22	0.84
Shopify	SHOP	115.16	0.84
SimonProperty	SPG	163.45	0.52
SiriusXM	SIRI	24.49	0.22
SkechersUSA	SKX	63.15	-0.06
Skyworks	SWKS	77.70	0.07
SmithAO	AOS	70.47	0.97
Smith&Nephew	SNN	31.07	0.38
SmithfieldFds	SFD	24.12	0.05
Smucker	SJM	104.66	0.49
SmurfitWestrock	SW	48.02	0.78
Snap	SNAP	9.34	0.22
Snap-On	SNA	320.70	2.58
Snowflake	SNOW	214.42	-7.48
SOQUIMICH	SQM	39.12	0.67
↓SoFiTech	SOFI	20.97	0.96
Solventum	SOLV	75.88	1.69
↓Somnigroup	SGI	72.94	-0.68
Sony	SONY	24.65	-0.52
SouthState	SSB	97.65	0.25
Southern	SO	93.26	1.30
SoCopper	SCCO	102.26	2.34
↓SouthwestAir	**LUV**	**37.35**	**2.81**
↓Sportradar	SRAD	29.17	-0.24
Spotify	SPOT	709.95	-12.17
SproutsFarmers	SFM	158.72	-1.03
StandardAero	SARO	30.01	-0.05
StanleyB&D	SWK	73.85	0.94
Stantec	STN	110.80	-0.48
Starbucks	SBUX	95.15	-0.10
StateStreet	STT	110.21	0.81
SteelDynamics	STLD	137.37	1.29
Stellantis	STLA	10.37	0.09
Steris	STE	238.72	-0.55
StifelFinancial	SF	109.60	1.10
STMicroelec	STM	33.14	1.17
Stryker	SYK	394.77	2.72
SumitomoMits	SMFG	14.81	-0.07
SummitTherap	SMMT	25.88	1.14
SunComms	SUI	125.96	-1.40
SunLifeFinancial	SLF	62.00	0.43
SuncorEnergy	SU	39.41	0.18
SuperMicroComp	SMCI	50.90	-0.46
Suzano	SUZ	8.99	-0.09
↓Symbotic	SYM	47.81	0.65
↓SynchronyFinl	SYF	71.14	0.98
Synopsys	SNPS	566.19	15.24
Sysco	SYY	77.46	1.13

T U V

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
TC Energy	TRP	47.26	0.68
TD Synnex	SNX	142.38	0.88
↓TE Connectivity	TEL	175.03	2.38
Telus	TU	16.53	-0.03
TIM	TIMB	19.32	-0.15
TJX	TJX	124.16	-1.29
TKO	TKO	172.89	1.09
T-MobileUS	TMUS	228.15	-4.16
TPG	TPG	55.99	1.79
T.RowePrice	TROW	102.96	1.51
TaiwanSemi	TSM	229.76	-2.08
Take-TwoSftwr	TTWO	235.33	-6.90
TakedaPharm	TAK	14.69	-0.29
TalenEnergy	TLN	267.62	-4.53
↓Tapestry	TPR	97.64	2.33
TargaResources	TRGP	170.74	0.75
Target	TGT	104.74	2.31
TechnipFMC	FTI	35.36	0.19
TeckResourcesB	TECK	38.81	0.37
↓TeledyneTech	TDY	527.52	7.66
Ericsson	ERIC	8.18	-0.01
TelefonicaBras	VIV	11.48	-0.07
Telefonica	TEF	5.20	-0.07
TelekomIndns	TLK	16.57	0.19
TempusAI	TEM	59.60	1.19
Tenaris	TS	38.05	-0.52
TencentMusic	TME	20.00	-0.35
TenetHealthcare	THC	173.66	2.26
Teradyne	**TER**	**98.62**	**5.84**
Tesla	TSLA	309.87	13.99
TetraTech	TTEK	36.52	0.21
TevaPharm	TEVA	16.53	-0.18
↓TexasInstruments	TXN	219.66	3.27
TexasPacLand	TPL	1051.03	3.48
TexasRoadhouse	TXRH	186.38	-0.19
Textron	TXT	85.23	2.76
ThermoFisher	TMO	430.73	10.85
ThomsonReuters	TRI	201.58	1.57
3M	MMM	157.32	1.34
Toast	TOST	44.26	-0.38
TollBros	TOL	122.63	1.24
TopBuild	BLD	384.77	5.97
TorontoDomBk	TD	73.89	0.56
TotalEnergies	TTE	62.61	0.05
ToyotaMotor	TM	170.39	-0.15
TractorSupply	TSCO	57.44	0.23
TradeDesk	TTD	76.85	1.22
Tradeweb	TW	134.68	-1.94
TraneTech	TT	434.53	0.92
↓TransDigm	TDG	1539.53	13.09
TransUnion	TRU	94.98	1.46
Travelers	TRV	255.99	0.67
↓Trimble	TRMB	80.83	1.21
Trip.com	TCOM	61.87	0.52
TruistFinl	TFC	45.50	0.34
Twilio	TWLO	117.32	-4.17
TylerTech	TYL	559.90	-19.08
TysonFoods	TSN	54.64	-0.44
↓UBS Group	UBS	36.11	0.31
UDR	UDR	40.49	0.20
U-Haul	UHAL	62.21	0.61
U-Haul N	UHAL/B	56.77	0.71
UL Solutions	ULS	71.47	0.57
UMB Fin	UMBF	111.46	0.77
US Foods	USFD	80.25	0.40
Uber	UBER	96.40	-0.24
Ubiquiti	UI	399.62	-3.39
UltaBeauty	ULTA	476.14	0.57
Unilever	UL	61.47	0.67
UnionPacific	UNP	237.00	0.51
UnitedAirlines	**UAL**	**91.67**	**11.49**
UnitedMicro	UMC	7.56	-0.14
UPS B	UPS	102.92	0.77
UnitedRentals	URI	819.74	15.75
US Bancorp	USB	47.77	0.57
UnitedTherap	UTHR	300.16	-0.40
UnitedHealth	UNH	299.51	-3.40
UnitySoftware	U	29.16	-0.19
UniversalHealthB	UHS	184.05	1.49
UnumGroup	UNM	80.47	1.20
VICI Prop	VICI	33.63	0.68
Vale	VALE	9.96	0.10
ValeroEnergy	VLO	154.81	5.74
VeevaSystems	VEEV	281.64	-2.74
Ventas	VTR	63.58	0.92
VentureGlobal	VG	16.86	0.44
Veralto	VLTO	103.13	0.76
VeriSign	VRSN	285.29	-4.47
VeriskAnalytics	VRSK	302.90	-0.82
Verizon	VZ	42.03	0.10
↓VeronaPharma	VRNA	104.85	0.08
VertexPharm	VRTX	479.53	0.56
Vertiv	**VRT**	**120.72**	**-7.65**
Viatris	VTRS	9.25	0.02
↓Viking	VIK	56.62	0.35
VinFastAuto	VFS	3.53	0.03
Visa	V	355.88	-1.88
Vistra	VST	195.78	-1.23
Vodafone	VOD	10.91	0.03
VulcanMatls	VMC	270.73	0.78

W X Y Z

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
WEC Energy	WEC	105.68	1.46
W.P.Carey	WPC	62.48	0.68
Wabtec	WAB	213.75	0.70
WalgreensBoots	WBA	11.56	-0.02
Walmart	WMT	94.86	-1.95
WarnerBrosA	WBD	11.65	0.16
WarnerMusic	WMG	29.93	-0.06
WasteConnections	WCN	182.01	-0.06
WasteMgt	WM	225.65	-0.10
Waters	WAT	353.28	4.07
Watsco	WSO	476.29	3.28
↓WattsWater	WTS	258.16	1.59
WebsterFin	WBS	59.51	0.62
WellsFargo	WFC	82.36	0.57
Welltower	WELL	152.72	0.47
WescoIntl	WCC	201.26	2.96
WestPharmSvcs	WST	229.23	3.05
WestAllianceBcp	WAL	83.11	0.48
WesternDigital	WDC	65.06	0.42
WesternMidstrm	WES	39.24	-0.03
Westlake	WLK	86.48	0.99
WeyerhaeuserW	WY	26.18	0.03
WheatonPrecMet	WPM	89.89	1.05
Williams	WMB	57.78	-0.07
Williams-Sonoma	WSM	176.50	2.77
WillisTowers	WTW	309.82	1.31
Wingstop	WING	330.16	-3.90
WintrustFinl	WTFC	133.33	0.72
Wipro	WIT	2.92	-0.15
Wix.com	WIX	155.95	-2.05
WoodsideEnergy	WDS	15.80	0.11
Woodward	WWD	250.83	3.81
WooriFinl	WF	54.66	1.20
Workday	WDAY	229.30	-10.87
↓WynnResorts	WYNN	111.93	1.85
XP	XP	18.61	-0.58
XPO	XPO	133.94	1.81
XcelEnergy	XEL	68.45	0.61
XPeng	XPEV	17.43	-0.22
Xylem	XYL	131.60	0.05
YPF	YPF	31.80	-0.11
YumBrands	YUM	152.35	1.30
YumChina	YUMC	47.88	0.68
ZTO Express	**ZTO**	**19.33**	**1.63**
ZebraTech	ZBRA	330.35	8.57
Zillow C	Z	78.91	3.40
Zillow A	ZG	76.17	3.21
ZimmerBiomet	ZBH	95.15	-0.05
ZionsBancorp	ZION	55.57	0.95
Zoetis	ZTS	158.80	0.53
ZoomComms	ZM	75.05	-2.33
Zscaler	**ZS**	**296.18**	**-20.32**

Dividend Changes

Company	Symbol	Yld %	Amount New/Old	Frq	Payable / Record
Increased					
Marsh & McLennan	MMC	1.7	.90 /.815	Q	Aug15 /Jul24
Reduced					
Methode Electronics	MEI	3.6	.07 /.14	Q	Aug01 /Jul21
Foreign					
Banco Macro ADR	BMA	9.2	.39852		Jul25 /Jul18
Himalaya Shipping	HSHP		.05	M	Aug05 /Jul21

Note: Dividend yields as of 3:30 p.m. ET

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

KEY: A: annual; M: monthly; Q: quarterly; r: revised; SA: semiannual; S2:1: stock split and ratio; SO: spin-off.

New Highs and Lows

The following explanations apply to the New York Stock Exchange, NYSE Arca, NYSE American and Nasdaq Stock Market stocks that hit a new 52-week intraday high or low in the latest session. % CHG-Daily percentage change from the previous trading session.

Thursday, July 10, 2025

Highs

Stock	Sym	52-Wk Hi/Lo	% Chg
AGCO	AGCO	116.25	3.5
A2ZCust2Mate	AZ	11.20	7.2
AZZ	AZZ	113.58	5.5
AbCelleraBio	ABCL	4.64	1.7
AboveFoodWt	ABVEW	0.15	254.9
AcadianAsset	AAMI	39.34	3.3
Acushnet	GOLF	79.23	2.7
AdvEnergyInds	AEIS	144.54	1.8
AffiliatedMgrs	AMG	208.05	1.9
AlamoGroup	ALG	230.16	0.5
AlgonquinNt2079	AQNB	25.80	0.7
AllegroMicro	ALGM	38.45	1.7
Allient	ALNT	40.00	-0.1
Allot	ALLT	10.77	1.7
AlphaTimeAcqn	ATMC	11.85	0.1
AltisourcePtfWt	ASPSW	0.10	4.4
AltisourcePortf	ASPS	14.48	1.3
Amarin	AMRN	17.49	-0.1
AmerPubEduc	APEI	31.83	0.4
AmericanGold&SilverUSAS	USAS	1.00	6.1
AmpriusTech	AMPX	6.96	9.1
AmylyxPharm	AMLX	7.61	2.1
Ansys	ANSS	374.78	2.1
Aramark	ARMK	43.84	1.5
ArdaghMetalPkg	AMBP	4.78	3.1
ArmstrongWorld	AWI	170.86	0.9
ArteloBiosci	ARTL	28.60	31.9
Artivion	AORT	32.94	1.3
AtourLifestyle	ATAT	37.46	0.5
Autoliv	ALV	118.98	0.7
AutoNation	AN	217.40	0.7
AvinoSilver	ASM	4.09	3.8
AxisBudget	CAR	194.94	6.4
BitMining	BTCM	8.07	154.1
BankofButterfield	NTB	46.89	1.0
BankMontreal	BMO	114.76	1.3
BankNY Mellon	BK	93.93	0.7
Barclays	BCS	18.82	1.0
BassettFurniture	BSET	19.75	12.7
BelFuse B	BELFB	103.72	0.1
BentleySystems	BSY	56.80	1.2
BigBearAI	BBAI	7.20	3.1
BiglariB	BH	308.62	-0.9
BiglariA	BH.A	1478.00	...
Blackboxstocks	BLBX	8.39	14.1
BlackRock	BLK	1105.72	1.4
BlueprintMed	BPMC	129.49	0.6
BootBarn	BOOT	177.10	2.9
BoydGaming	BYD	87.76	1.5
BridgeBioPharma	BBIO	46.80	0.6
BritishAmTob	BTI	50.85	3.5
Broadcom	AVGO	281.18	-0.9
BuildABear	BBW	57.78	4.1
CNH Indl	CNH	14.27	0.8
CVR Energy	CVI	32.67	5.2
CanadaGoose	GOOS	13.69	4.1
CIBC	CM	73.52	1.0
CapitalCityBank	CCBG	42.00	1.0
Carlyle	CG	58.84	2.9
Cemex	CX	7.50	0.7
CoinbaseGlbl	COIN	389.16	4.0
Cipa	CPA	114.15	4.5
CoStar	CSGP	86.14	1.8
CrackerBarrel	CBRL	63.35	6.7
DallasNews	DALN	13.58	208.9
DeleKUS	DK	26.80	9.6
DieboldNixdorf	DBD	60.33	1.2
DollarTree	DLTR	108.95	3.5
EPR Prop	EPR	59.92	1.4
EPR PropPfdC	EPRpC	26.21	1.7
EPR PropPfdE	EPRpE	32.06	1.7
Electrovaya	ELVA	3.80	1.7
EmersonElec	EMR	142.32	0.6
F3KXCapAcqn	FGXU	10.04	...
Fastenal	FAST	44.00	0.4
FederalSignal	FSS	114.40	0.5
FederatedHermes	FHI	46.84	0.9
FennecPharm	FENC	9.11	1.7
FergusonEnts	FERG	226.63	0.2
FirstBuseyPfdB	BUSEP	25.35	0.2
FirstWesternFin	MYFW	24.26	0.5
Flex	FLEX	52.20	0.5
FranklinRscs	BEN	25.36	1.6
Futu	FUTU	150.01	0.8
GalaxyDigital	GLXY	23.19	2.0
GlobalShipLease	GSL	27.69	2.6
GoldRoyaltyWt	GROY.WS	0.49	11.6
GrAeroportuario	OMAB	114.80	2.5
HSBC	HSBC	62.87	1.1
Hawkins	HWKN	156.61	0.1
HeartSciences	HSCS	6.47	31.1
HiltonGrandVac	HGV	48.44	2.8
Hilton	HLT	277.77	1.8
HomeBancorp	HBCP	56.80	...
HoulihanLokey	HLI	192.44	0.8
i3Verticals	IIIV	30.10	-2.3
InhibrxBiosci	INBX	21.77	0.3
Insteelnds	IIIN	40.03	2.0
InteractiveBrkrs	IBKR	59.21	1.9
InterDigital	IDCC	236.45	-0.2
Johnson Controls	JCI	107.20	-0.2
JobyAviationWt	JOBY.WS	3.59	17.9
JohnsonControls	JCI	107.20	...
KKR Pfd	KKRpD	57.03	1.9
KLA	KLAC	932.17	0.6
KalVistaPharm	KALV	13.75	2.1
LatamAirlines	LTM	42.53	2.6
LifecoreBiomed	LFCR	8.82	7.2
LincolnElectric	LECO	225.25	1.4
LixiangEducation	LXEH	4.33	53.5
LixteBiotechWt	LIXTW	0.38	45.2
MP Materials	MP	48.12	50.6
MSC Industrial	MSM	92.68	1.1
MagicSoftware	MGIC	22.00	-0.5
Marqeta	MQ	6.19	3.4
MasterBeef	MB	15.77	12.1
MelcoResorts	MLCO	8.91	0.2
MicrochipTechPfdA	MCHPP	70.80	0.8
MillrosePropr	MRP	29.94	1.9
MingteengIntl	MTEN	22.35	56.8
Nasdaq	NDAQ	90.84	1.0
NationalVision	EYE	25.39	-2.8
Newegg	NEGG	28.82	32.3
NewMarket	NEU	743.52	0.4
NorthernDynasty	NAK	2.40	4.3
NovaLifestyle	NVFY	2.23	7.9
Novartis	NVS	124.83	0.6
Nucor	NUE	145.77	2.6
Openlane	KAR	26.04	0.9
OrmatTech	ORA	70.83	-2.9
Oshkosh	OSK	129.02	0.9
Owlet	OWLT	9.74	-0.8
OysterEnt	OYSEU	10.23	0.3
PagayaTech	PGY	23.85	0.8
ParPacific	PARR	34.82	5.8
ParamountGroup	PGRE	6.72	4.7
PatrickIndustries	PATK	102.84	2.0
PenskeAuto	PAG	186.33	1.4
PerformantHlthcr	PHLT	4.44	0.7
PrimerSolutions	PRM	16.33	2.5
PhibroAnimal	PAHC	27.76	0.5
Precipio	PRPO	16.89	-3.1
PreformedLine	PLPC	171.94	-0.5
PriorityIncmPfdL	PRIFpL	24.52	0.2
ProAssurance	PRA	23.85	0.3
PureCycleTech	PCT	15.98	0.7
QuantzseaAcqn	QSEA	10.06	-0.1
QuantzseaAcqnRt	QSEAR	0.34	7.7
RL	RL	295.52	-0.2
RalphLauren	RL	295.52	-0.2
RedRiverBcshs	RRBI	64.65	1.5
Reliance	RS	333.71	1.7
RexAmerRscs	REX	54.74	0.5
RhythmPharm	RYTM	94.80	1.7
RoyalBkCanada	RY	133.84	0.6
RoyalCaribbean	RCL	351.58	2.3
RyanairHldgs	RYAAY	58.93	0.7
RyderSystem	R	177.46	3.8
SAP	SAP	313.28	-1.8
SEI Investments	SEIC	94.03	1.3
Sanmina	SANM	105.72	0.9
SchwabC	SCHW	93.65	1.8
ScrippsEW	SSP	3.37	9.3
ScullyRoyalty	SRL	7.71	5.0
ShakeShack	SHAK	144.65	0.9
SoFiTech	SOFI	21.32	3.7
SomnigroupIntl	SGI	71.73	1.3
SonicAutomotive	SAH	89.62	0.4
Southland	SLND	4.89	2.1
SouthwestAir	LUV	37.68	8.1
Sportradar	SRAD	29.73	-0.8
Sportsman	SPOT	7.62	...
StandardLithium	SLI	2.79	14.2
Stantec	STN	110.61	0.4
Stevanato	STVN	26.18	2.7
STMicroAdrHedged	STGW	8.68	8.7
SuperGroup	SGHC	12.18	-1.7
Symbotic	SYM	49.28	1.4
SynchronyFinl	SYF	71.88	1.4
TE Connectivity	TEL	175.31	1.4
TectonicFinPfdB	TECTP	10.74	0.5
TeledyneTech	TDY	530.44	1.5
Ten-League	TLIH	5.77	-10.5
TexasInstruments	TXN	220.78	1.5
Toro	TORO	3.37	31.6
TradeDesk	TTD	77.63	1.6
TrailblazerI Rt	TBMCR	0.49	-9.2
TransDigm	TDG	1546.54	0.9
TranslationalDev	TDAC	10.30	0.3
TriMas	TRS	30.25	1.2
Trimble	TRMB	81.66	1.5
UBS Group	UBS	36.24	0.9
US Foods	USFD	80.96	0.5
UYScutiAcqn	UYSC	10.09	0.2
UnityBancorp	UNTY	54.34	3.2
VeronaPharma	VRNA	104.99	0.1
Viking	VIK	57.65	0.6
VillageFarms	VFF	1.47	-6.5
VineHillCapWt	VCICW	0.41	28.7
VirnetX	VHC	17.00	11.0
VivosTherap	VVOS	6.74	11.2
WKKellogg	KLG	22.96	30.6
WattsWater	WTS	260.93	0.6
Wayfair	W	59.51	4.0
Willdan	WLDN	75.50	0.7
WisdomTree	WT	12.84	0.6
WorldAcceptance	WRLD	177.25	0.1
WynnResorts	WYNN	112.36	1.7
Yuanbao	YB	31.00	-3.8
ZevraTherap	ZVRA	12.37	4.0

Lows

Stock	Sym	52-Wk Hi/Lo	% Chg
AifeexNexusAcqn	AIFEU	9.91	-4.2
AmphastarPharm	AMPH	22.20	-1.0
Anterix	ATEX	23.93	-1.4
ArgoBlockchainNts	ARBKL	2.98	21.5
AustralianOilseeds	COOT	0.54	...
BriaCellTherap	BCTX	1.97	-1.9
BrookfieldBRP7.25Nt	BEPJ	24.36	...
BrookfieldNts2084	BIPJ	24.48	0.1
CNA Fin	CNA	43.78	-1.3
CO2EnTransitionWt	NOEMR	0.15	12.5
Campbell's	CPB	29.39	-0.8
ChurchillCapX	CCCX	10.15	-0.2
ConagraBrands	CAG	19.43	-4.4
ConcordeIntl	CIGL	2.12	-79.9
Corts PECO KTH	KTH	28.02	-1.4
EIDP$350Pfd	CTApA	53.35	-1.6
ElevanceHealth	ELV	339.43	-0.1
FirstAmerFin	FAF	53.09	-5.7
FlowersFoods	FLO	15.46	1.2
FusionFuelGreen	HTOO	0.16	-12.2
Gauzy	GAUZ	5.50	3.7
GeneralMills	GIS	49.86	1.5
HelenofTroy	HELE	21.20	-22.7
HighPeakEnerWt	HPKEW	0.06	-15.6
Hongli	HLP	0.63	1.7
InspireVeterinary	IVP	1.00	-13.5
JamfHolding	JAMF	8.62	-2.5
MolinaHealthcare	MOH	227.63	-3.6
MullenAuto	MULN	0.15	-10.9
Natuzzi	NTZ	3.05	-1.9
NewGenIvf	NIVF	0.61	2.1
NewYorkMtgNts	NYMTZ	22.37	...
NextNRG	NXXT	2.06	-6.6
OriginAgritech	SEED	0.74	-2.0
ProgressSoftware	PRGS	55.40	-0.2
SMX	SMX	2.95	-23.6
SimplyGoodFoods	SMPL	30.47	-0.1
SlideInsurance	SLDE	17.77	1.4
UWM Wt	UWMC.WS	0.05	-4.4
UltragenyxPharm	RARE	29.06	-25.1
VCIGlobal	VCIG	1.28	-7.9
X4 Pharm	XFOR	1.54	-4.3
Youlife	YOUL	2.55	-82.1
zSpace	ZSPC	2.72	-4.7

Mutual Funds

Data provided by LSEG

Top 250 mutual-funds listings for Nasdaq-published share classes by net assets.

e-Ex-distribution. **f**-Previous day's quotation. **g**-Footnotes x and s apply. **j**-Footnotes e and s apply. **k**-Recalculated by LSEG, using updated data. **p**-Distribution costs apply, 12b-1. **r**-Redemption charge may apply. **s**-Stock split or dividend. **t**-Footnotes p and r apply. **v**-Footnotes x and e apply. **x**-Ex-dividend. **z**-Footnote x, e and s apply. **NA**-Not available due to incomplete price, performance or cost data. **NE**-Not released by LSEG; data under review. **NN**-Fund not tracked. **NS**-Fund didn't exist at start of period.

Thursday, July 10, 2025

Fund	NAV	Net Chg	YTD %Ret
AB Funds			
MunilncmShares	10.88	...	-0.2
AB Funds - ADV			
LgCpGrAdv	118.07	-0.32	7.9
American Century Inv			
Ultra	96.09	-0.18	3.0
American Funds Cl A			
AmcpA	44.80	+0.05	9.5
AMutlA	60.24	+0.25	10.0
BalA	36.96	+0.10	8.9
BondA	11.29	...	3.6
CapIBA	77.18	+0.28	13.0
CapWGrA	71.82	+0.24	13.9
EupacA	60.97	+0.06	16.7
FdInvA	88.90	+0.38	13.0
GwthA	83.14	+0.17	11.7
HI TrA	9.84	...	4.2
ICAA	64.02	+0.24	12.6
IncoA	26.89	+0.09	11.6
N PerA	70.34	+0.13	13.3
NEcoA	68.32	+0.08	11.8
NwWrldA	89.45	+0.01	16.1
SmCpA	73.40	+0.26	9.0
TxExA	12.13	+0.01	-0.5
WshA	64.82	+0.27	10.6
Artisan Funds			
IntlVal Inst	52.54	+0.14	12.6
Baird Funds			
AggBdInst	9.82	...	3.7
CorBdInst	10.18	...	3.7
IntBdInst	10.46	...	3.8
BlackRock Funds			
HiYBlk	7.20	+0.01	5.1
HiYldBd Inst	7.19	...	5.0
BlackRock Funds III			
iShS&P500IdxK	735.01	+2.13	7.5
BlackRock Funds Inst			
StratIncOpptyIns	9.67	...	4.7
Calamos Funds			
MktNeutI	15.44	+0.02	3.9
CausewayInst			
CausewayInst	22.93	+0.13	23.5
Columbia Class I			
DivIncom I	35.31	+0.15	8.0
Dimensional Fds			
EmgMktVa	34.46	+0.14	16.5
EmMktCorEq	26.53	+0.06	15.1
IntlCoreEq	18.63	+0.02	22.6
IntSmCo	23.80	+0.05	24.3
IntSmVa	27.19	+0.06	27.8
LgCo	41.67	+0.12	7.5
US CoreEq1	45.98	+0.17	6.9
US CoreEq2	40.64	+0.15	6.1
US Small	49.84	+0.31	2.5
US SmCpVal	48.99	+0.42	1.6
US TgdVal	35.04	+0.28	3.0
USLgVa	52.08	+0.37	6.7
Dodge & Cox			
Balanced	108.40	+0.19	9.2
Income	12.60	...	4.0
Intl Stk	61.72	+0.20	23.1
Stock	274.10	+0.95	8.8
DoubleLine Funds			
TotRetBdI	8.80	...	4.0
Edgewood Growth Instituti			
EdgewoodGrInst	47.36	-0.09	6.7
Fidelity			
500IdxInstPrem	218.82	+0.63	7.5
Contrafund K6	34.95	-0.07	12.6
ExtMktIdxInstPre	95.37	+0.21	4.9
FidSerInt	8.68	...	0.5
FidSer5	7.68	...	4.2
FidSerToMarket	20.52	+0.06	7.2
FIDZroLgCpIx	22.71	+0.05	7.2
GlexUSIdxInstPre	17.21	+0.03	19.3
GrowthCompanyK6	32.51	+0.02	6.9
IntlIdxInstPrem	57.53	+0.02	21.0
LgCpGwldInstPre	41.97	+0.01	7.1
MidCpInxInstPrem	36.08	+0.17	7.1
SAIUSLgCpIndxFd	24.29	+0.07	7.5
SeriesBondFd	9.00	...	3.5
SeriesOverseas	16.20	-0.05	18.1
SerLTTreBdldx	5.36	...	1.0
SmCpIdxInstPrem	28.32	+0.14	2.3
TMktIdxInstPrem	172.74	+0.48	7.2
TotalMarketIndex	21.85	+0.07	7.1
TtlIntIdxInstPr	16.04	+0.04	19.4
USBdIdxInstPrem	10.28	...	3.7
Fidelity Advisor			
TotBdFdClZ	9.53	...	3.8
Fidelity Freedom			
Freedom2030 K	18.80	+0.02	9.5
Idx2030InsPre	21.73	+0.03	9.4
Idx2035InsPre	25.31	+0.05	9.0
Idx2040InsPre	27.06	+0.05	10.3
Idx2045InsPre	28.74	+0.06	11.0
Idx2050InsPre	28.76	+0.06	11.0
Fidelity Invest			
Balanc	31.18	+0.06	6.8
BluCh	239.73	+0.14	5.5
BluChpGr K6	39.93	...	5.5
Contra	23.37	-0.05	12.0
ContraK	23.46	-0.05	12.0
CpInc	11.26	+0.02	5.7
DivIntl	50.22	-0.15	19.1
GroCo	42.67	+0.04	5.8
InvGrBd	10.05	...	4.0
LowP	46.49	+0.20	7.1
Magin	15.67	-0.05	11.8
NASDAQ	262.40	+0.24	7.2
OTC	22.43	+0.02	4.7
Puritn	25.77	+0.02	6.2
SAIUSMinVolIndFd	22.08	+0.04	6.7
SAIUSQtyIdx	22.90	+0.02	7.6
SrsBlChGroRetail	20.94	+0.01	5.5
SrsEmrgMkt	21.51	+0.05	17.4
SrsGlobal	16.92	+0.03	19.3
SrsGroCoRetail	25.50	+0.02	6.2
SrsIntlGrw	20.03	-0.03	16.2
SrsIntlVal	15.35	-0.02	28.8
TotalBond	9.55	...	4.0
Fidelity SAI			
FidSaiInfltnFnd	10.23	...	4.5
IntlValue	9.91	...	...
Fidelity Selects			
Semiconductors r	36.44	+0.16	15.0
Tech	39.18	-0.08	9.2
Fidelity Strategic A			
StratAdEmrMrt	NA	...	NA
First Eagle Funds			
GlbA	77.54	+0.33	15.7
Franklin A1			
IncomeA1	2.44	+0.01	6.8
FrankTemp/Frank Adv			
IncomeAdv	2.41	+0.01	6.8
FrankTemp/Franklin A			
DynaTech A	189.45	-1.44	8.5
Growth A	144.19	-0.07	8.6
RisDv A	95.65	+0.23	7.2
Guggenheim Funds Tru			
TotRtnBdFdClInst	23.81	...	4.2
Harbor Funds			
CapApInst	122.72	-0.41	8.0
JHF III DispVal			
DispValMCI	NA	...	NA
John Hancock			
BondR6	13.52	...	3.8
JPMorgan I Class			
CoreBond	10.27	...	3.7
EqInc	25.64	+0.18	8.1
LgCpGwth	84.83	-0.15	6.4
JPMorgan R Class			
CoreBond	10.29	...	3.8
CorePlusBd	7.22	+0.01	4.0
Lord Abbett I			
ShtDurInc p	3.88	...	3.3
Metropolitan West			
TotRetBdI	NA	...	NA
MFS Funds			
IIE	39.79	-0.05	17.7
MFS Funds Class I			
GrowthI	217.14	-0.62	7.7
ValueI	52.34	+0.33	8.3
Natixis Funds			
InvGradeBdY	9.83	...	3.6
Northern Funds			
StkIdx	63.67	+0.18	7.5
Old Westbury Fds			
LrgCpStr	NA	...	NA
Parnassus Fds			
ParnEqFd	64.48	+0.07	8.3
PGIM Funds Cl Z			
TotalReturnBond	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Fds Instl			
TotRt	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Funds A			
IncomeFd	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Funds I2			
Income	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Funds Instl			
IncomeFd	NA	...	NA
Price Funds			
BlChip	201.96	-0.25	8.4
DivGro	82.87	+0.25	8.3
Growth	111.80	-0.21	8.4
LgCapGow I	88.61	-0.20	7.9
Putnam Funds Class A			
PutLargCap p	37.54	+0.26	9.2
Putnam Funds Class Y			
PutLargCap	37.57	+0.26	9.4
Schwab Funds			
1000 Inv r	133.36	+0.38	7.1
IntlSml r	27.34	+0.01	20.9
S&P Sel	97.06	+0.28	7.5
TSM Sel r	106.21	+0.30	7.2
Strategic Adviser			
StratAdCorInc	NA	...	NA
StratAdEmgMkt	13.40	...	...
StratAdFidEmr	14.04	+0.04	15.8
StratAdFidUS	18.69	+0.03	7.8
StratAdIntlFnd	NA	...	NA
StratAdlUSTot	NA	...	NA
StratAdvFidIntl	14.31	-0.02	21.2
TIAA/CREF Funds			
EqIdxInst	43.96	+0.12	7.2
IntlEqIdxInst	26.61	...	21.0
LgCpGrIdxInst	75.17	+0.06	7.0
VANGUARD ADMIRAL			
500Adml	579.77	+1.67	7.5
BalAdml	50.19	+0.09	6.2
CAITAdml	11.41	...	3.0
CapOpAdml r	204.59	+1.63	8.1
DivAppIdxAdm	56.25	+0.13	6.1
EMAdmr	41.21	+0.07	12.5
EqIncAdml	94.86	+0.51	9.0
ExplrAdml	107.67	+0.02	0.8
ExtndAdml	150.20	+0.33	4.9
GNMAAdml	9.21	...	3.6
GrwthAdml	209.47	+0.26	7.9
HlthCareAdml r	74.04	+0.38	-1.8
HYCorAdml r	5.52	+0.01	5.1
InfProAd	23.21	...	5.1
IntlGrAdml	117.74	+0.47	17.9
ITBondAdml	10.39	...	4.4
ITIGradeAdml	8.77	...	5.1
LarCapAd	145.78	+0.35	7.5
MidCpAdml	351.82	+1.04	8.5
MuHYAdml	10.29	...	-0.6
MuIntAdml	13.43	...	0.7
MuLTAdml	10.49	...	-0.7
MuLtdAdml	10.92	+0.01	2.4
MuShtAdml	15.83	...	2.1
PrmcpAdml r	182.24	+1.85	9.6
RealEstatAdml	127.23	+0.82	2.8
SmCapAdml	117.32	+0.64	2.6
SmGthAdml	99.52	+0.16	1.6
STBondAdml	10.26	...	3.5
STIGradeAdml	10.44	...	3.4
STIPSIxAdm	25.02	...	4.1
TotBdAdml	9.37	...	3.8
TotIntBdIdxAdm	19.67	-0.03	1.9
TotIntlAdmIdx r	37.31	+0.05	18.9
TotStAdml	153.97	+0.45	7.1
TxMCapAdml	322.74	+0.92	7.3
TxMIn r	18.43	+0.03	21.5
USGroAdml	201.21	-0.51	8.7
ValAdml	69.99	+0.43	7.2
WdsrllAdml	83.98	+0.35	9.0
WellsIAdml	62.45	+0.15	6.0
WelltnAdml	78.50	+0.17	7.4
WndsrAdml	73.79	+0.45	5.7
VANGUARD FDS			
DivdGro	36.62	+0.07	4.5
IntlVal	44.20	+0.17	17.6
LifeCon	21.74	...	6.0
LifeGro	48.20	+0.10	10.1
LifeMod	33.60	+0.05	8.2
PrmcpCor	37.30	+0.36	11.5
STAR	29.36	+0.04	8.0
TgtRe2020	28.21	+0.02	6.5
TgtRe2025	20.14	+0.03	7.4
TgtRe2030	41.08	+0.06	8.3
TgtRe2035	26.16	+0.04	8.9
TgtRe2040	47.19	+0.09	9.3
TgtRe2045	32.71	+0.07	9.8
TgtRe2050	55.31	+0.12	11.0
TgtRe2060	56.97	+0.12	11.0
TgtRet2055	61.71	+0.13	11.0
TgtRetInc	13.72	+0.01	6.1
Welltn	45.46	+0.10	7.4
WndsrII	47.24	+0.19	7.6
VANGUARD INDEX FDS			
ExtndIstPl	370.78	+0.80	4.9
IdxIntl	22.31	+0.04	18.9
IdxIntl	22.31	+0.04	18.9
MdCpVlAdml	87.19	+0.71	5.2
SmValAdml	87.19	+0.72	3.1
TotBd2	9.50	...	3.6
TotIntlInstIdx r	149.22	+0.23	19.0
TotItlInstPlId r	149.25	+0.23	19.0
TotSt	150.08	+0.42	7.1
VANGUARD INSTL FDS			
BalInst	50.20	+0.09	6.2
DevMktsIndInst	28.85	+0.05	21.5
ExtndInst	150.25	+0.33	4.9
FTScInst	43.15	+0.07	6.8
GrwthInst	227.71	-0.09	8.1
InPrSeIn	9.46	...	5.1
InstIdx	510.66	+1.47	7.5
InstPlus	510.65	+1.47	7.5
InstTStPlus	104.85	+0.29	7.1
MidCpInst	77.72	+0.23	8.5
MidCpIstPl	383.29	+1.12	8.5
SmCapInst	117.31	+0.64	2.6
SmCapIstPl	338.60	+1.84	2.6
STIGradeInst	10.44	...	3.4
STIPSIxins	25.04	...	4.1
TotBdInst	9.37	...	3.8
TotBdInst2	9.50	...	3.6
TotBdInstPl	9.37	...	3.8
TotIntBdIdxInst	29.52	-0.04	1.9
TotStInst	150.13	+0.42	7.1
ValueInst	69.99	+0.43	7.2
WCM Focus Funds			
WCMFocIntlGrwIns	26.71	-0.25	22.7

Stocks Climb as Investors Look To Trade Deals, Earnings Reports

By Vicky Ge Huang

THURSDAY'S MARKETS

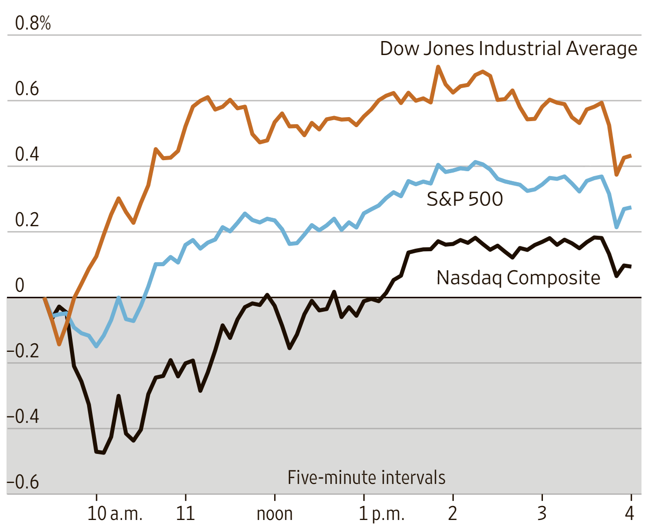
The prospects of new trade deals and a promising start to earnings season helped lift stocks to records.

Stocks opened lower after President Trump unveiled a 50% tariff on Brazilian goods, citing legal action against its former president, Jair Bolsonaro, and U.S. tech firms as justification for the levies. But by midafternoon the major indexes had turned higher, driven in part by the president's latest Truth Social post urging the Federal Reserve to "RAPIDLY LOWER RATE TO REFLECT THIS STRENGTH."

The market ambled to new heights this month despite regular reminders that the U.S. is still locked in a trade war with much of the world, and investors' reaction to Trump's late-Wednesday notice on Brazil's levy fit the pattern.

"There's a lot of social-media postings, and yet what we've seen really play out is [Treasury] Secretary [Scott] Bessent driving a process to lead to various announcements," said David Bahnsen, chief investment officer of Bahnsen Group. "Markets could hear 50% tariffs on Brazil and copper, or they could just conclude that, one way or the other, with a little bit of a roller coaster along the way, we're going to end up at a place where those worst-case outcomes don't come to be."

Index performance on Thursday



Source: FactSet

The S&P 500 rose 0.3% to 6280.46, a record closing high. The tech-heavy Nasdaq also ended trading at a record, adding just shy of 0.1%. The Dow Jones Industrial Average gained 192 points, or 0.4%.

Some investors are shifting their attention to corporate earnings reports. Second-quarter profits for S&P 500 companies are expected to rise 4.8% from a year earlier, the slowest pace since late 2023, according to FactSet.

Delta Air Lines jumped 12% after the airline posted better-than-expected results.

WK Kellogg shares posted a record gain of 31% after Italian candy maker **Ferrero** agreed to buy the cereal maker for roughly $3 billion.

The yield on the 10-year Treasury note edged higher to 4.35% from 4.34% on Wednesday. Bond yields rise as prices fall.

Copper futures rose 1.9% to $5.548 a pound after Trump confirmed a 50% tariff on the metal will take effect Aug. 1. Prices for the metal hit record highs Tuesday after the president unveiled the levy.

The Labor Department said that the number of Americans who newly filed for unemployment benefits declined last week, but the size of the unemployed population continued to grow in June, reaching the highest level since November 2021. "The labor market continues to hold, but it's not firing on all cylinders," said Bret Kenwell, U.S. investment analyst at eToro. "That's what keeps investors on edge when it comes to the labor market, because it's such a key cog in the U.S. economy."

STOCK SPOTLIGHT

Freeport-McMoRan
U.S. and overseas mining stocks rallied after President Trump confirmed copper tariffs will take effect Aug. 1. Freeport-McMoRan shares rose more than 3%.

MP Materials
The U.S.'s biggest rare-earth miner struck a deal in which the Defense Department will take a 15% stake in the company. Shares soared more than 50%.

WK Kellogg
The Italian candy maker behind Ferrero Rocher agreed to buy the cereal conglomerate for about $3 billion. Shares of Kellogg surged nearly 31%.

Delta Air Lines
The carrier reported a leap in profit and forecast a stronger third quarter than expected. The stock rallied 12%, with United Airlines rising 14%.

Conagra Brands
The company behind Slim Jim and Swiss Miss hot chocolate posted disappointing quarterly results, and forecast that tariffs would add $200 million to its annual costs. Shares dropped more than 4%.

Embraer
Shares of the Brazilian jet maker sold off nearly 4% after President Trump threatened Latin America's biggest nation with 50% tariffs. The company has a large U.S. business.

Coinbase
Shares of the crypto exchange operator advanced by 4% as bitcoin added to its record price set on Wednesday.

AUCTION RESULTS

Here are the results of Thursday's Treasury auctions. All bids are awarded at a single price at the market-clearing yield. Rates are determined by the difference between that price and the face value.

FOUR-WEEK BILLS

Applications	$247,056,673,500
Accepted bids	$80,260,099,700
" noncompetitively	$5,913,095,400
" foreign noncompetitively	$0
Auction price (rate)	99.670611 (4.235%)
Coupon equivalent	4.308%
Bids at clearing yield accepted	90.97%
Cusip number	912797QJ9

The bills, dated July 15, 2025, mature on Aug. 12, 2025.

EIGHT-WEEK BILLS

Applications	$200,397,818,600
Accepted bids	$70,227,968,600
" noncompetitively	$1,842,949,000
" foreign noncompetitively	$100,000,000
Auction price (rate)	99.335000 (4.275%)
Coupon equivalent	4.363%
Bids at clearing yield accepted	64.92%
Cusip number	912797QT7

The bills, dated July 15, 2025, mature on Sept. 9, 2025.

29-YEAR, 10-MONTH BONDS

Applications	$55,034,067,400
Accepted bids	$24,603,117,400
" noncompetitively	$26,237,100
" foreign noncompetitively	$0
Auction price (rate)	97.817084 (4.889%)
Interest rate	4.750%
Bids at clearing yield accepted	60.85%
Cusip number	912810UK2

The bonds, dated July 15, 2025, mature on May 15, 2055.

Bitcoin Hits Record Price Level

Continued from page B1

too.

Some analysts worry that if such companies run into trouble, they could be forced to unload bitcoin, potentially setting off a downward price spiral.

In January 2024, regulators reluctantly approved the listing of exchange-traded funds that hold bitcoin—known as spot bitcoin ETFs—after a yearslong push by the crypto industry. Issued by the likes of **BlackRock** and **Fidelity Investments**, these funds make it easy for investors to hold bitcoin along with stocks and bonds in their portfolios.

The data show heavy inflows into spot bitcoin ETFs after Trump's election victory; in late April and May, when bitcoin was climbing its way back to a record and after the Senate passed the stablecoin bill in June.

In all, there is nearly $148 billion worth of bitcoin held in such ETFs, according to the Block Research.

Oil Demand to Rise Through 2050, OPEC Says

By Giulia Petroni

The Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries doubled down on its view that global oil demand will keep rising through mid-century and that there is no peak in sight.

In its annual report on long-term energy trends, the cartel nudged up its forecast, projecting oil demand will reach 113.3 million barrels a day in 2030 and nearly 123 million in 2050, up from 103.7 million barrels last year.

Oil is expected to hold nearly 30% of the energy mix, while combined with gas it will stay above 50% through the period. "Oil underpins the global economy and is central to our daily lives," OPEC said. "There is no peak in oil demand on the horizon."

Members of the group—whose economies rely heavily on revenue from oil exports—have traditionally taken a more-bullish stance than other forecasters. The International Energy Agency, which represents major oil-consuming nations including the U.S., instead expects global oil-demand growth to plateau by the end of the decade.

Thursday's report comes as oil prices hover around $70 a barrel, with market sentiment weighed down by uncertainty surrounding President Trump's tariff agenda and concerns about oversupply following OPEC+'s latest supersize output increase.

With the exception of coal, demand for all major energy sources is set to rise through 2050, with the largest increases coming from renewables—mainly wind and solar—and natural gas, OPEC said. Nuclear energy is expected to log a significant rebound after years of stagnation.

The bulk of last year's energy-demand growth came from surging electricity use, fueled by the rapid expansion of data centers and artificial intelligence, particularly in the U.S., Europe and China, the cartel said.

OPEC's demand outlook hinges on expectations of robust population and economic growth.

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HEARD ON THE STREET

FINANCIAL ANALYSIS & COMMENTARY

Health Insurers Have a Chronic Problem

Companies like UnitedHealth, Centene and Humana are getting squeezed between rising costs and a stingier government

Health insurance has never been a flashy, high-growth business. But for many years it offered something nearly as good: steady, dependable returns, fueled by the expansion of government programs such as Medicare, Medicaid and the Obamacare exchanges.

Lately, though, Wall Street has a problem with America's health insurers: They keep missing their numbers. What began as trouble in Medicare Advantage has now spread across nearly all government-backed plans, signaling deeper issues in the model itself.

After a rough 2024, insurers are warning that 2025 won't be better. The trouble started when industry giant **UnitedHealth Group** ousted its chief executive and withdrew its outlook in May, blaming higher costs in Medicare Advantage. Then, earlier this month, **Centene** pulled its guidance, citing a sicker-than-expected population on plans under the Affordable Care Act, or Obamacare. And this week, **Molina Healthcare** cut its profit forecast, citing cost pressure across all its government plans, including Medicaid.

The trouble has sent shares of insurance companies plunging. This also comes as the recently passed tax-and-spending package is set to cut more than $1 trillion in healthcare spending over a decade.

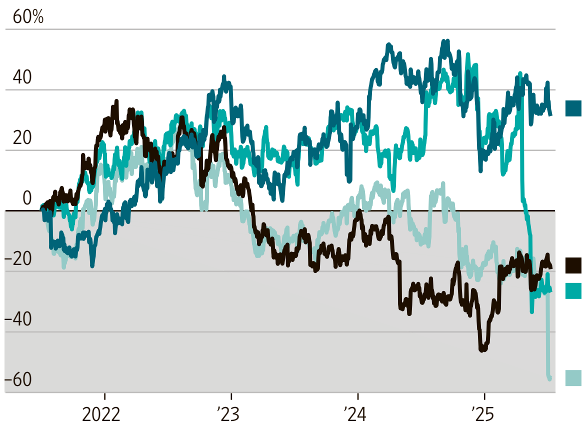
Some might see an opportunity to buy the dip. But value can only be measured if you can trust company numbers—and increasingly, investors can't. "Against a backdrop in which executives are being increasingly challenged by sharp changes in the industry, it becomes harder for investors to make educated decisions," said Jared Holz, healthcare strategist at Mizuho Securities.

The core problem is that the assumptions insurers rely on to price plans—how many people will enroll, how sick they will be and how much care they will use—are no longer holding up. Medical usage has surged and become more volatile in the postpandemic landscape. Changes to how insurers and providers are allowed to bill and code care have eroded margins for payers. And the mix of healthy and sick enrollees in government-sponsored plans is shifting, as millions fall off insurance rolls.

ALLISON BAILEY/NURPHOTO/REUTERS

The tax-and-spending package is set to cut more than $1 trillion in healthcare spending over a decade.

Performance over the past four years



Source: FactSet

Take Medicaid, a program that costs nearly $1 trillion annually. Enrollment ballooned during the pandemic, when federal rules barred states from removing people from coverage. Many insurers were suddenly managing millions of low-cost enrollees, some of whom didn't even know they had insurance. But with the unwinding of those protections, millions have been dropped, leaving behind a sicker and more expensive population, said John Selby, president of Rebellis Group, which provides consulting on health plans.

It might only get worse. The recently passed "One Big, Beautiful Bill" will further cut Medicaid enrollment with work requirements and more-frequent eligibility checks. Meanwhile, enhanced subsidies for ACA plans are set to shrink next year. As more people lose coverage, insurers could be left managing smaller, sicker and costlier risk pools—just as they are already struggling to price accurately.

The reasons each government program is struggling might differ, but the bigger picture is the same: Surging medical costs are outpacing what the government is willing to pay. J. Mario Molina, who was formerly chief executive of Molina Healthcare, founded by his father, put it simply in an interview: On one hand, insurers are facing skyrocketing expenses—from costlier procedures and rising nurse wages to expensive drugs such as GLP-1s. On the other hand, they can't pass those rising costs along to the government as easily as they once could, with healthcare already accounting for an exorbitant 17% of gross domestic product.

The challenges are leading some to retrench, giving up market share to recover profit margins. Others are walking away from some programs altogether, as **CVS** did when it said earlier this year that its insurance unit Aetna would leave the ACA exchanges. "It's difficult to control and predict costs, especially when revenues are flattening," said Mario Molina, who left the company in 2017 after running it for about two decades. "And the one thing Wall Street hates more than anything is uncertainty."

Over the past four years, most large managed-care companies have lost investors money. UnitedHealth, Centene, CVS, **Elevance** and **Humana** are all down over that stretch. Of the major competitors, only **Cigna** has delivered a positive return. The reason? It steered clear of the government-heavy business lines now under pressure. Cigna left Medicare Advantage and has focused instead on commercial plans sold to employers.

Cigna's success reflects a broader shift: Investors are no longer rewarding growth at all costs. Instead they are favoring restraint and profitability. CVS, which stumbled in 2024 after a poorly timed Medicare Advantage expansion, has seen its stock rebound this year by pulling back.

Molina Healthcare is a clear example of how pain is spreading across the government insurance system—it operates in all the major programs. On Monday, it warned of rising costs across the board, citing higher care utilization and tighter government payments.

"The short-term earnings pressure we are experiencing results from what we believe to be a temporary dislocation between premium rates and medical cost trend which has recently accelerated," Molina's current CEO, Joe Zubretsky, said in a written statement.

But how temporary is it really? With 2024 and 2025 already looking bad, 2026 is unlikely to be much better as many insurers look to retrench. UnitedHealth might not grow earnings over its 2024 levels until 2027, according to analyst estimates on FactSet. Humana might not return to its 2023 profit peak until 2028.

That has Wall Street asking whether this industry still deserves the benefit of the doubt.

—David Wainer

Recessions Are Rare, Worries About Them Aren't

Investors are always worried, sometimes about things that should make them happy.

For example, we fret about how many years the economy has gone without stumbling. It just seems natural that an expansion that has lasted very long must be living on borrowed time.

The good news is that economic cycles aren't like people—they don't die of old age.

And when expansions do end, the consequences aren't nearly as awful as they used to be, at least for Americans.

Whereas your savings could have been wiped out on several occasions when the country was young—there were the Panics of 1785, 1789, 1792, 1796, 1819, 1825, 1837, 1847, 1857, 1873, 1884, 1893, 1896 and 1907—crashes, bank runs and even recessions are rare now.

Americans are enjoying what would have been a record-long expansion before World War II. The previous one, ended by Covid-19, was the longest ever. Jim Reid, who heads macroeconomic research at Deutsche Bank, points out that five of the top seven were in the past 43 years.

That isn't a coincidence. Governments and central banks have been willing and able to boost a sagging economy since inflation has been tamed and globalization took off. And all those panics were before the Federal Reserve or deposit insurance existed. Back then, governments didn't even engage in automatic countercyclical spending like unemployment insurance.

Reid wonders if stimulus might flow as freely the next time the economy needs it, though. Federal borrowing has mushroomed and shows no sign of slowing with tax cuts just signed into law. That has spooked the Treasury market on a few occasions recently.

Even if plenty of cash is forthcoming from Washington the next time the economy swoons, what if it results in higher bond yields? They normally fall when a recession hits, cushioning retirement portfolios and lowering the costs of mortgages and corporate loans.

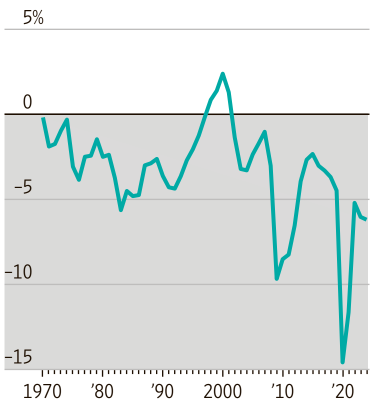
The Fed might not come to the rescue as readily either, Reid says. If inflation is higher because of protectionism and demographic challenges, central banks could be cautious about cutting rates.

And then there's a danger that really might be an indirect result of such a long period of smooth sailing. While expansions don't die of old age, former Fed Chair Ben Bernanke once joked they can "get murdered."

Overconfidence makes policy mistakes like keeping interest rates too high or entering into a trade war more likely.

And, as we saw with the tech and housing busts, confidence also encourages excesses to build up as investors project growth to infinity. Valuations get silly and credit too loose, making downturns more painful.

U.S. budget deficit as percentage of gross domestic product



Source: Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis

With stocks so expensive and credit spreads so tight, maybe it's healthy for investors to be a bit worried.

—Spencer Jakab

BUSINESS & FINANCE

Orsted Secures Financing for a Taiwan Wind Farm

ANN WANG/REUTERS

Orsted's preassembly site in Taichung Port, Taichung, Taiwan.

By Dominic Chopping

Orsted is pushing ahead with an offshore project in Asia as renewables companies face increasingly onerous regulatory headwinds in the U.S. and higher interest rates in Europe.

The Danish renewable-energy company said Thursday that it had secured more than $3 billion in project financing for the Greater Changhua 2 wind farm offshore Taiwan.

Orsted said it has reached financial close on a project-finance package with 25 banks and five export-credit agencies to raise around 90 billion New Taiwan dollars, or $3.08 billion, for the 632-megawatt project.

In January, the company's shares sank after it announced a $1.7 billion impairment amid higher costs at a U.S. project and increased financing costs.

The Sunrise Wind project off the coast of New York was navigating supply chain and construction challenges, Orsted said, which resulted in delays and increased costs and led to an impairment of 4.3 billion Danish kroner, or $600.3 million.

The industry has faced headwinds since the inauguration of President Trump, who has been vocal in opposing wind as an energy source due to cost, security and environmental concerns.

In April, Norwegian energy group **Equinor** suspended construction activities at its Empire Wind project off the coast of New York following a halt-work order from the U.S. government.

The order was lifted a month later, allowing work on the project, which is about 30% complete, to continue.

In May, Orsted said it was discontinuing a wind project in the U.K. due to rising costs, and warned that the closure would hurt earnings this year.

It said the halting of its Hornsea 4 offshore project was expected to incur costs of 3.5 billion to 4.5 billion Danish kroner, which would in turn hit earnings. Rising supply-chain costs and higher interest rates were among the adverse developments that prompted its decision, the company said.

The Taiwan agreement announced on Thursday is part of the project's financing structure, which sees Orsted simultaneously progress with an equity divestment of the wind farm, which is expected to be completed once the project is operational.

Greater Changhua 2 is comprised of both Greater Changhua 2a, which is operational, and Greater Changhua 2b, which is currently under construction and is expected to be commissioned toward the end of 2025.

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$49.5 Million A circa-1930s house near the Playboy Mansion in L.A. lists. **M4**

MANSION

Ketchum Idaho town has historic vibes and pricey mountain homes. **M5**

Stan and Jimmie Duda with their $2.5 million Newell motor coach at Hearthside Grove Motorcoach Resort in Petoskey, Mich.

KEITH KING FOR WSJ (4); KENNETH POLLICH/MOTORCOACH COUNTRY CLUB

RV Parks Go Upscale

Million-dollar parking spots and resort-like amenities, such as private pools, casitas and fire pits, are driving up costs at motor coach communities across the country

Motorcoach Country Club in Indio, Calif.

By Robyn A. Friedman

Angie Skinner, 53, a SiriusXM host, and her husband, Mike Skinner, 67, a former Nascar Truck Series champion, own a 55-by-200-foot lot with views of the Blue Ridge Mountains at Mountain Falls Luxury Motorcoach Resort in Lake Toxaway, N.C. The couple paid $239,000 for their lot in 2016 and over $1 million to custom-build a spacious two-bedroom cabin with a host of luxury perks: Thermador appliances, a butler's pantry, a built-in bar with a backlit onyx wall, a glass-enclosed wine cellar and even a built-in feeding station for their rescue Doberman, Clyde. During the summer and fall, when they are not on the road and living in what Angie calls "our home on wheels," they stay in the cabin.

These for-sale RV lots offer more than just a guaranteed spot to park your RV. They provide owners with a home base and a sense of community, something many RVers lack once they sell their homes and hit the road full time. Plus, when the lots aren't in use, they can serve as investment properties, providing owners with a passive income stream if rented and the possibility of appreciation if they are sold.

"We came for a visit and were only supposed to be there for a week, but we fell in love with it, and Mike

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Meet the Army of Staffers Who Manage The Homes of the Ultrarich

It takes a village (and sometimes millions of dollars) to keep luxury properties running smoothly

By E.B. Solomont

AS A PROPERTY MANAGER to the 1%, Sarah Korpela's duties over the years have ranged from mundane to whimsical to downright bizarre.

She has tuned bicycles and picked up takeout, planned parties and cleaned up parties. One Christmas Eve in Aspen, Colo., she bought a vintage Rolls-Royce for a client's girlfriend, only to have the client skid off the road into a ditch four days later. (The client was unharmed.)

Not long after, Korpela helped the same client move out of his roughly 10,000-square-foot house and sell seven of his cars, five ATVs, seven motorcycles and a few horses. She also sold his $1 million wine collection to a local restaurant (for about $400,000)—but she put her foot down when the client asked her to ship his gun collection to him overseas. "There's something called trafficking," she recalled telling him. She sold the guns instead. "If it's legal, I have done it in this business," said Korpela, president of Luxury Estate Managers of Aspen.

Please turn to page M6

GIULIA NERI

A critical part of mansion management is being ready when the client visits—whether staff are given five minutes', five days' or five months' notice. 'My staff are go-ready at all times,' said estate manager Sarah Korpela.

INSIDE STORY

Post Cancer Treatment, She Got a Dream Home

Emily Kwan didn't let breast cancer stop her from creating the San Francisco home she always wanted—and getting a dog

By Nancy Keates

After Emily Kwan finished breast cancer treatment, she decided she didn't want to wait anymore to live the way she wanted. Specifically, she wanted pets and she wanted to be in downtown San Francisco.

"I was thinking that I don't know how long I'll live and I want to enjoy what I can right now. I told myself I want to speak up for myself," said Kwan, 55, who is a stay-at-home mom and an artist.

Kwan and her husband, Wing Lui, 73, who owns a hair salon in Pacific Heights, were living in an area on the outskirts of the city called Sutro Heights because he wanted to be by the ocean. They had no pets because he convinced her it was too much work, said Kwan.

The first step she took after her cancer treatment was finished in 2015 was to get a white dog she named Ricey. In 2016, she bought a $2.42 million, 1,924-square-foot, two-story, two-bedroom house on a peaceful street in Telegraph Hill, a neighborhood that is in the city. She told her husband that she'd love for him to move there with her, but if he didn't want to, that was OK. "I can't waste my time anymore," she said.

$8 MILLION
Home price plus costs to turn it into three bedrooms, four levels

Lui agreed to move there. He didn't want to leave his house by the sea, where he could smell the ocean and see dramatic sunsets, he said. But he knew it was important to Kwan. "As long as she enjoys it, I will be fine," he said. "With life there are different stages and you do different things." The same philosophy applied to the pets: They are a lot of work, but it is impossible to dislike animals, he said.

The couple decided to renovate the house on Telegraph Hill, spending around $8 million, including the cost of the original home, furniture and fees, to turn it into a modern, four-level, three-bedroom house. The project added a roof deck that has views of the San Francisco Bay, the Golden Gate Bridge, Alcatraz and downtown. In April 2024, they moved in with their two children, who are 16 and 18. They now have two dogs and a cat.

Kwan hired Vivian Lee, a partner with Robert Edmonds at San Francisco architectural firm Edmonds + Lee and a fellow mom from her children's school. The main design goal for the house was to create spaces for privacy, restoration, serenity, quiet and family unity, says Kwan. Each level has private and public spaces, as well as visual and physical access to the outdoors.

Edmonds + Lee designed a plan that created a new floor by excavating below the house. The bottom level is now a family room with glass pocket doors that open to a backyard with concrete and wood walls, a water fountain and a garden landscaped with small trees and flowers.

On the second floor, a narrow hallway with a TV room alcove leads to Kwan and Lui's son's room, which has a balcony overlooking the yard below. On the other end of the hall is an office that the couple shares, sparsely decorated with a large Arun Patel Studio photo of the Chinese region of Huangshan, a desk and two nubby white chairs from Italian company Porro.

San Francisco architectural firm Edmonds + Lee designed the home for privacy, restoration, serenity, quiet and family unity.

Their daughter's room is on the third floor, down the hall from the main suite, which has a large bedroom in various hues of taupe and white, with a large B&B Italia bed and an alcove area with a desk. The windows, which have views of the Bay, are accented with sheer gray curtains to emphasize the feeling of a sanctuary; the bathroom is almost all white marble. "We definitely didn't want high contrast moments, with black and white or bright colors," Lee said. "That's not a good environment for someone to come home and decompress."

The kitchen, on the fourth floor, is designed by Boffi. On one side of the room is a gray velvet banquette and a large oval table where Kwan holds weekly dinners and card games with friends. The living room has a glass wall at one end with a pocket door that leads out to a patio. Kwan's two paintings of fog and a clearing sky are above a long white sofa.

Kwan was raised in Hong Kong, where her mother still lives, by parents who made a living in real-estate development. When she was 13, she was sent to boarding school in Los Angeles, and when she was 15, she went to live with her college-aged brother and sister in a house the family owned in San Francisco while she attended high school. She studied hotel management but never got a college degree because she moved to Hong Kong to help run her parents' business. She and her first husband opened a Japanese restaurant there before getting divorced in 2003.

After the divorce, Kwan moved back to San Francisco. She'd known Lui since she was 15—he had cut her hair when she was a teen. They reconnected and married in 2005.

Now that the family is settled, Kwan says her children don't ever want to leave the new home, which is fine by her. "I enjoy everything more now," she says.

Emily Kwan with her dogs Ricey, right, and Charlie at the home she renovated. Glass pocket doors open to a backyard.

ANGELA DECENZO FOR WSJ (4)

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PRIVATE PROPERTIES

A California Ranch With Four Greenhouses and a Party Barn

In 2014, tech entrepreneur Don McKinney found himself at a crossroads. After four consecutive startups—including one that sold to Lucent Technologies for billions of dollars—he could launch another business, or pursue an entirely different type of project.

He chose the latter. He purchased a roughly 1,100-acre ranch in Sonoma, Calif., for $12 million and painstakingly restored it, spending $33 million over the years. Now McKinney is looking to sell the ranch, which has multiple residences, two lakes, four greenhouses and a custom wood shop, for around $50 million.

Known as Sonoma Summit Ranch, the ranch is perched at the top of Sonoma Mountain about an hour from San Francisco.

A Florida native, McKinney started his tech career in Silicon Valley in the 1980s as a founding vice president of sales at Silicon Graphics, which worked on 3D imaging. In 1991, he founded International Network Services, which was acquired by Lucent in 1999 for $3.7 billion.

By the mid-2000s, McKinney, a conservation advocate, was looking for a ranch to preserve when he heard about an available 1,119-acre ranch that had been owned by a single family for years. By sheer coincidence, McKinney, an avid fisherman, had caught a 1,119-pound marlin in a fishing tournament a few years earlier. He took the parallel as a sign and bought the property.

FOR SALE
AROUND
$50 MILLION
5,200-sq.-ft. wood shop, two lakes

The ranch hadn't been touched in years, McKinney said, and he relished the opportunity to dig in.

After tackling the ranch infrastructure he turned to the main house, originally built in the 1950s. "Many windows did not close," he said. "It was not clear where the front door was located." He took the roughly 4,240-square-foot house down to the studs and rebuilt it.

One by one, McKinney rebuilt other outbuildings, he said, including a circa-1930s cottage and a horse barn, which is now a party barn. A skilled woodworker, he also added a 5,200-square-foot wood shop, where he made the gates for the entrance to the ranch.

McKinney, who also has a home in the Bahamas, moved with his partner, Cindy Mercer, full-time to the ranch in 2016. He is selling so that he and Mercer can have more time and resources to devote to philanthropy. "Why wait until we kick off and then have our estate dole it out?" he said. "Let's participate now."

The market for prime ranches is strong, thanks to liquidity among high-net-worth buyers, said Bernard Uechtritz of Icon Global, which is marketing the property. "There's a lot of people hedging in land," he said.

—E.B. Solomont

JACOB D. ELLIOTT (2)

‘Arthur’ Creator Lists in Martha’s Vineyard

As an author-illustrator, Marc Brown’s art often imitates life.

In his wildly successful “Arthur” children’s book series, Brown modeled the lovable aardvark’s bedroom after his son’s room in Hingham, Mass. In his new animated TV series “Hop,” Brown reimagined a stone bridge on his Martha’s Vineyard property as the tucked-away home of a troll named Helga.

In the animated version, “I added a little door right under the bridge,” Brown said. “Then it was fun to imagine what’s inside.”

The real-life bridge leads to the entrance of Brown’s roughly 7.8-acre vacation home. For the past 37 years he has shared the compound with his wife, artist Laurene Krasny Brown. After purchasing the property for $700,000 in 1988, the couple spent three decades restoring the circa-1730s farmhouse and several outbuildings. There are

FOR SALE
$6.9 MILLION
7.8 acres, circa-1730s farmhouse, two artist studios

two artist studios; Marc wrote and illustrated about half of the Arthur books at the property, he said.

Now, itching for another restoration project closer to their current primary residence in New York City, the Browns are putting the Vineyard Haven property on the market for $6.9 million.

Marc and Laurene, who goes by Laurie, spent millions of dollars on improvements over the years, including adding a pool. “We’re both artists—we look at a space and it’s a composition,” Marc said. “It has the potential for objects to fill that negative space in a way that can make it more beautiful.”

The main house has five bedrooms and measures roughly 3,700 square feet. It was once part of a 225-acre dairy farm owned by oceanographer Columbus Iselin. The Iselin family farmed the property for four decades and housed child refugees there during World War II. “Our bedroom was a dormitory,” said Marc, who was told about the setup from one of the Iselin children.

The Iselins sold the farmhouse in 1976, put 75 acres into conservation and divided the rest into buildable lots for houses, which became a residential enclave known as Pilot Hill Farm.

When the original farmhouse came up for sale again in the 1980s, Marc spotted a small black-and-white photograph of it in the Vineyard Gazette newspaper. At the time, the Browns were living in Hingham and owned a smaller vacation home on the Vineyard.

Marc had grown up in Erie, Pa., and attended the Cleveland Art Institute before teaching art at Garland Junior College in Boston. In 1976, he was looking for a job when he dreamed up Arthur, while telling his young son a bedtime story. The character spawned a series of books and a TV show.

“I kept showing the photograph [of the farmhouse] to Laurie,” Marc recalled. “I had this restless spirit—I love restoring old houses.”

When the Browns bought the farm, it was in disrepair. To restore it, they hired a contractor but acted as the architects, drawing up plans and using orange spray paint to mark spots on the ceiling where lights would be installed. The couple chipped away at various other restoration projects and additions over the years.

Marc claimed space above the carriage house for his studio, where he built a standing desk and added storage for his illustrations. “I’ve got art from some 140 books,” he said.

Laurie—who collaborated on 14 nonfiction picture books with Marc before focusing on fine art—converted a former horse barn into a studio. She also works in a one-room shed where a previous owner kept a tractor.

Over the years, the Browns spent summers at the farm and habitually visited between Christmas and New Year’s Eve and for a week in the fall.

The property was always a second home—although they lived there full-time from around 2006 to 2008 when they sold their home in Hingham and moved to Laurie’s native New York City, seeking a new adventure away from suburbia.

Pilot Hill Farm is on the more developed eastern part of Martha’s Vineyard, but the enclave feels more rural, said Alexis Holden of Tea Lane Associates/Forbes Global Properties, who is marketing the property with colleague Elle Lash. Last year, a smaller property in Pilot Hill Farm sold for $4.574 million, records show.

—E.B. Solomont

Inventor’s L.A. Estate Hits Market

A circa-1930s estate just a few houses from the Playboy Mansion in Los Angeles is coming on the market for $49.5 million.

The roughly 8,000-square-foot, nine-bedroom estate was the longtime home of the late inventor Ronald Katz and his wife, Madelyn Katz. Ronald was best known for a series of patents that revolutionized automated customer service and telephones, and for making breakthroughs in credit-card technology, said his son Todd Katz.

Built around the same time as the Playboy Mansion, the Katz home resembles an English country house. With a tennis court and pool, it sits on roughly 1½ acres in Holmby Hills overlooking the Los Angeles Country Club. On Mapleton Drive, one of L.A.’s most storied streets, it is also adjacent to the former Aaron Spelling mansion.

It was the prestigious location that drew Ronald to the property in the 1970s. A real-estate hobbyist who enjoyed fixing up and reselling homes, his father perused the real-estate pages in the newspaper every week, Todd said.

The Katzes spent years renovating the estate before moving in, said Todd, who was leaving for college around the same time. They gutted the interior, choosing fin-

ishes in keeping with the storybook aesthetic of the exterior: wood paneling, a grand mahogany staircase and carved fireplaces.

The couple filled the home with art and collectibles from around the world. A game room includes an antique billiards table and vintage arcade games.

Also on display was Madelyn’s collection of pigs—stuffed animals, ornaments, sculptures and paintings. It started with just a few pigs but grew to become “her thing” as friends and family kept adding to the troupe, Todd said. The family plans to auction much of the home’s contents, he said, but will

FOR SALE
$49.5 MILLION
8,000 sq. ft., nine bedrooms, tennis court, pool

keep a few pigs. Madelyn died in 2009 and Ronald earlier this year.

The home’s price tag is justified by its position on the golf course, according to listing agent Stephen Shapiro of Westside Estate Agency. He is co-listing the property with his son Max Shapiro, as well as Jeff Pion of CBRE.

—Katherine Clarke

FROM TOP: DANIELLE MULCAHY/TEA LANE ASSOCIATES (2); ANTHONY BARCELO

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RICH ZIPS | A LOOK AT SOME OF THE MOST EXCLUSIVE ZIP CODES IN THE COUNTRY

Ketchum, Idaho 83340

By Jessica Flint

SURROUNDED BY MOUNTAINS in south-central Idaho, the Wood River Valley is a roughly 20-mile-long stretch whose key attraction is the historic Sun Valley Resort, built in 1936 as a ski destination. It's located in Sun Valley, a village that is one of the valley's four small municipalities. Nearby Ketchum, a former mining town, has a historic feel. Ketchum is the valley's main tourist city. It's also a destination for discreet wealthy home buyers. In May 2025, Ketchum's 83340 ZIP Code had a median home listing price of $3.72 million, according to Realtor.com. (News Corp, owner of The Wall Street Journal, also operates Realtor.com.) This makes it one of the country's priciest mountain towns, surpassed only by the areas around Aspen and Telluride, both in Colorado, and Jackson, Wyo. Ketchum's appeal lies in its privacy, culture and authenticity.

$3.72 MILLION
Median List Price (down 4% year-over-year)

86
Median days on market

$1,419
Median price per square foot

71
Active Listings (up 9% year-over-year)

Realtor.com (May 2025)


A house near the base of Bald Mountain, which is close to downtown Ketchum.

NOTABLE STOPS AND SHOPS

The Pioneer Saloon
This restaurant's current incarnation dates back to 1972. It is known for its classic American West ambience, steaks and Idaho-style potatoes.

Gold Mine Thrift Store
This thrift store opened in 1955 by the founders of the Community Library in Ketchum. It's a treasure trove of secondhand outdoor gear—skis, snowshoes, bikes, golf clubs, fishing vests—but shoppers can find a little bit of everything, including a lot of clothes.


Trailing of the Sheep Parade in Ketchum in 2024.

Sun Valley Museum of Art
Ketchum's vibrant arts scene—there is an art gallery on nearly every block downtown—is anchored by this contemporary museum, founded in 1971.

The Casino
Established in 1936, this late-night dive bar is an institution. Drinks are affordable. There are pool and foosball tables and a jukebox.

OUTDOOR PURSUITS

Bald Mountain and Dollar Mountain are home to two of the Wood River Valley's ski areas. Bald Mountain, otherwise known as Baldy, is very close to downtown Ketchum. It has more advanced ski terrain. Dollar Mountain, in Sun Valley, has more family-friendly skiing.

EVENT OF THE YEAR

Every July, the area draws attention for being the site of investment bank Allen & Co.'s media and technology conference, where titans of industry gather behind closed doors. But for locals, homespun traditions on Ketchum's Main Street define the year. At summer's end, the Wagon Days Big Hitch Parade rolls through town as part of a weekend-long festival. Come fall, the Trailing of the Sheep Parade marks the annual migration of 1,500 sheep through town, honoring the region's ranching heritage.

ADVICE FOR THE BUYER

"In the Ketchum area, properties range from ski-in/ski-out townhomes to single family homes right in town to properties further out that have more privacy," says Summer Baldwin, an agent with Sun Valley Sotheby's International Realty. "I recommend that buyers visit the area for themselves, because there are many different neighborhoods that all have different benefits. Until you spend some time here, you won't know what you prefer."

LISTINGS

$13.5 million
4 bedrooms, 6 bathrooms
This 9,217-square-foot property was remodeled in 2025. Updates include a new entertainment room. The lot is 1.62 acres. Agent: Sonya Johnston, Sun Valley Standard and Noah Hendricks, Sun Valley Real Estate.

$7.25 million
5 bedrooms, 6 bathrooms
Built in 2000, this 4,734-square foot house is on a 0.25-acre lot and is just steps to chair lifts on Bald Mountain. Agent: Sue Engelmann, Berkshire Hathaway HomeServices Sun Valley Properties and Evan Wyman, Compass.

$7.995 million
4 bedrooms, 4 bathrooms
Located on an 0.8-acre lot on Big Wood River, this 5,152 square foot house was built in 1988. The living areas have expansive water views. Agent: Martha Hausmann and Katherine Schroder, Sun Valley Real Estate, LLC.

CLOCKWISE FROM TOP: KYLE GREEN FOR WSJ; FELISHA AZEVEDO; JOSH WELLS/SUN VALLEY PHOTO (2); CAROL WALLER; VERONICA GRECH (MAP)

Managing Mansions

Continued from page M1

Upkeep on mansions is an expensive and a labor-intensive job frequently outsourced to an army of property managers, decorators, housekeepers, chefs, landscapers and more.

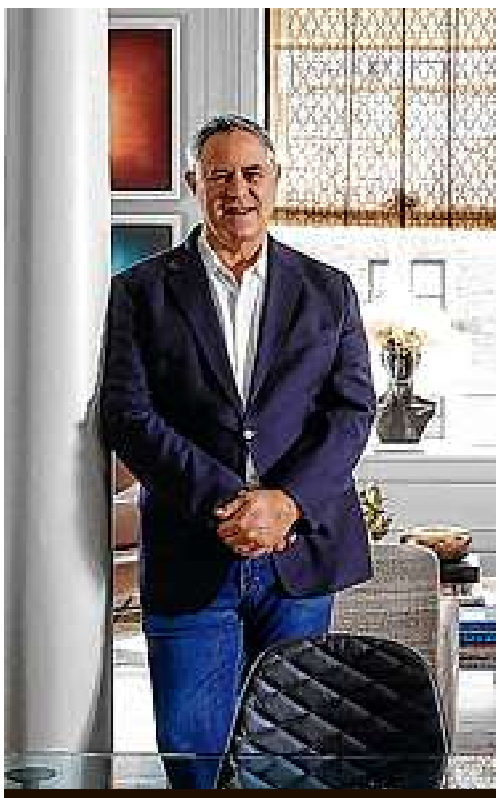
In recent years, demand for these jobs has ticked up as the number of ultra-wealthy households has swelled. In 2024, there were 2.2 million individuals in North America with a net worth of $5 million, up from 1.5 million in 2020, according to global wealth intelligence firm Altrata.

Affluent buyers have scooped up second, third and fourth homes that are increasingly larger and more complex; high-net worth families are willing to pay a premium to take care of these assets.

Some are forming "family offices" to manage a multitude of personal investments, from staff to property to charitable foundations. "It becomes a business," said Jamie Gagliano, a real-estate agent at Douglas Elliman who spent nine years as a chief of staff for hedge-fund executive Larry Robbins, according to her LinkedIn bio. She oversaw his homes and vehicles, including a helicopter. In general, she said, "we're talking about assets that are sometimes north of $10 million—each of them."

Typically, the hierarchy of staff includes a director of residences, who can earn $350,000 to $600,000 or more a year and oversees a portfolio of real estate. Often, wealthy property owners have full-time caretakers, jacks of all trades who changes lightbulbs and handles small repairs. "We


Real-estate agent Jamie Gagliano spent nine years as a chief of staff for a hedge-fund executive.


Andrew Sheinman designs homes for clients with multiple residences.


Sarah Korpela cares for Aspen properties when the owners are away.


Designer Bryan Graybill creates 'look books' for staff so they know how to style the home.


As an estate manager, Kelly Fore Dixon slept with her phone by her ear.


Healthcare entrepreneur Rob Vadas has someone take care of his Bentley when he is not in Florida.

CLOCKWISE FROM TOP LEFT: SARA FOX, GENEVIEVE GARRUPPO, SHERRI INNIS, BONNY VADAS, PAIGE RAY, ERIC PIASECKI/OTTO call it the ideal husband," said Peter Mahler of Mahler Private Staffing, noting the job can pay $60,000 to $200,000 depending on location, size and complexity.

The latest "it" job among the uber-wealthy is a tech specialist—effectively a personal Geek Squad—who makes sure the Lutron shades, Crestron lights and Sonos speakers are working, along with all of the televisions, remotes and high-tech appliances. The person, who can make $90,000 to $140,000 a year, is also responsible for all cellphones, computers and security-camera updates.

Regardless of the staff makeup, daily upkeep is constant. Even empty houses need to be inspected regularly, said Mahler, who had a client in the Hamptons whose house was left alone for four days during the offseason—during which time the ice maker leaked. Several inches of water pooled on the floor, causing millions of dollars worth of damage. "Everything was ruined, every leg of every chair, every piece of drywall," he said.

Luxury homeowners pay handsomely to avoid such scenarios. Someone with four homes can easily spend $1 million on staff annually, said Mahler, who said demand has gone up since Covid, along with staff wages.

GIULIA NERI (ILLUSTRATIONS)

CHIEF OF STAFF

Salary: $300,000 to $500,000+

Role: Atop the org chart, a chief of staff is the ultimate all-purpose adviser. Gagliano oversaw a 25-person team for Robbins. When hiring, she prioritized candidates who previously worked in hospitality.

Tales from the job: During Gagliano's tenure, Robbins renovated a home in New Jersey and added an indoor ice rink. She was heavily involved in the complex approvals process, and acting as an owner's representative with the team of architects and engineers sparked her interest in real estate. A perk? She learned to drive a Zamboni.

ESTATE MANAGER

Salary: $200,000 to $350,000+

Role: An estate manager oversees one or two large properties and handles everything related to the physical care of the house, from managing housekeepers to overseeing repair work and routine maintenance with vendors. Years ago, when Kelly Fore Dixon worked for the late Microsoft co-founder Paul Allen and managed his house in Beverly Hills, Calif., she slept with her phone by her ear. There were four other full-time staffers at the house at the time—a maintenance worker, two housekeepers and a gardener—plus private security and 80 subcontractors. The 12,000-square-foot estate had a recording studio, pool and 30 HVAC units, said Dixon, founder of consulting firm Estate Management Systems. When Allen was there, "silent and unseen was the protocol," she said.

Tales from the job: The house contained $50 million worth of artwork, including a Monet that was inadvertently sprayed with soda. "The art contractor came in for an annual inspection and said, 'What the hell have you done to the painting?,'" Dixon said. They pulled security footage to find the culprit. It was Allen.

HOUSEKEEPER

Salary: $60,000 to $150,000+

Role: Housekeepers are on the front lines of keeping beds made, clothing laundered, furniture dusted and accessories arranged to the boss's liking. "People are passionate about how their pillows look," said Korpela. "Do they like sheets ironed? Pillow straight or karate chopped? What's on the bedside table?" One client prefers toiletries placed in the identical position in multiple homes so that she can reach into a drawer without thinking.

Tales from the job: Healthcare entrepreneur Rob Vadas, who has homes outside of Cleveland and in Naples, Fla., said his housekeeper in Florida works four hours a week to keep their $3 million condo dust-free even if he and his wife, Bonny Vadas, aren't there. Before they arrive, she strips the beds and changes the sheets. If there is less than half a tube of toothpaste, she replaces it. "It's spic and span," he said.

Please turn to page M8

Continued from page M7

INTERIOR DESIGNER

Salary: Project-based fees

Role: An interior designer's job doesn't always end after the home is done. Graybill said he often creates "look books" for staff, so they know precisely how to make the beds, style the curtains and arrange accessories. When he returns to a project, his rate is $1,000 an hour.

When owners have multiple homes, they typically appreciate having the same exact mattress, linens and towels in each place, said Andrew Sheinman of Pembrooke & Ives. "It's creature comfort," he said. The closet layout may also be the same across multiple residences so it's easy to find things. To help maintain the look, some housekeepers travel with clients for consistency (i.e., to help unpack and set up the house per their exact preferences).

Tales from the job: Sheinman said he once had a client who showed him a photograph of a Moroccan-style chair that he liked in Architectural Digest, and said to him: "You see the chair? Now build the house."

CHEF

Salary: $100,000 to $300,000

Role: Fridge stocking, menu planning, cooking meals and sometimes helping to cater large events (all while accommodating myriad food requests). Many chefs travel with the family. "Before we know what food they do like, we want to know what food they don't like," said chef Mike Shand, co-founder of Elite Private Chefs placement agency who has cooked for Beyoncé and Adele. He said chefs keep copious notes on client preferences.

Tales from the job: Christian Paier, founder of Private Chefs, once had clients who insisted he buy three 1-kilo tins of Beluga caviar for a 70-person Christmas party—about two cans too many. Sure enough, the guests didn't finish a single can. At the end of the night, the staff was eating caviar by the spoonful to avoid throwing it out. "Of course I left them a kilo in the fridge, but who is going to eat that much caviar? It's impossible," he said.

DRIVER

Salary: $100,000 to $225,000

Role: Drivers handle everything from chauffeuring homeowners to routinely driving cars as part of their upkeep. Armed drivers double as security and earn even more.

Tales from the job: Rob and Bonny Vadas learned the importance of good car care the hard way. A few years ago the couple neglected to put a dehumidifying car bag in their white Bentley, which they left in Naples over the summer. The humidity took a toll and they returned to green mold on the white leather dashboard and seats. "If you're going to live there, you have to have a caretaker, a window guy, a car guy," Vadas said. "You have to pay to play and that's the truth." Despite a thorough cleaning, the Vadases traded in the Bentley. "I just felt like there was mold in there somewhere," said Rob, who disclosed the fungal fracas to the dealer. "They laughed and said, 'You're too honest.' "

LANDSCAPER

Salary: Varies

Role: Taking care of the landscaping of pricey homes is a year-round job, said Jay MacMullan, president of Mainstay Landscape in Cape Cod, Mass., who worked for the late heiress Rachel "Bunny" Mellon for years. Some of MacMullan's clients spend up to $300,000 to keep their grounds pristine. "You don't just mow it and take a hedge trimmer to it," MacMullan said. "They're paying for the fact that we know the difference between a Hosta and a crabgrass."

The offseason is packed with tasks like pruning and building stone walls, pools and patios. A "spring wake-up" typically includes weeding, mulching and planting, followed by clipping and pest management, said MacMullan, who once replaced $25,000 worth of flowers for a client after a rabbit mowed them down. (Mainstay covered the cost as a gesture of goodwill for the client.)

Tales from the job: A few years ago replanting wasn't an option when a client's hydrangea buds were ruined during a cold winter snap. The client wanted blooming flowers for his daughter's wedding so MacMullan sprung for fakes.

GIULIA NERI (ILLUSTRATIONS)

Luxe RV Living

Continued from page M1

bought a lot a day later," said Angie. "The biggest advantage of buying is customizing your lot to your specs and how you entertain."

Angie said she regrets not buying more lots when she had the chance because prices have appreciated. Empty lots that started at $190,000 are now reselling for a minimum of $1.5 million, she said. "That would have been a good retirement fund."

That increase in value, however, has led to a steep increase in property taxes. The Skinners' taxes increased from $5,000 to $23,000 over the past two years—a carrying cost they have to pay in addition to a quarterly homeowners association fee of $1,600 and $3,000 a year for homeowners insurance.

Ken Pollich, the on-site sales broker at Motorcoach Country Club in Indio, Calif., near Palm Springs, said that demand is strong for lots at communities that are in desirable locations and are amenity rich. He said that prices at the resort, where he owns two lots, currently range from $115,000 to $1.5 million and that 125 of the 400 lots have private pools. One lot, currently available for $1.2 million, has a 787-square-foot casita, as well as a resort-style pool with a grotto, two waterfalls and a hot tub, a fire pit with an onyx surround that illuminates at night, an outdoor kitchen and lush landscaping.

As for the investment potential of RV lots, Pollich said that waterfront sites that sold for $40,000 two decades ago are now priced at over $500,000. Rents at Motorcoach Country Club currently range from $160 to $255 a night, depending on the lot type and location, and renters are limited to a 30-day stay.

Stan Duda, 56, a retired business owner, and his wife, Jimmie Duda, 52, a retired accountant, live full time in their custom-built 2024 45-foot Newell motor coach, which cost the couple $2.5 million. It has a king-size bedroom, four air-conditioning units, one and one-half baths, a steam shower, an automatic toilet with a built-in bidet, heated wood floors and a dishwasher. The couple, originally from Texas, are in the process of selling their 4,400-square-foot home and now travel around the country, but they spend winters at Motorcoach Country Club in Indio and summers at Hearthside Grove in Petoskey, Mich.

"Buying lots, instead of renting them, is about elevating the experience for us," said Duda. "We don't just want a place to park, we want to have a beautifully designed space, resort-level amenities and a community of like-minded residents."

Duda purchased three contiguous lots at Motorcoach Country Club in Indio for $1 million, and he's spending an additional $600,000 to build a custom 1,200-square-foot casita, complete with chef-grade indoor and outdoor kitchens, spalike bathrooms and fully integrated smart controls.

While he hasn't yet built on his lot at Hearthside Grove in Petoskey, he is designing what he calls a "showpiece" that will feature a casita and coach house crafted for four-season use. Duda said the exterior will include heated patios, a chef's kitchen, a fire feature, water elements and lighting that will "transform the lot by evening."

But not all permanent RV lots

The 45-foot-long luxury motor coach owned by Angie Skinner and Mike Skinner is parked next to the couple's custom-built, two-bedroom cabin at Mountain Falls Luxury Motorcoach Resort in Lake Toxaway, N.C.

ALLISON JOYCE FOR WSJ (5)

turn out to be good investments.

Jeremy Puglisi, co-author of the "Where Should We Camp Next?" series of guidebooks, said that the RV industry as a whole has slowed down since the inception of the pandemic. "It felt like many companies in the RV and camping industries were printing money during Covid," he said. "Now, things have normalized."

While demand for permanent RV lots was strong at the height of Covid, when Puglisi said so many RVers took to the road full time that campsites were hard to find, many have returned home or become seasonal campers.

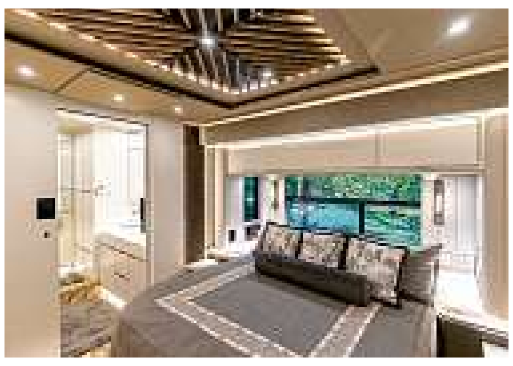
And while some RV resorts remain very much in demand because they are in popular vacation locations like Orlando, Fla., or Southern California, lots in other locations are facing challenges.

In November 2023, Wendy Heineke, 58, an outdoor hospitality consultant, and her fiancé, Jimmie Steinberg Jr., 56, paid $250,000 for a lot at Bella Terra Luxury RV Resort in Foley, Ala. The couple planned to spend winters at the resort in their 42-foot American Dream motor coach, but they later decided to get off the road and purchased a home. "We wanted to settle down," Heineke said. "Travel and full-timing were tough."

Nine months ago, the couple listed their 3,464-square-foot RV lot, which houses a small casita with indoor and outdoor kitchens, for $315,000. Since then, they reduced the price to $275,000, but there have been no takers. "I think it's because of the economic uncertainty and interest rates," Heineke said.

But the resort's inland location 15 miles north of the Gulf of Mexico, which the U.S. now calls the Gulf of America, may be a factor as well, said Kim Kirkendoll, a real-estate agent who holds the listing on Heineke's lot. She said that out of a total of 180 sites at Bella Terra, there are currently 41 for sale, a number she said is relatively high.

The kitchen in the Dudas' custom motor coach has porcelain countertops and an induction cooktop. Their primary bedroom has a projection TV with surround sound and a king-size bed.



KEITH KING FOR WSJ (4)

WHAT TO KNOW

If you're considering purchasing a permanent home for your motor home, here are some things to consider.

Try before you buy. RV resorts vary widely. Rent first at any resorts you're considering to ensure you find the best fit. Spend at least a week in each location to get a good feel for it. Duda suggests not only trying out different resorts, but also renting lots in different locations within each community to test out the views, breezes and movement of the sun in each spot.

Prepare for the costs. It may be a "parking spot," but for-sale RV resorts still have a homeowner's association to maintain the property. Duda pays dues of $760 a month for each of his three lots at Motorcoach Country Club. He said that taxes on the three lots are about $6,000 a year, and insurance is about $2,000. Duda said that insurance can be "a little challenging" to find, but an RV resort can direct prospective buyers to local agents providing the necessary coverage.

Check out the association. Do the same kind of due diligence on your RV lot that you would if you were buying a condo or a house in a homeowners association. Review the rules and regulations governing your ownership to make sure you're aware of restrictions that may limit your use of the property. Get a copy of the annual budget. Duda also suggests meeting the property-management staff. "Make sure the people are doing a good job of maintaining the assets," he said.

HOUSE CALL | ABBY ELLIOTT

Restaurant Servers Give Her a Wink, a Nod

'The Bear' actress on her grandfather's improv legacy, her famous father and getting fired from 'SNL'

Abby Elliott in Beverly Hills, Calif., in 2024. Below left, Elliott with her younger sister, Bridey, in the late 1990s in Wilton, Conn.

MY FIRST VISUAL MEMORY came at age 4, on the soundstage of "Get a Life" in 1991. My dad, actor-comedian Chris Elliott, played a 30-something paperboy who still lives with his parents. I was captivated by the set lights and everyone's laughter. What amazed me most was seeing others enjoy the funny, make-believe stuff he did at home.

Growing up, I lived with my parents and younger sister, Bridey, in a white, two-story house with black shutters deep in the woods of Wilton, Conn. A long gravel driveway led to a big flat front lawn where we played softball.

My dad met my mom, Paula, when he appeared regularly on "Late Night With David Letterman." She was the show's talent booker. Whenever Dad was on TV, we watched. Bridey and I were like, "Wow, you can do that?" He'd be away in Los Angeles for months at a time, but he frequently sent us faxes of silly drawings.

My parents never groomed us for acting or comedy. In fact, I don't think they wanted an actor's life for us and even discouraged it.

Out back was a horse trail that led to a farm where we pet horses. After we moved there when I was 6, my dad took me to a large rock by the creek. He said, "Well, this is where you'll be making out with your boyfriends." I rolled my eyes, but that's what happened in high school.

Early on in Catholic school, my face would turn bright red when I had to speak in class. Starting in third grade, everyone had to participate in plays, which forced me to overcome my shyness. By sixth grade, I wanted to play the lead.

After my freshman year of high school, we moved to nearby Ridgefield. Our new house was nearly identical to the old one, just slightly smaller and not in the woods.

At Danbury High, there were lots of kids from different places and upbringings. Cliques didn't exist. You got to know everybody.

I applied to NYU but didn't get in, so I had to choose between Juilliard and Marymount Manhattan College. Juilliard was too intimidating, so I went to Marymount but soon left. Their drama program was Broadway-focused. I wanted to be in front of a camera.

My plan was to move to Los Angeles. Dad encouraged me to try improv. His father, Bob Elliott, had been half the Bob and Ray comedy duo, which helped pioneer improv in the late 1940s. I studied his humor. His wit was so dry you didn't know when he was making a joke.

In L.A., I joined the Groundlings improv group and then the Upright Citizens Brigade. I was recruited in 2008 by "Saturday Night Live" when I was 21. I was on for five years. Then I asked to leave. Soon after, I wanted to come back, but producer Lorne Michaels had the final say, so essentially I was fired before I was rehired.

I auditioned for "The Bear" over Zoom immediately after Covid.

Today, I live with my husband, television writer Bill Kennedy, and our two kids in the hills of the San Fernando Valley in California. We moved here in 2021. It's a midcentury house, and our yard backs up on the hill and feels cozy.

Thanks to the "The Bear," I'm spotted at restaurants. We ate out recently, and five different servers gave me a wink and a nod. Their expressions said it all: "You know exactly what we're going through."

—As told to Marc Myers

Abby Elliott, 38, is an actress and comedian who was a cast member on "SNL" and co-starred in the 2018 film "Clara's Ghost." She stars in season 4 of Hulu's "The Bear."

FROM LEFT: ABBY ELLIOTT; EMMA MCINTYRE/GETTY IMAGES

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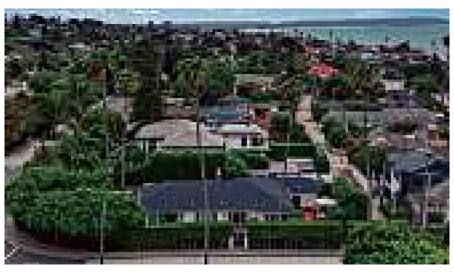

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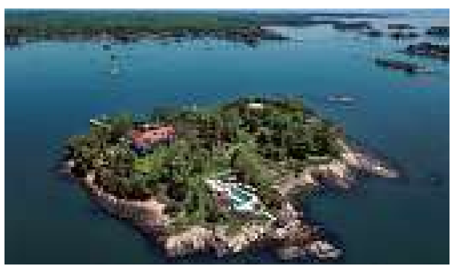

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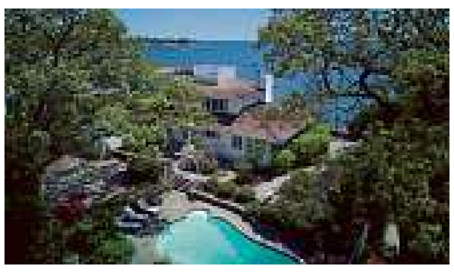

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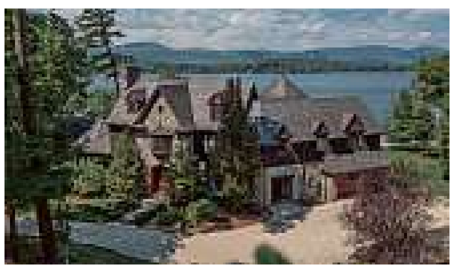

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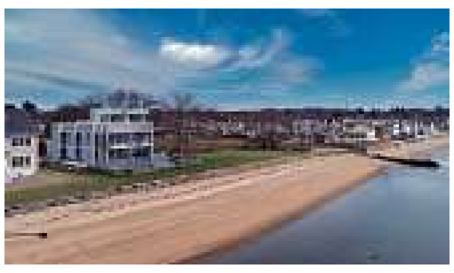

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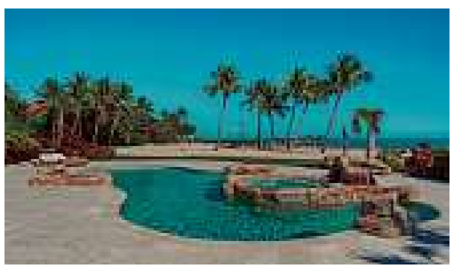

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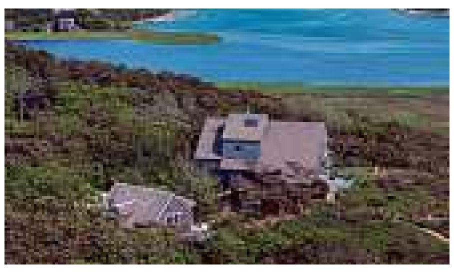

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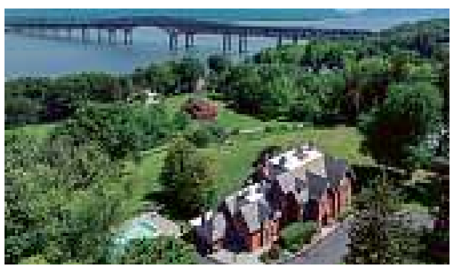

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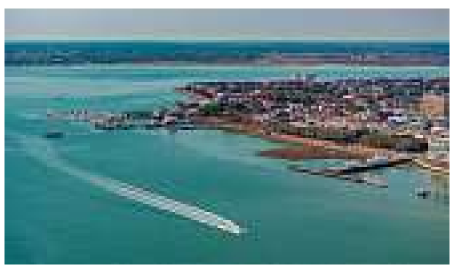

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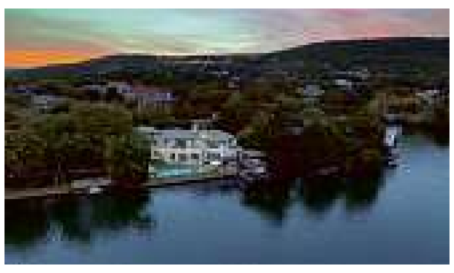

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